

A Free Introductory Grammar of Biblical Hebrew

Michael Malessa

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The L^AT_EX source for the book and a PDF file of the latest version are available at GitHub: <https://github.com/michaelmalessa/figbh>.

Preface

The Free Introductory Grammar of Biblical Hebrew is intended to enable students to read the Hebrew Bible with the help of a lexicon. Verbal morphology is introduced at a very early stage because of its importance in the grammar of Biblical Hebrew and the biblical texts themselves. The vocabulary includes almost all words that occur fifty times or more in the Hebrew Bible and a number of less frequent but important words. All exercises and examples are taken from the Hebrew Bible.

Special thanks go to my students at the Biblical Seminary of the Philippines in Valenzuela City and the Asian Theological Seminary in Quezon City for letting me try this introductory grammar on them in the academic year 2024–25.

With the plethora of Hebrew introductory grammars on the market the natural question is why another one is presented to the public. There are two reasons for this.

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Second, this grammar introduces the most frequent verbal forms including weak forms at a very early stage and uses only authentic Biblical Hebrew for the examples and the exercises. In this respect it follows the model of Ernst Jenni's *Lehrbuch der hebräischen Sprache des Alten Testaments* (4th ed.; Basel: Schwabe, 2009). This approach makes it possible to present authentic Hebrew sentences already in Chapter 3 and to avoid the pitfalls of self-composed Hebrew.

This book was typeset in $\LaTeX$ because of the capabilities of $\LaTeX$ and the fact that it is open source software and platform independent. The use of open source software is a prerequisite for a truly free work. This applies to fonts, as well. As a consequence, only fonts under a free license are used.

January 2026

Michael Malessa

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Chapter 1

1.1 The Hebrew Alphabet

The Hebrew alphabet consists of 22 letters, originally representing only consonants. Hebrew is written from right to left. One letter, the letter װ, represents two distinct consonants.

I	II	III	IV	V
א	אָלֶפֶת <i>ʾālæp̄</i>	ʾ	ʔ	1
ב	בֵּית <i>bēt</i>	<i>b, b/v</i>	bet, vet	2
ג	גִּימֶל <i>gīmæġ</i>	<i>g</i>	get	3
ד	דָּלֶת <i>dālæġ</i>	<i>d</i>	dot	4
ה	הֵא <i>hē</i>	<i>h</i>	hat	5
ו	וָו <i>wāw</i>	<i>w</i>	vase	6
ז	זַיִן <i>zayin</i>	<i>z</i>	zoo	7
ח	חֵת <i>hēt</i>	<i>ḥ</i>	Bach	8
ט	טֵת <i>tēt</i>	<i>ṭ</i>	ton	9
י	יּוֹד <i>yōd</i>	<i>y</i>	yard	10
כ, כּ	כָּף <i>kaṗ</i>	<i>k, k̄</i>	kite, Bach	20
ל	לָמֶד <i>lāmæd</i>	<i>l</i>	long	30
מ, מּ	מֵם <i>mēm</i>	<i>m</i>	map	40
נ, נּ	נוּן <i>nūn</i>	<i>n</i>	nun	50
ס	סָמֶךְ <i>sāmæḵ</i>	<i>s</i>	sun	60
ע	עֵיִן <i>ʿayin</i>	ʿ	ʿ	70
פ, פּ	פֶּא <i>pē</i>	<i>p, p̄/f</i>	pan, fun	80
צ, צּ	צָדִי <i>ṣādē</i>	<i>ṣ</i>	tsar	90
ק	קוֹף <i>qōṗ</i>	<i>q</i>	kaddish	100

Chapter 1

I	II	III	IV	V
ר	רֵישׁ <i>rēš</i>	<i>r</i>	run	200
ש { ש	שֵׁן <i>śīn</i>	<i>ś</i>	sin	} 300
ש { ש	שֵׁן <i>šīn</i>	<i>š</i>	shin	
ת	תָּו <i>tāw</i>	<i>t</i>	tag	400

Key to the Table

- I Hebrew letters in square script (with final letters after the comma)
- II Name of the letters in Hebrew and transliteration
- III Transliteration
- IV Pronunciation
- V Numerical value

Additional Information

The Hebrew term for alphabet is אֲלֶפֶת אֲבֹתֵי *ālāp̄-bēt* (abbreviated א"ב).

The pronunciation of the consonants is indicated by English words beginning with a corresponding consonant except for the letter ת. At times, the English word gives the pronunciation of the Hebrew sound only by approximation.

The second letter after the comma (when read from right to left) in the first column is the shape of the letter when it occurs at the end of a word. These letters with a distinct shape at the end of a word are called final letters or כְּמוֹנֵי *kamnappēš* letters.

The ר is pronounced with the tip of the tongue (as *r* in Tagalog).

The letter ש originally represented two distinct consonants, i.e., /ś/ and /š/. Traditionally, ש representing /ś/ is pronounced as a voiceless sibilant [s]. Its original pronunciation was probably that of a lateral-fricative sibilant [ɬ], i.e., a sibilant [s] combined with an [l]-element. The graphical distinction between /ś/ and /š/ was only introduced by the Masoretes by placing a diacritic point either on the right or the left upper corner of the letter. The result were two distinct letters (or graphemes) with /ś/ being represented by ש and /š/ by שׁ. Before the introduction of the diacritic points only the correct understanding of a text made it possible for the reader to distinguish between the two consonants. The letter שׁ is much more frequent in Hebrew than the letter ש.

It is important to distinguish letters that look alike and consonants that sound alike or identical in the applied reading tradition.

1.2 Bəḡadkəfat Letters

The letters ב, כ and פ have a double pronunciation in the table above. When they are preceded by a consonant or when they are doubled (geminated), they are pronounced as plosives whereas they are pronounced as fricatives when they are preceded by a vocalic element, either vowel or a reduced vowel.

	plosive	fricative
ב	<i>b</i>	<i>b̥/v</i>
כ, כּ	<i>k</i>	<i>k̥</i>
פ, פּ	<i>p</i>	<i>p̥/f</i>

Final פּ is always pronounced as a fricative. Final כּ is mostly pronounced as a fricative but it can represent a plosive sound, too.

In Masoretic Hebrew three more consonants had a double pronunciation, i.e., as plosives after a consonant or when doubled or as fricatives after a vowel.

	plosive	fricative
ג	<i>g</i>	<i>g̥</i> like <i>γ</i> in Mod. Gr. <i>γάλα</i>
ד	<i>d</i>	<i>d̥</i> like <i>th</i> in Engl. <i>this</i>
ת	<i>t</i>	<i>t̥</i> like <i>th</i> in Engl. <i>thing</i>

As a group, these six letters are called **בְּגָדְכַּפֹּת** *bəḡadkəfat* letters (אותיות בג"ד (כפ"ת)).

In Modern Hebrew, only the letters ב, כ and פ have a double pronunciation. This distinction is followed for the pronunciation of these letters in Biblical Hebrew. The double pronunciation of ג, ד and ת in Masoretic Hebrew is usually ignored.

In pointed (or vocalized) Hebrew (see the next chapter), a dot called *dageš* is added to *bəḡadkəfat* letters to distinguish the plosive pronunciation (with *dageš*) from the fricative pronunciation (without *dageš*).

1.3 Gutturals

The four consonants א, ח, ע and ג represent guttural sounds which means that they are articulated in the throat. (The term *guttural* is derived from Latin *guttur* *throat*.)

The letter א stands for the glottal stop. In English the glottal stop is found in the negative *uh-uh* and in Tagalog between the two vowels of the word *daan*. At the end of syllables it became silent (quiescent) in most cases, e.g., אבצ *šāḇā(?) army*. In this grammar, the quiescent א is transcribed (?) to indicate the presence of the letter א and the fact that it is no longer a consonant.

The ח /ḥ/ is a fricative sound that corresponds to /ḥ/ in Arabic, e.g., *Muhammad*. As in Modern Hebrew, the /ḥ/ is usually pronounced like the fricative כ *k* as the final *-ch* in the name of the German composer Bach or the Scottish-Gaelic word *loch* (as in Loch Ness, the name of a lake on Scotland).

The ג is the voiced counterpart to the ח /ḥ/. It is the same sound as the initial sound of the Arabic word ‘ayn “eye”. As in Modern Hebrew, the ג usually pronounced as the א. For a clearer distinction of the two consonants it is recommended to pronounce the ג with more force than the א.

1.4 Emphatic Consonants

The three consonants ט, צ and ק are called emphatic because they are “articulated farther back in the mouth in the region called the soft palate, and with greater tension of the articulatory organs than is the case for the non-emphatics” (JM § 5i).

	emphatic	non-emphatic
Dental	ט <i>t</i>	ת <i>t</i>
Palatal-velar	ק <i>q</i>	כ <i>k</i>
Sibilant	צ <i>s</i>	ס <i>s</i>

The emphatics ט and ק should be pronounced with more force or emphasis than their non-emphatic counterparts ת and כ to avoid confusion. The traditional pronunciation of צ as *ts* makes confusion with ס *s* impossible.

1.5 Semivowels

The letters ו and י represent so-called semivowels (also called glides or semi-consonants). Technically, the semivowels are considered consonants. Originally, ו was pronounced as a bilabial sound *w* as in Engl. *well*. In Modern Hebrew it is pronounced as /v/ as in Engl. *vase*. Its transliteration, however, is *w*.

Semivowels often interact with vowels by merging with them to form long vowels. This process is called contraction.

1.6 Vowel Letters

Originally, the letters of the Hebrew alphabet only indicated consonants. As a consequence, readers of Hebrew texts had to supply all vowels by using their knowledge of the language. Before 700 BCE, however, scribes introduced the use of three consonants for indicating vowels.

The letters ו and י are used to indicate long vowels in the middle of words and at the end of words. The letter ה only indicates vowels at the end of words. Originally, vowel letters were only used to indicate long vowels. The following vowels are indicated by these three vowel letters:

- ו *ō, ū*, e.g., יום *yōm* day, סוס *sūs* horse
- י *ī, ē, ā*, e.g., איש *ʾiš* man, בין *bēn* between, בָּנִיךָ *bānāʿēkā* your sons
- ה *ā, ē, ī, ō* (only at the end of words), e.g., אשה *ʾiššā* woman, זה *zē* this, הנה *hinnē* look!, כה *kō* thus,

When vowels are written with a vowel letter, it is called *plene* spelling (Latin *scriptio plena* from Hebrew מְלֵא כְּתִיב *kətib mālēʿ* full spelling). When vowels that could be spelled *plene*, are spelled without vowel letter it is called defective spelling (Latin *scriptio defectiva* from Hebrew חֲסֵר כְּתִיב *kətib ḥāsēr* defective spelling).

Sometimes, vowel letters are used for short vowels, e.g., כולם *kullām* all of them (Jer 31:34; the form is normally spelled כלם).

Traditional terms for vowel letters are the Latin *mater lectionis* (singular) and *matres lectionis* (plural) which are calques of the Hebrew terms אִמּוֹת קְרִיָּאָה *ʾimmōt qərīʾā* mother of reading (singular) and אִמּוֹת קְרִיָּאָה *ʾimmōt qərīʾā* mothers of reading (plural), respectively. In English, these terms are often shortened to *mater* or *matres*.

The letter **ס** is not a vowel letter in the same sense as **ו**, **י** and **ה**. At the end of syllables /ʔ/ often became silent – this happened always at the end of words – but was retained in writing so that vowels appear to be written with **ס**. The most common vowels preceding silent **ס** are *ō*, *ē* and *ā*, e.g., **רֹשׁ** *rō(ʔ)š head*, **לִמְוֹר** *lē(ʔ)mōr* (introduction of direct speech), **יִמְמָה** *yīmā(ʔ)*.¹

Unlike **ו** and **י** which can be used as vowel letters even in positions where there was no semivowel /w/ or /y/ before, silent **ס** only occurs where there was once a consonantal /ʔ/ (exceptions are possible).

1.7 Position of the Stress

In Masoretic Hebrew, most words are stressed on the last (or ultimate) syllable. Exceptions to this are nouns with originally two final consonants (see Chapter 2) and a number of verbal forms.

In this grammar, the position of stress of a Hebrew word is indicated by the sign ˈ on the stressed syllable when it is useful, e.g., **בְּאֶרֶץ** *bāʾāræʃ in the land*. Penultimate stress of pausal forms is marked with the accent *atnaḥ* even when the form has a different accent in the Masoretic text, e.g., **וְהָיָה**.²

1.8 Numerical Values of Letters

The numerical value for Hebrew letters is a feature of postbiblical times. In Hebrew inscriptions from the First Temple period, hieratic number signs were used. In extant biblical manuscripts, number words are used instead of number signs. In English, this corresponds to using the word *seventy* for the number 70.

1.9 Exercises

1.9.1 Proper Nouns without Vowel Letters

Identify the following proper nouns from the Hebrew Bible. The names do not contain vowel letters; every Hebrew character indicates a consonant. Use the vowels a, e, i, o, u (as they sound in Tagalog). Syllables in Hebrew always begin with a consonant; only one vowel may follow. Reminder: The letter **שׁ** may represent either the sound /š/ or the sound /ś/.

¹ In this grammar, silent **ס** is indicated in transcription by (ʔ).

² Pausal forms are special forms in certain positions of a verse (cf. Ch. 2.12).

Names of Persons

- 1 אברהם 2 אבשלם 3 אדם 4 אהרן 5 אחאב 6 אסף 7 אסתר
 8 אפרים 9 אשר 10 בלעם 11 בנימן 12 ברק 13 גר 14 גלית
 15 דוד 16 דן 17 הבל 18 הגר 19 חגי 20 יעקב 21 יפת 22 יפתח
 23 יצחק 24 ירבעם 25 ישראל 26 כלב 27 לבן 28 למך 29 מנחם
 30 מרים 31 נבכדנצר 32 נעמן 33 נתן 34 נתנאל 35 עשו 36 קין
 37 רחבעם 38 רחל 39 שם 40 תמר

Geographical Names

- 1 אררט 2 באר שבע 3 גלגל 4 גלעד 5 גת 6 דמשק 7 דן 8 חרן
 9 ירדן 10 כנען 11 כרמל 12 מדין 13 סדם 14 עדן 15 שכם

1.9.2 Proper Nouns with Vowel Letters

Identify the following proper nouns with vowel letters from the Hebrew Bible. Use the vowels a, e, i, o, u (as they sound in Tagalog). Syllables in Hebrew always begin with a consonant; only one vowel may follow. The ending יהו- is to be pronounced -yáhu with the stress on the penultimate syllable. It is a short form of the name of God יהוה that is used as final element in proper nouns.

Reminder: The letter ש may represent either the sound /š/ or the sound /ś/.

Names of Persons

- 1 אביגיל 2 אבימלך 3 אבשלום 4 אליהו 5 אליעזר 6 אלישע 7 ברוך
 8 גדעון 9 דויד 10 זבולן 11 זכריהו 12 חנה 13 חפני 14 יאשיהו
 15 יהוא 16 יהודה 17 יהונתן 18 יהורם 19 יהושע 20 יהושפט
 21 יואב 22 יואל 23 יונה 24 יוסף 25 ירמיהו 26 ישעיהו 27 לאה
 28 לוט 29 לוי 30 מיכל 31 מנשה 32 משה 33 נחמיה 34 נעמי
 35 נפתלי 36 עזרא 37 עלי 38 עמוס 39 פינחס 40 צפניה 41 ראובן
 42 רבקה 43 רות 44 שאול 45 שלמה 46 שמואל 47 שמעון 48 שמעי
 49 שמשון 50 שרה

Geographical Names

- 1 אדום 2 אור 3 אשור 4 בית אל 5 חברון 6 יריחו 7 לבנון
 8 לכיש 9 מגדו 10 מואב 11 סיני 12 עמון 13 עמרה 14 ציון
 15 שמרון

Chapter 1

1.9.3 Modern Hebrew

Identify the following foreign words in Modern Hebrew (with and without vowel letters). You know them from English or Tagalog.

Foreign Words in Modern Hebrew without Vowel Letters

1 בנק 2 בר 3 גז 4 גנרל 5 טנק 6 מגנט 7 מטר 8 סלט 9 פנתר
10 פרק 11 צמנט

Foreign Words in Modern Hebrew with Vowel Letters

1 שימפנזה 2 גורילה 3 פינגווין 4 קנגורו 5 יגואר 6 סטודנט 7 פרופסור
8 דוקטור 9 מיניסטר 10 דיפלומט 11 קונסול 12 בישוף 13 מונרך
14 מיליונר 15 אידיוט 16 דמוקרט 17 טרוריסט 18 סוציאליסט
19 קומוניסט 20 אופוזיציה 21 אופטימיסט 22 פסימיסט 23 ריאליסט
24 פרוטסטנט 25 לוקמוטיב 26 רדיו 27 טלפון 28 פילם 29 הומור
30 דרמה 31 קונצרט 32 קפה 33 קופיאין 34 תה 35 אלכוהול
36 קוניק 37 רום 38 פיקניק 39 שוקולד 40 מקרוני 41 ספורט
42 פינג-פונג 43 גולף 44 טניס

Chapter 2

2.1 The Vocalization of the Hebrew Bible

The Masoretes, the Jewish scholars who worked on the transmission of the Hebrew Bible between 700 and 1000 CE, added an elaborate system of vowel signs and other signs to the biblical text to ensure its correct pronunciation. Each vowel was now indicated by a sign. As a result, some vowels are indicated twice – once with a vowel letter and once with the vowel sign that was added by the Masoretes.

During the period from 700–1000 CE three different vocalization systems were developed, the Tiberian, the Babylonian and the Palestinian system. In the history of the transmission of the Hebrew Bible, the Tiberian system became the standard vocalization system. It consists of sublinear and supralinear vowel signs and additional signs to indicate the absence of a vowel, the plosive pronunciation of *bəḡadkəfat* letters and the doubling of consonants and other phonetic features. The Hebrew term for the vocalization system is נִקּוּד (vocalized נִקּוּד) *niqqūd*.

The existing biblical text to which the Masoretes added the pointing is often called the consonantal text. This term is not accurate because the biblical text contained vowel letters, i.e., letters that indicated vowels and not consonants. In this work, the term “unpointed text” is used instead of “consonantal text.”

2.2 Full Vowels

Biblical Hebrew according to the Tiberian vocalization system has seven distinct vowels. Originally, the vowel signs only indicated vowel quality but not vowel quantity (length). The Tiberian system was later reinterpreted according to another reading tradition. This reinterpretation is presented here.

I	II	III	IV	V	VI	
כִּי	i	i	i, ī	kit, breeze	חִירָק	<i>híræq</i>
כֶּי	e	ε	ē, e	bet	צֶרֶי	<i>ṣērē</i>

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I	II	III	IV	V	VI
הַ	æ	ε	æ, ǣ	hat	סֵגוֹל <i>səgōl</i>
חָ	a	a	a	cut	פָּתַח <i>pātaḥ</i>
חֹ	ɔ	a, ɔ	ā, ɔ	balm [ba:m], got	קָמֶץ <i>qāmæṣ</i>
חֻ	o	o	ō, o	as British law, got	חֹלֶם <i>ḥōlæm</i>
חֻּ	u	u	u, ū	rule	קִבּוּץ <i>qibbūṣ</i>
וּ	u	u	ū	rule	שׁוּרֵק <i>šūræq</i>

Key to the Table

- I Vowel sign
- II Masoretic vowel quality
- III Modern Hebrew
- IV Pronunciation and transcription
- V Approximate pronunciation
- VI Hebrew name

Notes

For grammatical explanations a simplified transliteration of the names of vowels and other signs will be used (*hireq, sere, segol, pataḥ, qameṣ, holem, qibbuṣ, šureq*).

Vowels are pronounced after the consonant they are placed with. The combination מַ, for example, stands thus for /ma/.

The approximate pronunciation does not distinguish vowel length. Vowel quality is indicated only by approximation.

The *qameṣ* indicating ā is called *qāmæṣ gādōl* (simplified *qameṣ gadol*). The *qameṣ* indicating ɔ is called *qāmæṣ qātān* or *qāmæṣ ḥātūf* (simplified *qameṣ qatan* and *qameṣ ḥatuf*, respectively).

For the vowel /ū/ the sign *qibbuṣ* is used when there is no vowel letter whereas *šureq* is used when there is a vowel וּ in the unpointed text, e.g., פְּקוּדֵיךָ and פְּקֻדָּיֶיךָ *your precepts* (Ps 119:15, 27).

The vowel *holem* is the only vowel sign that is placed on the top left corner of the letter (except with לְ, e.g., חֵלֶם *dream*). If combined with the vowel letter וּ the *holem* is placed on the וּ, e.g., לוֹט *Lot*. If combined with a silent א the *holem* is placed on the top right corner of the א, e.g., רֹאשׁ *head*. In some printed works the *holem* merges with the diacritic point of a following שׁ or a preceding שׁ. Examples: מֹשֶׁה instead of מֹשֶׁה; שֹׁנֵא instead of שֹׁנֵא *one who hates you*.

2.3 The Distinction between *qameš gadol* and *qameš qatan*

In the Tiberian vocalization system as it was intended, the *qameš* only represented the vowel *ɔ*. The distinction between *qameš gadol* and *qameš qatan* is the result of a later reinterpretation of the Tiberian vocalization system and is linguistically justified. A *qameš* is a *qameš qatan* (or *qameš haṭuf*) in the following cases:

1. In closed, unstressed syllables, i.e., before silent *šwa*, before *maqṣef* (see below) and before *dageš forte* (infrequent), אָזְנִי *ʾaznī* my ear (from sg. אָזֶן), שָׁמֹר-לָךְ *šəmōr ləḵā* keep (cf. שָׁמֹר without *maqṣef*), כֻּסְּתִי *kossū* they were covered.
2. In the first syllable of the plural noun קְדָשִׁים *qdašīm* (usually spelled with *meteg*) because of the vowel *ō* (< **u*) in the first syllable of the singular form קֹדֶשׁ.

The vowel *qameš qatan* *ɔ* always originates from a short /u/, whereas *qameš gadol* goes back to an original /a/ or – less frequently – /ā/. If a word has the vowel *qameš qatan* in a certain form, the vowel may appear either as *holem* or *qibbuš* in other forms of the word, e.g., חֹק *hōq* statue, חֻקִּים *ḥuqqīm* statues (pl.), חֹק *ḥoq* statue of (construct state).

Note

The plural of the noun בַּיִת *báyit* house is spelled בָּתִּים but pronounced *bātīm* with *qameš gadol* and a single plosive /t/.

2.4 The *šwa*

The sign *šwā* (simplified *šwa*) consists of two dots under the letter that are arranged vertically: ׀ . Phonetically, the *šwa* indicates the lack of a vowel. For the morphological analysis of words three different types of *šwa* can be distinguished, the silent *šwa*, the vocal *šwa* and the medial *šwa*.

2.4.1 Silent *šwa*

The silent *šwa* is used to mark vowelless consonants at the end of closed syllables except at the end of words, e.g., אַבְרָהָם *ʾabrāhām*, מִדְבָּר *midbār* desert.

In three cases silent *šwa* is found at the end of words:

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1. Words ending with the consonant /k/, e.g., מַלְאָךְ *mal'āk messenger, angel*, אֲבִיךָ *'ābīk your (fem.) father* (but אֲבִיכָא *'ābīkā your (masc.) father* with ך followed by a vowel)
2. Words with two consonants at the end, e.g., שָׁאַלְתָּ *šā'alt you have asked*, וַיִּשְׁתָּ *wayyēšt and he drank*
3. The independent personal pronoun אַתָּ *'at you (fem. sg.)*

The only words with silent *šwa* at the beginning of the word are שְׁתַּיִם *štayim* and שְׁנַיִם *šnayim* two.

2.4.2 Vocal *šwa*

The vocal *šwa* is used with the initial consonant of an originally open syllable in which the original short vowel was reduced, e.g., דְּבָרִים *words* (< **dabarīm* with a reduced vowel in the first syllable; pl. of דָּבָר *word* with two full vowels).

If possible, a consonant with vocal *šwa* should be pronounced vowelless. For the sake of convenience, the vocal *šwa* may be pronounced as a hurried *e* as in the first syllable of Engl. *atone* [ə'toun], e.g., בְּגָדִים *bəgādīm clothes* (with two plosives) as opposed to סְפָרִים, transliterated *safārīm*, pronounced [sfari:m] *books*. Vocal *šwa* is always transliterated *a* despite its vowelless pronunciation.

The following three criteria help to distinguish a vocal *šwa* from a silent *šwa*. A *šwa* is a vocal *šwa* in the following cases:

1. *šwa* at the beginning of the word, e.g., פְּרִי *pəri* [pri:] *fruit*
2. *šwa* following *šwa*, e.g., מִשְׁפָּטֵי *mišpātē precepts of*
3. *šwa* following a long vowel, e.g., שׁוֹפְטִים *šōpəṭīm judges*, אָמְרָה *'āmərā she said*
4. *šwa* with a consonant with *dageš forte* (see below), e.g., דַּבְּרִי *dabbərū speak! (impv. masc. pl.)*

2.4.3 Medial *šwa*

When two open syllables with reduced vowels would have to follow each other immediately, the first consonant gets a full short vowel (often /i/) and the second consonant gets a silent *šwa*. This particular *šwa*, however, does not cause the following *bagadkəfat* letter to become plosive, e.g., קִזְבִּי *kizbē* < **kazabē* *lies of somebody* (from קָזַב *lie*). In this respect this *šwa* is different from the regular silent *šwa* (cf. מִדְּבָר *midbār* above) and therefore it is called medial *šwa* or *šwa medium*.

2.4.4 Composite šwa with Gutturals

Gutturals do not take simple vocal šwa. Instead they take *ḥatef šwa* (also called composite šwa). When a guttural would have to take silent šwa, it is frequently replaced by *ḥatef šwa* of the same vowel quality as the preceding full vowel.

Vowel Sign	Transl.	Hebrew Name	
ְ	ă	<i>ḥatef pataḥ</i>	חֵטֵף פָּתַח
ֱ	æ	<i>ḥatef səgol</i>	חֵטֵף סֶגוֹל
ִ	ɪ	<i>ḥatef qamæṣ</i>	חֵטֵף קָמֶץ

Ḥatef šwa for vocal šwa is found in the following words: חֲצִי *ḥăṣī half* (cf. פֶּרִי *pəri fruit*), אֱמֶת *ʾəmət truth*, עֲנִי *ʿənī misery*.

Ḥatef šwa for silent šwa is found in the following words: יַעֲמֹד *yaʿmōd* < **yaʿmōd* he will stand, יֶאֱהַב *yæʿăhab* < **yæʿhab* he will love, יִצְמַח *yīʿmad* < **yīʿmad* he shall be placed.

At times, even non-gutturals may have *ḥatef šwa* instead vocal šwa, e.g., סוֹרְרִים *sōrārīm stubborn ones* (Ps 68:7).

2.5 The dageš

The *dāgēš* (simplified *dageš*) is a point in the middle of the letter: ׀. It has two functions. The *dageš* either indicates the doubling of a consonant or the plosive pronunciation of *bəgadkəfat* letters.

2.5.1 *dageš forte*

The *dageš* in a consonant with a preceding full short vowel indicates *doubling* (or *gemination*) of the consonant, i.e., its long pronunciation, e.g., רַקֶּב *rakkāb charioteer*, עַמִּים *ʿammīm nations*. When used in this way, the *dageš* is called *dageš forte* or רִנָּה חֶזֶק. A *dageš forte* in *bəgadkəfat* letters causes them to be pronounced as plosives, e.g., לִבּוֹ *libbō his heart*.

In the course of the history of Hebrew, gutturals and ׀ lost the ability to be doubled (with few exceptional cases of doubled ׀). As a result, the letters א, ה, ך, ם and ן do not take *dageš forte*. In Biblical Hebrew, the vowels preceding א and ך that stand in a position where other consonants would be doubled, are normally preserved unchanged despite the fact that they now are in an open syllable (see Syllable Structure below). Vowels preceding א and ם are usually lengthened (/a/ > /ā/, /i/ > /ē/, /u/ > /ō/) although preservation of the

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short vowel may also occur. Before ך the vowels are always lengthened (/a/ > /ā/, /i/ > /ē/, /u/ > /ō/). Examples:

רחום	<i>raḥūm</i>	< * <i>raḥhūm</i>	<i>compassionate</i>
רעים	<i>rā'im</i>	< * <i>ra'im</i>	<i>bad, evil (pl.)</i>
חרש	<i>ḥārāš</i>	< * <i>ḥarrāš</i>	<i>craftsman</i>

2.5.2 *dageš lene*

In *bəgadkəfat* letters, the *dageš lene* indicates the plosive pronunciation as /b/, /g/, /d/, /k/, /p/ and /t/, respectively. These letters are pronounced as plosives and are therefore marked with a *dageš lene* when they are

1. At the beginning of a sentence, e.g., כָּרַם הָיָה לְיָדַי My friend had a vineyard (Isa 5:1b)
2. At the beginning of a word following a word ending with a consonant, e.g., בָּנִים נָדַלְתִּי I raised sons (Isa 1:2a)
3. In the middle of a word immediately after a consonant, e.g., מִדְבָּר midbār desert, מִשְׁכָּב miškāb place of lying, מִשְׁפָּט mišpāt judgment

A *dageš* in a *bəgadkəfat* letter can be either be a *dageš forte* or a *dageš lene*. If a full short vowel precedes the *bəgadkəfat* letter, it is a *dageš forte*. In all other cases it is a *dageš lene*. The Hebrew term for *dageš lene* is דָּגֵשׁ קָל.

2.6 *Mappiq*

If the ך at the end of a word is not a vowel letter but indicates a consonant, it is marked by a point in the middle of the ך called *mappiq* (simplified *mappiq*). Examples: שְׁמָהּ šəmāh her name, מַלְכָּהּ malkāh her king (as opposed to מַלְכָּה malkā queen with the feminine ending -ā), אֱלֹהִים 'ēlōah God (with *furtive pataḥ*).

2.7 *Furtive pataḥ*

Words ending with the gutturals ה, ח and ע preceded by a long vowel other than /ā/ require the insertion of a short vowel /a/ before the guttural. This /a/ is called *furtive pataḥ*. It is placed under the guttural but pronounced before it. The *furtive pataḥ* is not stressed. Examples: מָשִׁיחַ māšīaḥ anointed one, רֵעַ rēa' friend, גָּבֹהַּ gābōah high, tall, רוּחַ rūaḥ wind, spirit.

2.8 Meteg

The *méteg* is a short vertical stroke to the left of the vowel sign. It indicates that the pronunciation of the syllable should not be hasty (*meteg* means *bridle*). It often marks the secondary stress of a word or expression. In some cases, it helps distinguish forms that look identical but are to be pronounced differently and have a different meaning. In biblical manuscripts the *meteg* is not used consistently. Examples: וַיִּירָאוּ *wayyirə'ū* and *they were afraid* (1 Sam 7:7; often the form is spelled plene וַיִּירְאוּ) as opposed to וַיִּירֶאוּ *wayyir'ū* and *they saw* (never with *meteg*).

2.9 Maqqef

The *maqqēf* line (simplified *maqqef*) or *linea maqqef* connects two or more words so that they form a stress unit with only one main stressed syllable in the last word of the unit, e.g., בֵּית־אֱבִיךָ (Gen 24:23). In many cases the last vowel of the word before the *maqqēf* line is changed, e.g., כָּתֹב *katob* write (impv.) and כָּתֹב־לְךָ *katob lakā* write (impv.) (לְךָ is < difficult to translate into English; Exod 34:27).

2.10 Syllable Structure

Biblical Hebrew has a relatively simple syllable structure. Most syllables are either open syllables that end in a vowel (or vocal *šwa* or *ḥatef šwa*) (CV) or closed syllables that end in a consonant (CVC). Doubly closed syllables ending in two consonants (a so-called consonant cluster) (CVCC) are infrequent; they only occur at the end of words. The following table gives an overview of possible syllables:

Open syllable	CV
Closed syllable	CVC
Doubly closed syllable	CVCC

For a proper understanding of syllable structure, the following notes are important:

1. Every syllable must begin with a consonant.

2. Open syllables (CV) include syllables with vocal *šwa* or *ḥatef šwa* for historical reasons. The vocal *šwa* or *ḥatef šwa* are the result of the reduction of short vowels.
3. In unstressed closed syllables only short vowels are possible.
4. In unstressed open syllables short vowels are not possible, only long vowels or reduced vowels are possible. An exception to this rule are cases of the loss of gemination in gutturals with preservation of the short vowel, e.g., **רחום** *raḥūm* < **raḥḥūm* *compassionate*.
5. Syllables with the structure CVCC only occur at the end of words and almost exclusively as the final syllable of verbal forms.
6. Exceptions to these syllabification rules are the words for *two* **שְׁנַיִם** *šnayim* (masc.) and **שְׁנַיִם** *štayim* (fem.) with two initial consonants.

2.11 Segolate Nouns

Biblical Hebrew words are usually stressed on the final syllable. A relatively high number of words, however, are stressed on the penultimate syllable. To this group belong a number of verbal forms and the so-called segolate nouns. As they are relatively frequent it is important to know the patterns of segolate nouns so that their correct pronunciation is ensured.

Originally, Hebrew had only three short vowels (/a/, /i/, /u/) and three long vowels (/ā/, /ī/, /ū/). The three originally short vowels /a/, /i/ and /u/ were subject to change over time. Segolate nouns give evidence to this.

Segolate nouns are originally monosyllabic nouns with a CVCC syllable structure. After the loss of the final short vowel indicating case (e.g., **malku* > **malk*) in an early phase of Hebrew, the resulting final consonant cluster -CC was broken up by insertion of a helping vowel (also called epenthetic or anaptyctic vowel). In most cases the helping vowel is *segol* (therefore the term *segolate nouns*). Three basic patterns (**qatīl*, **qitīl*, **quṭl*) can be distinguished.

<i>*qatīl</i>	מֶלֶךְ	<i>king</i>
<i>*qitīl</i>	סֵפֶר	<i>book</i>
<i>*quṭl</i>	קֹדֶשׁ	<i>holiness</i>

If the second or/and the third root consonants are gutturals or semi-vowels, segolate nouns have different vowel patterns than the basic patterns. Except for roots with the semivowel *y* in third position the stress is on the original vowel and thus on the penultimate syllable.

<i>*qaṭl</i>	מֶלֶךְ <i>king</i>
II gutt.	נֶעַר <i>boy</i>
III gutt.	זֶרַע <i>seed</i>
II w	מָוֶת <i>death</i>
III w	שָׁחוּ <i>swimming</i>
II y	זֵית <i>olive</i>
III y	גִּדִּי <i>kid</i>
<i>*qiṭl</i>	סֵפֶר <i>book</i>
II gutt.	נֶצַח <i>everlastingness</i>
III y	שְׁבִי <i>captivity</i>
<i>*quṭl</i>	קֹדֶשׁ <i>holiness</i>
II gutt.	פֶּעַל <i>deed, work</i>
III gutt.	רֶמַח <i>spear</i>
III w	תְּהוֹ <i>wilderness</i>
III y	חֲלִי <i>sickness</i>

It is important to be familiar with these patterns. When one encounters them in the biblical text with different consonants, one should be able to recognize the pattern as a segolate formation.

Notes

In segolate nouns of the *qaṭl* type the original vowel /a/ has been assimilated to the anaptyctic vowel /æ/, e.g., דֹּלֶת *door*. In roots with a guttural the helping vowel is usually /a/ because of the preference of gutturals for /a/.

Some nouns in the II gutt. category have the helping vowel /æ/ instead of /a/, e.g., לֶחֶם *bread*, רֶחֶם *womb*, אֶהָל *tent*, בֶּהֶן *thumb*.

The first vowel of pausal forms of *qaṭl* segolate nouns is usually changed to /ā/, e.g., דֶּרֶךְ *way* (context form דֶּרֶךְ; but מֶלֶךְ *king*)

In some nouns the vowel may shift from the position following the first root consonant to the position between the second and third radical, e.g., דְּבִשׁ *honey*, שֵׁכָם *shoulder*, בְּאֵר *well*.

Segolate endings also appear in polysyllabic nouns, dual endings of nouns, and verbal forms with an original final syllable with the structure CVCC, e.g., תְּכֵלֶת *purple wool*, נְחֹשֶׁת *bronze*, יָדַיִם *hands* (dual), וַיִּבֶן *he built*, וַיִּשְׁתָּחוּ *he prostrated*, יְהִי *may it be* (< *yihy).

Proper nouns can be segolate nouns or contain a segolate ending, e.g., יָרֵד *Jared*, קַיִן *Cain*, אֵלִיָּהוּ *Elijah*.

2.12 Pausal Forms

When the reader or speaker is supposed to slow down at the end of a sentence and pause briefly before continuing with the next sentence, the form of the word may slightly change at times. The meaning of the form is not affected by this. This happens frequently at the end of a verse or the middle of verse, but it may happen also in other places in a verse. These forms are called *pausal forms* as opposed to the more frequent *context forms*. The following changes may be observed:

- Lengthening of the stressed vowel, e.g., pausal form אֶרֶץ vs. the context form אֶרֶץ *to the ground*
- Change of vowel quality, e.g., pausal form אֶרֶץ vs. the context form אֶרֶץ *land*
- Stress moves to a different syllable, e.g., pausal form אֲנִי vs. the context form אֲנִי *I*
- Restoration of a reduced vowel which takes the stress, e.g., pausal form וַיֵּשְׁבוּ vs. the context form וַיֵּשְׁבוּ *and they sat down, settled*

In this grammar, both context forms and pausal forms are included in the explanation of forms. In the grammatical explanations, pausal forms are indicated by the accent *atnah* אֲ, e.g., אֲנִי. In quotations from the Hebrew Bible, the original accent is used.

2.13 Exercises

2.13.1 Proper Nouns with Vowel Pointing

Names of People

- Read the following proper nouns of people and give the English translation if possible (cf. the Alphabetical List of Proper Nouns).

b. Identify the syllable structure of the names 1–20.

These proper nouns occur frequently in the Hebrew Bible (more than fifty times; except the last five names from Genesis שָׂרִי, שָׂרָה, רָחֵל, לֵאָה, and רַב־קָה). They will not be referenced again in later chapters.

1 יִשְׂרָאֵל 2 דָּוִד 3 יְהוּדָה 4 מֹשֶׁה 5 שָׁאוּל 6 לֵוִי 7 יַעֲקֹב 8 אֶחָד
9 שְׁלֹמֹה 10 יְהוֹשֻׁעַ 11 יוֹסֵף 12 אֶפְרַיִם 13 אֲבִרָהֶם 14 בְּנִימִין
15 מִנְשֶׁה 16 יוֹאָב 17 שְׁמוּאֵל 18 יִרְמְיָהוּ 19 אֲבִשָׁלוֹם 20 יִצְחָק
21 יִרְבֵּעַם¹ 22 עִשָׂו 23 אַחָאב 24 יְהוֹשָׁפָט 25 יְהוֹנָתָן 26 חִזְקְיָהוּ
27 רְאוּבֵן 28 נָדָב 29 אֶלְעָזָר 30 דָּן 31 אֲבִימֶלֶךְ 32 אֱלִיָּהוּ 33 אֲבִיגַיִר
34 בִּלְעָם 35 אֲבִרָם 36 אֱלִישָׁע 37 יְהוּא 38 אָסָא 39 אִיֹּב 40 צְדָקְיָהוּ
41 אֶסְתֵּר 42 יֵאֲשִׁיָּהוּ 43 שָׂרִי 44 שָׂרָה 45 רַב־קָה 46 לֵאָה 47 רָחֵל

Geographical Terms

Read the following geographical terms and give the English translation if possible (cf. the Alphabetical List of Proper Nouns).

These geographical terms occur frequently in the Hebrew Bible (more than fifty times). They will not be referenced again in later chapters.

1 בָּבֶל 2 יֶרֶד 3 מוֹאָב 4 צִיּוֹן 5 אֲשׁוּר 6 שְׁמֶרֶן 7 אֲרָם 8 עַמּוֹן
9 גִּלְעָד 10 אֲדוֹם 11 כְּנָעַן 12 שָׁכֶם 13 בֵּית-אֵל 14 לְבָנוֹן 15 חֶבְרוֹן
16 מִדְּיָן 17 יְרִיחוֹ

2.13.2 Proper Nouns (Segolate Nouns or Segolate Endings)

Read the following proper nouns and give the English translation if possible (cf. the Alphabetical List of Proper Nouns).

1 אֲבִינִיָּל 2 אֲחִימֶלֶךְ 3 אֲחִינֵעַם 4 אִיזָבֵל 5 אֱלִיעֶזֶר 6 בַּעַז 7 הָבֵל
8 יָפֶת 9 יִרְבֵּעַל 10 לֵמָד 11 פָּקַח 12 קִין

2.13.3 Less Frequent Proper Nouns

Read the following proper nouns and give the English translation if possible (cf. the alphabetical list of proper nouns at the end).

¹ The second syllable is closed and unstressed.

Chapter 2

1 אָדָם 2 אָחִיז 3 אָמוֹץ 4 אָסָף 5 אֲשֶׁר 6 בָּרַק 7 גִּדְעוֹן 8 גִּלְיָת
9 הֶגֶר 10 הוֹשֵׁעַ 11 זְבוּלֹן 12 חֲנִי 13 יוֹנָה 14 יִפְתָּח 15 כָּלָב
16 לָבֵן 17 מְנַחֵם 18 מְרִים 19 נַחֲמִיָּה 20 נַעֲמָן 21 נִפְתָּלִי 22 נָתָן
23 נְתַנְאֵל 24 עֵלִי 25 עֲמֹרִי 26 רוּת 27 רְחַבְעָם 28 שֵׁם 29 שְׁמֵעוֹן
30 תָּמָר

Chapter 3

3.1 Vocabulary

3.1.1 Verbs

עָשָׂה	<i>he did, he made</i>
וַיַּעַשׂ	<i>and he did, and he made</i>
לָקַח	<i>he took</i>
וַיִּקַּח	<i>and he took</i>
נָתַן	<i>he gave</i>
וַיִּתֵּן	<i>and he gave</i>
רָאָה	<i>he saw</i>
וַיִּרְא	<i>and he saw (wayyar(?))</i>
שָׁמַע	<i>he heard, he listened</i>
וַיִּשְׁמַע	<i>and he heard, and he listened</i>

3.1.2 Prepositions

לְ	<i>to, for, regarding, also indicating indirect objects</i>
בְּ	<i>in, at, with (local and temporal)</i>
כְּ	<i>like, as, according to</i>

3.1.3 Nouns

אָב	<i>father</i>
אִישׁ	<i>man</i>
אֱלֹהִים	<i>God, god, gods</i>

Chapter 3

אֱלֹהִים	god, God (sg. of אֱלֹהִים; much less frequent)
אֶרֶץ	earth, land (fem.) (pl. אֲרָצוֹת; with the article הָאָרֶץ, pausal form אֶרֶץ)
בֶּן	son
בָּקָר	cattle, herd (coll.)
דָּבָר	word, matter, thing
דָּם	blood
זָהָב	gold
חֶרֶב	sword (fem., pl. חֶרְבוֹת)
יָד	hand (fem.; dual יָדַיְהוּ hands, pl. יָדוֹת only with figurative meanings)
יוֹם	day (הַיּוֹם as an adverb today)
יֶלֶד	boy
כֶּסֶף	silver
מִזְבֵּחַ	altar (masc., pl. מִזְבְּחוֹת)
מֶלֶךְ	king
מִצְרַיִם	Egypt
מָקוֹם	place (masc., pl. מְקוֹמוֹת)
מִשְׁתֶּה	feast, banquet
עֶבֶד	slave, servant
עַיִן	eye, spring (fem.)
עִיר	city, town (fem.)
עַם	people, nation (also עַמִּים)
פַּרְעֹה	Pharaoh
צֹאן	small cattle, sheep and goats, flock, flocks (coll., fem.)
שָׂדֶה	field (masc., pl. שָׂדוֹת)

3.1.4 Other Parts of Speech

את	object marker indicating the direct object
זֶה, זֹאת	<i>this</i> (masc., fem.)
אֵלֶּה	<i>these</i> (comm.)
הִנֵּה	<i>look, behold</i>
יוֹמָם	<i>by day</i> (adv.)
כֵּן	<i>so, thus</i> (Modern Hebrew: <i>yes</i>)
שָׁם	<i>there</i> (adv.)

3.2 Frequent Verbal Forms

Verbs are the most important part of speech in Biblical Hebrew. Among the verbal forms, weak forms are very frequent, i.e., verbal forms that have only two root consonants or sometimes only one instead of the three root consonants of the strong verb. In order to make it easier to become familiar with verbal forms, the most frequent verbal forms are introduced as vocabulary in chapters 3 and 4.

The first set of ten forms of five verbs is in the section Vocabulary above; the second set is in the vocabulary of chapter 4. At this stage, it is sufficient to memorize the forms and their meanings without understanding how the forms are actually formed.

The twenty verbal forms in the vocabulary of chapters 3 and 4 are about 10 % of all verbal forms in the Hebrew Bible. All forms of these ten verbs make up about 30 % of the total number of verbal forms in the Hebrew Bible. These numbers make it clear that it is essential to be familiar with these twenty verbal forms in particular and the ten verbs in general. Only two of the ten verbs are strong verbs, i.e., verbs that have three root consonants in *all* their forms.

The most frequent forms that are introduced in chapters 3 and 4, are the 3 masc. sg. suffix conjugation (SC) form and the 3 masc. sg. *waw*-prefix conjugation (*waw*-PC) or *wayyiqtol* form. The SC usually has past tense meaning (simple past, present perfect or past perfect depending on the context). The *waw*-PC serves as simple past (preterite). Chains of *waw*-PC forms are the backbone of narratives in the Hebrew Bible. *waw*-PC forms are always placed in first position in the clause. The other forms of the SC and PC will be introduced in later chapters.

3.3 The Verbal Clause

A clause with a finite verbal form (i.e., a form that is marked for person, 1st *I*, *we*, 2nd *you*, or 3rd person *he*, *she*, *it*, *they*) as predicate is called *verbal clause*. Most clauses in biblical literature are verbal clauses. The other type of clause is the verbless or nominal clause.

With a finite verb as predicate there is no need for an explicit (overt) subject because the subject is contained in the verbal form, e.g., **וַיֵּרְא** *and he saw*. With an overt subject the verbal form is to be rendered only as a verbal form, e.g., **וַיֵּרְא יַעֲקֹב** *and Jacob saw*.

If a clause includes an overt subject, the subject and the verbal predicate agree with each other in number, gender and – in the case of 1st or 2nd person verbal forms – in person. This means, for example, that a common noun as subject that is masculine and singular, is combined with a masc. sg. verbal form (in the 3rd person). There are, however, exceptions to this rule (→ 5.6).

The most common constituent order is verb-subject-object (VSO). As a consequence, the function of a constituent is often indicated by its position in the clause. Subjects normally precede direct objects, indirect objects or prepositional objects. Indirect objects usually follow direct objects. Adverbial phrases tend to be put at the end of the clause although temporal adverbial expressions are often placed up front. The length of constituents also plays a role. Short constituents, e.g., pronouns or short adverbs, have the tendency to be placed earlier in the clause. In most cases, the meaning of the verb and context help in identifying the function of clause constituents.

Any constituent maybe be fronted, that is, placed before the verb. The result is marked constituent order. There is usually a specific reason for employing marked constituent order. Usually, it is the activation or reactivation of a topic (also for contrast) or putting a constituent in focus, that is, highlighting it as the most salient constituent of the clause.

3.4 The Definite Article

Different from English but similar to Greek, Biblical Hebrew only has a definite article. Its use is similar to the use of the definite article *the* in English but there are quite many differences in the use of the definite article between the two languages. Most frequently, the definite article is used when an entity can be identified by both the speaker and the addressee in the context of the communication.

The Hebrew definite article is directly prefixed to the noun. Its basic form is

הַ, i.e., *ha-* followed by *dageš forte* in the first consonant of the noun. This is illustrated by the following examples:

מֶלֶךְ	king	הַמֶּלֶךְ	the king
יָד	hand	הַיָּד	the hand
מִזְבֵּחַ	altar	הַמִּזְבֵּחַ	the altar

If the noun begins with *yə-* or *mə-*, the *dageš forte* of the article is usually lost, e.g., הַיְּהוּדִים *the Judeans*, הַמְּנַגְלִים *the spies*.

As the consonants א, ה, ח, ע and ר are not geminated there is no *dageš* in the first consonant of the noun if it begins with a guttural or /r/. The following rules apply with in regard to the vowel of the article:

1. If the noun begins with ה or ח, the *pataḥ* of the article is preserved in the open syllable, e.g., הַהֵיכָל *the temple*, הַחֶרֶב *the sword*. Frequent exceptions to this rule are the noun הַר *mountain*, which is הָהָר with the article, and the independent personal pronoun 3 m./f. pl. with the article as demonstrative pronoun הֵהֶם, הֵהֶמָּה (masc.), הֵהֶנָּה [fem.] (in the singular, however, the *pataḥ* of the article is preserved: הֵהוּא [masc.] and הֵהיא [fem.], see below).
2. If the noun begins with א, ע or ר, the *pataḥ* of the article is changed to *qameṣ*, e.g., הָאֵשׁ *the fire*, הָעִיר *the city*, הָרֹאשׁ *the head*. This change is sometimes not found with ע, e.g., הָעִוְרִים *the blind* (2 Sam 5:6).
3. If the noun begins with ה or ע followed by unstressed *qameṣ*, the *pataḥ* of the article is changed to *segol*, e.g., הַהָרִים *the mountains*, הָעָרִים *the cities*.
4. Likewise, if the noun begins with ח followed by stressed or unstressed *qameṣ gadol* or *ḥatef qameṣ*, the *pataḥ* of the article is changed to *segol*, e.g., הַחֹכָם *the wise one*, הַחֵג *the feast*, הַחֲדָשִׁים *the new moons* (i.e., the festivals held at new moon).

Some nouns change their vowels to the vowel of the pausal form of the noun when they are used with the article, e.g., הָאָרֶץ *the land, the earth* (context form אֶרֶץ *land, earth*), הָהָר *the mountain* (context form הַר *mountain*). In a similar way, the noun אָרוֹן *ark, chest* with the article is הָאָרוֹן *the ark*.

Common nouns may be used with the article to indicate the vocative function, e.g., הַמֶּלֶךְ הַזֶּה הוֹשָׁעָה וְהִתְאַמֵּר *And she said, "Help, O king!"* (2 Sam 14:4); בֶּן־מִי אַתָּה הַנֶּעַר *Whose son are you, young man?* (1 Sam 17:58).

As Hebrew does not have an indefinite article, an expression like *a great nation* in English is simply גוֹי גָּדוֹל in Hebrew, i.e., only the noun גוֹי with the attributive adjective גָּדוֹל.

3.5 Demonstrative Pronouns

Unlike English with *this*, *these* and *that*, *those* or Greek with οὗτος etc. *this* and ἐκεῖνος etc. *that*, Biblical Hebrew has only one set of demonstrative pronouns. In the singular there are distinct forms for masc. and fem. while in the plural there is only one form with common gender. The function of the demonstrative pronouns as deictic elements is to point to specific entities in the communicative situation or the immediate context.

sg.	masc.	זֶה	<i>this</i>
	fem.	זֹאת	
pl.	comm.	אֵלֶּה	<i>these</i>

Note

The **ʾ** in the fem. sg. form זֹאת *zō(ʾ)t* is silent.

Demonstrative pronouns can either be used independently as subject or direct object replacing a noun or they can be used as attributes depending on nouns. When they are used as attributes, they follow the noun and both the noun and the demonstrative pronoun have the definite article. The demonstrative pronoun agrees with the noun it modifies in number and – in the singular – in gender. As the plural form is common gender it can be used with both masc. and fem. nouns.

הָאִישׁ הַזֶּה	<i>this man</i> (masc.)
הָאִשָּׁה הַזֹּאת	<i>this woman</i> (fem.)
הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה	<i>these words</i> (masc.)
הַבְּרָכוֹת הָאֵלֶּה	<i>these blessings</i> (fem.)

The demonstrative pronoun זֶה can be used as adverb with local or temporal deictic function with the meanings *here*, *there* or *now*.

Rare forms of the demonstrative pronoun are זֵה *this* (fem.), הַזֶּה *this* (masc.) and הַזֶּה *this* (comm.).

For far deixis (pointing to something at a distance, e.g., Engl. *that* or Greek ἐκεῖνος, Biblical Hebrew uses the 3rd person personal pronoun following the modified noun. Both the noun and the personal pronoun have the article. The personal pronoun agrees with the noun in number and gender.

הָאִישׁ הַהוּא	<i>that man (masc.)</i>
הָאִשָּׁה הַהִיא	<i>that woman (fem.)</i>
הָאֲנָשִׁים הָהֵם	<i>those men (masc.)</i>

3.6 The Prepositions לְ, בְּ and כִּי

Prepositions are a small set of expressions that are frequently used and very important. Their function is to denote the relations between elements in the outside world that speech refers to, or between elements of a clause. In this section, the three prepositions לְ, בְּ and כִּי are introduced. They are extremely frequent with about 20,275, 15,570 and 2,895 occurrences in the Hebrew Bible, respectively.

Formally, these three prepositions are characterized by the fact that they are not separate words but are attached directly to the following word. Therefore, they are called *proclitic* prepositions (as opposed to the other prepositions which are separate words).

The prepositions לְ, בְּ and כִּי have a number of different meanings and functions that cannot be exhaustively explained here. The standard lexica contain more detailed information. In this context a short overview of meanings must be sufficient.

לְ	<i>to, for, in regard to</i> , also indicating indirect objects
בְּ	<i>in, at, with</i> (local and temporal)
כִּי	<i>like, as, according to</i>

When prefixed to a word beginning with a syllable with a full vowel (except the definite article) the prepositions לְ, בְּ and כִּי appear in the forms as in the overview above, e.g., לַמֶּלֶךְ, בַּמֶּלֶךְ and כִּי־הָרִים.

The prepositions לְ, בְּ and כִּי have deviating forms in the following circumstances:

1. If the prepositions לְ, בְּ and כִּי are prefixed to a noun with the article, the /h/ of the article is lost but the vowel of the article is preserved, e.g., לַמֶּלֶךְ *to the king*, לְעַם *for the people*, בְּהָרִים *in the mountains*. Sometimes, the /h/ of the definite article may be preserved, e.g., כִּי־הָחֲכָם *like the wise* (Qoh 8:1).
2. If prefixed to a word beginning with a consonant with vocal *šwa* (except words beginning with יָ *yā-*), the three prepositions have the full vowel /i/

and the vocal *šwa* becomes a medial *šwa*, לְבָרִית עוֹלָם *for an everlasting covenant* (לְ with the noun בָּרִית).

3. If prefixed to a word beginning with *hatef šwa*, the three prepositions take the full vowel that corresponds to the *hatef šwa* and the *hatef šwa* itself remains unchanged, e.g., לְחֹמְרוֹ *to his donkey*, בְּאֵמֶת *in faithfulness, faithfully*, לְחֹלִי *to sickness*.
4. If prefixed to a word beginning with יַע-, the preposition is followed by a long vowel /ī/ which is the result of the contraction of the short vowel /i/ and the following semivowel (*bāy- > *biy- > bī-), e.g., בִּיהוּדָה *in Judah* (basic form בְּיְהוּדָה)
5. Before words that are stressed on the first syllable the prepositions sometimes have the vowel *qames*, e.g., לָרַב *abundantly*, בְּזֶה *here*, כְּאֵלֶּה *like them*.
6. If the three preposition are to be prefixed to the noun אֱלֹהִים *God* or to a form of the noun אֲדֹנָי *lord* other than the citation form, the א of these nouns becomes silent although it is retained in writing, and the following *hatef šwa* is changed to a full vowel, e.g., לְאֱלֹהִים *lē(ʿ)lōhīm to God* and לְאֲדֹנָי *la(ʿ)dōnī to my lord* (לְ + אֲדֹנָי).

3.7 The Conjunction וְ

The function of the conjunction וְ is to connect words, phrases and clauses. Its most frequent meaning is *and* although in many cases a different rendering like *but* or *or* is more appropriate in English. It is also called a coordinating conjunction.

The most common form of the conjunction is וְ wā- which is directly prefixed to the following word, e.g., וְאַבְרָהָם *and Abraham*.

The conjunction וְ has deviating forms in the following circumstances:

1. If the following word begins with a consonant with vocal *šwa*, the conjunction is וּ ū, e.g., וְדָבָר־הַמֶּלֶךְ *and the word of the king* (This is an exception to the rule that every word must begin with a consonant.)
2. If the following word begins with a labial consonant, i.e., בּ, מּ, and פּ, the conjunction is וּ ū, e.g., וּמֹשֶׁה *and Moses*. (This is another exception to the rule that every word must begin with a consonant.)
3. If the conjunction connects two words and the second one is stressed on the first syllable, especially in the case of common word pairs, the form of the conjunction is וָ wā-, e.g., וָחֶם וָמַיִם *bread and water* (despite the labial /m/; 2 Kgs 6:22), קָר וְחָם *cold and heat, and*

summer and winter, and day and night (Gen 8:22 with three word pairs).

4. With words beginning with a consonant with vocal *šwa* or *hatef šwa*, the vowel of the conjunction ו resembles the vowels of the proclitic prepositions ל, כ, and ב.
 - a) Conjunction ו + word beginning with *hatef šwa*: וַחֲמֹרִים *and donkeys*, וְאֵמֶת *and truth*, וַחֲלִי *and sickness*
 - b) Conjunction ו + word beginning with וַ: וַיְהִי וְיָדָה *and Judah*
 - c) Conjunction ו + the noun אֱלֹהִים or a form of the noun אֲדֹנָי *lord* other than the citation form: וַאֲלֹהִים *wē(?)lōhīm and God*, וַאֲדֹנָי *wa(?)dōnī and my lord*, both with silent א.
5. In the case of *waw-PC* form (or *wayyiqṭol* form) the form of the conjunction is וַ (wa- with following *dageš forte*).

The /h/ of the article is preserved after the conjunction ו, e.g., וְהָאָרֶץ *and the earth*.

3.8 Differential Object Marking

Differential object marking means that only a more or less well defined part of direct objects is explicitly marked as such while the rest of the direct objects is not.

3.8.1 The Use of the Object Marker אֵת

In Biblical Hebrew only definite direct objects are marked with the object marker אֵת (with *maqṣef* אֵת). This word does not have a meaning and, therefore, does not have a translation equivalent. It only has the function of marking the direct object of a clause.

Not all definite direct objects, however, are marked. Proper nouns as direct objects have the highest percentage of marked elements in prose texts (97 %) whereas only 73 % of definite common nouns as direct objects are marked. It should, therefore, not be surprising to find relatively many definite direct objects that are not marked with אֵת. The following nouns are definite:

1. Proper nouns, e.g., הַמֶּלֶךְ, יִצְחָק
2. Nouns with the definite article, e.g., הַמֶּלֶךְ *the king*
3. Nouns with enclitic personal pronouns, e.g., בֵּיתִי *my house* (→ 8.2)
4. Nouns with a definite dependent noun in a construct chain, e.g., בֵּית הַמֶּלֶךְ *the house of the king* (→ 4.6)

Chapter 3

The use of the object marker **אֶת** is illustrated in the exercises.

In the Hebrew Bible, there are only very few indefinite direct objects that are marked with **אֶת**.

Sometimes, the object marker **אֶת** is used with nouns as adverbial expressions of time and place.

3.8.2 Ellipsis of Direct Objects

Direct objects do not need to be included in the clause if they can be easily retrieved from the immediate context. As a consequence, Biblical Hebrew does not need to have a direct object where English has a personal pronoun as direct object.

וַיִּקַּח אַבְרָהָם צֹאן וּבָקָר *And Abraham took sheep and oxen and gave*
וַיִּתֵּן לְאַבְיִמֶלֶךְ *[them] to Abimelech. (Gen 21:27a)*

Gen 21:27a consists of two clauses. In the first one, the verbal form **וַיִּקַּח** has the direct object **צֹאן וּבָקָר** (two coordinated indefinite nouns). In the second clause with the verbal form **וַיִּתֵּן** there is only the indirect object **לְאַבְיִמֶלֶךְ** and no direct object because it can be easily supplied from the immediately preceding clause.

Direct objects may also be omitted when they can be easily supplied from common knowledge.

3.9 Exercises

3.9.1 Frequent Verbal Forms

Translate the following clauses from the Hebrew Bible. In some clauses there is a fronted constituent. The fronting, however, may be ignored in these exercises. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: **יֹאָשׁ, יְהוֹיָקִים, יְהוֹיָדָע, יְהוֹאָחָז, נָעַל, גִּדְעוֹן, בְּנֵי־הוֹ, בָּלָק, בַּלְעָם, אַהוּד, אַבְיִמֶלֶךְ, שִׁמְשׁוֹן**.

1 גִּדְעוֹן בֶּן־יֹאָשׁ¹ עָשָׂה הַדָּבָר הַזֶּה 2 אֵלֶּה עָשָׂה בְנֵי־הוֹ בֶּן־יְהוֹיָדָע² 3 וַיַּעַשׂ
מִשְׁתָּה 4 וַיַּעַשׂ יַעֲקֹב בֵּן 5 וַיַּעַשׂ לוֹ³ 6 אַהוּד חָרַב 6 וַיַּעַשׂ שָׁם שִׁמְשׁוֹן מִשְׁתָּה

¹ בֶּן־יֹאָשׁ *son of Joash*; apposition to גִּדְעוֹן

² בֶּן־יְהוֹיָדָע *son of Jehoiada*; apposition to בְנֵי־הוֹ

³ לוֹ *for himself*

7 וְאֵת־יְהוֹאָחַז לָקַח⁴ 8 וַיִּקַּח אֶת־שָׁרָה 9 וַיִּקַּח הָעֶבֶד אֶת־רַבֶּקָּה 10 וַיִּקַּח
 מֹשֶׁה אֶת־הָרָדִים 11 וַיִּקַּח בָּלָק אֶת־בִּלְעָם 12 וַיִּקַּח אֶת־הָעָם 13 וַיִּקַּח שָׂאוּל
 אֶת־הַחֶרֶב 14 וַיִּקַּח אֶל־יְהוֹיָדָה אֶת־הַיֶּלֶד 15 וְהַכֶּסֶף וְהַזָּהָב נָתַן יְהוֹיָקִים לַפֶּרֶעַה
 16 וַיִּקַּח אֶבְרָהָם צֹאן וּבָקָר וַיִּתֵּן לְאַבְיִמֶלֶךְ 17 וַיִּתֵּן יְהוֹנָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל מוֹשִׁיעַ⁵
 18 וּשְׂמוּאֵל רָאָה אֶת־שָׂאוּל 19 וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת־הָאָרֶץ 20 וַיֵּרָא וְהִנֵּה בְּאֵר⁶
 בְּשָׂדֶה 21 וַיֵּרָא־נֶעַל אֶת־הָעָם 22 וַיֵּרָא אֶת־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ 23 וַיֵּרָא אֶת־הַמָּקוֹם
 מֵרָחֵק⁷ 24 וַיִּשְׁמַע פֶּרֶעַה אֶת־הַדְּבָר הַזֶּה

3.9.2 Exercises with the Article

Write down every noun in the vocabulary section (except the word פֶּרֶעַה) with the definite article attached to it and read it out loud. (The words מְצָרִים and פֶּרֶעַה are never used with the article.)

⁴ לָקַח pausal form for לָקַח

⁵ מוֹשִׁיעַ deliverer, savior

⁶ בְּאֵר well

⁷ מֵרָחֵק from a distance

Chapter 4

4.1 Vocabulary

4.1.1 Verbs

אָמַר	<i>he said</i>
וַיֹּאמֶר	<i>and he said</i> (pausal form וַיֹּאמֶר)
דִּבֶּר	<i>he spoke, he said</i> (pausal form דִּבֶּר)
וַיְדַבֵּר	<i>and he spoke, and he said</i>
הָלַךְ	<i>he went</i>
וַיֵּלֶךְ	<i>and he went</i> (pausal form וַיֵּלֶךְ)
בָּא	<i>he came, he went inside</i> (bā(ʔ) with silent א)
וַיָּבֹא	<i>and he came, and he went inside</i> (wayyābō(ʔ) with silent א)
הָיָה	<i>he was, he became</i>
וַיְהִי	<i>and he was, and he became</i>

4.1.2 Nouns

אִשָּׁה	<i>woman</i>
בֹּקֶר	<i>morning</i>
גִּבּוֹר	<i>hero</i> (as substantive), <i>strong, mighty</i> (adj.)
דֶּרֶךְ	<i>way, road; distance, journey</i> (sg. mostly fem., pl. masc.)
הָר	<i>mountain, hill, hill-country</i>
חֵיל	<i>strength, wealth, army</i>
חֶלֶם	<i>dream</i> (masc.; pl. חֶלְמוֹת)
לַיְלָה	<i>night</i>
מִגְדָּל	<i>tower</i>
מִדְבָּר	<i>wilderness, desert</i>
מַחֲנֶה	<i>camp</i>

עֹז	<i>might, strength</i>
עָנָן	<i>cloud, cloud-mass</i>
עֶרֶב	<i>evening</i>
רָעָב	<i>famine, hunger</i>
שְׁלוֹם	<i>welfare, peace, completeness</i>
שֵׁם	<i>name (masc., pl. שְׁמוֹת)</i>
שֶׁמֶשׁ	<i>sun (fem.)</i>
שָׁנָה	<i>year (pl. שָׁנִים)</i>
תּוֹךְ	<i>midst (cs. st. תוֹךְ)</i>

4.1.3 Prepositions

אֶל	<i>to, towards (spatial), at, by (local), against, according to</i>
עַל	<i>on, upon, above, at, by, against, on account of, because of, about, concerning</i>
מִן	<i>from, away from, out of; in comparisons: (more) than</i>

4.1.4 Other Parts of Speech

כַּאֲשֶׁר	<i>as, according to (modal), when (temporal), because (causal) (conj.)</i>
כֹּה	<i>thus, here (adv.)</i>
כִּי	<i>for, because (causal), if (conditional), when (temporal) that, etc. (conj.)</i>
עוֹד	<i>still, yet, again, besides (adv.)</i>

4.2 The Prepositions אֶל, עַל and מִן

The prepositions אֶל and עַל are always separate words. The Preposition עַל is very often followed by *maqfef*, אֶל almost always.

The preposition מִן is a separate word before nouns with the definite article, e.g., מִן הַמִּזְבֵּחַ *from the altar*, מִן הַשָּׂדֶה *from the field*.

In other cases, מִן is put immediately in front of the following word. As a consequence, the /n/ of the preposition is immediately followed by another

consonant and therefore it is assimilated to that consonant. The following sound changes take place:

1. Assimilation of the /n/ to the first consonant of the following noun which is doubled as a consequence, e.g., **min-miṣráyim* > *mimmiṣráyim* מִמִּצְרַיִם *from Egypt*, **min-gil'ād* > *miggil'ād* מִגִּלְעָד *from Gilead*
2. If the following word begins with a guttural or /r/, the /n/ is also assimilated to the first consonant of the following word but the vowel of the preposition is changed to *šere* and the first consonant of the following word is *not* doubled, e.g., מֵאֶפְרַיִם *mē'əp̄ráyim* < **mi''əp̄ráyim* < **min-''əp̄ráyim* *from Ephraim*, מֵחֶבְרוֹן *mēḥəbrōn* < **miḥḥəbrōn* < *min-ḥəbrōn* *from Hebron*, מֵרָחוֹק *from a distance*, מֵאֱלֹהִים *from God*. This may also happen with the direct article, e.g., מִהַמֶּלֶךְ *from the king*.
3. The doubling of the first consonant before vocal *šwa* is often lost, e.g. מִקְצֵה *miqṣē* < *miqqəṣē* *at the end of* (noun קֵצַה *end* in the construct state קֵצֶה with the prep. מִן).
4. With a word beginning with יַ *yə-* assimilation of the /n/, loss of the doubling of the /y/ and contraction of *-iy-* > *-ī-* takes place, e.g., מִיְּהוּדָה *mīhūdā* < *miyyəhūdā* < *min-yəhūdā*.

4.3 Other Local Adverbial Expressions

In addition to prepositional phrases, Biblical Hebrew uses other means to express spatial and local relations (e.g., *to, towards, in* etc.)

4.3.1 The Locative He

The locative He is the ending *-ā* that is attached to a noun or adverb to indicate the goal of a motion. The locative He is *not* stressed and can be used with common nouns, proper nouns or adverbs, e.g., הַבַּיִתָּה *into the house*, הַחֶבְרֹנָה *to Hebron*, שָׁמָּה *there* (as in *They went there*).

With feminine nouns with the ending *-ā* the locative He is attached to the construct state form (see below), e.g., עֲזָה *Gaza*, with locative He עֲזָתָה *to Gaza*.

4.3.2 Noun Phrases

Bare noun phrases without preposition or the locative He can also be used as adverbial expressions indicating spatial relations (*to, towards, in, at* etc.), e.g., the place name בֵּית-אֵל *in the clause* וַיָּבֹאוּ הָעָם בֵּית-אֵל *And the people came to Bethel*.

Bare noun phrases may also be used to indicate time, e.g., הַלַּיְלָה *this night, tonight* (2 Sam 19:8), הַשָּׁנִים הָאֵלֶּה *these years, during these years* (1 Kgs 17:1). Other adverbial functions are possible, too.

4.4 Vowel Changes in Biblical Hebrew

Originally, Biblical Hebrew had the following vowels:

Short Vowels	Long Vowels
<i>i</i>	<i>ī</i>
<i>a</i>	<i>ā</i>
<i>u</i>	<i>ū</i>

These vowels were subject to change in various ways over the course of time. The following outline summarizes the main changes that are relevant for understanding the morphology of Biblical Hebrew.

1. The long vowel /ā/ changed to /ō/ in stressed syllables at a very early date (cp. Hebrew שָׁלוֹם *peace* with its cognates in Aramaic שָׁלָם and Arabic *salām*).
2. Originally long vowels are usually not subject to change. This applies also to long vowels originating from contraction of diphthongs (semivowel /y/ or /w/ + vowel), e.g., -ay > -ē or -aw > -ō.
3. Originally short vowels in closed syllables are preserved.
4. Originally short vowels in open syllables may be subject to change depending on vowel quality and position of the syllable in the word.
 - a) In propretonic syllables all short vowels in open syllables are reduced to vocal *šwa* (or *ḥatef šwa*), e.g., *šadaqā > šadāqā צְדָקָה *justice*, *ibādā > ʾibōdā עֲבָדָה *work*.
 - b) In pretonic syllables original /a/ is preserved in disyllabic words before syllables with originally short vowel or syllables with an originally long vowel, e.g., *dabar > dābār דָּבָר, *šalām > šālōm שָׁלוֹם.
 - c) Originally short /i/ is preserved as *šere* in disyllabic words if the next syllable has an originally short vowel, e.g., *libab > lēbāb לֵבָב. If it is a long vowel, originally short /i/ is reduced to *šwa*, e.g., *ḥimār > ḥāmōr חֲמֹר.

- d) Originally short /u/ in pretonic syllables is always reduced to *šwa*, e.g., **ruhāb* > *rəḥōḇ* רְחוֹב *broad open place, plaza*.
 - e) If an open syllable with an originally short vowel is stressed as in some pausal forms of verbs, these vowels are preserved, e.g., יִשְׁמְרוּ as opposed to the context form יִשְׁמְרוּ.
5. If preserved, originally short vowels have the following forms in Biblical Hebrew according to the Tiberian Masoretic tradition:
- a) The originally short vowel /a/ appears usually either as *qameš* or *pataḥ* and at times also as *segol*. If the syllable is stressed, *pataḥ* only occurs in verbal forms; in other forms /a/ becomes *qameš* /ā/.
 - b) The vowel /i/ appears either as *hireq*, *šere* or *segol*.
 - c) The vowel /u/ appears either as *holem*, *qameš ḥaṭuf* or *qibbuš*. A *holem* originating from /u/ can only change into *qameš ḥaṭuf* or *qibbuš*, e.g., כָּל *all of*, with maqqef כָּל־ *kāl all of*; דֹּב *dōḇ* < *dubb bear*, plural דְּבִים *dubbīm*.
6. Original short /a/ in an unstressed closed syllable may change to /i/ (law of attenuation), e.g., the proper noun מִרְיָם which is Μαριαμ in the LXX.
7. Original short /i/ in a closed stressed syllable may change to /a/ (Philippi's Law); e.g., **bint* > *bat* בַּת *daughter*.

Notes

The law of attenuation and Philippi's law are not laws in the strict sense as there are exceptions to them (cf. JM § 29aa). They rather reflect a strong tendency to these vowel changes in defined circumstances.

4.5 Inflection of Nouns

Inflection of nouns happens in the following cases:

1. change of number from singular to plural or dual
2. in constructions called construct chains in which two (or more) nouns are joined to express the possessive relation and other relations as in בֵּית הַמֶּלֶךְ *the house of the king*
3. the attachment of enclitic personal pronouns (ePP) (also called pronominal suffixes in other grammars) as in בֵּיתוֹ *his house*

4.5.1 Gender and Number

Biblical Hebrew has two categories of gender, masculine (masc. or m.) and feminine (fem. or f.) and three categories of number, the singular (sg.), the plural (pl.) and for some nouns and uses, the dual (du.).

Masc. nouns in the singular are always without an ending whereas fem. nouns are often marked as fem. by the endings *-ā* or *-t*. A number of fem. nouns, though, are not marked as fem. by means of a fem. ending. An example of a marked fem. noun is אִשָּׁה *woman* with the fem. ending; an example of unmarked fem. noun is אִמָּה *mother* without the fem. ending.

In Biblical Hebrew the plural is used with most nouns if two or more entities are meant. The dual is mainly used with nouns referring to measures of time and space, body parts that come in pairs and certain objects consisting of two main parts.

singular		dual	
יָד	<i>hand</i>	יָדַיִם	<i>hands</i>
יוֹם	<i>day</i>	יוֹמַיִם	<i>two days</i>
—		מֵאֲזֵנַיִם	<i>scales</i>

When used for body parts, the dual replaces the plural; it is used even when more than two items are meant.

4.5.2 Absolute State and Construct State

For expressing the possessive relationship as in the noun phrase *the house of the king* Biblical Hebrew uses a construction called construct chain in which two or more nouns are joined to form a noun phrase. The following two examples illustrate this.

קוֹל יַעֲקֹב	<i>Jacob's voice</i> (Gen 27:22)
בֵּית הַמֶּלֶךְ	<i>the house of the king</i> (2 Sam 11:2)

In noun phrases like these, the first noun is in the construct state (cs. st.) and the second noun is in the absolute state (abs. st.). The first noun is the governing noun (in Latin *nomen regens*) and the second noun is the dependent noun (in Latin *nomen rectum*).

Construct chains form a stress unit. As the first element loses its main stress there is only one syllable in a construct chain carrying the main stress. This

may result in vowel changes in the noun in the construct state. In the example *בֵּית הַמֶּלֶךְ* *the house of the king* above, *בֵּית* is the cs. st. form of the noun in the abs. st. *בֵּית*.

The lexical form (or citation form) of nouns is the form of the absolute state.

Details of the use of the construct state are presented after the explanation of the vowel changes that come with the inflection of nouns.

4.5.3 Nominal Endings

The following nominal endings are found in Biblical Hebrew. They are attached to the adjective *טוֹב* *good* because the vowel of the adjective is unchangeable and it is attested in all forms mentioned. The endings of the dual forms of nouns with the fem. ending *-ā* are illustrated with the noun *שֵׁפָה* *lip, edge* which has changeable vowels. The noun *מֵאֲזֵנַיִם* *scale, balance* is always used in the dual (because of the two plates or bowls).

		masculine	feminine
sg.	abs. st.	∅ טוֹב	<i>-ā</i> שֵׁפָה
	cs. st.	∅ טוֹב	<i>-at</i> שֵׁפֶת
pl.	abs. st.	<i>-īm</i> טוֹבִים	<i>-ōt</i> שֵׁפּוֹת
	cs. st.	<i>-ē</i> טוֹבֵי	<i>-ōt</i> שֵׁפּוֹת
dual	abs. st.	<i>-āyīm</i> מֵאֲזֵנַיִם	<i>-ātāyīm</i> שֵׁפְתַיִם
	cs. st.	<i>-ē</i> מֵאֲזֵנֵי	<i>-tē</i> שֵׁפְתֵי

Normally, masc. nouns have the plural ending *-īm*, e.g., *דָּבָר* *word*, pl. *דְּבָרִים*, and fem. nouns have the plural ending *-ōt*, e.g., *בְּרָכָה* *blessing*, pl. *בְּרָכוֹת*. There are, however, masc. nouns with the plural ending *-ōt*, e.g., *מָקוֹם* *place*, pl. *מְקוֹמוֹת*, and some fem. nouns with the plural ending *-īm*, e.g., *שָׁנָה* *year*, pl. *שָׁנִים*.

Endings distinguish construct state forms from absolute state forms only in nouns with the feminine singular ending *-ā*, plural nouns with the ending *-īm* and masculine and feminine dual nouns. Masculine singular nouns, feminine nouns without ending like *אֶרֶץ*, and plural nouns with the ending *-ōt* are not distinguished by their endings from their counterparts in the absolute state.

Beside the distinct endings in some nouns in construct state, construct chains are recognizable by the presence of a dependent noun and the vowel changes in many nouns in construct state as compared to their form in the absolute state.

4.5.4 Vowel Changes

When nouns are used in the plural or dual or in the construct state, vowel changes may happen. With the addition of endings the position of the stress moves. Nouns in a construct chain form a stress unit with the main stress on the stressed syllable of the last noun in the construct chain. As a result vowels in unstressed open syllables of the noun in construct state are subject to change unless they are originally long. The following explanations focus on nouns with changeable vowels.

Monosyllabic nouns in the singular

	abs. st.	cs. st.
sg.	דָּם	דֶּם <i>blood of</i>
	עֵץ	עֵץ <i>tree of</i>
pl.	דָּמִים	דְּמִי
	עֲצִים	עֲצִי

Disyllabic nouns

Masculine nouns have the following forms:

	abs. st.	cs. st.
sg.	דָּבָר	דְּבַר
	זָקֵן	זֶקֶן
	לֵבָב	לֶבֶב
pl.	דְּבָרִים	דְּבָרִי
	זִקְנִים	זִקְנִי
	עֲנָבִים	עֲנָבִי

Note: The *dageš forte* in עֲנָבִי is secondary and has the purpose of making the *šwa* more audible (cf. GKC § 20h).

As an example of a feminine disyllabic noun זְדִקָּה *righteousness* can be mentioned.

	abs. st.	cs. st.
sg.	צִדְקָה	צִדְקַת
pl.	צִדְקוֹת	צִדְקוֹת

Segolate nouns

In the singular, the cs. st. of segolate nouns is identical to the abs. st. except in segolate nouns with a semivowel as second root consonant. In the cs. st., the original diphthong is contracted to a long vowel.

	abs. st.	cs. st.
sg.	בֵּית	בֵּית <i>house of</i>
	מוֹת	מוֹת <i>death of</i>

In the plural, segolate nouns use disyllabic bases with two originally short vowels. In the cs. st., the original vowel of the first root consonant of the singular form is found (with $\text{v} < *u$); the second root consonant has medial šwa .

	abs. st.	cs. st.	sg. form
pl.	מְלָכִים	מְלָכֵי <i>kings of</i>	מְלָךְ < <i>*malk</i>
	שְׁבָטִים	שְׁבָטֵי <i>tribes of</i>	שְׁבַט < <i>*šibṭ</i>
	חֳדָשִׁים	חֳדָשֵׁי <i>months of</i>	חֹדֶשׁ < <i>*ḥudš</i>

In segolate nouns with a semivowel as second root consonant the diphthong (or triphthong) is always contracted in the cs. st. while in the abs. st. forms with contraction are attested as well as forms without.

	abs. st.	cs. st.
pl.	זֵיתִים	זֵיתֵי <i>olive trees of</i>
	חֵילִים	חֵילֵי <i>armies of</i>
		מוֹתֵי <i>deaths of</i>

Geminate nouns

Geminate nouns are nouns with an originally geminated final consonant that was simplified after the loss of the short final vowel: עַם *'am* < *'amm* < *'ammu*. In forms with an ending the gemination of the final consonant is restored.

	abs. st.	cs. st.
sg.	עַם	עַם
	צֶלַל	צֶלַל
	דָּבַר	דָּבַר
pl.	עַמִּים	עַמִּי
	חֲצִים	חֲצִי
	דְּבָרִים	דְּבָרִי*

Nouns ending in *segol-He*

Nouns with the ending *-ā* have the cs. st. ending *-ē*. The endings of the plural are attached to the last consonant of the noun.

	abs. st.	cs. st.
sg.	קֶנֶה	קֶנֶה <i>reed of</i>
	שָׂדֶה	שָׂדֶה <i>field of</i>
pl.	קִנִּים	קִנִּי
	שָׂדוֹת	שָׂדוֹת

4.5.5 Construct Chains

The Syntax of Construct Chains

The definiteness of construct chains is determined by the noun in the absolute state, that is the last noun in the construct chain. If it is indefinite, the construct chain is indefinite (Judg 20:40; 1 Sam 10:3).

רֹאשׁ־חֲמֹר *a head of a donkey* (2 Kgs 6:25)

פֶּת־לֶחֶם *a morsel of bread* (Gen 18:5)

If the dependent noun is definite, the entire construct chain becomes definite (Gen 21:17; Gen 32:31). (Nouns are made definite by the definite article, by a enclitic personal pronoun or a definite dependent noun; proper nouns are definite in themselves; cf. Chapter 3, Section 8.1).

In a construct chain, only the last noun, that is the noun in the absolute state, may be definite.

קוֹל הַנֶּעַר *the voice of the boy* (Gen 21:17)

בֶּן־הַמֶּלֶךְ *the son of the king* (2 Sam 18:12)

Note:

If it needs to be avoided that the entire phrase becomes definite because of a definite noun in it as in *a son of Jesse*, Biblical Hebrew uses constructions with the preposition לְ, e.g., בֶּן לְיִשִּׁי בֵּית הַלְחָמִי *a son of Jesse the Bethlehemite* (1 Sam 16:18).

Construct chains may contain more than two nouns. If there are more than two nouns in a construct chain, only the last one is in the absolute state. The other nouns in the construct chain are in the construct state.

אֲב הַמּוֹן נוֹיִם *the father of a multitude of nations* (Gen 17:4)

מִסְפַּר שְׁבֻטֵי בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל *the number of the tribes of the sons of Israel* (1 Kgs 18:31)

קַרְנוֹת מִזְבֵּחַ קְטֹרֶת הַסִּמִּים *the horns of the altar of the incense of spices* (Lev 4:7)

In a construct chain, nouns in the construct state may have two or more dependent nouns (e.g. 1 Sam 23:7; Num 20:5) although this is often avoided.¹ On the other hand, a dependent noun may only have one governing noun which means that an English phrase like *the officials and elders of Succoth* needs to be broken up into two noun phrases in Biblical Hebrew (Judg 8:14).

עִיר דְּלָתִים וּבָרִיחַ *a city with gates and bars* (1 Sam 23:7)

מָקוֹם זֵרַע וַתְּאֵנָה וְנָפֶן וְרִמּוֹן *a place of seed or figs or vines or pomegranates* (Num 20:5)

אֶת־שָׂרֵי סִכּוֹת וְאֶת־זִקְנֶיהָ *the officials of Succoth and its elders* (Judg 8:14)

¹ Cf. אֶל־נְבִיאֵי אָבִיךָ וְאֶל־נְבִיאֵי אִמְךָ *to the prophets of your fathers and to the prophets of your mother* (2 Kgs 3:13)

Chapter 4

As a construct chain is a very close unit, nothing may separate its nouns, the only exception being the locative *He*.

בֵּיתָהּ יוֹסֵף *to the house of Joseph* (Gen 43:17)

Attributive adjectives that modify the governing noun of a construct chain and demonstrative pronouns follow the dependent noun at the end of the construct chain.

בַּעַל הַבַּיִת הַזֶּקֶן *the old owner of the house* (Judg 19:22)

כֵּן הַשֶּׁמֶן הַזֶּה *this flask of oil* (2 Kgs 9:1)

In the construct chain בַּעַל הַבַּיִת הַזֶּקֶן in Judg 19:22 the adjective זֶקֶן modifies the noun בַּעַל as shown by the noun phrases זֶקֶן אִישׁ and הָאִישׁ הַזֶּקֶן in Judg 19:16–17 although it would be grammatically possible to translate the construct chain *the owner of the old house*. In 2 Kgs 9:1, the antecedent of the demonstrative pronoun זֶה is the noun כֵּן and not the noun שֶׁמֶן (cf. the differing renderings of the phrase in Vg and LXX).

The Functions of Construct Chains

Besides the possessive relation construct chains express a number of different concepts. Important concepts are:

Quality or characteristic

הַר הַקֹּדֶשׁ *the holy mountain* (lit. *the mountain of holiness*) (Isa 27:13)

אֱלֹהֵי הַנֹּכַר *the foreign gods* (lit. *the gods of foreignness*) (1 Sam 7:3)

מִגְדָּל עֹז *a strong tower* (lit. *a tower of strength*) (Judg 9:51)

The matter out of which something is made, or the content of something

רֶכֶב בְּרֹזָל *iron chariots* (Judg 1:19)

נְצִיב מֶלַח *a pillar of salt* (Gen 19:26)

בִּקְבֹּק דְּבַשׁ *a bottle of honey* (1 Kgs 14:3)

If the governing noun expresses a verbal idea, the dependent noun can express the object of the action.

חַמַּס אָחִיךָ *violence against your brother* (Ob 10)
 נִקְמַת הַיְּקָלוֹ *vengeance for his temple* (Jer 50:28)

Construct chains can express the partitive idea, i.e., someone or something belonging to a group.

אֶחָד הָעָם *one of the people* (1 Sam 26:15)

Adjectives can be used in the cs. st. as normal nouns as in 1 Sam 16:4 or for expressing various other ideas.

זִקְנֵי הָעִיר *the elders of the city* (1 Sam 16:4)
 עַם־קָשָׁה־עֵרָךְ *a stiff-necked people* (Exod 32:9)
 שָׂבַע יָמִים *full of days* (Gen 35:29)
 צָחָה צָמָא *parched with thirst* (Isa 5:13)

Although proper nouns are definite in themselves they may occur in special phrases as governing noun in a construct chain.

יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת *the Lord of hosts* (1 Sam 1:11)
 יַרְדֵּן יְרִיחוֹ *the Jordan at Jericho* (Num 33:48)
 בֵּית לָחֶם יְהוּדָה *Bethlehem of Judah* (Judg 19:1))

4.6 Exercises

4.6.1 Sentences with Frequent Verbal Forms

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: בָּלָק, בִּלְעָם, אַבְיִמֶלֶךְ, צֶעֶר, עָלִי, עֵזָה, לוֹט, פְּרָמֶל, יִשְׁמָעֵאל, יִפְתָּח, חָרָן, חֲרָב.

1 כַּח־אָמַר הַמֶּלֶךְ 2 וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ² הָעָם כִּדְבַר חֵזָה 3 וַיַּעַשׂ בָּלָק כַּאֲשֶׁר
 דִּבֶּר בִּלְעָם 4 כִּדְבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה דִּבֶּר דָּוִד 5 וַיְדַבֵּר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה וְאֶל־אַהֲרֹן

² לוֹ *to him*

6 והוא־הָלַךְ³ בַּמִּדְבָּר דֶּרֶךְ יוֹם⁴ 7 וַיֵּלֶךְ עָשׂוֹ אֶל־יִשְׁמָעֵאל 8 וַיֵּלֶךְ מִשָּׁם
 יִצְחָק 9 וַיֵּלֶךְ חֲרָנָה 10 וַיֵּלֶךְ שְׁמִשׁוֹן עֲזָתָה 11 וַיֵּלֶךְ בְּשָׁלוֹם 12 וַיֵּלֶךְ
 מִשָּׁם אֶל־הַר הַפְּרָמָל 13 הַשֹּׁמֵשׁ יֵצָא⁵ עַל־הָאָרֶץ וְלוֹט בָּא צִעְרָה 14 וַיִּשְׁמַע
 בָּלָק כִּי בָא בַלְעָם 15 בָּא־אֲבִנֵּר בֶּן־נֵר⁶ אֶל־הַמֶּלֶךְ 16 בָּא אֱלֹהִים אֶל־הַמַּחֲנֶה
 17 וַיָּבֹא יַעֲקֹב מִן־הַשָּׂדֶה בְּעָרֶב 18 וַיָּבֹא אֱלֹהִים אֶל־אֲבִימֶלֶךְ בַּחֲלוֹם הַלַּיְלָה⁷
 19 וַיָּבֹא אֶל־הַר הָאֱלֹהִים חֲרָבָה 20 וַיָּבֹא מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן⁸ אֶל־פְּרַעֲה 21 וַיָּבֹא
 מֹשֶׁה בְּתוֹךְ הָעָנָן 22 וַיָּבֹא אֱלֹהִים אֶל־בַּלְעָם לַיְלָה 23 וַיָּבֹא מִלֶּאדָּה הָאֱלֹהִים
 עוֹד אֶל־הָאִשָּׁה 24 וַיָּבֹא אִישׁ־אֱלֹהִים אֶל־עָלִי 25 וּמִגִּדֵּל־עִז הָיָה בְּתוֹךְ־הָעִיר
 26 וַיִּפְתַּח הַגִּלְעָדִי⁹ הָיָה גִבּוֹר חֵיל 27 וַיְהִי רָעַב בָּאָרֶץ

4.6.2 Construct Chains

Identify the construct chains in the clauses in Section 4.6.1 and write down the abs. st. forms of the nouns in the cs. st. and identify the vowel changes.

4.6.3 Translation into English

Translate the following construct chains into English:

גִּבּוֹר חֵיל
 דֶּרֶךְ מִדְּבָר מוֹאָב
 (יָמִים plural of יָמִי הַמִּשְׁתָּה)

4.6.4 Translation into Hebrew

Translate into Hebrew using construct chains:

man of words
 a strong tower (lit. a tower of strength)
 a man of blood (use the plural of the word for blood)
 the servant of the king

³ הוא *he* (independent personal pronoun)

⁴ דֶּרֶךְ יוֹם is a construct chain.

⁵ יֵצָא *yāšā(?) he went out*

⁶ בֶּן־נֵר *the son of Ner*

⁷ הַלַּיְלָה pausal form of לַיְלָה

⁸ With a compound subject like מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן the preceding verbal predicate is often in the singular (→ 5.6).

⁹ גִּלְעָדִי *Gileadite*

the servants of the king of יִשְׂרָאֵל

Chapter 5

5.1 Vocabulary

5.1.1 Verbs

אכל	Q. to eat
אמר	Q. to say
ידע	Q. to know
ילד	Q. to bear, beget
ירד	Q. to go down, come down, descend
ישב	Q. to sit, remain, dwell
כבר	Q. to be heavy; to be insensitive, dull; to be honored (stative verb, SC כָּבֵד, PC יִכְבֹּד)
לקח	Q. to take
מלך	Q. to reign (as king) to become king
נפל	Q. to fall
נתן	Q. to give, to put, to make into, to allow
ראה	Q. to see
שאל	Q. to ask, inquire
שלח	Q. to send
שמע	Q. to hear, to listen to
שמר	Q. to keep, watch, preserve

5.1.2 Nouns

אָדָם	man, mankind
אָח	brother

Chapter 5

אָחױת	<i>sister</i>
אָמָה	<i>slave, handmaid</i>
אָרױן	<i>chest, ark</i> (with the article הָאָרױן)
אֵשׁ	<i>fire</i> (fem.)
בֵּית	<i>house</i>
בַּת	<i>daughter</i>
כְּבוֹד	<i>glory, honor</i>
כָּל	<i>the whole, every, all</i>
כֵּל	<i>article, utensil, vessel, weapon</i>
לֵב	<i>heart</i> (cs. st. לֵבָב)
לֶחֶם	<i>bread, food</i>
מַיִם	<i>water</i>
נֶעַר	<i>boy, lad, youth</i>
נַעֲרָה	<i>young woman, girl; maid, attendant, servant</i>
פֶּה	<i>mouth</i>
קוֹל	<i>voice, sound</i> (masc., pl. קוֹלוֹת)
רֹאשׁ	<i>head</i> (rō(ʿ)š)
שָׁמַיִם	<i>heaven, sky</i>

5.1.3 Other Parts of Speech

לֹא	<i>not, no</i>
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5.2 Irregular Nouns in Biblical Hebrew

A number of nouns have irregular forms in the absolute state in the plural and in the construct state in both the singular and the plural. Most of these nouns are very frequent in the Hebrew Bible. Therefore, familiarity with these forms is important.

5.2 Irregular Nouns in Biblical Hebrew

Singular			Plural			Meaning
abs. st.	cs. st.	with ePP	abs. st.	cs. st.	with ePP	
אָב	אָבִי	אָבִינוּ אָבִיכֶם	אָבוֹת	אָבוֹת	אָבוֹתַי אָבוֹתֵיכֶם	<i>father</i>
אָח	אָחִי	אָחִינוּ אָחִיכֶם	אָחִים	אָחִי	אָחִי אָחֵיהֶם	<i>brother</i>
אָחוֹת	אָחוֹת	אָחוֹתַי	*אָחוֹת	*אָחוֹת	אָחוֹתַי אָחוֹתֵיכֶם	<i>sister</i>
בֶּן	בֶּן	בָּנִי בָּנֶיךָ	בָּנִים	בָּנִי	בָּנִי בָּנֵיכֶם	<i>son</i>
בַּת	בַּת	בָּתִּי	בָּנוֹת	בָּנוֹת	בָּנוֹתַי בָּנוֹתֵיכֶם	<i>daughter</i>
אִישׁ	אִישׁ	אִישִׁי	אֲנָשִׁים	אֲנָשִׁי	אֲנָשִׁי אֲנָשֵׁיהֶם	<i>man</i>
אִשָּׁה	אִשָּׁה	אִשְׁתִּי	נָשִׁים	נָשִׁי	נָשִׁי נָשֵׁיכֶם	<i>woman</i>
אִמָּה	*אִמָּה	אִמָּתִי	אִמָּהוֹת	אִמָּהוֹת	אִמָּהַתִּי אִמָּהֵיכֶם	<i>female slave</i>
בַּיִת	בַּיִת	בֵּיתִי	בָּתִּים	בָּתִּי	בָּתֵּינוּ	<i>house</i>
יוֹם	יוֹם	יוֹמוֹ	יָמִים	יָמִי	יָמִי יָמֵיכֶם	<i>day</i>
רֹאשׁ	רֹאשׁ	רֹאשִׁי	רָאשִׁים	רָאשִׁי	רָאשֵׁיךָ רָאשֵׁיכֶם	<i>head</i>
עִיר	עִיר	עִירִי	עָרִים	עָרִי	עָרֵיו עָרֵיכֶם	<i>city, town</i>
פֶּה	פִּי	פִּי פִּיכֶם	פִּיּוֹת or פִּיּוֹת			<i>mouth</i>

Singular			Plural			Meaning
abs. st.	cs. st.	with ePP	abs. st.	cs. st.	with ePP	
כָּלִי	כְּלִי	כְּלִיךָ	כְּלִים	כְּלִי	כְּלִיכֶם	vessel
			מַיִם	מֵי	מַיִיךָ	water
				מַיִמֵּי or מֵימֵי		
			שָׁמַיִם	שָׁמַי	שָׁמַיךָ	sky, heaven
					שָׁמַיְכֶם	

Notes

1. The asterisk * indicates that the form is not attested in Biblical Hebrew.
2. More information can be found in P. Joüon and T. Muraoka, *A Grammar of Biblical Hebrew*, § 98 (abbr. JM). Other irregular nouns that are mentioned there, are אָבִי husband's father, אִמּוֹת* husband's mother, שֶׁהָ a head of small livestock.
3. The noun אָח brother has the following forms with enclitic personal pronoun that need to be mentioned: אָחֵי my brothers (pausal form), אֶחָיו 'æḥāw his brothers. (with silent /y/)
4. The plural form אֲחֵיות sisters is attested in Rabbinic Hebrew but not in Biblical Hebrew.
5. The *dageš* in the ה in the plural forms בָּתִּים *bātīm*, בָּתֵּי *bātē*, בָּתֵּינוּ *bātēnū* our houses, etc. is an exceptional *dageš lene* because it is preceded by a full (long) vowel. According to a different explanation, the *dageš* is a *dageš forte*; the forms are then pronounced as *bāttīm*, *bāttē*, *bāttēnū*, etc., with an exceptional *qameṣ gadol* in a closed unstressed syllable.
6. The nouns מַיִם and שָׁמַיִם are exceptional plural nouns (JM § 90f, 91f).

5.3 The Noun כָּל

The noun כָּל can be used as a substantive in the abs. st. meaning *the whole, entirety, everything*, e.g., וַיְהִי וַיְבָרֶךְ אֶת־אֲבְרָהָם בְּכָל And the Lord had blessed Abraham in all things (Gen 24:1).

5.4 Stem Formations and Conjugations in Biblical Hebrew

It is much more frequently used as the governing noun in construct chains with the cs. st. forms כָּל, כָּל־ and כָּל־. Used in this way, כָּל means *all (of), every* or *any*. Illustrative examples are:

כָּל־מָקוֹם	<i>every place</i> (Deut 12:13)
כָּל־אִישׁ	<i>everyone</i> (lit. <i>every man</i> [person]) (Gen 45:1)
כָּל־תַּפִּלָּה כָּל־תַּחֲנֻנָּה	<i>any prayer, any supplication</i> (1 Kgs 8:38)
כָּל־מַמְלָכוֹת	<i>all kingdoms</i> (1 Kgs 10:20)
כָּל־הָאָרֶץ	<i>all the land, the entire land</i> (Gen 13:15)
כָּל הָאֲרָצוֹת	<i>all the lands</i> (Gen 41:54)

Note

The particular combination of signs כָּל is to be pronounced *kāl* only *once* in the Hebrew Bible in Isa 40:12 (3 m. sg. suffix conjugation of the verb כוֹל). In all other instances כָּל is the cs. st. of כָּל and is to be pronounced *kāl*.

5.4 Stem Formations and Conjugations in Biblical Hebrew

The morphology of the verb in Biblical Hebrew is characterized by a set of *stem formations* (Hebrew בְּנִינִים, singular בְּנִין) and a set of *conjugations* consisting of finite forms expressing tense, aspect and mood and the participle and the two infinitives as non-finite nouns (verbal nouns).

The finite forms with the suffix conjugation, prefix conjugation, jussive, cohortative and imperative are introduced in Chapters 5–7, the non-finite forms with the active and the passive participle and the infinitive construct and infinitive absolute in Chapters 8–9.

The system of the *binyanim* consists of the seven main *binyanim*: Qal, Niphal, Hiphil (with its passive counterpart Hophal), Piel (with its passive and reflexive counterparts Pual and Hitpael, respectively). Compared to the Qal, the other *binyanim* are characterized by prefixes or the gemination of the second root consonant. These additional elements modify the meaning of forms. The following examples illustrate this.

Qal מָלַךְ <i>he reigned as king</i>	Hiphil הִמְלִיךְ <i>he made (someone) king</i>
Qal אָבַד <i>he perished</i>	Piel אֶבַד <i>he made (someone) perish</i>
Qal קָנָה <i>he bought</i>	Niphal נִמְכַּר <i>he was sold</i>

The Qal forms are introduced in Chapters 5–15; the other *binyanim* are introduced beginning in Chapter 16. About 69 % of all verbal forms are Qal forms, making this *binyan* most frequent one by far. Hiphil forms are about 13 %, Piel forms about 9 % and Niphal forms about 6 %.

5.5 The Suffix Conjugation Qal

5.5.1 The Forms of the Suffix Conjugation Qal

The suffix conjugation is characterized by suffixes that are attached to the verbal root at the end. Other terms for the suffix conjugation are *perfect* or in Hebrew עָבַר (*עָבַר*) *past tense*. As the terms *perfect* and עָבַר make implicit statements about the meaning and use of these forms, the term *suffix conjugation* is preferred in this grammar because it pertains exclusively to formal features.

In the suffix conjugation Qal, Hebrew makes a formal distinction between fientive or active verbs on the one side and stative verbs on the other side. Fientive verbs are much more frequent than stative verbs. Among the stative verbs, Hebrew distinguishes between verbs with the thematic vowel /e/ and verbs with the thematic vowel /o/. The last category is very infrequent except for the verb יָכַל *to be able to, prevail* with 182 occurrences.

		suffix	fientive verb	stative verb	
sg.	3 m.	-Ø	כָּתַב	כָּבַד	קָטַן
	3 f.	-ā	כָּתְבָה	כָּבְדָה	קָטְנָה
	2 m.	-tā	כָּתַבְתָּ	כָּבַדְתָּ	קָטַנְתָּ
	2 f.	-t	כָּתַבְתְּ	כָּבַדְתְּ	קָטַנְתְּ
	1 c.	-tī	כָּתַבְתִּי	כָּבַדְתִּי	קָטַנְתִּי
pl.	3 c.	-ū	כָּתְבוּ	כָּבְדוּ	קָטְנוּ
	2 m.	-tæm	כָּתַבְתֶּם	כָּבַדְתֶּם	קָטַנְתֶּם
	2 f.	-tæn	כָּתַבְתֶּן	כָּבַדְתֶּן	קָטַנְתֶּן
	1 c.	-nū	כָּתַבְנוּ	כָּבַדְנוּ	קָטַנּוּ

The suffix conjugation forms include an expression of the subject in the suffixes. An overt subject is grammatically not necessary but frequently present.

The suffixes can be categorized into three groups: The vocalic suffixes in the 3 f. sg. and 3 c. pl. forms consist of only a vowel. These suffixes are stressed in context forms and unstressed in pausal forms. Among the consonantal suffixes – those that begin with a consonant – light and heavy consonantal suffixes can be distinguished. Whereas the light suffixes in the 2 m./f. sg., 1 c. sg. and 1 c. pl. forms are not stressed (except in a certain set of forms), the heavy suffixes in the 2 m./f. pl. forms are stressed.

Attaching vocalic suffixes or heavy suffixes leads to vowel reduction. In the case of heavy suffixes the first vowel is reduced. When vocalic suffixes are attached, the second vowel is reduced in context forms. In pausal forms the thematic vowel is preserved and stressed, e.g., **כָּתְבוּ**.

As examples of distinct pausal forms can be mentioned: 3 m. sg. **כָּתַב**; forms with vocalic suffix: 3 f. sg. **כָּתְבָהּ**, **כָּתְבָהּ** and 3 c. pl. **כָּתְבוּ**, **כָּתְבוּ**; forms with light suffix with lengthening of the thematic vowel: **כָּתְבֻּתְּ** etc.

The thematic vowel of static verbs of the type **כָּבַד** changes from /e/ to /a/ in all forms with consonantal suffix.

Sometimes the suffix of the 2 m. sg. is spelled with a vowel letter: **כָּתְבָתָהּ**.

In 2nd person forms and 1 c. sg. forms of verbs with /t/ as third radical, the /t/ of the root and the initial /t/ of the suffix stand next to each other; the **ת** is spelled only once and it is doubled, e.g., *kārátī* **כָּרַתִּי** *I have cut*.

Although in forms of verbs with /n/ as third radical the /n/ is immediately followed by the consonant /t/ in all forms with consonantal suffix except the 1 c. pl. forms, the /n/ of the root is *not* assimilated to the following /t/, e.g., *šāknī* **שָׁכַנְתִּי** *I dwelt*. An exception is the verb **נָתַן**, e.g., *nātantī* **נָתַתִּי** < *nātantī* *I gave*, *nātantēm* **נָתַתֶּם** < *nātantēm* *you gave*.

In 1 c. pl. forms of verbs with /n/ as third radical (e.g., **נָתַן**) the /n/ of the root and the initial /n/ of the suffix -*nū* stand next to each other; the **נ** is spelled only once and it is doubled, e.g., *nātannū* **נָתַנּוּ** *we gave*.

The original forms of the suffixes may have bearing on verbal forms with enclitic personal pronouns. The zero morpheme of the 3 m. sg. form originates from the loss of a short final vowel **kataba* > *kātab* without an ending. The original forms of the suffixes of the 3 f. sg. and 2 m./f. sg. need to be mentioned here, too.

3 m. sg.	-a > Ø	*kataba > katab	כָּתַב
3 f. sg.	-at > -ā	*katabat > katabā	כָּתְבָה
2 m. sg.	-ta > -tā	*katabta > katabtā	כָּתַבְתָּ
2 f. sg.	-ti > -t	*katabti > katabt	כָּתַבְתְּ

5.5.2 The Suffix Conjugation Qal of Guttural Verbs

Suffix conjugation forms of guttural verbs are characterized by only few differences in comparison with the verbs without gutturals. In verbs I gutt. and II gutt. the vocal *šwa* is replaced by *hatef pataḥ* in the 3 f. sg. and 3 c. pl. and the 2 m./f. pl., respectively. In verbs III gutt., the consonant cluster in the 2 f. sg. form is broken up by insertion of a vowel. The *dageš lene* in the /t/ of the suffix that is found in the verbal forms without guttural is retained.

	I gutt.	II gutt.	III gutt.
sg. 3 f.		כָּתְבָה	
2 f.			שָׁלַחְתְּ
pl. 3 c.		כָּתְבוּ	
2 m.	עֲזַבְתֶּם		
2 f.	עֲזַבְתֶּן		

5.5.3 The Use of the Suffix Conjugation

The use of the suffix conjugation and how it is translated depends on the verb type. Suffix conjugations forms of fientive verbs have different translation options than the same forms of stative verbs.

Fientive verbs

The suffix conjugation is used for events in the past.

מִים שָׁאַל חֵלֶב נָתַןָּהּ *He asked for water, she gave [him] milk.*
(Judg 5:25)

Sometimes the past event has bearing on the present. Then the present perfect should be used in the English translation.

5.5 The Suffix Conjugation Qal

וַהֲנִיחַ נָתַן יְהוָה עֲלֵיכֶם מֶלֶךְ ... and see, the Lord has set a king over you.
(1 Sam 12:13)

קָרַע יְהוָה אֶת־מַמְלָכוֹת
יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵעַלְיָךְ הַיּוֹם The Lord has torn the kingdom of Israel from
you today. (1 Sam 15:28)

In narratives the suffix conjugation is used instead of the *wayyiqtol* form when a constituent is fronted (often for emphasis or contrast).

וַהֲעִיר שָׂרְפוּ בָאֵשׁ And the city they burnt with fire. (Jos 6:24)
וְאֶת־בָּנוֹתֵיהֶם נָתַנוּ לְבָנֵיהֶם ... and their daughters they gave to their sons.
(Judg 3:6)

וַיַּצִּידָהּ נָתַן לוֹ ... and he gave him provisions. (1 Sam
22:10)

The suffix conjugation is used for anterior events (in a past tense context the pluperfect is used in English).

וַיִּקְחוּ אֶת־הַפָּר אֲשֶׁר־נָתַן And they took the bull that he had given them.
לָהֶם (1 Kgs 18:26)

וַיִּשְׂפֹךְ הַדֶּשֶׁן מִן־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ And the fat ashes poured out from the altar
כַּמּוֹפֵת אֲשֶׁר נָתַן אִישׁ according to the sign that the man of God had
הָאֱלֹהִים בְּדַבַּר יְהוָה given. (1 Kgs 13:5)

Stative verbs

Suffix conjugation forms of stative verbs refer to states in the present. This applies also to verbs of mental perception (e.g., יָדַע Q. *to know*) and verbs that express emotions (e.g., אָהַב Q. *to love*).

עַל־כֵּן גָּדֹלָתְךָ אֲדֹנָי יְהוָה Therefore you are great, O Lord GOD (2 Sam
7:22)

קָטַנְתִּי מִכָּל הַחֲסָדִים I am too insignificant for all your kindness
(Gen 32:11)

לֹא יָדַעְתִּי מִי עָשָׂה I do not know who did this thing (Gen 21:26)
אֶת־הַדָּבָר הַזֶּה

אָהַבְתִּי אֶת־אֲדֹנָי אֶת־אִשְׁתִּי I love my lord and my wife and my children
וְאֶת־בָּנֵי (Exod 21:5)

Chapter 5

Suffix conjugation forms of stative verbs can also express a state in the past or the entrance into a state in the past.

כִּי יִגְדַּתִּי מִפְּנֵי הָאֵף וְהַחֲמָה אֲשֶׁר קִצַּף יְהוָה עֲלֵיכֶם	<i>For I was afraid of the anger and wrath that the LORD had against you. (Deut 9:19)</i>
וַיִּנְעֵץ אֶת־הַיְלָדִים אֲשֶׁר נָדְלוּ אִתּוֹ	<i>And he exchanged counsel with the young men that had grown up with him. [= that had become grown-up with him] (1 Kgs 12:8)</i>

The suffix conjugation has other functions that do not need to be introduced here.

5.6 Subject Expression and Agreement

As explained above, the suffix conjugation forms and the other finite verbal forms include an expression of the subject in the suffixes and prefixes marking the forms for person, gender and number. An overt subject is grammatically not necessary but frequently present. If an overt subject is present, it agrees with the verbal form in gender and number. In Gen 13:12 the verb and the subject are in the singular; in Judg 3:5 they are both in the plural.

אַבְרָם יָשַׁב בְּאֶרֶץ־כְּנָעַן וְלוֹט יָשַׁב בְּעָרֵי הַכְּפָר	<i>Abram settled in the land of Canaan while Lot settled in the cities in the vicinity [of the Jordan] (Gen 13:12)</i>
וּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל יָשָׁבוּ בְּקֶרֶב הַכְּנַעֲנִי	<i>So the Isrealites settled among the Canaanites (Judg 3:5)</i>

With 1st and 2nd person verbal forms only independent personal pronouns may be used as overt subjects. They agree with the verbal form in person, number and gender.

אֲנִי שָׁמַעְתִּי	<i>I have heard [it] (Ezek 35:13)</i>
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While agreement is the norm, lack of agreement does occur. In Gen 9:15, for example, the subject מַיִם *water* is plural, but the following verbal predicate יִהְיֶה is a singular form. Especially when the verb is at the beginning of the clause and followed by a compound subject consisting of more than one entity, lack of agreement can be observed (Exod 7:10).

וְלֹא־יִהְיֶה עוֹד הַמַּיִם לְמַבּוּל The water shall not become a flood again
(Gen 9:15)

וַיָּבֹאוּ מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן אֶל־פַּרְעֹה Moses and Aaron came to Pharaoh (Exod
7:10)

When singular nouns like עַם or גּוֹי *nation, people* are used as subject, the verbal predicate is often in the plural as in Josh 24:24 (cf. Josh 24:21 with a singular verb). This is possible because the subject refers to an entity consisting of more than one element. The technical term for this phenomenon is *constructio ad sensum* (Engl. *construction according to meaning or notional agreement*), which means that grammar follows meaning and not form.

וַיֹּאמְרוּ הָעָם אֶל־יְהוֹשֻׁעַ and the people said to Joshua (Josh 24:24)

The rules for agreement and the expression for the subject apply to all finite verbal forms, i.e., the suffix conjugation, the prefix conjugation, the volitive forms jussive, cohortative and imperative, and the *wayyiqtol* and *wāqataltí* forms. They also apply to the participle with respect to gender and number.

Other terms for *agreement* and *lack of agreement* are *congruency* and *incongruency*.

5.7 The Negative לֹא

The most common negative in Biblical Hebrew is לֹא *lō*(?) *not* (with silent א). It is used with verbal forms (except infinitives) as negation of the entire clause. The negative לֹא is usually placed immediately before the verbal form, e.g., לֹא צָחַקְתִּי *I have not laughed* (Gen 18:15).

The negative לֹא is also used as the negative answer *no* to a yes-no question, request or statement (e.g., Gen 23:11; 1 Sam 1:15).

It can be used to negate a single word as in לְדֶרֶךְ לֹא־טוֹב *a way not good* (Ps 36:5), בֶּן לֹא חָכָם *an unwise son* (Hos 13:13), בֵּלֹא־אֵל *with a not-God* (Deut 32:21).

5.8 Exercises

5.8.1 Translation of Verbal Forms

Translate the following verbal forms. Identify the gender (masc., fem., comm.) and number (sg., pl.) the forms of which the English translation is ambiguous

(i.e., *you, they*). Mark the stressed syllable if stress is not on the last syllable.

1 אָמְרוּ 2 הִלְכֹתִי 3 לָקַח 4 לָקַחְתָּ 5 שְׁלַחְתִּי 6 יָדַעְתָּ 7 יָשְׁבוּ
8 הִלְכְנוּ 9 שָׁמַעְתָּ 10 נָפַל 11 שָׁמְרָתֶם 12 שָׁאַלְתָּ 13 יָלַדְתָּ
14 אָכַלְתֶּם 15 מָלַכְתָּ 16 יָדַעְתָּ 17 אָמְרָה 18 נָתַנּוּ 19 נָתַתָּה
20 נָתַתָּ

5.8.2 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: נַעֲמָן, בֶּן־הַדָּד, אֲסָא.

1 לָחֶם לֹא אָכַלְתֶּם 2 הִנֵּה יֵרֶדְהָ אֵשׁ מִן־הַשָּׁמַיִם 3 וּפְלִשְׁתִּים¹ לָקְחוּ אֶת־אֲרוֹן
הָאֱלֹהִים 4 כִּי־אָתָּה² יָדַעְתָּ לְבַדְּךָ³ אֶת־לִבְבִּי כָּל־בְּנֵי הָאָדָם 5 שָׁמַעְתִּי אֶת־קוֹל
דִּבְרֵי הָעָם הַזֶּה אֲשֶׁר דִּבְּרוּ אֵלַיךָ⁴ 6 הִנֵּה שְׁלַחְתִּי אֵלַיךָ⁵ אֶת־נַעֲמָן עַבְדִּי⁶
7 יָדַעְתִּי כִּי־נָתַן יְהוָה לָכֶם⁷ אֶת־הָאָרֶץ 8 מָה⁸ אָמְרוּ הָאֲנָשִׁים הָאֵלֶּה 9 וַיֵּרָא
אֲלֵהִים אֶת־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל 10 וַיִּשְׁמַע אֱלֹהִים אֶת־קוֹל הַנַּעַר 11 וַיִּשְׁמַע שְׁאוּל
וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־דִּבְרֵי הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי⁹ הָאֵלֶּה 12 וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ¹⁰ כֹּה אָמַר יִפְתָּח לֹא־לָקַח
יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־אֶרֶץ מוֹאָב וְאֶת־אֶרֶץ בְּנֵי עַמּוֹן 13 וַיִּשְׁמַע בֶּן־הַדָּד אֶל־הַמֶּלֶךְ אֲסָא
14 כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

¹ פְּלִשְׁתִּי *the Philistines* (usually without the article; sg.)

² אָתָּה *you* (independent personal pronoun, 2 m. sg.)

³ לְבַדְּךָ *you alone*

⁴ אֵלַיךָ *which they have spoken to you*

⁵ אֵלַיךָ *to you* (preposition אֶל with enclitic pronoun 2 m. sg.)

⁶ עַבְדִּי *my servant* (עַבְדִּי with enclitic personal pronoun 2 m. sg.)

⁷ לָכֶם *to you* (preposition לְ with enclitic personal pronoun 2 m. pl.)

⁸ מָה *what?* (interrogative pronoun)

⁹ פְּלִשְׁתִּי *Philistine* (sg.)

¹⁰ לוֹ *to him* (preposition לְ with enclitic pronoun 3 m. sg.)

Chapter 6

6.1 Vocabulary

6.1.1 Verbs

זָכַר	Q. <i>to remember</i>
חָזַק	Q. <i>to be firm, strong</i> (stative verb, PC יִחְזֹק but SC חָזַק)
כָּרַת	Q. <i>to cut</i> (frequently with the noun בְּרִית <i>covenant</i> as direct object)
כָּתַב	Q. <i>to write</i>
עָבַד	Q. <i>to serve, work</i>
פָּקַד	Q. <i>to visit, attend to, muster, appoint</i>
קָרַב	Q. <i>to draw near, approach</i> (stative verb; SC קָרַב and קָרַב; PC יִקָּרַב)

6.1.2 Nouns

אֹהֶל	<i>tent</i> (pl. abs. st. אֹהֶלִים, pl. cs. st. אֹהֶלִי <i>hōlē</i>)
אוֹת	<i>sign</i> (fem., pl. אוֹתוֹת)
בְּרִית	<i>covenant, agreement, contract</i> (fem.)
גְּבוּל	<i>border, boundary, territory</i>
יָם	<i>sea, west</i> (gem. noun; pl. יָמִים)
כָּבֵד	<i>heavy; oppressing; weighty</i> (adj.)
כֹּהֵן	<i>priest</i>
לֵב	<i>heart</i> (gem. noun; pl. לְבוֹת)

מַלְאָךְ	<i>messenger, angel</i>
מִצְוָה	<i>commandment</i>
נָבִיא	<i>prophet</i>
פָּנִים	<i>face, surface (only pl.)</i>
קָהָל	<i>assembly</i>
רוּחַ	<i>spirit, wind (fem. or masc.)</i>

6.1.3 Other Parts of Speech

אַל	<i>not (with the jussive or cohortative)</i>
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6.2 Prefix Conjugation Qal

6.2.1 The forms of the Prefix Conjugation

The prefix conjugation is characterized by prefixes in all forms of the paradigm. In some forms suffixes are attached to the form as well.

In the prefix conjugation Biblical Hebrew distinguishes two forms with different thematic vowels, i.e., the vowels between the second and third root consonants. The form יִקְטֹל *yiqṭōl* with the thematic vowel /ō/ is used for fientive verbs while the form יִכְבֵּד *yikḅad* with the thematic vowel /a/ is used for stative verbs.

For a proper understanding of the forms of the prefix conjugation forms of verbs with gutturals and some weak verbs it is important to note that the form יִקְטֹל *yiqṭol* is the result of the development **yaqtulu* > *yiqṭol* (with loss of the final short vowel as usual in BH).¹ The change of the prefix vowel /a/ > /i/ is due to the law of attenuation (/a/ > /i/ in unstressed closed syllables). The change of /u/ > /ō/ in stressed syllables is regular.

The prefix vowel /i/ and thematic vowel /a/ of the forms יִכְבֵּד *yikḅad*, etc., of the stative verb are the original vowels; they were not subject to change.

¹ The original vowels are preserved in Classical Arabic, e.g., *yaf'ulu he will do*. The forms of the prefix conjugation forms of verbs Iʔ, II w/y and II gem. can only be explained with the original forms with the vowel /a/ in the prefix syllable of fientive verbs.

		pref.	suff.	fientive	stative
sg.	3 m.	y-		יִכְתֹּב	יִכְבֵּד
	3 f.	t-		תִּכְתֹּב	תִּכְבֵּד
	2 m.	t-		תִּכְתֹּב	תִּכְבֵּד
	2 f.	t-	-ī	תִּכְתְּבִי	תִּכְבְּדִי
	1 c.	ʔ-		אִכְתֹּב	אִכְבֵּד
pl	3 m.	y-	-ū	יִכְתְּבוּ	יִכְבְּדוּ
	3 f.	t-	-nā	תִּכְתְּבֶנָּה	תִּכְבְּדֶנָּה
	2 m.	t-	-ū	תִּכְתְּבוּ	תִּכְבְּדוּ
	2 f.	t-	-nā	תִּכְתְּבֶנָּה	תִּכְבְּדֶנָּה
	1 c.	n-		נִכְתֹּב	נִכְבֵּד

Notes

The vowel /æ/ in the prefix of the 1 c. sg. form needs to be noted. The consonant /ʔ/ often triggers the change of a vowel to /æ/.

The forms with stressed vocalic suffix (2 f. sg. and 3/2 m. pl.) have distinct pausal forms. The stress is on the penultimate syllable and the original thematic vowel is preserved instead of being reduced as in the context forms: e.g., יִכְתְּבִי, יִכְבְּדִי.

In forms with /a/ as thematic vowel the *pataḥ* is lengthened to *qameṣ* in pausal forms, e.g., יִכְבֵּד.

The forms 3/2m. pl. are quite often extended by an additional ך called paragogic Nun, e.g., תִּשְׁמְרוּן *you shall keep* (Deut 6:17), יִשְׁמְעוּן *they will hear* (Deut 4:6). Most of the 305 examples in the Hebrew Bible are found in Deut, Isa, Job and Ps 104 (JM § 44e). There is no difference in meaning between the normal forms and the forms with paragogic Nun. In pausal forms the thematic vowel is preserved despite the position of the stress, e.g., תִּכְרֹתֶיךָ *you shall cut down* (Exod 34:13), תִּדְבְּקֶיךָ *you shall cling* (Deut 13:5). Sometimes pausal forms with paragogic Nun are found in context. In five cases 2 f. sg. forms also have a paragogic Nun, e.g., תִּדְבְּקֶיךָ *you shall cling* (Ruth 2:8).

The possible confusion of identical forms (3 f. sg. and 2 m. sg. forms and 3/2 fem. pl.) is hardly ever an issue in Biblical Hebrew texts.

6.2.2 Historical Background

In the earliest phase of Northwest Semitic the prefix conjugation had four distinct forms. Two forms had a short final vowel: *yaqtulu* and *yaqtula*. The form *yaqtulu* functioned as an indicative form while the form *yaqtula* was used as a subjunctive. Vestiges of the form *yaqtula* can still be found in the cohortative and the long form of the imperative.

The third form was a short form without a final vowel *yaqtul* which functioned either as a perfective past tense (or preterite) or as a volitive form. This form is preserved in the *wayyiqtol* form and the jussive in Biblical Hebrew.

Because of the general loss of short final vowels the formal difference between the forms *yaqtulu* and *yaqtul* is lost in most forms. It is reflected only in some volitive forms and *wayyiqtol* forms of certain classes of weak verbs and in some Hiphil forms.

A fourth form was the so-called energetic mode *yaqtulan(na)* which is preserved only in some forms of the prefix conjugation with enclitic personal pronouns.

6.2.3 Verbs with Gutturals in the Prefix Conjugation

		I gutt.		II gutt.	III gutt.
		fientive	stative		
sg.	3 m.	יַעֲזֹב	יִחְזֹק	יִבְחַר	יִשְׁלַח
	3 f.	תַּעֲזֹב	תִּחְזֹק	תִּבְחַר	תִּשְׁלַח
	2 m.	תַּעֲזֹב	תִּחְזֹק	תִּבְחַר	תִּשְׁלַח
	2 f.	תַּעֲזֹבִי	תִּחְזֹקִי	תִּבְחַרִי	תִּשְׁלַחִי
	1 c.	אֶעֱזֹב	אֶחְזֹק	אֶבְחַר	אֶשְׁלַח
pl.	3 m.	יַעֲזֹבוּ	יִחְזְקוּ	יִבְחְרוּ	יִשְׁלְחוּ
	3 f.	תַּעֲזֹבְנָה	תִּחְזְקְנָה	תִּבְחַרְנָה	תִּשְׁלַחְנָה
	2 m.	תַּעֲזֹבוּ	תִּחְזְקוּ	תִּבְחְרוּ	תִּשְׁלְחוּ
	2 f.	תַּעֲזֹבְנָה	תִּחְזְקְנָה	תִּבְחַרְנָה	תִּשְׁלַחְנָה
	1 c.	נֶעֱזֹב	נִחְזֹק	נִבְחַר	נִשְׁלַח

Notes

The gutturals ה, ח and ע prefer the vowel /a/ in the positions before and after the guttural. There are, however, some I gutt. verbs with *yaqtul* prefix conjugation forms that have the prefix vowel /æ/ instead of /a/, e.g., יִהְדֹּף *he will push*. When the guttural א is preserved as a consonant, the vowel /æ/ is preferred, e.g., יִאָּבֵד *he will bind*.

Many I gutt. verbs have a *ḥatef* vowel with the first root consonant instead of silent *šwa* (cp. יִעֲזֹב with יִכְתֹּב) while other I gutt. verbs tolerate the silent *šwa* (e.g., יִחַנֹּד *he shall desire*).

In context forms of I gutt. verbs with vocalic suffix (2 f. sg. and 2/3 m. pl.) the two consecutive vocal *šwa* are changed to a full vowel that corresponds to the *ḥatef šwa*, and medial *šwa* which does not trigger a *dageš lene* in the following consonant, e.g., **taʿāzabū* > *taʿazbū* תִּעְזְבוּ and **yæḥæzaqū* > *yæḥæzqū* יִחַזְקוּ. In forms like these Biblical Hebrew tolerates short vowels in open syllables.

Fientive verbs I gutt. have the vowel pattern *a–u* with preservation of the original vowel of the prefixes while stative verbs I gutt. have the vowel pattern *i–a* (with change of the /i/ to /æ/ to bring the prefix vowel closer to the vowel /a/ that is preferred by gutturals).

Verbs II gutt. usually have the vowel pattern *i–a* irrespective of their semantic classification as fientive or stative. The stem vowel /ō/ can be found with a few verbs, e.g., יִאָּחֵז *he shall grasp*. Verbs III gutt. almost always show the vowel pattern *i–a*.

In pausal forms with vocalic suffix the original thematic vowel is preserved and the stress is on the penultimate syllable, e.g., תִּשְׁלַחְוּ, יִעֲזְבוּ.

In forms with /a/ as thematic vowel the *pataḥ* is lengthened to *qameṣ* in pausal forms, e.g., יִכְתֹּבּ.

6.2.4 The Use of the Prefix Conjugation

The prefix conjugation has three main uses:

1. as a future tense and – almost exclusively occurring in questions and subordinate clauses – present tense (1 Sam 9:16; Gen 24:31)
2. as a form expressing imperfective aspect for durative or iterative (repeated) events in the past (1 Kgs 17:6)
3. as a modal form expressing obligation, capability etc. (expressed in English with auxiliary verbs like *may*, *would*, *shall*, *can*, *must*, *want*, *could*, *should*, etc.), e.g., Exod 20:9; Deut 23:7. With the negative אֵין the prefix conjugation is used for general or strict prohibitions (e.g., Exod 20:15).

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This use is called *vetitive* and forms a subgroup of the modal use of the prefix conjugation.

כֶּעֶת מָחָר אֶשְׁלַח אֵלֶיךָ אִישׁ מֵאֶרֶץ בִּנְיָמִן	<i>Tomorrow about this time I will send to you a man from the land of Benjamin (1 Sam 9:16)</i>
לָמָּה תֵּעָמַד בַּחוּץ	<i>Why are you standing outside? (Gen 24:31)</i>
וּמִן־הַנָּחַל יִשְׁתֶּה	<i>... and from the brook he used to drink. (1 Kgs 17:6b)</i>
שֵׁשֶׁת יָמִים תַּעֲבֹד	<i>Six days you may work. (Exod 20:9)</i>
לֹא תִגְנוֹב	<i>You shall not steal. (Exod 20:15)</i>

6.2.5 The *wayyiqtol* Form

The *wayyiqtol* form is a past tense form that is based on the short form of the prefix conjugation *yaqtul* in its function as perfective past tense. It is formed by a special form of the conjunction *waw* with *pataḥ* und *dageš forte* in the consonant of the prefix syllable. As the **נ** of the 1 c. sg. prefix does not take *dageš forte* the vowel is changed to *qameṣ*.

This special form of the conjunction is called *waw consecutive* (sometimes called *waw inversive* [Hebrew וְהִיפּוּךְ] although this term is rather misleading and historically incorrect). In the strong verb, the actual form of the *wayyiqtol* form is identical to the normal prefix conjugation. This applies to pausal forms as well. Deviating forms only occur with some weak verbs and in derived conjugations.

		<i>wayyiqtol</i>	
		fientive	stative
sg.	3 m.	וַיִּכְתֹּב	וַיִּכְבֹּד
	3 f.	וַתִּכְתֹּב	וַתִּכְבֹּד
	2 m.	וַתִּכְתֹּב	וַתִּכְבֹּד
	2 f.	וַתִּכְתְּבִי	וַתִּכְבְּדִי
	1 c.	וָאֶכְתֹּב	וָאֶכְבֹּד

		<i>wayyiqtol</i>	
		fientive	stative
pl.	3 m.	וַיִּכְתְּבוּ	וַיִּכְבְּדוּ
	3 f.	וַתִּכְתְּבֶנָּה	וַתִּכְבְּדֶנָּה
	2 m.	וַתִּכְתֹּב	וַתִּכְבֹּד
	2 f.	וַתִּכְתְּבִי	וַתִּכְבְּדִי
	1 c.	וַיִּכְתֹּב	וַיִּכְבֹּד

The *wayyiqtol* form is used as a past tense form, e.g., Exod 24:4. Chains of *wayyiqtol* forms form the backbone of narratives. *wayyiqtol* forms need to be in clause initial position.² With stative verbs the *wayyiqtol* form usually has ingressive meaning, i.e., *began to* ..., e.g., Gen 41:56.

וַיִּכְתֹּב מֹשֶׁה אֶת כָּל־דִּבְרֵי יְהוָה
And Moses wrote down all the words of the Lord. (Exod 24:4)

וַיִּחְזַק הָרָעָב בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם
And the famine became severe in the land of Egypt. (Gen 41:56)

6.3 Volitive Forms

6.3.1 Introduction

Volitive forms are verbal forms that express an intention or desire. Biblical Hebrew has three volitive forms, the cohortative (1st person), the imperative (2nd person) and the jussive (2nd and 3rd person). The most frequent volitive form is the imperative which is introduced in Chapter 7.

6.3.2 The Jussive

The jussive is a volitive form that can be used in the 3rd or 2nd person. Historically, the jussive is based on the short form of the prefix conjugation *yaqtul*. The jussive forms of strong verbs are identical to the prefix conjugation forms

² Whenever another element needs to be placed in clause initial position (e.g., the negative לֹא), different verbal forms need to be used.

discussed above. Only weak verbs of the types IIIy and IIw/y have distinct jussive forms in the Qal.

The jussive is used for commands, instructions, requests and petitions in the 3rd person and in the 2nd person. It is used both in positive and negative clauses. With negative commands, the negative **אַל** is used. Positive clauses with the 2nd person jussive forms as predicate, however, are very infrequent.

יִשְׁפֹּט יְהוָה בֵּינִי וּבֵינְךָ *Let the Lord judge between me and you.* (Gen 16:5)

יָבֹא־נָא אֵלַי *Let him come to me.* (2 Kgs 5:8)

אַל-תִּשְׁלַח יָדְךָ אֶל-הַנֶּעֱר *Do not lay your hand on the boy.* (Gen 22:12)

6.3.3 The Cohortative

The cohortative – the first person volitive form – is used for exhortations, requests, wishes, or declarations of intent. It is marked by the ending *-ā* that is attached to the 1 c. sg./pl. prefix conjugation form. The thematic vowel is reduced in context forms as the ending is stressed.

		cohortative
sg.	1 c.	אֶכְתָּבָה
pl.	1 c.	נִכְתָּבָה

In pausal forms the thematic vowel is preserved and stressed: נִכְתָּבָה, אֶכְתָּבָה

וְאֶקְבְּרָה אֶת-אָבִי *and let me bury my father.* (Gen 50:5)

הָבָה נִלְפְנֶה לְבָנִים *Come now, let us make bricks.* (Gen 11:3)

6.4 The Marker of Subordination אֲשֶׁר

The word **אֲשֶׁר** serves as a marker of subordination introducing dependent clauses among which relative clauses are the most frequent. Because of this, **אֲשֶׁר** is sometimes called relative particle.

6.4.1 Relative Clauses

Relative clauses can either function as dependent attributive clauses modifying a noun or they can be substantivized replacing a noun. Unlike the relative pronouns *which* and *that* in English or *ὅς, ἡ, ὃ* etc. in Greek, אשר is not a relative pronoun in the sense that it is a constituent of the relative clause. It rather functions as a marker of subordination. As a consequence, one often finds in the relative clause a resumptive pronoun or adverb which refers back to the antecedent. If the resumptive pronoun would be the direct object of the predicate of the relative clause, it is usually dropped because it can be easily retrieved from the immediate context.³ Other resumptive elements (e.g., prepositional phrases) may be dropped, too.

If the relative clause serves as attribute to a noun, it is possible to first render אשר as *about which can be said* and translate the relative clause as if it were an independent clause. In the next step, the relative clause can be integrated smoothly into the main clause.

מִן־הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר־אַתָּה שָׁם *from the place about which can be said: you are there > from the place where you are*
(Gen 13:14)

In the overview below it is indicated which element is dropped from the relative clause.

אֵינָהּ הָאֲנָשִׁים אֲשֶׁר־בָּאוּ אֵלַיךְ הַלָּיְלָה	<i>Where are the men who came to you tonight?</i> (Gen 19:5)
וַיִּקְרָא אַבְרָם שֵׁם־בְּנוֹ אֲשֶׁר־יָלְדָהּ הָגָר יִשְׁמָעֵאל	<i>And Abram called the name of his son whom Hagar bore, Ishmael</i> (Gen 16:15; direct object)
עַל־הַדָּבָר אֲשֶׁר־דִּבֶּר אֵלָיו נָבוֹת הַיִּזְרְעֵאֵלִי	<i>... because of the word that Naboth, the Jezreelite, had said to him</i> (1 Kgs 21:4; direct object)
וַיַּעַל מֵעָלָיו אֱלֹהִים בַּמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר־דִּבֶּר אִתּוֹ	<i>And God went up from him in the place where he had spoken with him</i> (Gen 35:13; local adverbial phrase, cf. Gen 35:15)

³ An example of an resumptive pronominal element as direct object is found in 2 Kgs 16:3
כַּתְּעֲבֹת הַגּוֹיִם אֲשֶׁר הוֹרִישׁ יְהוָה אֹתָם מִפְּנֵי בְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל
according to the abominations of the peoples that the Lord had driven out before the Israelites.

Chapter 6

The following two clauses contain substantivized clauses with **אֲשֶׁר** as subject (Gen 38:10) or direct object (Exod 19:4; Exod 18:24).

וַיֵּרַע בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה	<i>And what he did was evil in the eyes of the Lord (Gen 38:10)</i>
אַתֶּם רְאִיתֶם אֲשֶׁר עָשִׂיתִי לְמִצְרַיִם	<i>You have seen what I did to Egypt (Exod 19:4)</i>
וַיַּעַשׂ כֹּל אֲשֶׁר אָמַר	<i>And he [Moses] did everything he [Jethro] had told him (Exod 18:24)</i>

Substantivized clauses with **אֲשֶׁר** may also be dependent on a preposition.

בְּאֲשֶׁר תָּמוּתִי אָמוּת	<i>Where you will die I will die (Ruth 1:17)</i>
כִּי אֶסְלַח לְאֲשֶׁר אֲשָׂאִיר	<i>... for I will forgive those whom I will leave as a remnant (Jer 50:20; with ellipsis of the direct object)</i>
וַיֵּלֶךְ אַבְרָם כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר אֵלָיו יְהוָה	<i>And Abram went according to what the Lord had said to him (Gen 12:4)</i>

6.4.2 Other Subordinate Clauses Introduced with **אֲשֶׁר**

The subordination marker **אֲשֶׁר** maybe also be used as a conjunction subordinate clauses with causal (*because*), concessive (*although*), final (*in order to*), consecutive (*so that*) or temporal (*when*) meaning.

6.5 Exercises

6.5.1 Translation of Verbal Forms

Translate the following verbal forms. Identify the gender (masc., fem., comm.) and number (sg., pl.) the forms of which the English translation is ambiguous (i.e., *you, they*). Mark the stressed syllable if stress is not on the last syllable.

1 תִּזְכְּרוּ	2 אָכַרְתָּ	3 תַּעֲבֹד	4 תִּשְׁמְרוּן	5 תִּקְרַב	6 תִּזְכְּרִי	7 נִשְׁמַע
8 אֲשַׁלַּח	9 וּמָלְכוּ	10 תִּשְׁלַחְנָה				

6.5.2 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: בְּנֵי־הוּ, גִּדְעוֹן, גִּלְעָד, יָבִישׁ גִּלְעָד, יַפְתָּח.

- 1 לא שְׁמַרְתָּ אֶת־מִצְוַת יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ⁴ אֲשֶׁר צִוָּךְ⁵ 2 וַיְהִינָה פֶקֶד אֶת־שָׂרָה כַּאֲשֶׁר אָמַר⁶ וַיַּעַשׂ יְהוָה לְשָׂרָה כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר⁷ 3 וּמְלָאכִים שָׁלַח גִּדְעוֹן בְּכָל־הָרֵאָפְרִים 4 וְלֹא שָׁמַע מֶלֶךְ בְּנֵי עַמּוֹן אֶל־דִּבְרֵי יַפְתָּח אֲשֶׁר שָׁלַח אֵלָיו⁸ 5 וּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הָלְכוּ בִיבְשָׁה⁹ בְּתוֹךְ הַיָּם 6 וַיְהִי הַמֶּלֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹה מֶלֶךְ עַל־כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל 7 וַיְהִי דָבָר־שְׁמוּאֵל לְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל 8 וַהֲרַעַב הָיָה עַל כָּל־פְּנֵי הָאָרֶץ 9 וַיָּבֹא בְנֵי־הוּ אֶל־אֶחָד יְהוָה 10 הִנֵּה לֹא בָא־אִישׁ אֶל־הַמַּחֲנֶה מִיָּבִישׁ גִּלְעָד אֶל־הַקָּהָל 11 וַיֵּלֶךְ בְּכָל־הַדֶּרֶךְ אֲשֶׁר־הָלַךְ אָבִיו¹⁰ 12 וַיְדַבֵּר אֶחָד אֶת כָּל־הַדְּבָרִים אֲשֶׁר־דִּבֶּר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה וַיַּעַשׂ הָאֵתָת לְעֵינֵי הָעָם 13 וַיֹּאמֶר לָהֶם¹¹ הִנֵּה בֵן־הַמֶּלֶךְ יִמְלֹךְ כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר יְהוָה עַל־בְּנֵי דָוִד 14 וַיִּשְׁלַח יְהוָה אִישׁ נָבִיא אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל 15 וַיִּשְׁלַח מְלָאכִים אֶל־אַחָאָב מֶלֶךְ־יִשְׂרָאֵל הָעִירָה 16 וַנִּשְׁלַח מְלָאכִים בְּכָל גְּבוּל יִשְׂרָאֵל 17 וַיִּשְׁמְעוּ¹² כִּי־פָקֵד יְהוָה אֶת־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל 18 וַיִּשְׁמַע אַבְרָם לְקוֹל שָׂרִי¹³ 19 אֶל־תִּשְׁמְעוּ אֶל־חֲזַקְיָהוּ 20 וַיִּשְׁמַע שְׁמוּאֵל אֶת כָּל־דִּבְרֵי הָעָם 21 וַיַּחְזֹק לֵב פְּרָעָה וְלֹא שָׁמַע אֲלֵהֶם¹⁴ כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר יְהוָה 22 וַיַּעֲבְדוּ אֶת־יְהוָה 23 וַיֹּאמֶר הַכֹּהֵן נִקְרָבָה הַלֵּם¹⁵ אֶל־הָאֱלֹהִים 24 בְּהוֹצִיאָךְ¹⁶ אֶת־הָעָם מִמִּצְרַיִם תַּעֲבֹדוּן אֶת־הָאֱלֹהִים עַל הָהָר הַזֶּה

⁴ אֱלֹהֶיךָ *your God*

⁵ צִוָּךְ *he commanded you.*

⁶ אָמַר *pausal form of אָמַר*

⁷ דִּבֶּר *pausal form of דִּבֶּר*

⁸ אֵלָיו *to him (ʿēlāw with silent /y/; prep. אֶל with enclitic pronoun 3 m. sg.)*

⁹ יַבְשָׁה *dry ground*

¹⁰ אָבִיו *ʾābīw his father*

¹¹ לָהֶם *to them*

¹² וַיִּשְׁמְעוּ *and they heard (plural of וַיִּשְׁמַע)*

¹³ שָׂרִי *pausal form of the name שָׂרָה*

¹⁴ אֲלֵהֶם *to them*

¹⁵ הַלֵּם *to this place, here (adv.)*

¹⁶ בְּהוֹצִיאָךְ *when you have brought out*

Chapter 7

7.1 Vocabulary

7.1.1 Verbs

בחר	Q. <i>to choose</i> (with prepositional object with בָּ or direct object)
דרש	Q. <i>to seek, resort to</i>
הרג	Q. <i>to kill, slay</i>
זבח	Q. <i>to slaughter for sacrifice, slaughter</i>
עזב	Q. <i>to leave, forsake</i>
פתח	Q. <i>to open</i>
קבר	Q. <i>to bury</i>
רדף	Q. <i>to pursue, chase, persecute</i>
שמח	Q. <i>to rejoice, be glad</i> (stative verb, 3 m. sg. SC pausal form שָׂמַח)
שבר	Q. <i>to break, break in pieces</i>
שחט	Q. <i>to slaughter</i>
שכב	Q. <i>to lie down</i> (3 m. sg. PC יִשְׁכַּב)
שפט	Q. <i>to judge, govern</i>

7.1.2 Adjectives

גָּדוֹל	<i>great</i>
חַי	<i>alive, living</i> (pl. חַיִּים)
חָכָם	<i>wise</i>
טוֹב	<i>good</i>
יָשָׁר	<i>straight, right</i>
קָדוֹשׁ	<i>holy</i>

Chapter 7

רַב *much, many, great* (pl. רַבִּים)

רַע *bad, evil* (pl. רָעִים)

7.1.3 Nouns

בְּמָה *hill, high place (often as place of worship)*

חַטָּאת *sin, sin offering* (cs. חַטָּאת; pl. abs. חַטָּאוֹת; pl. cs. חַטָּאוֹת)

עוֹלָם *long time, duration, future time, long time back*

צָבָא *army, host, war, warfare* (pl. צְבָאוֹת)

קִדְּשׁ *holiness*

שִׁפְחָה *maid, maid-servant* (pl. שִׁפְחוֹת)

7.1.4 Other Parts of Speech

אַל *not* (with the jussive)

גַּם *also, even*

מְאֹד *very* (degree particle); as a noun *strength, power*

עַתָּה *now* (adv. of time)

7.2 The Independent Personal Pronoun

7.2.1 The Forms of the Independent Personal Pronoun

The independent personal pronoun (iPP) has the following forms:

Singular				Plural			
1	c.	אֲנִי, אֲנִי	<i>I</i>	1	c.	אֲנִי, אַתָּה, הֵם	<i>we</i>
2	m.	אַתָּה	<i>you</i>	2	m.	אַתָּה	<i>you</i>
	f.	אַתְּ	<i>you</i>		f.	אַתְּ, אַתָּה	<i>you</i>
3	m.	הוא	<i>he</i>	3	m.	הֵם, הֵמָּה	<i>they</i>
	f.	היא	<i>she</i>		f.	הֵנָּה	<i>they</i>

Notes about the Forms of the Independent Personal Pronoun

1. The following pausal forms are attested (some of them have a different position of the stress than the context forms): 1 c. sg. אֲנִי and אֲנִי; 2 m. sg. אַתָּה or אַתָּה (with *zāqēf qāṭōn*); 2 f. sg. אַתְּ; 1 c. pl. אֲנַחְנוּ or אֲנַחְנוּ.
2. In the Torah, the personal pronoun of the 3 f. sg. is spelled הוּא in the Ketiv with the Qere perpetuum הִיא in almost all instances. For more information cf. Joüon and Muraoka, *A Grammar of Biblical Hebrew*, §§ 16f, 39c.
3. The existence of two different pronouns for the 1 c. sg. is remarkable. The form אֲנִי is more frequent than the form אֲנִי (874 and 359 attestations, respectively). The longer form אֲנִי was phased out in Late Biblical Hebrew. Mishnaic Hebrew only uses אֲנִי.
4. The 2 m. sg. form is five times spelled אַתָּה.
5. Rare alternative forms are אַתָּה for the 2 m. sg. (four times); אַתְּ* for the 2 f. sg. (seven times as Ketiv אַתְּ); אֲנַחְנוּ* for the 1 c. pl. (as in Mishnaic Hebrew; only in Jer 42:6 Ketiv).

7.2.2 The Use of the iPP in Nominal Clauses

In nominal clauses the iPP may be used in the following ways.

1. The independent personal pronoun is used as the subject in nominal clauses (2 Sam 12:7).
2. The independent personal pronoun is used as subject in clauses with a participle as predicate (1 Sam 17:45).
3. The 3 m. sg. form הוּא may be used in verbless clauses to disambiguate the preceding subject and the predicate (2 Sam 7:28).
4. As subject of a nominal clause, the independent personal pronoun may be used similarly to the demonstrative pronoun (2 Kgs 15:12; Lev 10:3).

אַתָּה הָאִישׁ	<i>You are the man</i> (2 Sam 12:7)
אַתָּה בָּא אֵלַי בְּחֶרֶב וּבַחֲנִית וּבְכִידוֹן וְאֶנְכִי בָא-אֵלֶיךָ בְּשֵׁם יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת אֱלֹהֵי מִעְרָכֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל	<i>You are coming to me with a sword, with a spear and with a javelin, but I come to you in the name of the Lord of hosts, the God of the ranks of Israel</i> (1 Sam 17:45)
אַתָּה-הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים	<i>You are God</i> (2 Sam 7:28)

הוא דבר־יהוה אשר דִּבֶּר
אל־יהוה This is the word of the Lord that he had spo-
ken to Jehu (2 Kgs 15:12)

הוא אשר-ה' יהוה *This is what the Lord has said ...* (Lev 10:3)

7.2.3 The Use of the iPP in Verbal Clauses

The independent personal pronoun is used as the subject in clauses with finite verbal forms as predicate (often for emphasis of the subject):

כִּי אַתָּה יֹדַעַת לְבָבְךָ *For you alone know the heart of all children*
אֶת־לֵבב כָּל־בְּנֵי הָאָדָם *of mankind (1 Kgs 8:39)*

7.2.4 The iPP as Demonstrative Pronoun

As attribute to a noun the 3rd person forms may be used as demonstrative pronouns for far deixis. The independent personal pronoun in this function follows the noun it modifies and always has the article.

הָאִישׁ הַהוּא *that man* (Lev 20:4)

הַעִיר הַהִיא *that city* (Josh 20:4)

הָאֲנָשִׁים הַהֵמָּה *those men* (Num 9:7)

This use of the iPP is frequently found in the temporal adverbial phrases **בַּיּוֹם** *on that day* and **בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם** *in those days*.

7.2.5 The iPP in Apposition to an Enclitic Pronoun

The independent personal pronoun may be used in apposition to an enclitic personal pronoun for emphasis:

בְּרַכְנִי גַם־אֲנִי אָבִי *Bless me, too, O my father* (Gen 27:34)

בִּמְקוֹם אֲשֶׁר לָקְקוּ הַכְּלָבִים
אֶת־יָדָיִם נְבוֹת יִלְקוּ הַכְּלָבִים
אֶת־דַּמְךָ גַּם־אֶתָּה
*In the place where the dogs licked the blood
of Naboth the dogs will lick even your blood
(1 Kgs 21:19)*

7.3 The Imperative

7.3.1 The Forms of the Imperative

		fientive	stative
sg.	m.	כָּתֹב	כָּבֹד
	f.	כָּתִבִי	כָּבֹדִי
pl.	m.	כָּתְבוּ	כָּבְדוּ
	f.	כָּתְבֶנָּה	כָּבְדֶנָּה

Notes

The thematic vowel of the imperative form of a verb is identical to the thematic vowel of the *yiqtol* form of that verb.

There is no *dageš lene* in the third root consonant in the fem. sg. and masc. pl. forms. The *šwa* with the second root consonant is a medial *šwa*.

Pausal forms of the fem. sg. and masc. pl. forms have the same thematic vowel as the masc. sg. form, e.g., כָּתְבוּ, כָּתְבִי, כָּבְדוּ.

If the imperative is followed by *maqqef*, the thematic vowel *holem* is shortened to *qameṣ ḥatuf*, e.g., מְלִיכָהּ-עָלֵינוּ *Reign over us!* (Judg 9:14).

An example of an imperative form of a stative verb is חֲזַק *be strong!* (Josh 1:6). The pausal form of the m. sg. imperative of the stative verb has a lengthened thematic vowel, e.g., חֲזַקֵּךְ *be bold!* (Josh 1:6).

7.3.2 The Imperative of Strong Verbs with Gutturals

		I gutt.		I ^ʔ	II gutt.	III gutt.
sg.	m.	עֲזֹב	חֲזֹק	אֲמַר	בָּחַר	שָׁלַח
	f.	עֲזְבִי	חֲזֹקִי	אֲמָרִי	בָּחַרִי	שָׁלַחִי
pl.	m.	עֲזְבוּ	חֲזֹקוּ	אֲמַרוּ	בָּחַרוּ	שָׁלְחוּ
	f.	עֲזְבֶנָּה	חֲזֹקֶנָּה	אֲמַרְנָה	בָּחַרְנָה	שָׁלַחְנָה

Notes

Like the regular verb, verbs I gutt. and I^ʔ distinguish between fientive and stative verbs. An example of an imperative form of a I^ʔ stative verb is אֲמַץ *be*

bold! (Josh 1:7).

Imperative forms of verbs with **ס** as first root consonant are always strong with a consonantal **ס** (unlike the weak verbs I' in the prefix conjugation forms, e.g., **יֹאמֶר**). The thematic vowel is either *holem* or *pataḥ* depending on the verb type as fientive or stative, e.g., **אָמַר** *say!*, **אֲמִץ** *be bold!*

In the fem. sg. and masc. pl. forms, II gutt. verbs have the vowel *pataḥ* with the first root consonant and a composite *šwa* (*ḥaṭef pataḥ*) with the second root consonant instead of a silent *šwa*.

7.3.3 The Long Form of the Imperative

The imperative masc. sg. may be expanded by attaching the ending *-ā*. This ending is called paragogic **ה**. It occurs about 288 times in the Hebrew Bible. It “has, in general, no appreciable different nuance from the usual form” (JM § 114m). Illustrative forms are: **אֲכַלָּה** *ʾaklā eat!* (sometimes **מִכְרָה** *sell!*), **שְׁמַעָה** *hear!* (III gutt.).

In pausal forms the ending *-ā* is unaccented and the thematic vowel which is reduced in context forms, is preserved, e.g., **שְׁמַעָה** *hear!*.

7.3.4 The Use of the Imperative

The imperative is used mainly for commands and wishes.

שָׁמַר אֶת־הָאִישׁ הַזֶּה	<i>Guard this man</i> (1 Kgs 20:39)
וְעַתָּה שְׁמַע לְקוֹל דְּבָרֵי יְהוָה	<i>And now, listen to the voice of the words of the Lord</i> (1 Sam 15:1)
פָּתְחוּ אֶת־פִּי הַמְעָרָה	<i>Open the mouth of the cave</i> (Josh 10:22)
קַבְּצוּ אֶת־כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל הַמִּצְפָּתָה	<i>Gather all Israel to Mizpah</i> (1 Sam 7:5)

Imperatives may be used with an independent personal pronoun (2nd person) as subject, e.g., **לֵךְ אַתָּה** *Come!* (Judg 9:14).

The imperative may be used for addressing a superior like a king or God without being impolite.

The imperative is never used with a negative. Instead, either the jussive is used with **אַל** (the so-called prohibitive) or the prefix conjugation (*yiqṭol* form) is used with **לֹא** (the so-called vetitive). The prohibitive is usually used for specific negative commands in a certain situation, whereas the vetitive typically occurs

in general prohibitions in legal texts. Either form, however, can be found in contexts where one would expect the other.

אַל־תִּשְׁפֹּךְ דָּם	<i>Do not shed blood</i> (Gen 37:22)
אַל־תִּעֲמֹד	<i>Don't stop</i> (1 Sam 20:38)
לֹא־תִכְרֹת לָהֶם וְלֹא־לֵהֶם בְּרִית	<i>Do not make a covenant with them or their gods</i> (Exod 23:32)

The three volitive forms, the imperative, the jussive and the cohortative, may be followed by the particle **נָא**. The function of **נָא** is not completely clear. It may be indicating a polite request. According to a different interpretation, **נָא** is used if the speaker expects some resistance to the request or command or if the request comes unexpectedly or does not flow from the context. It is advisable to leave **נָא** untranslated.

דְּרִשׁ־נָא כִּיּוֹם אֶת־דְּבַר יְהוָה	<i>Seek first the word of the Lord</i> (1 Kgs 22:5)
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7.4 Nominal Clauses

Clauses without a finite verbal form as predicate are called nominal clauses. The subject is typically a noun or pronoun. Predicates can be nouns, adjectives or prepositional phrases.

If the predicate is indefinite, the nominal clause has descriptive or classifying function.

נַעַר מִצְרַיִם אָנֹכִי	<i>I am a young man from Egypt</i> (1 Sam 30:13)
הָרָה אָנֹכִי	<i>I am pregnant</i> (2 Sam 11:5)

If the predicate is definite, the nominal clause has identifying function.

אֲנִי יוֹסֵף	<i>I am Joseph</i> (Gen 45:3)
אָנֹכִי הָרֹאֶה	<i>I am the seer</i> (1 Sam 9:19)
אָנֹכִי אֱלֹהֵי אַבְרָהָם אָבִיךָ	<i>I am the God of Abraham, your father</i> (Gen. 26:24)

Prepositional phrases can also function as predicate of a nominal clause.

יִהְיֶה אֲנֹכִי עִמָּךְ *Behold, I am with you* (Gen 28:15)

מִחֲרָן אֲנִיחֵנוּ *We are from Haran* (Gen 29:4)

The most common unmarked constituent order of nominal clauses is subject–predicate. The reasons for deviating from this constituent order are diverse.

Nominal clauses are timeless. The default location in time is the present. In a past tense context, however, nominal clauses are located in the past. To make past or future reference explicit, forms of the verb *הָיָה* *to be* are used (→ 12.2). Temporal adverbs may serve the same function, e.g., *וּמָחָר אַתָּה וּבָנֶיךָ עִמִּי* *and tomorrow you and your sons will be with me* (1 Sam 28:19).

The independent personal pronoun *הוּא* may be used in nominal clauses as an additional element. Different explanations were presented for this use of *הוּא*. It possibly functions to disambiguate the preceding subject and the predicate.

אַתָּה־הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים *You are God* (2 Sam 7:28)

7.5 Adjectives

7.5.1 The Use of the Adjective

Adjectives are a subcategory of the noun. Adjectives have have three different functions in Hebrew:

1. As attribute they modify (describe) a noun (2 Sam 14:2).
2. They can be used independently like other nouns (the so-called substantivized use) (Qoh 2:14).
3. They can be used as the predicate of a nominal clause (Jer 8:8).

וַיִּקַּח מִשָּׁם אִשָּׁה חָכְמָה *And he took from there a wise woman* (2 Sam 14:2)

מִי כְּהָחֲכָם *Who is like the wise?* (Qoh 8:1)

חָכְמִים אֲנִיחֵנוּ *We are wise* (Jer 8:8)

Adjective phrases can be expanded with the degree particle *מְאֹד* *very*, e.g., *אִישׁ חָכָם מְאֹד* *a very wise man* (2 Sam 13:3). Sometimes, the preposition *עַד* *up to, until* is added, e.g., *חֲרָדָה גְּדֹלָה עַד־מְאֹד* *a very strong trembling* (Gen 27:33). Originally, *מְאֹד* is a noun meaning *strength, power*.

7.5.2 The Forms of the Adjective

As a subcategory of the noun, adjectives have the same endings except for the fact that they are not used in the dual. Adjectives with changeable vowels follow the rules for vowel reduction for nouns (→ 4.5.4).

	Masculine	Feminine
Singular	Ø טוב	-ā טובה
Plural	-īm טובים	-ōt טובות

7.5.3 Adjectives as Attribute or Predicate

If used as attribute, adjectives follow the noun they modify and must agree with the noun in number and gender. If the modified noun is definite, the adjective takes the article. The following examples illustrate this.

אִישׁ גָּדוֹל	<i>a great man</i> (2 Kgs 5:1)
מְלָכִים גָּדוֹלִים	<i>great kings</i> (Jer 25:14)
אִשָּׁה גְּדוּלָּה	<i>a wealthy woman</i> (2 Kgs 4:8)
מַמְלָכוֹת גְּדוּלוֹת	<i>great kingdoms</i> (Jer 28:8)
הַיָּם הַגָּדוֹל	<i>the great sea</i> (i.e., the Mediterranean Sea) (Josh 23:4)
הַבְּרֶכָה הָעֲלִיּוֹנָה	<i>the upper pool</i> (2 Kgs 18:17)
הַהָרִים הַגְּבוּהִים	<i>the high mountains</i> (Gen 7:19)
הָאֲתוֹת הַגְּדוּלוֹת	<i>the great signs</i> (Josh 24:17)

Note

Agreement is also required in the case of fem. nouns without a fem. ending, e.g., הָעִיר הַגְּדוּלָּה *the great city* (Gen 10:12).

If used as predicate of nominal clauses, adjectives agree with the subject in gender and number.

טוֹבָה הָאֶרֶץ מְאֹד מְאֹד *The land is exceedingly good* (Num 14:7)

7.5.4 Comparative and Superlative

Unlike English or Greek, Hebrew does not have distinct forms to express the comparative (e.g., *higher*) or the superlative (e.g., *highest*). For the comparative, a prepositional phrase with מִן is used to indicate the entity with which something is compared; the adjective itself remains unchanged. This is illustrated by the following examples with the adjectives מְתוֹק *sweet*, עָז *strong* and צְדִיק *righteous*

מִהַּמְּתוֹק מִדְּבַשׁ וּמִהַּ עָז מֵאַרְיֵה *What is sweeter than honey and what is stronger than a lion?* (Judg 14:18)
 צְדִיק אַתָּה מִמֶּנִּי *You are more righteous than I* (1 Sam 24:18)

For the superlative, the adjective is used with the definite article or it is made definite by other means, e.g., a definite dependent noun in a construct chain.

הָעִיר הַקְּרִבָּה אֶל-הַחָלָל *the town that is nearest to the slain man*
 (Deut 21:3)
 יְהוֹאָחָז קָטָן בְּנָיו *Jehoahaz, his youngest son* (2 Chr 21:17)

If the two entities that are compared are incommensurable, the particle *too* together with a prepositional phrase with *for* may be used in English.

קוּם אֲכַל כִּי רַב מְנַחֵךְ *Get up, eat, for the journey is too much for you* (1 Kgs 19:7)
 הַהֲרֹךְ

7.6 Exercises

7.6.1 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: בָּאֵר, אֵיזֶבֶל, אַבְיִמֶלֶךְ. תְּבוּר, צִלְמֶנֶעַ, יִשִּׁי, זָבַח, בֶּלֶק, בִּלְעָם, בֵּית לָחֶם, שֶׁבַע.

- 1 וַיִּכְרְתוּ בְרִית בֵּין בָּאֵר שֶׁבַע¹ 2 וַיֹּאמֶר שְׁמוּאֵל אֶל-יִשִּׁי לֹא-בָחַר יְהוָה בְּאַלְהָה
- 3 וַיִּבְחַר מִנְּשֵׁה אֲנָשֵׁי-חַיִּל מִכָּל-יִשְׂרָאֵל 4 וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל-זָבַח וְאֶל-צִלְמֶנֶעַ אֵיפָה²
- הָאֲנָשִׁים אֲשֶׁר הִרְגָתֶם בְּתְבוּר 5 וַיֹּגֵד³ אַבְיָתָר לְדָוִד כִּי הָרַג שְׂאוּל אֶת כַּהֲנֵי

¹ בָּאֵר שֶׁבַע pausal form of the place name

² אֵיפָה *where?*

³ וַיֹּגֵד *and (he) told*

יהוה 6 וַיִּגְדֹּר⁴ אַחֲאָב לְאִיזָבֵל אֵת כָּל־אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה אֱלֹהֵינוּ וְאֵת כָּל־אֲשֶׁר הָרַג
 אֶת־כָּל־הַנְּבִיאים בְּחָרֵב⁵ 7 וַיַּהַרְגֵם אֶת־אֲנָשֵׁי הָעִיר 8 וַיִּזְבַּח אֶת־כָּל־כַּהֲנָיו
 הַבָּמוֹת אֲשֶׁר־שָׁם עַל־הַמִּזְבְּחוֹת 9 לֹא־נָפַל דָּבָר מִכָּל הַדָּבָר הַטוֹב אֲשֶׁר־דִּבֶּר
 יְהוָה אֶל־בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל הַכֹּל בָּא 10 וַיִּזְכֹּר אֱלֹהִים אֶת־אַבְרָהָם 11 וַיִּזְכֹּר יוֹסֵף
 אֶת־הַחֲלֻמוֹת אֲשֶׁר חָלַם לָהֶם⁶ 12 וַיַּעֲזֹבוּ אֶת־יְהוָה 13 וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ פְּתָחוּ
 אֶת־פִּי הַמַּעְרָה⁷ 14 וַיִּקְבְּרוּ אֶת־הַמֶּלֶךְ בְּשִׁמְרוֹן 15 וַיֹּאמֶר הַכֹּהֵן נִקְרְבָה הַלֵּם⁸
 אֶל־הָאֱלֹהִים 16 וַיִּקְרַב אֶהֱרֹן אֶל־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ וַיִּשְׁחַט אֶת־עֹגֵל⁹ הַחֲטָאת אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ¹⁰
 17 וַיִּשְׁמַח שָׁם שָׂאוּל וְכָל־אֲנָשֵׁי יִשְׂרָאֵל עַד־מָאד 18 וַיַּעַשׂ שְׂמוּאֵל אֵת אֲשֶׁר
 דִּבֶּר יְהוָה וַיָּבֹא בֵּית לָחֶם¹¹ 19 וַיִּקַּח אֲבִימֶלֶךְ צֹאן וּבָקָר וַעֲבָדִים וּשְׂפָחוֹת וַיִּתֵּן
 לְאַבְרָהָם

⁴ וַיִּגְדֹּר *and (he) told*

⁵ חָרֵב pausal form of חָרֵב

⁶ הָלֶם *he had dreamed regarding them*

⁷ מַעְרָה *cave*

⁸ הַלֵּם *here*

⁹ עֹגֵל *young bull, ox*

¹⁰ לוֹ lit. *to him, i.e., belonged to him*

¹¹ בֵּית לָחֶם pausal form of בֵּית לָחֶם

Chapter 8

8.1 Vocabulary

8.1.1 Verbs

בטח	Q. to trust, be confident
בער	Q. to burn (intransitive)
ברך	Q. to bless (in the Qal only part. pass. בָּרַךְ blessed)
גאל	Q. to redeem
גדל	Q. to be great, become great, grow up (stative verb)
חשב	Q. to think, consider, regard, plan, devise
לכד	Q. to capture, seize, take
עמד	Q. to stand, take one's stand, to stop (cease moving)
פרש	Q. to spread out, spread
קבץ	Q. to gather, collect
רחץ	Q. to wash, bathe
שרף	Q. to burn completely (transitive)
שכן	Q. to settle down, dwell

8.1.2 Nouns

אֹיֵב	enemy
אַרְז	cedar
גִּמְלָה	camel (pl. גִּמְלִים)
דֶּלֶת	door (fem., du. דְּלֶתַיִם, pl. דְּלֶתוֹת)
חִכְמָה	wisdom (ḥokmā)

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חֵן	<i>favor, grace</i> (gem. noun; with ePP חֵנִי)
חֹשֶׁךְ	<i>darkness</i>
כֶּכֶר	<i>round loaf, talent, vicinity</i> (esp. the region of the Jordan) (fem.)
כַּף	<i>the hollow, flat of the hand, hand, sole (of the foot)</i> (gem. noun; dual כַּפַּיִם)
מַרְאֶה	<i>sight, appearance, vision</i>
סוּס	<i>horse</i>
רֶכֶב	<i>chariotry, chariots</i> (collective), <i>chariot</i> (rare meaning)

8.1.3 Prepositions

אַחֲרַי	<i>after, behind</i> (local and temporal)
לִפְנֵי	<i>in front of, before</i> (local and temporal) (prep. לְ + פְּנִים)
נֶגֶד	<i>in front of, in sight of, opposite to</i>
עַד	<i>up to, as far as, until</i> (local and temporal)
תַּחַת	<i>under, beneath, instead of, in place of</i>

8.1.4 Other Parts of Speech

לְאמֹר	<i>introduction of direct speech</i> (<i>lē(')mōr</i>)
תָּמִיד	<i>continuously, always</i> (adv.), <i>continuity</i> (noun)

8.2 Nouns with Enclitic Personal Pronouns

Nouns may be combined with enclitic personal pronouns (ePP) to express the idea of possession. They are attached directly to the noun which may then undergo changes in its form (see below), e.g., בֵּיתִי *my house*. Most forms of

8.2 Nouns with Enclitic Personal Pronouns

the enclitic personal pronouns show formal similarities with the corresponding independent personal pronouns.

			ePP	iPP	
sg.	1	c.	יְ -	אֲנִי	
		m.	*-ka >	אֹתָהּ	
	2	f.	*-ki >	אֹתָּהּ	< *ʾatti
		m.	*-ahu >	הוּא	
	3	f.	הָ -	הִיא	
pl.	1	c.	נִי -	אֲנֵינוּ	
		m.	כֶּם -	אַתֶּם	
	2	f.	כֶּן -	אַתֶּן	
		m.	הֶם -	הֵם	
	3	f.	הֵן -	הֵנָּה	

Enclitic personal pronouns may also express other ideas than possession like the object of an implied action, e.g., **הַמַּטְּרִי** *the wrong done to me* (Gen 16:5).

8.2.1 Singular Nouns with Enclitic Personal Pronoun

With singular nouns, the connecting vowels /ā/ and /ē/ are used for the forms with the 2 f. sg. 3 f. sg. 1 c. pl. and 3 m./f. pl. enclitic pronouns.

			masc.	fem.
1	c.	sg.	סוּסִי <i>my horse</i>	סוּסָתִי <i>my mare</i>
	m.	sg.	סוּסְךָ <i>your horse</i>	סוּסְתְּךָ <i>your mare</i>
2	f.	sg.	סוּסֶיךָ <i>your horse</i>	סוּסְתֶיךָ <i>your mare</i>
	m.	sg.	סוּסוֹ <i>his horse</i>	סוּסָתּוֹ <i>his mare</i>
3	f.	sg.	סוּסֶיהָ <i>her horse</i>	סוּסְתֶיהָ <i>her mare</i>

			masc.	fem.
1	c.	pl.	סוּסָנוּ <i>our horse</i>	סוּסָתָנוּ <i>our mare</i>
2	m.	pl.	סוּסְכֶם <i>your horse</i>	סוּסְתֶכֶם <i>your mare</i>
	f.	pl.	סוּסְכֶן <i>your horse</i>	סוּסְתֶן <i>your mare</i>
3	m.	pl.	סוּסָם <i>their horse</i>	סוּסָתָם <i>their mare</i>
	f.	pl.	סוּסָן <i>their horse</i>	סוּסָתָן <i>their mare</i>

Notes about the Form of Enclitic Personal Pronouns on Singular Nouns

1. Distinct pausal forms are only found with the 2 m. sg. enclitic pronoun with singular nouns (סוּסְךָ and סוּסְתְּךָ).
2. The 3 m. sg. enclitic personal pronoun was originally *-hū*. Together with the connecting vowel /a/ the suffix developed on singular nouns from *-āhū* via elision (loss) of the intervocalic /h/ and contraction of the diphthong to its current form: *-āhū* > *-aw* > *-ō*. The spelling of the 3 m. sg. enclitic personal pronoun in Hebrew inscriptions ה- reflects the older form with /h/ before it elision, e.g., [ע]בְדָה *his servant* (Lachish 2:5). The same spelling is sometimes found in the Hebrew Bible, e.g., the Ketiv אֶהְיֶה with the Qere אֶהְיֶה in Gen 12:8 or הַכֹּל *its entirety* in 2 Sam 2:9.
3. With nouns ending in *segol-he* (e.g., שְׂדֵה) the enclitic pronoun 3 masc. sg. is *-ēhū*, e.g., שְׂדֵהוּ *his field*.
4. With the nouns אָב (cs. st. אָבִי), אָח (cs. st. אָחִי), פֶּה (cs. st. פִּי) the 3 m. sg. enclitic pronoun is either *-hū* or *-w*, e.g., אָבִיהוּ or אָבִיו *ābīw*, אָחִיהוּ or אָחִיו *āhīw*, פִּיהוּ or פִּיו *pīw*.

8.2.2 Plural Nouns with Enclitic Personal Pronoun

With plural nouns with the plural ending *-īm*, the enclitic pronouns are attached to the original form of cs. st. with subsequent vowel contraction in all forms except the forms with 1 c. sg. and 2 f. sg. enclitic pronoun.

			masc.	fem.
1	c.	sg.	סוּסִי <i>my horses</i>	סוּסוֹתִי <i>my mares</i>

8.2 Nouns with Enclitic Personal Pronouns

			masc.	fem.	
2	m. sg.	סוֹסֶיךָ	<i>your horses</i>	סוסוֹתֶיךָ	<i>your mares</i>
	f. sg.	סוֹסֶיְךָ	<i>your horses</i>	סוסוֹתֶיךָ	<i>your mares</i>
3	m. sg.	סוֹסָיו	<i>his horses</i>	סוסוֹתָיו	<i>his mares</i>
	f. sg.	סוֹסֶיהָ	<i>her horses</i>	סוסוֹתֶיהָ	<i>her mares</i>
1	c. pl.	סוֹסֵינוּ	<i>our horses</i>	סוסוֹתֵינוּ	<i>our mares</i>
2	m. pl.	סוֹסֵיכֶם	<i>your horses</i>	סוסוֹתֵיכֶם	<i>your mares</i>
	f. pl.	סוֹסֵיכֶן	<i>your horses</i>	סוסוֹתֵיכֶן	<i>your mares</i>
3	m. pl.	סוֹסֵיהֶם	<i>their horses</i>	סוסוֹתֵיהֶם	<i>their mares</i>
	f. pl.	סוֹסֵיהֶן	<i>their horses</i>	סוסוֹתֵיהֶן	<i>their mares</i>

Notes about the Form of Enclitic Personal Pronouns on Plural Nouns

1. The pausal form of plural nouns with the 1 comm. sg. enclitic pronoun is סוֹסֵי.
2. The 3 m. sg. enclitic personal pronoun with plural nouns is pronounced *-āw* (the ך is *not* pronounced), e.g., יָמָיו *yāmāw his days*. This is often reflected in the phonetic spelling without ך in the Ketiv, e.g., וְאִנְשֵׁי *and his men* (with the Qere וְאִנְשָׁיו) (1 Sam 23:4). This phonetic spelling is already attested in a Hebrew inscription from the early 6th century BCE: אִנְשֵׁי *his men* (Lachish 3:18).
3. With plural nouns with the ending *-ōt* the 3 m. pl. enclitic pronoun may be *-ām*, especially with the noun אָב, e.g., אֲבוֹתָם *their fathers* (the form אֲבוֹתֵיהֶם is only attested in Late Biblical Hebrew), שְׁמוֹתָם *their names*. With the 3 f. pl. suffix the form שְׁמוֹתֵיהֶן *their names* is attested.

8.2.3 Changes of Nouns with Enclitic Personal Pronouns

Enclitic pronouns are attached to the cs. st. of nouns. This can be clearly seen with feminine nouns with feminine ending.

abs. st.	cs. st.	with ePP	
שִׁפְחָה	שִׁפְחָתָהּ	שִׁפְחָתָהּ	<i>her maidservant</i>
אִשָּׁה	אִשְׁתָּהּ	אִשְׁתִּי	<i>my wife</i>

Vowel changes may happen when an enclitic pronoun is attached, e.g., **דְּכָרִי** *my words*. For details see Section 4.5.4.

Enclitic pronouns on nouns ending in *segol-he* are attached to the last root consonant of the noun, **שְׂדֶךְ** *your field*, **שְׂדֶחָהּ** *her field*, **מִחְנֶהוּ** *his army*.

With geminate nouns, the gemination is restored when enclitic pronouns are attached, e.g., **עַמּוֹ** *his people*.

For irregular nouns with enclitic pronouns see Section 5.2.

8.3 The Participle

8.3.1 The Forms of the Participle Active Qal

The participle in Hebrew is a verbal noun (or verbal adjective) which is inflected for gender and number like the adjective. The participle active Qal has the following forms:

	Masculine	Feminine
Singular	כָּתֵב	כּוֹתֶבֶת
Plural	כּוֹתְבִים	כּוֹתְבוֹת

Notes

1. In the Masoretic Text, the plene spelling of the participle **כוֹתֵב** is much less frequent than the defective spelling **כָּתֵב**.
2. The vowel /ō/ is unchangeable. This vowel developed via the Canaanite sound change $\bar{a} > \bar{o}$: **kātib > kōtēb*.
3. The f. sg. form has the alternative form **כּוֹתֶבָהּ**.
4. Verbs with gutturals show the expected vowel changes: Verbs II gutt. **בּוֹחֲזִים**, etc.; verbs III gutt. **שּׁוֹלְחִים**, **שּׁוֹלְחָהּ**.
5. Stative verbs form a participle with the vowel pattern **כָּבֵד** with the forms **כָּבֵד** (masc. sg.), **כּוֹבְדִים** (masc. pl.), **כּוֹבְדָהּ** (fem. sg.), **כּוֹבְדוֹת** (fem. pl.).

8.3.2 The Forms of the Participle Passive Qal

	Masculine	Feminine
Singular	כָּתוּב	כּוֹתוּבָהּ
Plural	כּוֹתוּבִים	כּוֹתוּבוֹת

Note

In forms with an ending, the long vowel /ū/ is frequently spelled defectively, e.g., כְּתוּבִים *written, inscribed* (Deut 9:10).

8.3.3 The Use of the Participle

Like the adjective, the participle can be used as attribute, as predicate or substantivized. The same rules for the position of the attribute and the agreement between the governing noun and the attribute apply as for the adjective (→ 7.5.3).

The active participle is basically timeless and indicates progressive (on-going) or – at times – repeated events. Normally, the active participle refers to ongoing events like the English present progressive but it is also used for future events, especially events in the near future. In a past tense context it can also refer to past events. In narratives, the participle is frequently used in circumstantial clauses (with reference to the past).

The participle of the stative verb with the pattern כָּבֵד often functions like a normal adjective, e.g., עַמְּךָ הַכָּבֵד הַזֶּה *this your great people*. But it can also indicate a process, e.g., the participle נִגְדַל in עַד יִגְדַל וְנִגְדַל עַד כִּי־יִגְדַל מְאֹד *and the man become wealthier and wealthier, until he was very wealthy* (Gen 26:13).

The passive participle indicates a state that is the result of a preceding action.

Examples of the Attributive Use

In the following examples the participle is used as an attribute to a noun.

עַם בֹּטֵחַ	<i>an unsuspecting people</i> (Judg 18:10)
הָעָם הַיֹּשֵׁב בְּאֶרֶץ	<i>the people that lives in the land</i> (Num 13:28)
מִזְבֵּחַ יְהוָה הַהָרוּס	<i>the demolished altar of the Lord</i> (1 Kgs 18:30)

Examples of the Predicative Use

The predicative use of the participle is illustrated by the following examples.

הִנֵּה־עָם יוֹרֵד מִרְאשֵׁי הַהָרִים	<i>Look, people are coming down from the mountaintops</i> (Judg 9:36)
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רָאָה נָא אֲנִי יוֹשֵׁב בְּבֵית אֲרָזִים	<i>See, I am living in a house of cedar</i> (2 Sam 7:2)
בָּרוּךְ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי אֲדָנִי אַבְרָהָם	<i>Blessed be the Lord, the God of my master Abraham</i> (Gen 24.27)
וַיִּרְאוּ וַהֲגִידוּ דְלֹתוֹת הַעֲלִיָּה נִעְלָלוּ	<i>And they saw that the doors of the roof- chamber were locked</i> (Judg 3:24)
רָאִיתִי אֶת־יְהוָה יוֹשֵׁב עַל־כִּסֵּאוֹ	<i>I have seen the Lord sitting on his throne</i> (1 Kgs 22:19)

Examples of the Substantivized Participle

Examples of substantivized participles can be found in the following references.

אָרוּר נָתַן אִשָּׁה לְבִנְיָמִן	<i>Cursed is the one who gives a wife to Ben- jamin</i> (Judg 21:18)
וַיֵּצְאוּ מֵעָלָיו כָּל־הָעֹמְדִים עָלָיו	<i>and all those who were standing beside him went out from him</i> (Judg 3:19)

The Active Participle and its Complements

As a verbal adjective, the participle also has properties of the verb in the sense that it allows certain complements to be connected with it in all its three uses (as attribute, as predicate or substantivized). These can be direct objects and/or indirect objects (Judg 21:18), prepositional objects (1 Kgs 19:5) or local complements (Num 13:29).

אָרוּר נָתַן אִשָּׁה לְבִנְיָמִן	<i>Cursed is the one who gives a wife to Ben- jamin</i> (Judg 21:18)
וַהֲגִידָה מַלְאָךְ נֹגֵעַ בּוֹ	<i>And behold, here an angel touched him</i> (1 Kgs 19:5)
עַמְלֵק יוֹשֵׁב בְּאֶרֶץ הַנֶּגֶב	<i>Amalek is living in the land of the Negev</i> (Num 13:29)

Complements can be connected to the participle in the construct state. This even applies to prepositional phrases (Isa 9:1). Adverbial adjuncts can also be expressed as dependent nouns of participles (1 Kgs 18:19).

גִּזְזֵי צֹאנוֹ	<i>those who were shearing his sheep</i> (Gen 38:12)
יֹשְׁבֵי הָאָרֶץ	<i>the inhabitants of the land</i> (Exod 23:31)
יֹצְאֵי הַתֵּבָה	<i>those going out from the ark</i> (Gen 9:10)
יֹשְׁבֵי בְּאֶרֶץ צִלְמוֹת	<i>those living in the land of deep darkness</i> (Isa 9:1)
אֲכָלֵי שֻׁלְחַן אֵיזֶבֶל	<i>those eating at the Jezebel's table</i> (1 Kgs 18:19)

8.4 Circumstantial Clauses

A circumstantial clause gives background information to the main story line of a narrative text which is constituted by a chain of *wayyiqtol* forms. The circumstantial clause can be a nominal clause (sometimes with the copular verb *היה* *to be*), a clause with a participle or a clause with finite verb as predicate.

Circumstantial clauses can interrupt the main story line (Gen 18:1; 2 Kgs 8:7; Gen 37:24) or they can occur at the beginning of a narrative (or episode or scene) (1 Kgs 13:11). The typical constituent order of circumstantial clauses is subject-predicate.

וַיֵּרָא אֵלָיו יְהוָה בְּאֵלֶיךָ מִמָּרָא וְהוּא יֹשֵׁב פֶּתַח-הָאֹהֶל בְּחֹם הַיּוֹם	<i>And the Lord appeared to him at the terebinths of Mamre as he sat in the entrance of the tent in the heat of the day</i> (Gen 18:1)
וַיָּבֹא אֵלֵי־שָׁעַר דַּמְשָׁק וּבֶן-הַדָּד מֶלֶךְ-סְוּרָא חָלָה	<i>And Elisha came to Damascus at a time when Ben-hadad, king of Syria, was sick</i> (2 Kgs 8:7)
וַיִּקְחוּהוּ וַיִּשְׁלְכוּ אֹתוֹ תְּבִירָה וְהַתֵּבָה רִקָּה אֵין בָּהּ מַיִם	<i>And they took him and threw into the cistern; the cistern was empty, there was no water in it</i> (Gen 37:24)
וַיְהִי אִתּוֹ אֶחָד זָקֵן יֹשֵׁב בְּבֵית-אֵל וַיָּבֹא בְנוֹ	<i>There was an old prophet living in Bethel. Now his son came ...</i> (1 Kgs 13:11)

The circumstantial clause may even interrupt the clause on the main level of the narrative. In this case circumstantial clause is a parenthesis in Hebrew. In the following example the circumstantial clause is located before the direct speech which is the direct object of the verb *וַיֹּאמֶר*.

וַיֹּאמְרוּ לִי הַמֶּלֶךְ וְהַשֹּׁנֵל
יֹשֶׁבֶת אֶצְלוֹ עַד-מָתִי יִהְיֶה
מִהֶלְכְּךָ *And the kings asked me with the queen sitting
next to him, "How long will your journey be?"*
(Neh 2:6)

A clause with the structure *wā-X-qatal* that refers to an anterior event can also be classified as a circumstantial clause.

וַיֹּאמְרוּ אֲבִשָּׁלוֹם וְכָל-אִישׁ
יִשְׂרָאֵל טוֹבָה עֲצַת חוּשִׁי
הָאֲרָכִי מֵעֲצַת אַחִיתֹפֶל
וַיְהִי צִוָּה לְהַפְּרֹת אֶת-עֲצַת
אַחִיתֹפֶל הַטּוֹבָה *And Absalom and everyone of Israel said,
"The counsel of Hushai the Archite is better
than the counsel of Ahithophel." But the Lord
had ordained to thwart the good counsel of
Ahithophel* (2 Sam 17:14)

8.5 Exercises

8.5.1 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: יִפְתָּח, זָבֹל, גִּלְעָד, גִּלְעָד, יִשְׁבָּח, סִינִי, נַעֲמָן, מִצְפָּה, יִשִּׁי.

1 בְּרוּךְ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מִן-הָעוֹלָם וְעַד הָעוֹלָם 2 וַיִּלְכְּדוּ אֶת-הָעִיר 3 וַיֵּרָא
אִשָּׁה רֹחֶצֶת מַעַל הַגֹּגִי¹ וְהָאִשָּׁה טוֹבַת מְרָאָה מְאֹד 4 וְאֶל-תַּעֲמֹד בְּכָל-הַפֶּקֶד
5 וַיָּבֹא אֶל-הָאִישׁ וְהָיָה עִמָּד עַל-הַגְּמָלִים עַל-הָעֵינִי² 6 וַתִּקְרְבוּ וַתַּעֲמֹדוּן תַּחַת
הָהָר וְהָהָר בָּעֵר בָּאֵשׁ עַד-לֵב הַשָּׁמַיִם חֹשֶׁךְ עָנָן וְעֶרְפֶּל³ 7 וְאַתֶּם אֶל-תַּעֲמֹדוּ
רַדְפוּ אַחֲרֵי אִיבֵיכֶם 8 וַיַּעֲמֹד שְׁלֹמֹה לִפְנֵי מִזְבֵּחַ יְהוָה נֶגֶד כָּל-קָהֵל יִשְׂרָאֵל
וַיִּפְרֹשׁ כַּפָּיו הַשָּׁמַיִם 9 בְּרוּךְ אַתָּה בְּנֵי דָוִד 10 וַיִּשְׁכַּב שְׁמוּאֵל עַד-הַפֶּקֶד
וַיִּפְתַּח אֶת-דִּלְתוֹת בֵּית-יְהוָה 11 וַיִּשְׁלַח שְׁאוּל אֶל-יִשִּׁי לֵאמֹר יַעֲמֹד-נָא דָוִד
לִפְנֵי כִי-מִצָּא⁴ חֵן בְּעֵינַי 12 וַיִּקַּץ⁵ שְׁלֹמֹה וְהָיָה חֵלֹם וַיָּבֹא יְרוּשָׁלַם וַיַּעֲמֹד לִפְנֵי
אֲרוֹן בְּרִית-אֲדֹנָי 13 אֲשֶׁר־⁶ אֲנִשִּׁיךְ אֲשֶׁר־יְיָ אֱלֹהֶ⁷ הָעֹמְדִים לִפְנֵיךְ תָּמִיד

¹ גֹּגִי (flat) roof

² עֵינִי pausal form of עֵין eye, spring

³ עֶרְפֶּל thick darkness

⁴ מִצָּא he found

⁵ וַיִּקַּץ and he woke up

⁶ אֲשֶׁר־ O the blessedness/happiness of ...!

⁷ A demonstrative pronoun modifying a noun with enclitic personal pronoun does not get the article (cf. JM § 138g).

14 וַיָּבֹא נֶעְמָן בְּסוּסָיו וּבְרֶכְבּוֹ וַיַּעֲמֵד פֶּתַח-הַבַּיִת לְאֵלִישָׁע
 15 וַיִּקְבֹּץ יִפְתָּח אֶת-כָּל-אֲנָשֵׁי גִלְעָד 16 וַיֹּאמֶר שְׂמוּאֵל קִבְּצוּ אֶת-כָּל-יִשְׂרָאֵל
 הַמְצַפֶּתָה 17 וַיָּבֹא דָוִד וְאֲנָשָׁיו אֶל-הָעִיר וְהָיָה שְׂרוּפָה בְּאֵשׁ 18 וַיִּשְׁכֵּן
 בְּבוֹד-יְהוָה עַל-הַר סִינִי 19 וַיֵּרָא-נֶעַל אֶת-הָעָם וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל-זָבֹל הִנֵּה-עָם יוֹרֵד
 מִרְאשֵׁי הַהָרִים 20 רְאֵה נָא אֲנֹכִי יוֹשֵׁב בְּבֵית אֲרָזִים וְאֶרֶן הָאֱלֹהִים יֹשֵׁב בְּתוֹךְ
 הַיְרִיעָה⁸ 21 בְּרוּךְ אַתָּה בָּעִיר וּבְרוּךְ אַתָּה בַּשָּׂדֶה 22 בְּרוּךְ-יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי
 יִשְׂרָאֵל מִן-הָעוֹלָם וְעַד הָעוֹלָם

⁸ יְרִיעָה *tent curtain*

Chapter 9

9.1 Vocabulary

9.1.1 Verbs

ברח	Q. to run away, flee
דרך	Q. to tread (cf. דֶּרֶךְ way), with קָשָׁת to bend the bow
זעק	Q. to cry, cry out, call
עבר	Q. to pass over, through, by, pass on
צעק	Q. to cry, cry out, call
קרע	Q. to tear
תפש	Q. to lay hold of, seize

9.1.2 Nouns

בגד	garment, clothing
בעל	owner, lord, Baal
זקן	old, old man (הַזִּקְנִים the elders)
חק	statute (pl. חֻקִּים)
ימין	right side, right hand, south
כסא	seat, chair, throne
מגן	shield (pl. מִגְנִים)
ממלכה	kingdom, sovereignty, dominion, reign (cs. st. מַמְלָכָה)
סלע	rock, cliff
עד	witness
עדות	witness, testimony, pl. laws, legal provisions (pl. עֵדוּת; with ePP also עֵדוּתָיו 'ēdwōtāw his legal provisions, etc.)
עצם	bone (m. or f.; pl. עֲצָמוֹת)
קשת	bow (fem.)

Chapter 9

שְׁמאל *left side, left, north* (śamō(?)l)
 שֵׁבֶט *rod, staff, scepter, tribe*

9.1.3 Prepositions

אֵת *with, close to, beside*
 עִם *with, close to, beside*

9.1.4 Other Parts of Speech

אַחֲרֵי־כֵן *afterwards* (adv.)
 בֹּל *not* (negative used in poetry)
 בְּלִי *not; without*
 לְבִלְתִּי *not* (negative used with the inf. cs.; לְ + בִלְתִּי)
 לְכֵן *therefore* (לְ + כֵן)

9.2 Prepositions with Enclitic Personal Pronouns

Prepositions take enclitic pronouns either in their form with singular nouns or in their form with plural nouns.

The following prepositions take singular noun type enclitic pronouns: לְ, בְּ, אֵת, עִם (and with *maqqef* אֶת־). The prepositions אֵת and עִם follow the pattern of geminate nouns with enclitic pronouns.

		Prep. לְ	Prep. בְּ	Prep. אֵת	Prep. עִם
1	c. sg.	לִי	בִּי	אֵתִי	עִמִּי, עִמָּדִי
2	m. sg.	לָךְ	בָּךְ	אֵתְךָ	עִמָּךְ
	f. sg.	לְךָ	בְּךָ	אֵתְךָ	עִמָּךְ
3	m. sg.	לוֹ	בוֹ	אֵתּוֹ	עִמּוֹ
	f. sg.	לָהּ	בָּהּ	אֵתָּהּ	עִמָּהּ

9.2 Prepositions with Enclitic Personal Pronouns

		Prep. לְ	Prep. בְּ	Prep. אֶת	Prep. עִם
1	c. pl.	לָנוּ	בָּנוּ	אֵתָנוּ	עִמָּנוּ
2	m. pl.	לָכֶם	בָּכֶם	אֵתְכֶם	עִמָּכֶם
	f. pl.	לָכֶן	בָּכֶן	—	—
3	m. pl.	לָהֶם	בָּהֶם, בָּם	אֵתָם	עִמָּהֶם, עִמָּם
	f. pl.	לָהֶן	בָּהֶן	—	—

Notes

1. The only deviating pausal form is found with the 2 m. sg. enclitic pronouns: לָךְ, בָּךְ, אֵתְךָ and עִמָּךְ instead of the context forms לְךָ, בְּךָ, אֵתְךָ and עִמָּךְ.
2. With prepositions of the singular noun type different connecting vowels than with the noun are used with the pausal form of the 2 m. sg. enclitic pronoun, the 2 f. sg. enclitic pronoun and the 2/3 m./f. pl. enclitic pronoun.
3. In poetic texts, the form of the 3 m. pl. enclitic pronoun with the preposition לְ is often לָמוּ (53 attestations; mainly in Ps, Isa, Job, Lam).

The prepositions בְּ and לְ have special forms when used with enclitic pronouns. Both prepositions take the enclitic pronouns of the singular noun type. The form of the enclitic pronoun of the 1 c. sg. is נִי-.

The preposition בְּ uses a longer form with some enclitic pronouns. With the exception of forms with 2 and 3 pl. enclitic pronoun, the preposition לְ uses reduplicated forms (**minmin-* > **mimmin-*) to which the enclitic pronoun is attached

- with no change of consonants as in the case of the 1 c. sg. and 1 c. pl. enclitic pronoun forms מִמִּנִּי (< **mimmin-nī*) and מִמִּינוּ
- with assimilation of the final /n/ of the reduplicated preposition to the first consonant of the enclitic pronoun as in the 2 m. sg. form pausal form מִמִּיךָ (< **mimmin-ka*) (the 2 m. sg. context form מִיְךָ and 2 f. sg. form with enclitic pronoun מִיְךָ reflect a further development of this type)
- with assimilation of the initial /h/ of the original form of the enclitic pronoun to the preceding /n/ as in the 3 m. sg. and 3 f. sg. enclitic pronoun forms מִמִּינִי (< **mimmin-hu*) and מִמִּינִיהָ (< **mimmin-ha*).

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			Prep. כְּ	Prep. מִן
1	c.	sg.	כְּמֹנִי	מִמֶּנִּי
2	m.	sg.	כְּמוֹךָ	מִמְּךָ, מִמְּךָ
	f.	sg.	—	מִמְּךָ
3	m.	sg.	כְּמֹהוּ	מִמֶּנּוּ
	f.	sg.	כְּמוֹהָ	מִמֶּנָּה
1	c.	pl.	כְּמֹנוּ	מִמֶּנּוּ
2	m.	pl.	כְּכֻמְכֶם, כְּמוֹכֶם	מִכֶּם
	f.	pl.	—	—
3	m.	pl.	כְּהֵם, כְּמוֹהֶם	מֵהֶם, מִהֶמָּה
	f.	pl.	כְּהֵן	מֵהֶן, מִהֶנָּה

The object marker **אֶת** has the following forms with enclitic pronouns:

		Sg.	Pl.
1	c.	אֹתִי	אֹתָנוּ
2	m.	אֹתְךָ	אֹתְכֶם
	f.	אֹתְךָ	אֹתְכֶן
3	m.	אֹתוֹ	אֹתָם, אֹתָהֶם
	f.	אֹתָהּ	אֹתָהֶן, אֹתָהֶן

Notes

1. The forms may also be spelled plene; e.g., **אוֹתִי**, **אוֹתְךָ**.
2. The pausal form with the 2 m. sg. enclitic pronoun is **אֹתְךָ**.

The following prepositions take plural noun type enclitic pronouns: **עַל**, **אֶל**, **מִן**, **מֵן**, **מִמֶּנּוּ**, **מִמֶּנָּה** (with the exception of the form **מִמֶּנּוּ** beside the form **מִמֶּנָּה**) and the compound preposition **לְפָנֵי**. The forms of the three most frequent prepositions among these are as follows.

			Prep. אֶל	Prep. עַל	Prep. לְפָנַי
1	c.	sg.	אֵלַי	עָלַי	לְפָנַי
2	m.	sg.	אֵלַיָּךְ	עָלַיָּךְ	לְפָנַיָּךְ
	f.	sg.	אֵלַיִךְ	עָלַיִךְ	לְפָנַיִךְ
3	m.	sg.	אֵלָיו	עָלָיו	לְפָנָיו
	f.	sg.	אֵלֶיהָ	עָלֶיהָ	לְפָנֶיהָ
1	c.	pl.	אֵלֵינוּ	עָלֵינוּ	לְפָנֵינוּ
2	m.	pl.	אֵלֵיכֶם	עָלֵיכֶם	לְפָנֵיכֶם
	f.	pl.	אֵלֵיכֶן	עָלֵיכֶן	לְפָנֵיכֶן
3	m.	pl.	אֵלֵיהֶם	עָלֵיהֶם	לְפָנֵיהֶם
	f.	pl.	אֵלֵיהֶן	עָלֵיהֶן	לְפָנֵיהֶן

Note

The forms with 2/3 m./f. pl. enclitic pronoun are often spelled defectively, e.g., אֵלֵיכֶם.

9.3 The Infinitive Construct**9.3.1 The Form of the Infinitive Construct**

Biblical Hebrew has two infinitives, the infinitive construct and the infinitive absolute. They differ in form and usage. As verbal nouns they render the action of the verb as such, e.g., *reading* in *I like reading*.

The infinitive construct of fientive verbs has the following forms:

	Reg. verb	I gutt.	I ʿ	II gutt.	III gutt.
inf. cs.	כָּתַב	עָזַב	אָסַר	בָּחַר	שָׁלַח

Stative verbs have the forms כָּבֵד or כָּבֹד *to be heavy*, קָטַן *to be small* and חָזַק *to be strong*.

The inf. cs. of the stative verb שָׁכַב *to lie down* is שָׁכַב or שָׁכֵב. The form שָׁכֵב occurs thirteen times with or without enclitic pronoun whereas the form שָׁכַב is attested only four times and is used only with enclitic pronouns. Otherwise, the form כָּתַב for the inf. cs. of stative verbs is rare.

When followed by *maqfēf*, the *holem* is shortened to *qameṣ ḥatuf* קָתַבְּ *kəṭəḇ*.

When the second root consonant is a *bəḡadkəfat* letter, the inf. cs. with the prefixed prepositions בְּ and בִּ is usually בִּכְתֹּב and בְּכָתֹב, respectively, without *dageš lene* in the second root consonant. But with the preposition לְ it is לְכָתֹב with *dageš lene* in the second root consonant.

9.3.2 The Infinitive Construct with Enclitic Pronouns

With enclitic pronouns the infinitive construct has the following forms.

	Sing. Pron.	Pl. Pron.
1 c.	כְּתִבִּי / כְּתִבְנִי	כְּתִבְנוּ
2 m.	כְּתִבְךָ / כְּתִבְדָּךְ	כְּתִבְכֶּם / כְּתִבְכֵּם
f.	כְּתִבְךָ	
3 m.	כְּתִבוּ	כְּתִבְם
f.	כְּתִבְהָ	

Notes

1. The *qameṣ* with the first root consonant is a *qameṣ ḥatuf*, e.g., שְׁלַחִי *šəḥlāhī* *my sending*. Likewise, when the *qameṣ* is with the second root consonant, it is a *qameṣ ḥatuf* as well, e.g., אֲכַלְכֶּם *ʾəḵlākəṃ* *your eating*.
2. There are two distinct forms of the 1 c. sg. enclitic pronoun. In the form כְּתִבִּי the enclitic pronoun expresses the subject of the infinitive construct whereas in the form כְּתִבְנִי the enclitic pronoun expresses the object, e.g., לְשַׁכְנִי *ləšəḵnī* *that I might dwell* (Exod 29:46), לְלַכְדִּנִּי *lələḵdī* *to capture me* (Jer 18:22). All other suffixes can either express either the subject of the infinitive construct or the object.
3. Instead of *qameṣ ḥatuf*, the vowel *hireq* is sometimes found with the first root consonant, e.g., שִׁבְרִי *šəḇrī* *my breaking*. The vowel *hireq* is also used for the inf. cs. with the thematic vowel /a/ קָתַבְּ, e.g., שִׁכְבָּהּ *šəḵḇāh* *her lying* (Gen 19:33).

9.3.3 The Use of the Infinitive Construct

The Infinitive Construct as a Verbal Noun

The infinitive construct can be used just like regular nouns as subject (1 Sam 15:22) or object of the clause (Deut 2:7). The infinitive construct may be used

as it is or it may be preceded by the preposition לְ (1 Sam 15:22). It is also used as the dependent noun in a construct chain (Ruth 1:1).

הִנֵּה שְׁמַע מִזֶּבַח טוֹב לְהִקְשִׁיב מִחֶלֶב אֵילִים	<i>Obeying is better than sacrifice; listening [is better] than the fat of rams</i> (1 Sam 15:22)
יָדַע לְכַתֹּף אֶת־הַמִּדְבָּר הַגָּדֹל הַזֶּה	<i>He knows your walking through this great desert</i> (Deut 2:7)
וַיְהִי בִימֵי שְׁפָט הַשְּׁפָטִים וַיְהִי רָעָב בְּאֶרֶץ	<i>In the days of the ruling of the judges there was a famine in the land</i> (Ruth 1:1)

The Infinitive Construct with Prepositions in Adverbial Constructions

With the preposition לְ the infinitive construct is frequently used as final or consecutive adjunct (Gen 37:25; 1 Kgs 16:2) or as modal adjunct by *doing so* (Deut 6:2).

וַיֵּשְׁבוּ לֵאכֹל־לֶחֶם	<i>And they sat down to eat food</i> (Gen 37:25)
וַתַּחַטֵּא אֶת־עַמִּי יִשְׂרָאֵל לְהַכְעִיסֵנִי בְּחַטָּאתָם	<i>And you made my people Israel sin so that they provoked me to anger with their sins</i> (1 Kgs 16:2)
לְמַעַן תִּירָא אֶת־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לְשֹׁמֵר אֶת־כָּל־חֻקֹּתָיו וּמִצְוֹתָיו	<i>... that you may fear the Lord your God by keeping all his statutes and his commandments</i> (Deut 6:2)

With the prepositions בְּ and כִּי the infinitive construct is used frequently as temporal adjunct.

וַיְהִי בִּבְרֹחַ אֲבִיתָר בֶּן־אֲחִימֶלֶךְ אֶל־דָּוִד קַעֲלִיָּה אֶפֶוד יָרַד בְּיָדוֹ	<i>When Abiathar the son of Ahimelech fled to David to Keilah, an ephod came down in his hand.</i> (1 Sam 23:6)
כְּשָׁמַע עֲשָׂו אֶת־דְּבָרֵי אָבִיו וַיִּצְעַק צָעָקָה גְּדֹלָה וּמָרָה עַד־מָאֹד	<i>When Esau heard the words of his father, he cried out with a very loud and bitter cry</i> (Gen 27:34)

With the preposition בְּ the infinitive construct also may have modal or causal meaning (cf. ESV for the causal translation of the infinitive with בְּ in 1 Kgs

18:18).

לֹא עָכַרְתִּי אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל כִּי
אִם־אַתָּה וּבֵית אָבִיךָ
בַּעֲזֹבְכֶם אֶת־מִצְוֹת יְהוָה
*It is not I who have brought trouble on Israel,
but you and your father's House, by forsaking
the commandments of the Lord (1 Kgs 18:18
NJPS)*

The preposition **מן** together with the infinitive construct may have (negative) consecutive (1 Sam 8:7), causal (Deut 7:8) or temporal meaning (Lev 9:22).

כִּי־אֲנִי מֵאִסּוּ מִמְּלֶכֶךְ עָלֵיהֶם
... for it is me whom they have rejected so
that I am not king over them anymore (1 Sam
8:7)

כִּי מֵאֲהַבַת יְהוָה אֶתְכֶם
וּמִשְׁמְרוֹ אֶת־הַשְּׁבָעָה אֲשֶׁר
נִשְׁבַּע לְאַבְתִּיכֶם הוֹצִיא יְהוָה
אֶתְכֶם בְּיָד חֲזָקָה
*For because the Lord loved you and because
he kept his oath that he had sworn to your
fathers, he led you out with a strong hand
(Deut 7:8)*

וַיֵּרֶד מַעֲשֵׂת הַחֲטָאת וְהַעֲלָה
וְהַשְׁלָמִים
... and he stepped down after having sacri-
ficed the sin offering, the burnt offering, and
the offering of well-being (Lev 9:22)

The Infinitive Construct as Complement

With some verbs the infinitive construct is used as a complement (usually with the preposition **לְ** and at times without). The verbs **יָכַל** *to be able*, **חָדַל** *to cease* and **נָתַן** in the meaning *to allow, permit* can be mentioned here.¹

וְלֹא־יָכְלוּ עוֹד לַעֲמֹד לִפְנֵי
אֹיְבֵיהֶם
*And they could not stand any longer before
their enemies (Judg 2:14)*

וַיַּחֲדְלוּ לְבִנֵּת הָעִיר
And they stopped building the city (Gen 11:8)

וְלֹא־נָתַנוּ אִישׁ לַעֲבֹר
*And they did not allow anyone to cross (Judg
3:28)*

Other verbs that take infinitives as complements are: **אָבָה** Q. *to be willing*, **מָאן** Pi. *to refuse*, **כָּלָה** Pi. *to finish*, **חָלַל** Hi. *to begin*. These verbs will be introduced

¹ The verb **יָכַל** is a stative verb with the vowel /ō/ as thematic vowel in the suffix conjugation. For the other forms of the verb → 13.2.

in later chapters because they are weak verbs and/or are used in a different *binyan* than Qal.

With some verbs the preposition **בְּ** can be used instead of **לְ**, e.g., **כִּלֶּה** Pi. *to finish* and **חָדַל** Q. *to cease, stop*.

The use of the infinitive construct with so-called modifying verbs will be discussed in Chapter 23.

9.4 The Infinitive Absolute

9.4.1 The Form of the Infinitive Absolute

The infinitive absolute Qal has the following form:

inf. abs. **כָּתוּב**

The inf. abs. may be spelled defectively, e.g., **אָכַל**. With a guttural as third root consonant the form is **שָׁלַח**.

9.4.2 The Use of the Infinitive Absolute

The inf. abs. is not used with prepositions, enclitic pronouns or as the governing noun in a construct chain. This fact explains the term *infinitive absolute* as opposed to the term *infinitive construct*. The following three main functions of the inf. abs. can be mentioned.

The Intensifying Use of the Infinitive Absolute

Together with another verb form of the same root the inf. abs. is used to intensify the verbal content or the meaning of the other verbal form or the nuance in its context or a combination of all these.² Usually the inf. abs. is used in the same *binyan* as the other verbal form; but sometimes it can be in a different *binyan*. The following functions can be found frequently:

1. In positive statements, the inf. abs. can be used to intensify the factuality of the statement (Gen 37:33; Gen 18:18).
2. In negative statements the inf. abs. stresses the non-realization of the event (Gen 3:4; Dan 10:3).

² Jan P. Lettinga and Heinrich von Siebenthal, *Grammatik des biblischen Hebräisch*, 2nd ed. revised and expanded by Heinrich von Siebenthal (Gießen: Brunnen; Basel: Immanuel, 2016), 337.

3. In rhetorical questions the inf. abs. denies the realization of the event (2 Kgs 18:33).³
4. The inf. abs. intensifies the modal meaning of a verbal form (Num 35:16; Lev 7:24).

חַיָּה רָעָה אֲכָלְתָּהוּ טָרֶף טָרֶף יוֹסֵף	<i>A fierce animal has devoured him. Joseph has surely been torn to pieces. (Gen 37:33)</i>
וְאַבְרָהָם הָיָה לְגוֹי גָּדוֹל וְעָצוּם	<i>Abraham will surely become a great and mighty nation. (Gen 18:18)</i>
לֹא-מוֹת תִּמָּתוֹן	<i>You will definitely not die. (Gen 3:4)</i>
וְסוּד לֹא-סָכַתִּי	<i>I did not even anoint myself. (Dan 10:3)</i>
הֲהִצִּיל הָאֱלֹהִי הַגּוֹיִם אִישׁ אֶת-אֶרְצוֹ מִיַּד מֶלֶךְ אֲשׁוּר	<i>Did any of the gods of the nations save his land from the hand of the king of Assyria? (2 Kgs 18:33)</i>
מוֹת יוֹמֶת הָרָצָח	<i>The murderer must be put to death. (Num 35:16)</i>
וְחֶלֶב נִבְלָה וְחֶלֶב טָרֶף יַעֲשֶׂה לְכָל-מְלָאכָה וְאָכַל לֹא תֹאכְלֶהוּ	<i>The fat of an animal that is dying of itself, or of a torn animal may be used for any use, but you must certainly not eat it (Lev 7:24)</i>

The Infinitive Absolute as Verbal Predicate

The inf. abs. can be used as a replacement for a finite form. It can either continue a preceding finite verbal form in which case it has the same function (Judg 7:19) or it can be used without a preceding verbal form. In this case it often replaces an imperative (Exod 20:8; Jer 2:2) or a different finite verbal form (רָגוּם in Num 15:35).

וַיִּתְקְעוּ בַשּׁוֹפָרוֹת וַנִּפּוֹץ הַכִּדָּיִם אֲשֶׁר בְּיָדָם	<i>They blew the horns and smashed the jars that were in their hands (Judg 7:19)</i>
זְכוֹר אֶת-יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת לְקֹדֶשׁ	<i>Remember the sabbath day by keeping it holy (Exod 20:8)</i>

³ Christo H. J. van der Merwe, Jacobus A. Naudé and Jan H. Kroeze, *A Biblical Hebrew Reference Grammar*, 2nd ed. (London: Bloomsbury, 2017), 179.

הֵלֵךְ וְקִרְאתָ בְּאָזְנֵי יְרוּשָׁלַם *Go and proclaim in the hearing of Jerusalem*
(Jer 2:2)

מוֹת יוֹמֶת הָאִישׁ רְגוּם אֹתוֹ *The man must be put to death, the whole con-*
בְּאֲבָנִים כָּל־הָעֵדָה מִחוּץ *gregation shall stone him with stones outside*
לַמַּחֲנֶה *of the camp* (Num 15:35)

Two Consecutive Infinitives Absolute

When the inf. abs. is used after a finite form of the same verb together with another coordinated inf. abs., the two infinitives express the idea that the two events happened simultaneously (or nearly simultaneously).

וַיִּרְדֵּהוּ אֶל־כַּפְּיוֹ וַיִּלֶךְ הֵלֹךְ *He scraped it [the honey] out into his hands*
וְאָכַל *and ate as he went along* (Judg 14:9)

וְכָל־הָעָם אֲשֶׁר־אִתּוֹ חָפּוּ *...and all the people with him had covered*
אִישׁ רֹאשׁוֹ וַעֲלוּ עָלָה וּבְכָה *their heads and they went up, weeping as they*
 went (2 Sam 15:30)

The inf. abs. הֵלֵךְ may be used together with a finite form and the infinite absolute of another verb to express the idea that an event took place continually or increasingly. (In 2 Sam 5:10 even the finite verb is a form of הֵלֵךְ leaving the inf. abs. גָּדוֹל to express the main meaning to *become greater*.)

וַיֵּסַע אַבְרָם הֵלֹךְ וְנִסְעָה *And Abram journeyed by stages to the Negeb*
הַנֶּגֶב *(Gen 12:9)*

וַיִּלֶךְ דָּוִד הֵלֹךְ וְגָדוֹל *And David became greater and greater* (2 Sam
5:10)

9.5 Exercises

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: אִיזָבֵל, אֲשֶׁרָה, בִּלְהָה, סִיחֹן, כְּרִמְל, חִירָם.

1 וַיֹּאמֶר לָכֵן שָׁמַע דְּבַר־יְהוָה רָאִיתִי⁴ אֶת־יְהוָה יֹשֵׁב עַל־כִּסֵּאוֹ וְכָל־צְבָא הַשָּׁמַיִם עֹמֵד עָלָיו מִיְמִינוֹ וּמִשְׁמָאלוֹ 2 וַעֲתָה שְׁלַח קִבְץ אֲלֵי אֶת־כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶל־הָרֶה הַכְּרָמִל וְאֶת־נָבִיא הַבַּעַל אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת וַחֲמִשִּׁים⁵ וּנְבִיאֵי הָאֲשֵׁרָה אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת⁶ אֲכָלִי שְׁלֹחַן אֵיזֶבֶל. וַיִּשְׁלַח אַחָאֵב בְּכָל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּקְבֹּץ אֶת־הַנְּבִיאִים אֶל־הָרֶה הַכְּרָמִל 3 בִּיהוָה אֱלֹהֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל בָּטַח וְאַחֲרָיו לֹא־הָיָה כְּמֹהוּ בְּכָל מַלְכֵי יְהוּדָה וְאֲשֶׁר הָיוּ⁷ לִפְנָיו 4 וַיִּשְׁלַח אַבְרָהָם אֶת־יָדוֹ וַיִּקַּח אֶת־הַמֶּאֱכָלֶת⁸ לַשַּׁחַט אֶת־בְּנוֹ 5 וַיָּבֹא אֶל־הָאִישׁ וְהָנָה עֹמֵד עַל־הַנִּמְלִים עַל־הָעֵין 6 כְּשָׁמַע עֲשׂוֹ אֶת־דְּבָרֵי אָבִיו וַיִּצְעַק צָעָקָה⁹ גְּדֹלָה וּמָרָה¹⁰ עַד־מָאֵד וַיֹּאמֶר לְאָבִיו בְּרַכְנִי¹¹ גַּם־אֲנִי אָבִי 7 וַיְהִי בִשְׁכַן יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּאֶרֶץ הַהִיא וַיֵּלֶךְ רְאוּבֵן וַיִּשְׁכַּב אֶת־בִּלְהָה פִּילֻגְשׁ¹² אָבִיו וַיִּשְׁמַע יִשְׂרָאֵל 8 וְאֵלָה הַמְּלָכִים אֲשֶׁר מָלְכוּ בְּאֶרֶץ אֲדוֹם לִפְנֵי מֶלֶךְ־מֶלֶךְ לִבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל 9 וְלֹא־נָתַן סִיחֹן אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל עֶבֶר בְּנִבְלוֹ 10 וַיְהִי כְּשָׁמַעְכֶּם אֶת־הַקּוֹל מִתּוֹךְ הַחֹשֶׁךְ וְהָהָר בָּעַר בָּאֵשׁ וַתִּקְרְבוּן אֲלֵי כָל־רָאשֵׁי שְׁבָטֵיכֶם וּזְקֵנֵיכֶם 11 וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶל־הָעָם עַדִּים אַתֶּם בָּכֶם כִּי־אַתֶּם בַּחֲרַתֶּם לָכֶם אֶת־יְהוָה לַעֲבֹד אוֹתוֹ וַיֹּאמְרוּ¹³ עַדִּים 12 וַיְהִי בַיּוֹם שִׁפְטַת הַשְּׁפָטִים וַיְהִי רָעַב בְּאֶרֶץ וַיֵּלֶךְ אִישׁ מִבֵּית לֶחֶם יְהוּדָה לְגוֹר¹⁴ בְּשָׂדֵי מוֹאָב הוּא וְאִשְׁתּוֹ וּשְׁנֵי בָנָיו¹⁵ 13 וַיֹּאמֶר שְׁמוּאֵל אֶל־שְׂאוּל אֲתִי שְׁלַח יְהוָה לְמַשְׁחָךְ לְמֶלֶךְ עַל־עַמּוֹ עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל וַעֲתָה שָׁמַע לְקוֹל דְּבָרֵי יְהוָה 14 וַיִּזְבַּח אֶת־כָּל־כֹּהֲנֵי הַבָּמֹת אֲשֶׁר־שָׁם עַל־הַמִּזְבְּחוֹת וַיִּשְׂרֹף אֶת־עֲצָמוֹת אָדָם עָלֵיהֶם וַיָּשָׁב¹⁶ יְרוּשָׁלַם 15 וַיְהִי כְּשָׁמַע חִירָם אֶת־דְּבָרֵי שְׁלֹמֹה וַיִּשְׁמַח מְאֹד וַיֹּאמֶר בְּרוּךְ יְהוָה הַיּוֹם אֲשֶׁר נָתַן לְדָוִד בֶּן חָכֶם עַל־הָעָם הָרַב הַזֶּה 16 וַיְהִי כְּשָׁמַע אַחָאֵב אֶת־הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה וַיִּקְרַע בְּגָדָיו 17 וַעֲתָה הִנֵּה יִדְעָתִי כִּי מֶלֶךְ תִּמְלֹךְ וְקָמָה¹⁷ בְּיָדְךָ מַמְלָכֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל 18 שְׁמוֹר תִּשְׁמְרוּן אֶת־מִצְוֹת יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם וְעַדְתִּיו וְחֻקֵּיו אֲשֶׁר צִוָּךְ¹⁸ 19 קְרַע אֶקְרַע אֶת־הַמֶּלֶכָה מֵעַלְיָךְ 20 וַיֵּלֶךְ דָּוִד הַלּוֹךְ וְגִדּוֹל וַיְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי צְבָאוֹת עִמּוֹ

⁴ וַיֹּאמֶר לָכֵן שָׁמַע דְּבַר־יְהוָה רָאִיתִי (*I have seen* (verb *ראה* Q. *to see*))

⁵ וַחֲמִשִּׁים מֵאוֹת אַרְבַּע *four hundred and fifty*

⁶ אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת *four hundred*

⁷ הָיוּ *they were*

⁸ מֶאֱכָלֶת *knife*

⁹ צָעָקָה *cry, outcry*

¹⁰ מָרָה *bitter*

¹¹ בְּרַכְנִי *bless me* (imperative Pi. with enclitic pronoun)

¹² פִּילֻגְשׁ *concubine*

¹³ וַיֹּאמְרוּ *and they said*

¹⁴ לְגוֹר *to sojourn* (inf. cs. with ל)

¹⁵ וּשְׁנֵי בָנָיו *and his two sons*

¹⁶ וַיָּשָׁב *wayyáshb and he returned*

¹⁷ וְקָמָה *and [it] will be established*

¹⁸ צִוָּךְ *he commanded you*

Chapter 10

10.1 Vocabulary

10.1.1 Verbs

דבק	Q. <i>to cling, cleave, keep close</i>
זרע	Q. <i>to sow, scatter seed</i>
חדל	Q. <i>to cease, come to an end; to cease, leave off</i>
נטע	Q. <i>to plant</i>

10.1.2 Nouns

בור	<i>cistern, pit</i>
גבורה	<i>strength, might</i>
חג	<i>festival, festival-gathering, pilgrim-feast</i> (pl. חגים; abs. st. also חג)
חדש	<i>new</i>
חלק	<i>portion, share, possession</i>
נאם	<i>utterance, declaration, announcement</i>
נחלה	<i>possession, property, inheritance</i>
צדיק	<i>just, righteous</i>
קנה	<i>stalk, reed</i>
ריב	<i>dispute, lawsuit, quarrel</i>
שר	<i>ruler, official, prince, captain, chieftain, chief</i> (gem. noun; pl. שרים)
שופר	<i>horn (as a wind instrument)</i>
שער	<i>gate</i>

10.1.3 Other Parts of Speech

יֵשׁ	<i>there is</i> (particle of existence)
אֵין	<i>there is not</i> (particle of non-existence)
אַצֵּל	<i>in proximity to, beside</i> (prep.)
הַרְבֵּה	<i>greatly, exceedingly, much</i> (adv.; orig. inf. abs. Hi. of רַבָּה)
לְבַד	<i>alone, by itself</i> (with ePP לְבַדּוֹ; prep. לְ with noun בַּד separation)
מְעַט	<i>a little, fewness, a few</i>
רַק	<i>only, still, but, however, nevertheless, surely</i>

10.2 The waw-Suffix Conjugation or *wəqatalṭi* Form

10.2.1 The Forms of the waw-Suffix Conjugation

The waw-suffix conjugation or *wəqatalṭi* form consists of the forms of the suffix conjugation with an obligatory conjunction וְ called *waw consecutive* (cf. 6.2.5). The only formal difference to the regular suffix conjugation (→ 5.5.1) is the position of the stress in the forms 2 m. sg. and 1 c. sg.

sg.	3 m.	וְכָתַב
	3 f.	וְכָתְבָה
	2 m.	וְכָתַבְתָּ
	2 f.	וְכָתַבְתְּ
	1 c.	וְכָתַבְתִּי
pl.	3 c.	וְכָתְבוּ
	2 m.	וְכָתְבֻתֶּם
	2 f.	וְכָתְבֵינָן
	1 c.	וְכָתְבֻנוּ

10.2.2 The Use of the waw-Suffix Conjugation

The *wəqatalṭi* form typically continues a preceding verbal form or a temporal adverbial expression. It is, however, possible that *wəqatalṭi* is used without

10.2 The waw-Suffix Conjugation or *wəqataltí* Form

a semantically similar or identical preceding verb (cf. *wəqataltí* with modal meaning as in Judg 11:8; Jer 28:13; Ezek 11:17; Ezek 25:13; following a causal clause as in 1 Kgs 20:28; with reference to the past following a *wayyiqtol* form as in 1 Sam 7:16).

wəqataltí often follows *yiqtol* and has the same meaning as the preceding *yiqtol*. A possible semantic difference between the two forms may be that *wəqataltí* adds the idea of sequence of events *then ... and then ...*, whereas *yiqtol* simply expresses its meaning as such. The *wəqataltí* form may then refer to future events (1 Sam 17:32), to iterative or durative situations in the past (1 Sam 2:19; 1 Sam 16:23) or to general truths (Gen 2:24).

עֲבֹדָה יֵלֵךְ וְנִלְחָם עִם־הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי הַזֶּה	<i>Your servant will go and fight with this Philistine (1 Sam 17:32)</i>
וּמַעִיל קָטָן תַּעֲשֶׂה־לוֹ אָמוֹ וְהַעֲלֵתָהּ לוֹ מִיָּמִים יְמִימָה בַּעֲלוּתָהּ אֶת־אִשָּׁה לִזְבֹּחַ אֶת־זִבְחַ הַיָּמִים	<i>And his mother used to make him a little robe and bring it up to him every year when she went up with her husband to offer the yearly sacrifice (1 Sam 2:19)</i>
וְהָיָה בְּהֵיוֹת רוּחַ־אֱלֹהִים אֶל־שָׁאוּל וְלָקַח דָּוִד אֶת־הַכֶּנּוֹר וַיִּנָּן בְּיָדוֹ וְרוּחַ לְשָׁאוּל וטוֹב לוֹ וְסָרָה מֵעָלָיו רוּחַ הָרָעָה	<i>And whenever the spirit from God came to Saul, David would take the lyre and play it with his hand and Saul would feel himself relieved and it would be well with him and the evil spirit would depart from him (1 Sam 16:23)</i>
עַל־כֵּן יַעֲזֹב־אִישׁ אֶת־אָבִיו וְאֶת־אִמּוֹ וְדָבַק בְּאִשְׁתּוֹ וְהָיוּ לְבָשָׁר אֶחָד	<i>Therefore a man will leave his father and his mother and cling to his wife and they shall be one flesh (Gen 2:24)</i>

A *wəqataltí* form can follow a participle (Exod 17:6), an inf. cs. (Ruth 3:4), or a temporal adverbial expression (Exod 17:4). The verbal form may have modal meaning as in the case of *wəqataltí* following a volitive form.

הִנְנִי עֹמֵד לְפָנֶיךָ שָׁם עַל־הַצּוּר בְּחֹרֵב וְהָכִיתָ בַּצּוּר וַיֵּצְאוּ מִמֶּנּוּ מַיִם וְשָׁתָה הָעָם	<i>I will be standing before you on the rock at Horeb and you shall strike the rock and water will come out from it and the people will drink (Exod 17:6)</i>
וַיְהִי בְּשָׁכְבוֹ וַיֵּדַעַת אֶת־הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר יִשְׁכַּב־שָׁם	<i>When he lies down, note the place where he lies down (Ruth 3:4)</i>

עוד מעט וסקלני *A little more and they will stone me* (Exod 17:4 NAB)

wəqataltí can follow a volitive form (i.e., imperative, jussive, cohortative). *wəqataltí* has the modal meaning of the preceding verbal form (2 Kgs 9:1b-2).

חגור מתניך וקח פך השמן
הזה בידך ולך רמת גלעד
ובאת שמה וראה-שם יהוא
בן-יהושפט בן-נמשי ובאת
והקמתו מתוך אחיו והביאת
אתו חדר בחדר *Gird up your loins, take this flask of oil in your hand and go to Ramoth-gilead. And look there for Jehu, the son of Jehoshaphat, son of Nimshi and enter and raise him from the midst of his fellows and bring him to an inner chamber* (2 Kgs 9:1b-2)

It is possible, however, that *wəqataltí* is used with volitive meaning without a preceding volitive form (Judg 11:8).

לכן עתה שבנו אליך
והלכת עמנו ונלחמת בבני
עמון והיית לנו לראש לכל
ישיבי גלעד *Therefore, now that we have returned to you, go with us and fight against the Ammonites and become for us the leader, for all inhabitants of Gilead* (Judg 11:8)

As the *wəqataltí* form has to appear at the beginning of the clause without any preceding element, *yiqtol* has to be used whenever an element is placed before the verb (e.g., the negative לא or a constituent of the clause).

ויעקתם ביום ההוא מלפני
מלככם אשר בחרתם לכם
ולא-יענה יהוה אתכם ביום
ההוא *... and you shall cry out on that day because of your king which you have chosen for yourselves, but the Lord will not answer you on that day* (1 Sam 8:18)

10.3 Enclitic Personal Pronouns on Verbal Forms

10.3.1 Analytic and Synthetic Constructions

Biblical Hebrew has two ways of connecting a pronoun as direct object to a verb. Either the object marker with an enclitic pronoun can be used (2 Kgs 10:35) or the enclitic pronoun can be attached to the verbal form directly (2 Kgs 13:9).

וַיִּקְבְּרוּ אֹתוֹ בְּשַׁמְרֹון *And they buried him in Samaria* (2 Kgs 10:35)

וַיִּקְבְּרוּהוּ בְּשַׁמְרֹון *And they buried him in Samaria* (2 Kgs 13:9)

These two clauses have the same meaning. The choice between the two constructions is purely stylistic. Overall, the synthetic construction with the enclitic pronoun directly attached to the verb is more frequent than the analytic construction with the object marker *אֹת*. An important difference between the two constructions is that the analytic construction makes fronting of the pronominal direct object possible (2 Sam 2:7).

כִּי־מֵת אֲדֹנֶיכֶם שָׁאוּל *... for your lord Saul is dead and the House*
וְגַם־אֲתִי מָשְׁחוּ בֵּית־יְהוּדָה *of Judah have already anointed me king over*
לְמֶלֶךְ עֲלֵיהֶם *them* (2 Sam 2:7 NJPS)

10.3.2 The Forms of the Enclitic Personal Pronoun on Verbs

The enclitic pronouns on verbs are very similar to their counterparts on the infinitive construct or the noun. If a connecting vowel is used, it is /a/ (*pataḥ*) or /ā/ (*qameṣ*) with the suffix conjugation and /ē/ (*ṣere*) with the prefix conjugation and the imperative.

		Suffix	SC	PC	
sg.	1 c.	-nī	שָׁמְרֹנִי	יִשְׁמְרֵנִי	יִשְׁמְרֵנִי
	2 m.	-kā	שָׁמְרֶךָ	יִשְׁמְרֶךָ	יִשְׁאֲלֶךָ
	2 f.	-k	שָׁמְרֶיךָ	יִשְׁמְרֶיךָ	יִשְׁאֲלֶיךָ
	3 m.	-ō/-hū	שָׁמְרוּ	יִשְׁמְרוּ	יִשְׁכַּחֲהוּ
	3 f.	-āh/-hā	שָׁמְרָה	יִשְׁמְרָה	יִקְרַעֲהָ
וַיִּשְׁמְרָהָ					
pl.	1 c.	-nū	שָׁמְרָנוּ	יִשְׁמְרָנוּ	יִפְגְּעֵנוּ
	2 m.	-kæm	שָׁמְרֶכֶם*	יִשְׁמְרֶכֶם*	יִשְׁאֲלֶכֶם*
	2 f.	*-kæn			
	3 m.	-m	שָׁמְרֵם	יִשְׁמְרֵם	יִמְאָסֵם
	3 f.	*-n			

Notes

In PC forms with thematic vowel /ō/ (*holem*), the thematic vowel is usually reduced before the ePP while the thematic vowel /a/ is preserved as /ā/ (*qameš*). In the 3 m. sg. PC form with ePP 2 m. sg. the *holem* is shortened to *qameš hatuf*: *יִשְׁמְרֵךְ* *yišmōrkā*.

In verbs with gutturals, the expected changes occur, i.e., *hatef šwa* instead of simple *šwa*, e.g., *עָבַדְךָ* *he served you* (Deut 15:18), *מָשַׁחְךָ* *he has anointed you* (1 Sam 10:1).

The ePP 3 m. sg. -ō is the result of the development from -āhū via elision (loss) of the intervocalic /h/ and contraction of the diphthong to its current form: -āhū > -aw > -ō.

Forms of the verb with ePP 2 f. pl. are not attested in the Hebrew Bible. The ePP would have been -kæn *כְּנִי*.

The enclitic pronoun 3 f. pl. is -n *ן־* (with connecting vowel, if needed). Forms are analogous to the forms with ePP 3 m. pl.

With verbal forms other than the 3 m. sg. the following differences can be observed:

1. In verbal forms ending with a long vowel there is no need for a connecting vowel.
 - a) Verbal form 1 c. sg. SC: *מָשַׁחְתִּי* *I anointed him* (with elision of the intervocalic /h/ -tīhū > tīw); *עָבַדְתִּיךָ* *I served you*; *נָתַתִּיךָ* *I gave her*; *שָׁלַחְתִּים* *I have sent them*
 - b) Verbal form 3 c. pl. SC: *עָבְדוּהוּ* *they served him*; *רָדְפוּךָ* *they pursued you*
 - c) Verbal form 1 c. pl. SC: *רָדַשְׁנוּהוּ* *we sought him*
 - d) Verbal form 3 m. pl. PC: *יִרְנְמוּהוּ* *they shall stone him*
 - e) Verbal form 2 f. sg. PC: *וַתִּזְבְּחִים* *and you sacrificed them*
2. In verbal forms 2 f. sg. SC the original suffix -tī is preserved: *יָלַדְתִּנִּי* *you bore me*, *נָתַתִּיךָ* *you gave it*, *מָצַאתִים* *you found them*
3. In verbal forms 3 f. sg. SC the original suffix /t/ is preserved
 - a) ePP 1 c. sg.: *יָלַדְתִּנִּי* *she gave birth to me*
 - b) ePP 3 m. sg.: *הִרְגָּתוּהוּ* *she killed him*; *יָלַדְתוּ* *she gave birth to him* (with assimilation of the /h/ to the /t/ *-athu > -attū)
 - c) ePP 3 f. sg.: *אָחַזְתָּהּ* *it has taken hold of her* (with assimilation of the /h/ to the /t/ *-athā > -attā)

- d) ePP 1 c. pl.: מְצִאֲתָנוּ *it found us*
 e) ePP 3 m. pl.: גָּנְבָתָם *she stole them*
4. In verbal forms 2 m. sg. SC with the suffix *-tā* and an ePP 3 m. sg. contraction happens, e.g., יָדַעְתָּו *you know him* < *-tō* < **-taw* < **-tahū* (with elision of the intervocalic /h/ and following contraction). Other enclitic pronouns simply follow the suffix *-tā*, e.g., נָטַשְׁתָּנִי *you have permitted me*, עָזַבְתָּם *you forsook them*, שָׁלַחְתָּנוּ *you sent them*.
5. In verbal forms 2 m. pl. SC the suffix is *-tū* instead of *-tæm*: הָעֵלִיתָנוּ *you have brought us up* (2 m. pl. SC Hiphil עָלָה with ePP 1 c. pl.).

10.3.3 The Enclitic Personal Pronoun with Energetic Nun

In a number of cases an additional נ is used between the verbal form and the enclitic pronoun. This נ is called *energetic Nun* and is considered a residue of an early energetic mode (→ 6.2.2). It is almost always used in PC forms without suffix. Instances of the energetic Nun with the jussive, the *wayyiqṭol* form or the imperative are infrequent. The energetic Nun does not change the meaning of the form when compared to the forms without. The following forms of the ePP with energetic Nun are attested.

sg.	3 m.	יִשְׁמְרֶנּוּ
	3 f.	יִשְׁמְרֶנָּה
	2 m.	יִשְׁמְרֶךָ
	1 c.	יִשְׁמְרֶנִּי
pl.	1 c.	יִשְׁמְרֶנּוּ

Notes

The gemination of the /n/ in the forms with 3 m./f. sg. ePP is the result of assimilation of the /h/ of the ePP to the preceding /n/: *-ænnū* < **-ænhū* and *-ænnā* < **-ænhā*, respectively.

The gemination of the /n/ in the forms with 2 m. sg. ePP is the result of assimilation of the /n/ to the following /k/ of the ePP: *-ækkā* < **-ænkā*.

In forms of the PC with the thematic vowel /a/, the vowel is preserved as *qameṣ*, e.g., יִשְׁמְעֶךָ *he will hear you*.

10.4 Existential Clauses

To make statements about the existence or non-existence of somebody or something Hebrew uses the particles **יֵשׁ** *there is* and **אֵין** *there is not* which is used in the cs. st. **אֵין** most of the time.

וַיֵּרָא יַעֲקֹב כִּי יֵשׁ שָׂבָר בְּמִצְרַיִם	<i>And Jacob saw that there was grain in Egypt</i> (Gen 42:1)
יְבֹאֲנָא אֵלַי וְיָדַע כִּי יֵשׁ נָבִיא בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל	<i>Let him come to me, that he may know that there is a prophet in Israel</i> (2 Kgs 5:8)
וַיִּקְחֻהוּ וַיִּשְׁלְכוּ אֹתוֹ הַבְּרֶחֱ וַהֲבֹר רֶק אֵין בּוֹ מַיִם	<i>And they took him and threw him into the cistern; the cistern was empty, there was no water in it</i> (Gen 37:24)
וַיִּפֶן כֹּה וְכֹה וַיֵּרָא כִּי אֵין אִישׁ	<i>And he turned this way and that way and saw that there was no one</i> (Exod 2:12)

With the preposition **לְ**, the particle **יֵשׁ** expresses the idea that somebody possesses something or something is available to somebody. For the negation of these ideas, the **אֵין** is used.

וַיֹּאמֶר עֲשׂוֹ יִשְׁ-לִי רַב אָחִי	<i>And Esau said, "I have plenty, my brother"</i> (Gen 33:9)
וְיָדְעוּ כָּל-הָאָרֶץ כִּי יֵשׁ אֱלֹהִים לְיִשְׂרָאֵל	<i>... so that all the earth may know that Israel has a God</i> (1 Sam 17:46)
וַתְּהִי שָׂרַי עֲקָרָה אֵין לָהּ וָלֵד	<i>Sarai was barren; she did not have a child</i> (Gen 11:30)
וַתֹּאמֶר אֵין לִּשְׁפָחָתִי כָּל בֵּית כִּי אִם-אֶסֹד שֶׁמֶן	<i>And she said, "Your maidservant does not have anything in the house except a flask of oil"</i> (2 Kgs 4:2)

10.5 Particles with Enclitic Personal Pronouns

A number of particles can be used with enclitic pronouns. In some forms, an additional **נ** is found which is similar to the energetic Nun with verbal forms.

		הֵנָּה	יֵשׁ	אֵין	עוֹד
sg.	1 c.	הֵנָּנִי/הֵנָּנִי		אֵינָנִי	עוֹדִי/עוֹדָנִי
	2 m.	הֵנָּךְ	יֵשְׁךָ	אֵינָךְ	עוֹדְךָ
	2 f.	הֵנָּךְ		אֵינָךְ	עוֹדְךָ
	3 m.	הֵנוּ	יֵשְׁנוּ	אֵינָנוּ	עוֹדָנוּ
	3 f.			אֵינָנָה	עוֹדָה/עוֹדָנָה
pl.	1 c.	הֵנָּנוּ/הֵנָּנוּ		אֵינָנוּ	
	2 m.	הֵנְכֶם	יֵשְׁכֶם	אֵינְכֶם	
	3 m.	הֵנָּם		אֵינָם	עוֹדָם

Notes

Distinct pausal forms are הֵנָּנִי (ePP 1 c. sg.), הֵנָּךְ (ePP 2 m. sg.) הֵנָּנוּ (ePP 1 c. pl.).

Alternative forms are הֵנָּה (Jer 18:3 Ketiv) instead of הֵנוּ and יֵשְׁכֶם (Deut 13:14) instead of יֵשְׁכֶם.

10.6 Negative Nominal Clauses

In order to form negative nominal clauses, Hebrew uses the negative אֵין or, more frequently, its cs. st. form אֵין. The negative לֹא, however, is also used for this purpose.

אֵל-תַּעֲלוּ כִּי אֵין יְהוָה בְּקִרְבְּכֶם	<i>Do not go up, for the LORD is not in your midst (Num 14:42)</i>
כִּי אֲנֹכִי מֵת בְּאֶרֶץ הַזֹּאת אֵינָנִי עֹבֵר אֶת-הַיַּרְדֵּן	<i>For I am about to die in this land; I won't cross the Jordan (Deut 4:22)</i>
לֹא-עֵת הָאֶסֶף הַמִּקְנֶה	<i>It is not the time for the livestock to be gathered (Gen 29:7)</i>
לֹא אִישׁ בְּשָׂרָה אַתָּה הַיּוֹם הַיּוֹם	<i>You are not a man of news today (2 Sam 18:20)</i>

10.7 Exercises

10.7.1 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: יואש, יהואחז, בית-עקד, ישי, סכות.

1 וַיִּקְבֹּץ יְהוֹאָחָז אֶת-כָּל-הָעָם וַיֹּאמֶר אֲלֵהֶם אַחֲאָב עֲבַד אֶת-הַבַּעַל מִעַתָּה וְהוּא יַעֲבֹדְנוּ
הַרְבֵּה 2 וַיְהִי אַחֲרֵי קִבְרוֹ אֹתוֹ וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל-בָּנָיו לֵאמֹר בָּמוֹתַי וּקְבָרָתָם אֵתִי
בִקְבֹר אֲשֶׁר אִישׁ הָאֱלֹהִים קָבַר בּוֹ אֵצֶל עֲצֻמֹּתַי הַנִּיחוּ¹ אֶת-עֲצֻמֹּתַי 3 וַיִּשְׁכַּב
יְהוֹאָחָז עִם-אֲבֹתָיו וַיִּקְבְּרֵהוּ בְּשֶׁמְרוֹן וַיִּמְלֹךְ יוֹאָשׁ בֶּנּוֹ תַחְתָּיו 4 וַיִּקְרָא יְהוָה
אֶל-שְׂמוּאֵל וַיֹּאמֶר הִנְנִי 5 וַיִּשְׁלַח אֲבִשָּׁלוֹם מִרְגָּלִים² בְּכָל-שָׁבָטִי וַיִּשְׁרָאֵל לֵאמֹר
כְּשֶׁמַּעֲכֶם אֶת-קוֹל הַשֹּׁפָר וְאִמְרָתָם מִלֶּךְ אֲבִשָּׁלוֹם בְּחֶבְרוֹן 6 וַיֹּאמֶר הִנֵּה שְׂמִיעָתִי
כִּי יֵשׁ-שָׂבָר³ בְּמִצְרַיִם 7 וַיָּשָׁב⁴ רְאוּבֵן אֶל-חֶבְרוֹן וְהִנֵּה אֵין-יוֹסֵף בְּבֹר וַיִּקְרַע
אֶת-בְּגָדָיו 8 וַיֹּאמֶר אֲבָרְהָם כִּי⁵ אִמְרָתִי רַק אֵין-יִרְאַת⁶ אֱלֹהִים בְּמָקוֹם הַזֶּה
וְהַרְגוּנִי עַל-דָּבָר⁷ אֲשֶׁרִי 9 כָּל-מָקוֹם אֲשֶׁר תִּדְרֹךְ כַּף-רַגְלְכֶם בּוֹ – לָכֶם נִתְּתִיו
כֹּאֲשֶׁר דִּבַּרְתִּי אֶל-מֹשֶׁה 10 וַיִּלְכְּדוּ-נָעַר מֵאֲנָשֵׁי סֻכּוֹת וַיִּשְׁאַלְהוּ וַיִּכְתֹּב אֵלָיו
אֶת-שְׁרֵי סֻכּוֹת וְאֶת-זִקְנֵיהֶם שִׁבְעִים וְשִׁבְעָה אִישׁ⁸ 11 וַיְהִי בִבְקָר וַיֵּצֵא וַיַּעֲמֵד וַיֹּאמֶר
אֶל-כָּל-הָעָם צִדְקִים אַתֶּם הִנֵּה אֲנִי קֹשֶׁרֶתִי⁹ עַל-אֲדָנִי וְאֶתְּרָגְהוּ 12 וַיַּעַשׂ לָהֶם כֵּן
וַיִּצַּל¹⁰ אוֹתָם מִיַּד בְּנֵי-יִשְׂרָאֵל וְלֹא הָרְגוּם 13 וְעַתָּה כֹּה-תֹאמַר¹¹ לַעֲבָדֵי לְדָוִד
כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת אֲנִי לִקְחָתִיךָ מִן-הַנֶּנֶזֶה¹² מֵאַחֲרֵי הַצֹּאן לְהִיּוֹת נָגִיד¹³ עַל-עַמִּי
עַל-יִשְׂרָאֵל 14 וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל-יְהוֹשָׁע אֶל-תִּירָא¹⁴ מֵהֶם כִּי בִיָּדְךָ נִתְּתִים
לֹא-יַעֲמֵד אִישׁ מֵהֶם בְּפָנֶיךָ 15 וַיֹּאמֶר תַּפְשׁוּם חַיִּים וַיִּתְּפְשׁוּם חַיִּים וַיִּשְׁחָטוּם

¹ וַיִּנְחֻ put! (impv. masc. pl.)

² מִרְגָּלִים scouts (participle Piel masc. pl.)

³ שָׂבָר grain

⁴ וַיָּשָׁב wayyāšab and he returned (verb שׁוּב)

⁵ כִּי here functioning as introduction of the direct speech; not to be translated (cf. Greek ὅτι).

⁶ יִרְאַת fear, reverence

⁷ עַל-דָּבָר because of

⁸ שִׁבְעִים וְשִׁבְעָה seventy-seven men (The counted noun follows the numeral here in the singular.)

⁹ קֹשֶׁרֶתִי I have conspired

¹⁰ וַיִּצַּל and he rescued

¹¹ תֹּאמַר you shall say

¹² נֶנֶז grazing place

¹³ לְהִיּוֹת נָגִיד so that [you] become ruler

¹⁴ אֶל-תִּירָא do not be afraid (often with the prep. מִן to express the object of the verb)

אֶל-בּוֹר¹⁵ בֵּית-עֶקֶד אַרְבָּעִים וּשְׁנַיִם אִישׁ¹⁶ וְלֹא-הִשְׁאִיר¹⁷ אִישׁ מֵהֶם 16 וַיֹּאמֶר
 אֵין-לָנוּ חֶלֶק בְּדוֹד וְלֹא נַחֲלָה-לָנוּ בְּבֶן-יֹשִׁי 17 וְהַלְוִי¹⁸ אֲשֶׁר-בִּשְׁעָרָיָה לֹא
 תִּעֲזָבֵנוּ כִּי אֵין לוֹ חֶלֶק וְנַחֲלָה עִמּוֹ 18 וַיִּיקֶץ¹⁹ יַעֲקֹב מִשְׁנָתוֹ²⁰ וַיֹּאמֶר אָכֵן²¹ יֵשׁ
 יְהוָה בְּמָקוֹם הַזֶּה וְאֲנֹכִי לֹא יָדַעְתִּי 19 וְלֹא אֶתְכֶם לְבִדְכֶם אֲנֹכִי פָרַת אֶת-הַבְּרִית
 הַזֹּאת וְאֶת-הָאֱלֹהִים²² הַזֵּאת. כִּי אֶת-אֲשֶׁר יִשְׁנֶנּוּ פֹה עִמָּנוּ עַמֹּד הַיּוֹם לִפְנֵי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ
 וְאֵת אֲשֶׁר אֵינָנוּ פֹה עִמָּנוּ הַיּוֹם. 20 הִנֵּה יָמִים בָּאִים²³ נֹאֲם-יְהוָה וְכָרַתִּי אֶת-בֵּית
 יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאֶת-בֵּית יְהוּדָה בְּרִית חֲדָשָׁה. לֹא כַּבְּרִית אֲשֶׁר כָּרַתִּי אֶת-אֲבוֹתָם בַּיּוֹם
 הַחֲזִיקִי בְיָדָם לְהוֹצִיאָם²⁴ מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם ... כִּי זֹאת הַבְּרִית אֲשֶׁר אָכַרְתָּ אֶת-בֵּית
 יִשְׂרָאֵל אַחֲרֵי הַיָּמִים הָהֵם נֹאֲם-יְהוָה נִתְּתִי אֶת-תּוֹרָתִי בְּקֶרְפָּם וְעַל-לִבָּם אֶכְתָּבָנָה
 וְהָיִיתִי לָהֶם לֵאלֹהִים וְהָמָּה יִהְיוּ-לִי לְעָם.²⁵

¹⁵ Translate the preposition אֶל either as *at*, *by* (equivalent to על) or as *into* (indicating the goal).

¹⁶ אִישׁ אַרְבָּעִים וּשְׁנַיִם *forty men*

¹⁷ הִשְׁאִיר *he spared, left over*

¹⁸ הַלְוִי *Levite* (cf. the proper noun לֵוִי)

¹⁹ וַיִּיקֶץ *and he woke up*

²⁰ שָׁנָה *sleep*

²¹ אָכֵן *surely, truly*

²² אֱלֹהִים *curse*

²³ בָּאִים *are coming* (part. m. pl. Q. בּוֹא)

²⁴ לְהוֹצִיאָם *lit. on the day when I took them by their hand to bring them out*

²⁵ וְהָיִיתִי לָהֶם לֵאלֹהִים וְהָמָּה יִהְיוּ-לִי לְעָם ... *and I shall be their God and they shall be my people*

Chapter 11

11.1 Vocabulary

11.1.1 Verbs

אָבַר	Q. <i>to perish</i>
אָהַב	Q. <i>to love</i> (stative verb, PC וְאָהַב ; SC pausal form 3 masc. sg. וְאָהַב)
אָחַז	Q. <i>to grasp, take hold, take possession</i>
אָסַף	Q. <i>to gather, remove</i>
אָסַר	Q. <i>to tie, bind, imprison</i>
מָכַר	Q. <i>to sell</i>
מָשַׁל	Q. <i>to rule, reign</i> (with prepositional object with בְּ)
נָגַע	Q. <i>to touch, reach, strike</i> (usually with prep. object with בְּ)
נָגַשׁ	Q. <i>to draw near, approach</i> (in Qal only PC, impv., inf. cs.)
נָסַע	Q. <i>to pull up or out, set out, journey</i>
נָצַר	Q. <i>to watch, guard, keep</i>
שָׁכַח	Q. <i>to forget</i>

11.1.2 Nouns

אֶבֶן	<i>stone</i> (fem., pl. אֶבֶנִּים)
אֲדֹנָיִם	<i>lord</i> (often in the honorific plural, e.g., אֲדֹנָיִם <i>your lord</i> ; with ref. to God אֲדֹנָיִם <i>Lord</i>)
אֲחֻזָּה	<i>possession, property</i>
גּוֹי	<i>nation, people</i> (pl. גּוֹיִם)
זֶבַח	<i>sacrifice</i>
נֶגֶב	<i>south-country, Negev, south</i>
נֶגַע	<i>stroke, plague, blow, mark</i>

עץ *tree, wood, sometimes trees (coll.)* (pl. עצים)
 תורה *instruction*

11.1.3 Other Parts of Speech

אף *also, even (adv.)*

11.2 Weak Verbs in Biblical Hebrew

Strong verbs are verbs that have three root consonants in all *all* their forms. Weak verbs, on the other hand, are verbs that do not have three root consonants in all their forms, either because one of the three root consonants is weak and prone to be lost or because they do not have more than two root consonants.

The weak root consonant can be found in first position in the root or in third position. Verbal roots with two weak root consonants are called *doubly weak* verbs. Verbal roots with a vocalic element in the middle as weakness – the II w/y verbs in the table below – are verbs with only two root consonants. These verbal roots are also called *hollow roots*. The geminate verb with a doubled second root consonant is a case apart.

The classes of weak verbs are identified by different names in Hebrew grammars. The Hebrew designation of weak verbal roots is based on the root **פעל** *to do, make*. The **פ** represents the first, the **ע** the second and the **ל** the third root consonant. In this textbook the romanized designations are used.

Hebrew	Romanized	
פ"א	I- <i>ʾāleḥ</i>	I ʾ
פ"י	I- <i>yōd</i>	I y
פ"נ	I- <i>nūn</i>	I n
ע"ו/י	II- <i>wāw/yōd</i>	II w/y
ע"ע	II geminate	II gem.
ל"א	III- <i>ʾāleḥ</i>	III ʾ
ל"ה	III- <i>hē</i>	III y

11.3 Weak Verbs: *I n* Verbs

I n verbs have /n/ as the first root consonant. The consonant /n/ is weak because it is assimilated to the following consonant if this follows the /n/ immediately, e.g., -nC- > -CC-. The following forms of *I n* verbs in the Qal stem are weak.

1. The forms of the prefix conjugation including its related forms, the jussive and the cohortative, because of the assimilation of the /n/ to the following second root consonant: $*yinC_2VC_3 > yiC_2C_2VC_3$, e.g., $*yinpōl > yippōl$ יפֹל *he will fall*, $*yingaš > yiggaš$ יגַשׁ *he will approach*. In these forms the /n/ does not appear as a consonant anymore, but only in the *dageš forte* in the second root consonant. The assimilation, however, of the /n/ does not happen, when the second root consonant is a guttural, e.g., ינחֵל *he will inherit*.
2. The imperative and the inf. cs. of *I n* verbs with /a/ as the thematic vowel in the prefix conjugation and the imperative and inf. cs. of the verb נתן *to give* are weak forms. In these forms the /n/ is lost completely.

The very frequent verb נתן *to give* has the exceptional vowel pattern *a-i* in the prefix conjugation Qal: $*yattin > yittēn$ יִתֵּן *he will give* (with attenuation of *a > i* in closed unstressed syllable).

The very frequent verb לקח *to take* behaves like a *I n* verb in the Qal. The prefix conjugation forms, the imperative and the inf. cs. are weak.

			נפל	ננש	נתן	לקח
SC	sg.	3 m.	נָפַל		נָתַן	לָקַח
		3 f.	נָפְלָה		נָתְנָה	לָקְחָה
		2 m.	נָפַלְתָּ		נָתַתָּה	לָקַחְתָּ
		2 f.	נָפַלְתְּ		נָתַתְּ	לָקַחְתְּ
		1 c.	נָפַלְתִּי		נָתַתִּי	לָקַחְתִּי
	pl.	3 c.	נָפְלוּ		נָתְנוּ	לָקְחוּ
		2 m.	נָפַלְתֶּם		נָתַתֶּם	לָקַחְתֶּם
		2 f.	נָפַלְתֶּן		נָתַתֶּן	לָקַחְתֶּן
		1 c.	נָפַלְנוּ		נָתַנּוּ	לָקַחְנוּ

			נפל	ננש	נתן	לקח
PC	sg.	3 m.	יָפַל	יָנַשׁ	יָתַן	יָקַח
		3 f.	תָּפַל	תָּנַשׁ	תָּתַן	תָּקַח
		2 m.	תָּפַל	תָּנַשׁ	תָּתַן	תָּקַח
		2 f.	תָּפְלִי	תָּנְשִׁי	תָּתְנִי	תָּקְחִי
		1 c.	אָפַל	אָנַשׁ	אָתַן	אָקַח
	pl.	3 m.	יָפְלוּ	יָנְשׁוּ	יָתְנוּ	יָקְחוּ
		3 f.	תָּפְלָנָה	תָּנְשָׁנָה	תָּתְנָה	תָּקְחָנָה
		2 m.	תָּפְלוּ	תָּנְשׁוּ	תָּתְנוּ	תָּקְחוּ
		2 f.	תָּפְלָנָה	תָּנְשָׁנָה	תָּתְנָה	תָּקְחָנָה
		1 c.	נָפַל	נָנַשׁ	נָתַן	נָקַח
Jussive	sg.	3 m.	יָפַל	יָנַשׁ	יָתַן	יָקַח
waw-PC	sg.	3 m.	וַיָּפַל	וַיָּנַשׁ	וַיָּתַן	וַיָּקַח
Impv.	sg.	m.	נָפַל	נַשׁ	תֵּן	קַח
		f.	נָפְלִי	נְשִׁי	תְּנִי	קְחִי
	pl.	m.	נָפְלוּ	נְשׁוּ	תְּנוּ	קְחוּ
		f.	נָפְלָנָה	נְשָׁנָה		
Inf. cs.			נָפַל	נִשֵּׁת	תֵּת	קַחַת
Inf. abs.			נָפּוּל		נִתּוֹן	לִקְחוֹ
Part.	sg.	m.	נֹפֵל		נֹתֵן	לֹקֵחַ

Notes

In verbs have either the *i-o* or the *i-a* vowel pattern without a semantic difference between fientive and stative meaning.

The verb לקח loses the *dageš forte* in the second root consonant in context forms of the prefix conjugation with vocalic suffix, e.g., יָקְחוּ *they will take*.

The *dageš lene* in the 2 f. sg. SC form לִקְחָתְּ distinguishes this form from the inf. cs. with the preposition לִ: לִקְחַת *to take*.

In pausal forms with vocalic suffix the thematic vowel is preserved and stressed, e.g., יָתְנוּ, יָקְחוּ (impv.).

Verbs that are both In and III gutt. often have strong inf. cs. forms, e.g., נָסַע. Some verbs have both forms, e.g., נָנַע and less frequently נָנַעַת.

The inf. cs. נָתַת of the verb נָתַן is the result of the assimilation of the third root consonant /n/ to the ending -t: *tint > > *titt > tēt נָתַת. A strong form of the inf. cs. נָתַן (or נָתַן־) is attested only in Gen 38:9 and Num 20:21 whereas the weak form נָתַת is attested more than 150 times. With enclitic pronoun, the inf. cs. of the verb נָתַן has forms like נָתַתוּ, נָתַתָּנוּ, etc. with restoration of the gemination.

The imperative m. sg. of the verb נָתַן is often the long form תִּנֶּה give!.

The verb נָגַשׁ to draw near, approach is a so-called suppletive verb. In the Qal it is only used in the PC, imperative and inf. cs.; in the SC and the participle it is used in the Niphal with no difference in meaning. It is included in the table because it is the most frequent verb In with /a/ as thematic vowel in the PC Qal by far.

11.4 Weak Verbs: I^ʔ Verbs

A number of verbs I^ʔ have weak forms in the prefix conjugation. The five I^ʔ verbs that only have weak PC forms are the verbs: אָמַר to say, אָכַל to eat, אָבַד to perish and the two doubly weak verbs אָבַה to be willing (almost always with negation) and אָפַה to bake (I^ʔ and III y).¹ Therefore the rules of III y verbs apply to אָבַה and אָפַה as well (→ (→ 12.2)).

The weakness is due to ʔ becoming silent at the end of the prefix syllable. As a result, the prefix vowel was lengthened /a/ > /ā/ and then changed to /ō/ according to the Canaanite sound shift. Subsequently, the thematic vowel became /a/ through dissimilation to avoid two consecutive dark vowels /ō/ and /u/. This development started in the 1 c. sg. form to avoid two consecutive consonants /ʔ/:

*a^ʔmur > *āmur > *ōmur > ʔōmar אֶמַר I will say

From this form the loss of the consonantal ʔ spread to the rest of the PC forms. PC forms are the only weak forms of I^ʔ verbs in the Qal; all other forms are strong.

¹ Mnemonic saying: The baker says, “the one who does not want to eat will perish.”

			אמר	אכל
SC	sg.	3 m.	אָמַר	אָכַל
	sg.	3 f.	אָמְרָה	אָכְלָה
	sg.	2 m.	אָמַרְתָּ	אָכַלְתָּ
	sg.	2 f.	אָמַרְתְּ	אָכַלְתְּ
	sg.	1 c.	אָמַרְתִּי	אָכַלְתִּי
	pl.	3 c.	אָמְרוּ	אָכְלוּ
	pl.	2 m.	אָמַרְתֶּם	אָכַלְתֶּם
	pl.	2 f.	אָמַרְתֶּן	אָכַלְתֶּן
	pl.	1 c.	אָמַרְנוּ	אָכַלְנוּ
PC	sg.	3 m.	יֹאמַר	יֹאכַל
		3 f.	תֹּאמַר	תֹּאכַל
		2 m.	תֹּאמַר	תֹּאכַל
		2 f.	תֹּאמְרִי	תֹּאכְלִי
		1 c.	אֶמַר	אֶכַל
	pl.	3 pl.	יֹאמְרוּ	יֹאכְלוּ
		3 f.	תֹּאמְרֶנָּה	תֹּאכְלֶנָּה
		2 m.	תֹּאמְרוּ	תֹּאכְלוּ
		2 f.	תֹּאמְרֶנָּה	תֹּאכְלֶנָּה
		1 c.	נֹאמַר	נֹאכַל
Jussive	sg.	3 m.	יֹאמַר	יֹאכַל
waw-PC	sg.	3 m.	וַיֹּאמֶר	וַיֹּאכַל
Impv.	sg.	m.	אֱמַר	אֱכַל
		f.	אֱמְרִי	אֱכְלִי
	pl.	m.	אֱמְרוּ	אֱכְלוּ
Inf. cs.			אֲמַר	אֲכַל
Inf. abs.			אִמּוֹר	אִכּוֹל
Part.	sg.	m.	אֹמֵר	אֹכֵל

Notes

In the 1 c. sg. form אָמַר the root consonant א is never preserved in writing. In the other forms it is almost always preserved in writing which makes the identification of these forms easy.

The 3 m./f. sg. and 2 m. sg. *wayyiqtol* forms of the verbs אָמַר and אָכַל without suffix are stressed on the penultimate syllable, e.g., וַיֹּאמֶר, וַתֹּאמֶר, וַיֹּאכַל, וַתֹּאכַל. Pausal forms 3 m./f. sg., 2 m. sg. and 1 c. sg. forms, however, are stressed on the last syllable, e.g., וַיֹּאמֶר, וַיֹּאכַל, וַיֹּאמֶר, וַיֹּאכַל including the pausal form וַיֹּאכַל.

In the impv. m. sg. and the inf. cs., the א takes *hatef segol*. In the impv. אָמַר the original vowel $\bar{o} < u$ is preserved because there was no need for dissimilation as in the prefix conjugation.

The verbs אָהַב, אָחַז and אָסַף have strong forms with preservation of the א as consonant as well as weak forms with elision of the א, e.g., וַיֹּאחֶז, וַיֹּאחֶז, וַיֹּאסֵף, וַיֹּאסֵף, וַיֹּאסֵף (!), אָסְפָה (cohortative), וַיֹּאהֲב, וַיֹּאהֲב.

The introduction of direct speech לֵאמֹר is originally the inf. cs. of the verb אָמַר with the preposition ל.

11.5 Questions in Biblical Hebrew (Part 1)**11.5.1 Yes-No Questions**

Yes-no questions are usually marked with the syllable הָ *hă* which is prefixed to the first word of the question. This prefixed הָ *hă* is called *interrogative He*. In addition to this, it can be assumed that questions were pronounced with a different intonation than statements.

The interrogative He is vocalized in different ways:

1. Before non-gutturals with a full vowel it is הָ *hă*- (Gen 4:9)
2. Before non-gutturals with *šwa* it is הָ *ha*- (1 Kgs 21:20). Sometimes a *dageš forte* is added (Gen 37:32).
3. Before gutturals with any vowel except *qameš* or *hatef qameš* it is הָ *ha*- (Judg 13:11)
4. Before gutturals with *qameš* or *hatef qameš* it is הָ *hæ*- (Gen 24:5)

הַשֹּׁמֵר אֶחָי אֲנִי	<i>Am I the keeper of my brother?</i> (Gen 4:9)
הֲמִצַּאתִנִּי אִיבִי	<i>Have you found me, my enemy?</i> (1 Kgs 21:20)

הַכְּתָנֶת בֶּנְךָ הִיא אִם-לֹא	<i>Is it the robe of your son or not?</i> (Gen 37:20 Qere)
הֲאַתָּה הָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר-דִּבַּרְתָּ אֶל-הָאִשָּׁה	<i>Are you the man who spoke to the woman?</i> (Judg 13:11)
הֲהִשָּׁב אָשִׁיב אֶת-בְּנִי אֶל-הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר-יָצָאתָ מִשָּׁם	<i>Shall I then bring your son back to the land that you left?</i> (Gen 24:5)

Unmarked yes-no question are also attested in Biblical. It can be assumed that in spoken language they were discernible by their intonation. In a written text, the context helps to identify unmarked questions.

וַיֹּאמֶר הַמֶּלֶךְ שְׁלוֹם לְנַעַר לְאַבְשָׁלוֹם	<i>And the king said, "Is it well with the young man Absalom?"</i> (2 Sam 18:29)
וַיֹּאמֶר נָתָן אֲדֹנָי הַמֶּלֶךְ אַתָּה אָמַרְתָּ אֲדֹנִיָּהוּ יִמְלֹךְ אַחֲרָי וְהוּא יֹשֵׁב עַל-כִּסְאִי	<i>And Nathan said, "My lord, the king, have you said 'Adonijah shall become king after me and he shall sit on my throne'?"</i> (1 Kgs 1:24)

Biblical Hebrew does not have a word for yes. For a positive answer to a yes-no question either a word from the question (Gen 24:58) or another corresponding word (2 Kgs 18:7–8) is used. For a negative answer, Hebrew uses **לֹא** *no* (Judg 12:5).

וַיֹּאמְרוּ אֵלֶיהָ הֲתֵלְכִי עִם-הָאִישׁ הַזֶּה וַתֹּאמֶר אֵלָיו	<i>And they said to her, "Will you go with this man?" And she said, "Yes."</i> (Gen 24:58)
וַיֹּאמֶר הֲאַתָּה זֶה אֲדֹנָי אֵלֶיהוּ וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ אָנִי	<i>And he said, "Is it you, my lord Elijah?" And he said to him, "Yes."</i> (1 Kgs 18:7–8)
וַיֹּאמְרוּ לוֹ אַנְשֵׁי-גִלְעָד הֲאִפְרַתִּי אַתָּה וַיֹּאמֶר לֹא	<i>And the people from Gilead said to him, "Are you an Ephraimite?". And he said, "No."</i> (Judg 12:5)

11.5.2 Choice Questions

The interrogative **הֲ** is also used for introducing choice questions; the second option is introduced with **אִם**.

הֲלָנוּ אַתָּה אִם-לְצָרֵינוּ	<i>Are you for us, or for our enemies?</i> (Josh 5:13)
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הֲאֵלֶךְ עַל־רָמוֹת גִּלְעָד Shall I go to Ramoth-gilead for battle or shall
לִמְלָחְמָה אִם־אֶחְדָּל I refrain? (1 Kgs 22:6)

Note

The word אם is most frequently used as conditional conjunction *if* (→ 15.3).

11.5.3 Indirect Questions

The interrogative He also introduces indirect (or embedded) questions (Exod 4:18), but אם is used for this, as well (2 Kgs 1:2). For indirect choice questions אם ... הַ is used (Gen 27:21).

וְאַרְאֶה הָעוֹדִים חַיִּים ... I want to see whether they are still alive
(Exod 4:18)

לֵכוּ דְרֹשׁוּ בְּבַעַל זְבוּב Go, inquire of Baal-zebub, the god of Ekron,
אֵלֵהִי עֲקֹרוֹן אִם־אֶחְיֶה whether I will recover from this sickness
מִחֲלִי זֶה (2 Kgs 1:2)

לְדַעַת הֲהִצְלִיחַ יְהוָה דְּרָכּוֹ ... to find out whether God had made his
אִם־לֹא journey successful or not (Gen 24:21)

11.6 Exercises

11.6.1 Translation of Verbal Forms

Translate the following verbal forms. Identify the gender (masc., fem., comm.) and number (sg., pl.) of the forms of which the English translation is ambiguous (i.e., *you, they*). Mark the stressed syllable if stress is not on the last syllable.

1 וַיֵּאכְלוּ 2 אָכַל 3 אָכְלוּ 4 אָמַרְתִּי 5 אָמַר 6 אָמַר 7 תִּגְשׁוּ
8 גָּשׁ 9 וָאָפַל 10 נָפַלְתִּי 11 וַיֵּאחֲזֵ 12 וַיִּגַּע

11.6.2 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: גִּלְגָּל, בְּאֵר שֶׁבַע, אֲמֹנֹן, תִּמְנָה, קִדְשׁ בְּרִנְנֶה, לָבֵן, כָּלֵב, יִפְנֶה, זִלְפָּה.

1 וַיֹּאמְרוּ לוֹ אָחִיו תְּמַלֵּךְ תְּמַלֵּךְ עָלֵינוּ אִם-מִשׁוֹל תִּמְשָׁל בָּנוּ 2 וַיִּשְׁאַל לָהֶם לְשָׁלוֹם וַיֹּאמֶר הַשָּׁלוֹם אֲבִיכֶם הִזְקֵן אֲשֶׁר אִמְרָתֶם. הַעוֹדְנוּ חַי 3 וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ אֲמִנּוֹן אֶת-תִּמְרָא אַחֻזָּת אֲבִשָׁלָם אָחִי אֲנִי אֲהַב 4 וַיֹּאסֹף לָבֶן אֶת-כָּל-אֲנָשֵׁי הַמָּקוֹם וַיַּעַשׂ מִשְׁתֶּה. וַיְהִי בָעֶרֶב וַיִּקַּח אֶת-לֵאָה בִּתּוֹ וַיָּבֵא² אֹתָהּ אֵלָיו וַיָּבֵא אֵלֶיהָ. וַיִּתֵּן לָבֶן לָהּ אֶת-זֹלְפָה שִׁפְחָתוֹ לְלֵאָה בִּתּוֹ שִׁפְחָה. וַיְהִי בִבְקָר וַהֲגַה-הוּא³ לֵאָה 5 וַיִּלְדַּךְ מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן וַיֹּאסְפוּ אֶת-כָּל-זִקְנֵי בְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל. וַיַּדְבֵּר אַהֲרֹן אֶת כָּל-הַדְּבָרִים אֲשֶׁר-דִּבֶּר יְהוָה אֶל-מֹשֶׁה וַיַּעַשׂ הָאֵתָה לְעֵינֵי הָעָם. 6 וַיֹּאמֶר יוֹסֵף אֶל-אָחָיו גִּשְׁוֹנָא אֵלַי וַיִּגְשׁוּ⁴ וַיֹּאמֶר אֲנִי יוֹסֵף אֲחִיכֶם אֲשֶׁר-מָכַרְתֶּם אֹתִי מִצְרַיִמָּה 7 וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶל-בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל גִּשְׁוּ הִנֵּה⁵ וְשָׁמְעוּ אֶת-דְּבָרֵי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם 8 וַיִּגְשׁוּ בְנֵי-יְהוּדָה אֶל-יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בְּגִלְגָּל וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלָיו כָּלֵב בֶּן-יִפְנֶה הַקִּנְזִי⁶ אֵתָה יָדַעְתָּ אֶת-הַדְּבָר אֲשֶׁר-דִּבֶּר יְהוָה אֶל-מֹשֶׁה אִישׁ-הָאֱלֹהִים עַל אֲדֹתֵי⁷ וְעַל אֲדֹתֶיךָ בְּקָדֶשׁ בְּרִנֵּעַ 9 וַיִּגְשׁוּ בְנֵי-הַנִּבְיָאִים אֲשֶׁר-בִּירִיחוֹ אֶל-אַלְיָשָׁע וַיֹּאמְרוּ אֵלָיו תִּדְעָתָּ כִּי הַיּוֹם יִהְיֶה לְקַח אֶת-אֲדֹנֶיךָ מֵעַל רֹאשְׁךָ וַיֹּאמֶר גַּם-אֲנִי יָדַעְתִּי הַחֲשׂוֹ⁸ 10 וַיִּסַּע אֲבָרָם הַלּוֹךְ וְנָסוּעַ הַנִּנְבָּה 11 וַיִּסַּע יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכָל-אֲשֶׁר-לוֹ וַיָּבֵא בְּאֶרֶץ שָׁבַע⁹ וַיִּזְבַּח זִבְחִים לֵאלֹהֵי אָבִיו וַיִּצְחַק 12 בְּנֵי תוֹרָתִי אֶל-תִּשְׁכַּח וּמִצְוֹתַי יִצַּר לִבָּךְ 13 וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת-כָּל-אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה וַהֲגַה-טוֹב מְאֹד 14 יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי הַשָּׁמַיִם אֲשֶׁר לָקַחְנִי מִבֵּית אָבִי וּמֵאֶרֶץ מוֹלֶדְתִּי¹⁰ וַאֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּע-לִי¹¹ לֵאמֹר לְזָרְעֶךָ אֶתֵּן אֶת-הָאֶרֶץ הַזֹּאת הוּא יִשְׁלַח מְלָאָכָו לְפָנֶיךָ וְלָקַחְתָּ אִשָּׁה לְבְנֵי מִשְׁם 15 אֲנִי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי אֲבֹרָהֶם אָבִיךָ וְאֵלֹהֵי יִצְחָק הָאֶרֶץ אֲשֶׁר אֵתָה שָׁכַב עָלֶיהָ. לָךְ אֶתְנַנֶּה וּלְזָרְעֶךָ

² בוא and he brought her in (Hiphil of וַיָּבֵא)

³ הִיא to be read as וַיָּבֵא

⁴ וַיִּגְשׁוּ pausal form; context form וַיִּגְשׁוּ

⁵ הִנֵּה here, hither; the stress of the preceding word גִּשְׁוּ is moved to the syllable with the thematic vowel to avoid the clash of two stressed syllables.

⁶ קנזי Kenizzite

⁷ על אדות because of, concerning

⁸ חשׂה be quiet (impv. masc. pl. Hi. חשׂה)

⁹ בְּאֶר שָׁבַע pausal form of שָׁבַע

¹⁰ מוֹלֶדְתִּי kindred, offspring, birth

¹¹ נִשְׁבַּע he swore

Chapter 12

12.1 Vocabulary

12.1.1 Verbs

אבה	Q. <i>to be willing, consent</i> (almost always with a negative)
בכה	Q. <i>to weep, weep for</i>
בנה	Q. <i>to build</i>
גלה	Q. <i>to uncover, remove, go into exile</i>
היה	Q. <i>to be, become</i>
חטא	Q. <i>to sin</i>
חיה	Q. <i>to be alive, stay alive, revive, recover, return to life</i>
חנה	Q. <i>to encamp</i>
חרה	Q. <i>to burn, kindle</i> (of anger אף)
מלא	Q. <i>to be full</i> (stative verb; SC מלא; with noun to indicate the substance)
מצא	Q. <i>to find</i>
נטה	Q. <i>to stretch out, spread out, extend, bend, turn, incline</i>
נשא	Q. <i>to lift, carry, take</i>
עלה	Q. <i>to go up, ascend</i>
ענה	Q. <i>to answer, respond</i>
עשה	Q. <i>to do, to make</i>
קרא	Q. <i>to call, proclaim, read</i>
שנא	Q. <i>to hate</i> (stative verb, PC שנא)
שתה	Q. <i>to drink</i>

12.1.2 Nouns

חדש	<i>new moon, month</i>
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Chapter 12

מִלְחָמָה	battle, war
מַעֲשֶׂה	deed, work
מִשְׁכָּן	dwelling-place, abode
מִשְׁפָּחָה	extended family, clan
מִשְׁפָּט	judgment; justice; ordinance; decision; custom
נֶפֶשׁ	soul, self, life, living being, person, desire, throat (fem.)
סֵפֶר	something written, letter, scroll
סֹפֵר	secretary, scribe
עֹלָה	(whole) burnt offering
עֵת	time (fem.; gem. noun; with enclitic pronoun עִתּוֹ)
פְּלִשְׁתִּים	Philistines (sg. פְּלִשְׁתִּי)
צֶרֶךְ	enemy (pl. צָרִים), pl. cs. st. צָרִי (gem. noun)

12.1.3 Other Parts of Speech

אוֹ	or
אֵי	where?
אֵימָה	where?
אֵךְ	yea, surely, only
אֵלָּה	where to? (interrogative adverb אֵן where to? with directional He)
לָמָּה	why? (preposition לָ + מָה)
לְמַעַן	in order to, so that (conj.); on account of, for the sake of (prep.) (לְ + מַעַן)
מֵאַיִן	whence? where from? (prep. מִן + the interrogative adv. אֵן where?)
מָדוּעַ	why?
מָה	what?
מִי	who?
מָתַי	when?
פֹּה	here (adv.)

12.2 Weak Verbs: III y Verbs

Originally, verbs of the category III y were verbs with the semivowels /y/ or /w/ as third root consonant. Because of contraction of the semivowel and the vowels preceding and/or following the semivowel, forms of III y verbs are often characterized by a long vowel after the second root consonant. The only form, in which the original root consonant /y/ is found regularly, is the participle passive.¹

			גלה	עשה	היה
SC	sg.	3 m.	גָּלָה	עָשָׂה	הָיָה
		3 f.	גָּלְתָה	עָשִׂתָה	הָיִיתָה
		2 m.	גָּלִיתָ	עָשִׂיתָ	הָיִיתָ
		2 f.	גָּלִיתְּ	עָשִׂיתְּ	הָיִיתְּ
		1 c.	גָּלִיתִי	עָשִׂיתִי	הָיִיתִי
	pl.	3 c.	גָּלוּ	עָשׂוּ	הָיוּ
		2 m.	גָּלִיתֶם	עָשִׂיתֶם	הָיִיתֶם
		2 f.	גָּלִיתֶן	עָשִׂיתֶן	הָיִיתֶן
		1 c.	גָּלִינוּ	עָשִׂינוּ	הָיִינוּ
PC	sg.	3 m.	יָגַלָה	יַעֲשֶׂה	יִהְיֶה
		3 f.	תִּגְלָה	תַּעֲשֶׂה	תִּהְיֶה
		2 m.	תִּגְלָה	תַּעֲשֶׂה	תִּהְיֶה
		2 f.	תִּגְלִי	תַּעֲשִׂי	תִּהְיִי
		1 c.	אֶגְלָה	אֶעֱשֶׂה	אֶהְיֶה
	pl.	3 m.	יִגְלוּ	יַעֲשׂוּ	יִהְיוּ
		3 f.	תִּגְלִינָה	תַּעֲשִׂינָה	תִּהְיִינָה
		2 m.	תִּגְלוּ	תַּעֲשׂוּ	תִּהְיוּ
		2 f.	תִּגְלִינָה	תַּעֲשִׂינָה	תִּהְיִינָה
		1 c.	נִגְלָה	נַעֲשֶׂה	נִהְיֶה

¹ A number of times, the semivowel may occur in other forms as well, e.g., יִבְכְּיוּן *they weep* (Isa 33:7); יִשְׁלָיו *may they be at ease* (Ps 122:6) from the verb שָׁלַח; compare the adjective שָׁלוֹ *quiet, at ease* with a consonantal ל.

			גלה	עשה	היה
Jussive	sg.	3 m.	יִגַּל	יַעַשׂ	יְהִי
<i>wayyiqtol</i>	sg.	3 m.	וַיִּגַּל	וַיַּעַשׂ	וַיְהִי
Impv.	sg.	m.	גַּלְה	עֲשֵׂה	הִיְהֵא
		f.	גַּלִּי	עֲשִׂי	הִיְהִי
	pl.	m.	גַּלוּ	עֲשׂוּ	הִיְהוּ
		f.	גַּלִּינָה		
Inf. cs.			גָּלוּת	עֲשׂוּת	הִיּוּת
Inf. abs.			גָּלָה	עָשָׂה	הָיָה
Part. act.	sg.	m.	גֹּלֶה	עֹשֶׂה	
Part. pass.	sg.	m.	גָּלוּי	עָשׂוּי	

Notes

Verbs IIIy were originally roots with the semivowels /y/ or /w/ as third root consonant. The diphthongs and triphthongs of the early forms of these root were simplified to long vowels, e.g., -*aya* > -*ā* in the 3 m. sg. form *galaya* > *galā* (cf. the original form of the strong verb **kataba*).

The 3 f. sg. SC form גַּלְתָּה combines the original suffix -*āt* and the suffix -*ā* of the strong verb. The resulting form גַּלְתָּה has the same syllable structure as the corresponding form of the strong verb כָּתַבְתָּה. The pausal form is גַּלְתָּהּ.

The 3 c. pl. SC form גָּלוּ is the result of the contraction of a diphthong -*ay*- and the 3 c. pl. morpheme /ū/: **galayū* > *gālū*.

Suffix conjugation forms of IIIy verbs in the Qal binyan are characterized by a long vowel -*ā* following the second root consonant in the 3 m. sg. form (e.g., גָּלָה) or by the long vowel -*ī* before consonantal suffixes (e.g., גַּלְתִּי).

Prefix conjugation forms of IIIy verbs in the Qal binyan are characterized by the long final vowel -*ē* in the forms without suffix. In the imperative m. sg. the final vowel is -*ē*.

IIIy verbs have distinct jussive and *wayyiqtol* forms. The 3 m./f. sg., 2 m. sg. jussive and *wayyiqtol* forms do not have the long final vowel -*ē*. The resulting consonant cluster at the end of the word is frequently resolved by insertion of a helping vowel similar to segolate nouns, e.g., יַעַשׂ, וַיַּעַשׂ, and *he did*. The prefix vowel is stressed except with the verbs היה and חיה. Important jussive and *wayyiqtol* forms of some frequent verbs are the following:

- Verb רָאָה: jussive יִרְאֵ, wayyiqtol 3 m. sg. יִירָא (wayyar(?)) with preservation of the א in the spelling although it is not pronounced), 3 f. sg. וִירְאָה, 1 c. sg. וִאֲרָא. The wayyiqtol forms with enclitic pronoun have consonantal א, e.g., וִירְאֵהוּ and he saw him (Judg 19:3)
- Verb בָּכָה: וַיִּבְכֶּה, וַתִּבְכֶּה
- Verb שָׁתָה: וַיִּשְׁתֶּה

Short jussive and wayyiqtol forms without the long final vowel -*ā* are called *apocopate forms* (Latin *forma apocopata* or in the pl. *formae apocopatae* from the Latin noun *apocope* which comes from the Greek noun ἀποκοπή *a cutting off*).

At times, the long final vowel -*ā* is preserved in jussive and wayyiqtol forms, e.g., יִרְאֵה let him see, וַיִּבְנֶה and he built, וַיַּעֲשֶׂה and he made.

Instead of distinct forms for the cohortative, III y verbs use the regular prefix conjugation forms 1 c. sg./pl. as volitive forms, e.g., נִבְנֶה let us build (Gen 11:4).

The forms of the participle active are גֹּלֶה (m. sg.), גֹּלְיָה (f. sg.), גֹּלִים (m. pl.), גֹּלוֹת (fem. pl.). The forms of the participle passive are גָּלוּי (m. sg.), גָּלוּיָה (f. sg.), גָּלוּיִם (m. pl.), גָּלוּיוֹת (fem. pl.).

Verbs III y with gutturals have the same vowel differences when compared to strong verbs without gutturals, e.g., עָלִיתָם you went up (2 m. sg. SC), יַעֲלוּ they shall go up (3 m. pl. jussive), עֲלֵה go up! (impv. m. sg.). As a stative verb, the verb חָרָה has prefix conjugation forms with the prefix vowel *segol*, e.g., יִחַרְרֶה. The jussive and wayyiqtol 3 m. sg. are יִחַר and יִחַרְרֵה.

The very frequent verb הָיָה to be has *hatef segol* with the first root consonant in the 2 m. pl. SC form: הָיִיתֶם (the 2 f. pl. form is not attested in Biblical Hebrew). With the conjunction ו the form is וַהֲיִיתֶם. In the PC the verb הָיָה has the prefix vowel /i/ in all forms except the 1 c. sg. despite the guttural ה. The first root consonant ה always has silent *šwa*. In the wayyiqtol form 3 m. sg. the *dageš forte* in the prefix consonant י is lost: וַיְהִי. The inf. cs. with the proclitic prepositions is לְהִיּוֹת and בְּהִיּוֹת. The inf. abs. may also be הִיּוֹ. There is one occurrence of a participle in Exod 9:3: הוֹיָה (f. sg.).

The verb חָיָה to live has forms corresponding to those of the verb הָיָה, e.g., יִחְיֶה, יִחְיֶהוּ, וַחְיִיתֶם, וַיְחִי, etc. The 3 m. sg. SC form may also be חִי, as pausal form חָי and with consecutive *waw* וַיְחִי.

The verb נָטָה to stretch out is doubly weak being In and III y. It has prefix conjugation forms like יִנָּטֶה, jussive forms like יִנָּט (3 m. sg.) and יִנָּטִי (2 f. sg.) and wayyiqtol forms like וַיִּנָּט (3 m. sg.) and וַיִּנָּטִי (3 f. sg.) with only one root consonant.

12.3 Weak Verbs: III' Verbs

III' verbs are characterized by the loss of the /ʔ/ as a consonant at the end of syllables. The silent (or: quiescent) **ס** is usually retained in the spelling of the forms which makes the identification of forms of III' verbs easy.

			Fientive	Stative	
			מצא	שנא	נשא
SC	sg.	3 m.	מָצָא	שָׁנָא	נָשָׂא
		3 f.	מָצְאָה	שָׁנְאָה	נָשְׂאָה
		2 m.	מָצַאתָ	שָׁנַאתָ	נָשַׂאתָ
		2 f.	מָצַאת	שָׁנַאת	נָשַׂאת
		1 c.	מָצַאתִי	שָׁנַאתִי	נָשַׂאתִי
	pl.	3 c.	מָצְאוּ	שָׁנְאוּ	נָשְׂאוּ
		2 m.	מָצַאתֶם	שָׁנַתֶם	נָשַׂאתֶם
		2 f.	מָצַאתֶן	שָׁנַתֶן	נָשַׂאתֶן
		1 c.	מָצַאתִנוּ	שָׁנַאתִנוּ	נָשַׂאתִנוּ
PC	sg.	3 m.	יָמָצָא	יָשָׁנָא	יָשָׂא
		3 f.	תִּמְצָא	תִּשְׁנָא	תִּשָּׂא
		2 m.	תִּמְצָא	תִּשְׁנָא	תִּשָּׂא
		2 f.	תִּמְצְאִי	תִּשְׁנְאִי	תִּשְׂאִי
		1 c.	אֶמְצָא	אֶשְׁנָא	אֶשָּׂא
	pl.	3 m.	יִמְצְאוּ	יִשְׁנְאוּ	יִשָּׂאוּ
		3 f.	תִּמְצְאֶנָּה	תִּשְׁנְאֶנָּה	תִּשָּׂאֶנָּה
		2 m.	תִּמְצְאוּ	תִּשְׁנְאוּ	תִּשָּׂאוּ
		2 f.	תִּמְצְאֶנָּה	תִּשְׁנְאֶנָּה	תִּשָּׂאֶנָּה
		1 c.	נִמְצָא	נִשְׁנָא	נִשָּׂא
Impv.	sg.	m.	מָצָא	שָׁנָא	שָׂא
		f.	מָצְאִי	שָׁנְאִי	שְׂאִי
	pl.	m.	מָצְאוּ	שָׁנְאוּ	שָׂאוּ
		f.	מָצְאֶנָּה		

	Fientive	Stative	נשא
	מצא	שנא	
Inf. cs.	מצא	שנא	שאת/שאת
Inf. abs.	מצוא	שנוא	
Part. act. sg. m.	מצא	שנא	נשא
Part. pass. sg. m.		שנוא	נשוא

Notes

While in the suffix conjugation fientive and stative verbs are distinguished, there is no such distinction in the prefix conjugation. In the prefix conjugation, III^ʔ verbs always have the vowel pattern *i-a*.

In forms with vocalic suffix or with enclitic pronouns the **ס** is preserved as a consonant, e.g., **מָצְאוּ** *they found*, **תִּמְצְאוּ** *you will find*, **מָצְאוּ** *he found him*, **יִמְצְאוּ** *he will find you*. Therefore, these forms are strong forms.

In the 3/2 f. pl. PC forms of III^ʔ verbs the vocalization follows the corresponding form of III^y verbs. The **ס** is usually retained in the spelling. At times, other forms of III^ʔ verbs follow the lead of III^y verbs as well.

The very frequent verb **נָשָׂא** *to lift, carry* is doubly weak (Iⁿ and III^ʔ) with elision of the third root consonant /ʔ/ at the end of syllables and assimilation of the first root consonant /n/ in the prefix conjugation and complete loss of the /n/ in the imperative and the inf. cs.

III^ʔ verbs do not have distinct jussive or *wayyiqtol* forms.

The verb **חָטָא** *to sin* as a verb I gutt. and III^ʔ has prefix conjugation forms with *segol* as prefix vowel, e.g., **יִחָטְאוּ**.

12.4 WH-Questions

12.4.1 The Interrogative Pronouns **מִי** *Who?* and **מָה** *What?*

Biblical Hebrew has two interrogative pronouns proper, **מִי** *who?* and **מָה** *what?*. The forms of **מָה** differ depending on the initial consonant of the following word.

- Before words beginning with a non-guttural it is **מָה־** (with *dageš forte* in the first consonant of the following word), e.g., **מָה־שְׁמֶךָ** *What is your name?* (Gen 32:28)

- Before the guttural א (always), before ר (always) and before the guttural ע (almost always) it is מָה without *dageš forte*, e.g., מָה אֶמַר אֲלֵהֶם *What shall I say to them?* (Exod 3:13), מָה רָאוּ בְּבֵיתְךָ *What have they seen in your house?* (2 Kgs 20:15)
- Before the gutturals ה and ח it is מַה, e.g., מַה הוּא *What is it?* (Exod 16:15), מַה חַטָּאתִי *What is my sin?* (Gen 31:36) (except before the article)
- Before the definite article it is מֶה, e.g., מֶה הָאֲבָנִים הָאֵלֶּה *What are these stones?* (Josh 4:21)
- Before gutturals with *qameṣ* or *qameṣ hatuf* it is מֶה, e.g., מֶה עָשִׂיתָ *What have you done?* (Gen 4:10), מֶה הָיָה הַדָּבָר בְּנִי *What is the matter, my son?* (1 Sam 4:16). At times, this may be the case before gutturals with other vowels as well, e.g., מֶה עָשִׂיתִי מֶה עֲוֹנִי וּמַה חַטָּאתִי *What have I done? What is my guilt and what is my sin?* (1 Sam 20:1). This happens rarely even before non-gutturals, e.g., מֶה מִשְׁפָּט הָאִישׁ *What is the manner of the man?* (2 Kgs 1:7).

Both מִי and מָה can be used together with prepositions. When מָה is used with the prepositions בְּ or כִּי, the forms are בְּמָה, כִּימָה, and כִּמָּה; forms with *pataḥ* and following *dageš forte* do not occur. The following examples illustrate this use.

לְמִי־אֶתָּה	<i>To whom do you belong?</i> (1 Sam 30:13) (Ps 78:25)
לְמִי אֲנִי אֶעֱבֹד	<i>Whom should I serve?</i> (2 Sam 16:19)
בְּמָה	<i>With what?, i.e., How [are you going to entice him]?</i> (1 Kgs 22:21)
כִּמָּה יָמֵי שְׁנֵי חַיֶּיךָ	lit. <i>How many are the days of the years of your life?</i> (Gen 47:8)

The interrogative pronouns מִי and מָה can be used in construct chains, e.g., מִי בֶת־מִי אַתָּה *Whose daughter are you?* (Gen 24:47) בֶּן־מִי אַתָּה הַנָּעַר *Whose son are you, young man?* (1 Sam 17:58)

The interrogative pronoun מָה preceded by the preposition לְ has the meaning *why?* (see the next paragraph).

If מִי is the object of the interrogative clause it is always used with the object marker אֶת, e.g., אֶת־מִי אֶשְׁלַח *Whom shall I send?* (Isa 6:8).

Beside *what?* the interrogative pronoun מָה has other meanings like *how?*, *why?*. It may also be used in exclamations, e.g., מַה־טֹבֹו אֹהֶלֶיךָ יַעֲקֹב מִשְׁכְּנֹתֶיךָ *How fair are your tents, O Jacob, your dwellings, O Israel!* (Num 24:5).

12.4.2 Interrogative adverbs

Biblical Hebrew has the following frequent interrogative adverbs:

- Local: **אַיְה** *where?*, **אֵי** *where?*, **אַנְה** *where to?* (interrogative adverb **אֵן** *where to?* with directional **הֵ**), **מֵאַיִן** *from where?*
- Temporal: **מָתַי** *when?*
- Causal: **לָמָּה** *why?* (preposition **לְ** + **מָה**), **מָדוּעַ** *why?*

אַנְה may be used together with the preposition **עַד** in a temporal sense *How long?*, e.g., **עַד-אַנְה יִנְאַצְנִי הָעָם הַזֶּה** *How long will this people despise me?* (Num 14:11).

The interrogative adverb **לָמָּה** *why?* is **לָמָּה** before gutturals.

12.5 Exercises

12.5.1 Translation of Verbal Forms

Translate the following verbal forms. Identify the gender (masc., fem., comm.) and number (sg., pl.) the forms of which the English translation is ambiguous (i.e., *you, they*). Mark the stressed syllable if stress is not on the last syllable.

- 1 בָּנוּ 2 אָנְלָה 3 מְצֹאֶתָ 4 לֹא אָבִיתִי 5 תַּחֲטָאוּ 6 תַּחֲיוּ 7 וַיַּחֲיוּ
8 מָלְאוּ 9 וַיֵּט 10 וַיִּשְׂאוּ 11 וַתַּעַל 12 עָנִיתָם 13 קָרָא 14 שָׁתָה 15 נִשְׁתָּה

12.5.2 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: **יִבְשׁ**, **חִלְקִיָּהוּ**, **הַבֶּל**, **אַכִּישׁ**, **שָׁפָן**, **קִין**, **עֶכָן**, **נַחֲשׁ**, **גִּלְעָד**.

- 1 וַיַּעַשׂ לָהֶם מִשְׁתֶּה וַיֹּאכְלוּ וַיִּשְׁתּוּ 2 וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל-קִין אֵי הַבֶּל אָחִיךָ וַיֹּאמֶר
לֹא יָדַעְתִּי הֲשִׁמֵּר אָחִי אֲנֹכִי 3 וַיֹּאמֶר שָׁמוּאֵל אֶל-כָּל-הָעָם הַדְּאִיתֶם אֲשֶׁר בָּחַר-בּוֹ
יְהוָה כִּי אֵין כָּמֹהוּ בְּכָל-הָעָם 4 וַיֵּצְאוּ² בְּנֵי-הַנְּבִיאִים אֲשֶׁר-בֵּית-אֵל אֶל-אֱלִישָׁע
וַיֹּאמְרוּ אֵלָיו הִידְעָתָ כִּי הַיּוֹם יִהְיֶה לְקַח אֶת-אֲדֹנֶיךָ מֵעַל רֹאשֶׁךָ וַיֹּאמֶר גַּם-אֲנִי
יָדַעְתִּי הַחֲשׂוֹ³ 5 וַיַּעַן עֶכָן אֶת-יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וַיֹּאמֶר אָמֵנָה⁴ אֲנֹכִי חָטָאתִי לַיהוָה אֱלֹהֵי

² וַיֵּצְאוּ *and they went out*

³ הַחֲשׂו *be quiet! (impv.)*

⁴ אָמֵנָה *amnā truly, indeed*

יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכִזְזָת וְכִזְזָת עָשִׂיתִי 6 וַיַּעַן אָכִישׁ וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל־דָּוִד יִדְעָתִי כִּי טוֹב אֶתָּה
 בְּעֵינַי כְּמִלְאָד אֱלֹהִים אֲדָה שְׂרֵי פִלְשִׁתִּים אָמְרוּ לֹא־יַעֲלֶה עִמָּנוּ בְּמִלְחָמָה 7 וַיַּעַל
 נָחָשׁ הָעַמּוֹנִי⁵ וַיַּחֲנֶה עַל־יָבֶשׁ גִּלְעָד וַיֹּאמְרוּ כָל־אֲנָשֵׁי יִבִּישׁ אֶל־נָחָשׁ כְּרַת־לָנוּ בְרִית
 וְנַעֲבֹדָה 8 וַיַּעַל יוֹסֵף לְקַבֵּר אֶת־אָבִיו וַיַּעֲלוּ אֹתוֹ כָּל־עַבְדֵי פָרְעֹה זִקְנֵי בֵיתוֹ וְכָל
 זִקְנֵי אֶרֶץ־מִצְרָיִם 9 וַיֹּאמֶר חֲלָקֶיהוּ הַכֹּהֵן הַגָּדוֹל עַל־שָׁפָן הַסֵּפֶר הַסֵּפֶר הַתּוֹרָה
 מִצָּאֵתִי בְּבֵית יְהוָה וַיִּתֵּן חֲלָקֶיהָ אֶת־הַסֵּפֶר אֶל־שָׁפָן וַיִּקְרָאֻהוּ 10 וַיְהִי בַחֲיֹות
 יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בִּירִיחוֹ וַיִּשָּׂא עֵינָיו וַיֵּרָא וְהִנֵּה־אִישׁ עֹמֵד לְנִגְדּוֹ וְחָרְבוֹ שְׁלוּפָה⁶ בְּיָדוֹ וַיִּלָּךְ
 יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֵלָיו וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ הֲלָנוּ אֶתָּה אִם־לְצָרֵינוּ

⁵ עַמּוֹנִי Ammonite

⁶ שְׁלֹפָה Q. to draw out; to draw off

Chapter 13

13.1 Vocabulary

13.1.1 Verbs

הלך	Q. <i>to go</i>
טמא	Q. <i>to be unclean, become unclean</i> (stative verb, SC טָמֵא)
יטב	Q. <i>to be good, well, glad, pleasant</i>
יצא	Q. <i>to go out, come out</i>
יצק	Q. <i>to pour out</i>
ירא	Q. <i>to fear, be afraid</i> (stative verb, SC יָרָא; with direct object or prep. מִן or מִפְּנֵי indicate the object)
ירש	Q. <i>to take possession of, inherit, dispossess</i>
רעה	Q. <i>to pasture, tend, graze</i> (part. רֹעֶה shepherd)

13.1.2 Nouns

אָזן	<i>ear</i> (du. אָזְנַיִם ʾaznáyim)
אֵל	<i>God, god</i>
אַמָּה	<i>cubit</i>
אַף	<i>nose, anger, nostrils</i> (gem. noun; dual אַפִּים)
אַפִּים	<i>face</i> (dual of אֵף)
בְּאֵר	<i>well</i> (of underground water), <i>watering place</i> (fem.)
בָּשָׂר	<i>flesh, meat</i>
גֶּפֶן	<i>vine</i> (fem.)
דַּעַת	<i>knowledge</i> (inf. cs. Q. יָדַע)

זֶרַע	seed, sowing; offspring, descendants
חֶסֶד	joint obligation, loyalty, faithfulness, goodness, graciousness
טָמֵא	unclean (adj., m. pl. טָמְאִים)
כֶּרֶם	vineyard
מוֹעֵד	appointed time, appointed place, meeting (אֹהֶל מוֹעֵד tent of meeting)
מִטָּה	staff, tribe
קֶצֶה	edge, end, extremity

13.1.3 Other Parts of Speech

אָז	then, at that time (often with a PC form with past tense meaning)
אַחֵר	behind, afterwards (adv.), behind, after (prep.)
בֵּין	between (prep., usually וּבֵין ... בֵּין or לְ ... בֵּין)
לְקָרָא	toward, against (prep.; לְ + inf. cs. of קָרָא ₂ to encounter)
עַל־כֵּן	therefore

13.2 Weak Verbs: Iy Verbs

In the suffix conjugation Iy verbs have strong forms with three root consonants. Forms of the prefix conjugation are always weak, and so are most forms of the imperative and the infinitive construct. The infinitive absolute and the participles are strong.

In the prefix conjugation, two groups of Iy verbs need to be differentiated. There are Iy verbs with the vowel pattern *i-a* and verbs with the vowel pattern *a-i*. The verb יָכַל *to be able* is a case apart.

The group of Iy comprises two groups of verbs; first, verbs with /y/ as first root consonant originally. and, second, verbs with /w/ as first root consonant originally. In early Northwest Semitic initial /w/ became /y/. As a consequence, the verbs with an original first root consonant /w/ have /y/ as first root consonant in the suffix conjugation Qal.

13.2 Weak Verbs: I y Verbs

			ירש	ישב	הלך	יכל
SC	sg.	3 m.	יִרְשׁ	יֵשֵׁב	הֵלֵךְ	יִכֹּל
		3 f.	יִרְשָׁה	יֵשְׁבָה	הֵלְכָה	יִכְלֶה
		2 m.	יִרְשֶׁתָּ	יֵשְׁבֶתָּ	הֵלְכֶתָּ	
		2 f.	יִרְשֶׁתִּי	יֵשְׁבֶתִּי	הֵלְכֶתִּי	
		1 c.	יִרְשָׁתִּי	יֵשְׁבָתִּי	הֵלְכָתִּי	יִכְלֹתִי
	pl.	3 c.	יִרְשׁוּ	יֵשְׁבוּ	הֵלְכוּ	יִכְלוּ
		2 m.	יִרְשָׁתֶּם	יֵשְׁבֶתֶם	הֵלְכֶתֶם	
		2 f.	יִרְשָׁתֶּן	יֵשְׁבֶתֶן	הֵלְכֶתֶן	
		1 c.	יִרְשָׁנוּ	יֵשְׁבָנוּ	הֵלְכָנוּ	
PC	sg.	3 m.	יִירָשׁ	יֵשֵׁב	יֵלֵךְ	יִיכֹל
		3 f.	תִּירָשׁ	תֵּשֵׁב	תֵּלֵךְ	תִּיכֹל
		2 m.	תִּירָשׁ	תֵּשֵׁב	תֵּלֵךְ	תִּיכֹל
		2 f.	תִּירָשִׁי	תֵּשְׁבִי	תֵּלְכִי	תִּיכְלִי
		1 c.	אִירָשׁ	אֵשֵׁב	אֵלֵךְ	אִיכֹל
	pl.	3 m.	יִירְשׁוּ	יֵשְׁבוּ	יֵלְכוּ	יִיכְלוּ
		3 f.	תִּירְשְׁנָה	תֵּשְׁבְּנָה	תֵּלְכְּנָה	
		2 m.	תִּירְשׁוּ	תֵּשְׁבוּ	תֵּלְכוּ	תִּיכְלוּ
		2 f.	תִּירְשְׁנָה	תֵּשְׁבְּנָה	תֵּלְכְּנָה	
		1 c.	נִירָשׁ	נֵשֵׁב	נֵלֵךְ	נִיכֹל
Jussive	sg.	3 m.	יִירָשׁ	יֵשֵׁב	יֵלֵךְ	
wayyiqtol	sg.	3 m.	נִירָשׁ	נֵשֵׁב	נֵלֵךְ	נִיכֹל

		יֵרֵשׁ	יֵשֵׁב	הֵלֵךְ	יָכַל
Impv.	sg. m.	יֵרֵשׁ	יֵשֵׁב	הֵלֵךְ	
	f.		יֵשְׁבִי	לָכִי	
	pl. m.	יֵרֵשׁוּ	יֵשְׁבוּ	לָכוּ	
	f.				
Inf. cs.		יֵרֵשֶׁת	יֵשְׁבֶת	לָכֶת	יָכֻלֶת
Inf. abs.			יֵשׁוּב	הֵלֹךְ	יָכוּל
Part. act.	sg. m.	יֵרֵשׁ	יֵשֵׁב	הֹלֵךְ	

Notes

In the *i-a* verbs – represented by the verb יֵרֵשׁ in the first column – the development of the prefix conjugation form was *yīraš* > *yīraš* יֵרֵשׁ with contraction of *iy* > *i*.

The group with the *a-i* vowel pattern – represented by the verb יֵשֵׁב in the second column – contains the following six verbs: יֵשֵׁב *to sit*, יָדַע *to know*, יָצָא *to go out*, יָרַד *to go down*, יָלַד *to bear, beget* and the verb הֵלֵךְ *to go*.

The explanation of the actual vowels *ē-ē* of the form יֵשֵׁב of *a-i* verbs is disputed.¹ Based on an original form **yašib* with only two root consonants and an open prefix syllable the form either developed along the path **yašib* > **yašēb* > *yēšēb* with assimilation of the prefix vowel to the thematic vowel or along the path **yašib* > **yayšib* > *yēšēb* with addition of the semivowel /y/ to the bring the form closer to the regular verb with three root consonants and subsequent contraction of the diphthong *ay* > *ē*.

In both types of *Iy* verbs the prefix vowel is unchangeable while the thematic vowel is reduced to *šwa* in context forms with vocalic suffixes, e.g., יֵרֵשׁוּ, יֵשְׁבִי. In pausal forms the thematic vowel is preserved, e.g., יֵרֵשׁוּ, יֵשְׁבִי (with defective spelling of the prefix).

The prefix vowel *ū* of the verb יָכַל is the result of the contraction of the diphthong *iw* > *ū*: **yiwkal* > *yūkal* יָכַל.²

In the prefix conjugation forms of the verb יָדַע the thematic vowel is changed to /a/ because of the guttural יָדַע: יָדַע, יָדַע, יָדַע etc. In pausal forms

¹ The same vowel pattern in its original form *a-i* is found in the prefix conjugation forms of the verb נָתַן, e.g., יָתַן with attenuation of the prefix vowel *a* > *i*.

² At face value, the prefix conjugation forms of יָכַל look like Hophal forms (→ 23.2.1), but they are indeed Qal forms.

the thematic vowel is lengthened to *qameṣ*, e.g., *יִרְעַ*, *יִרְעֵי*. The same vowel /a/ is also found in the forms of the impv. *רַע*, etc., and the inf. cs. *רַעַת*.

In the frequent doubly weak verbs *יָצָא* *to go out* and *יָרָא* *to fear* the /ʔ/ becomes silent at the end of the syllable, e.g., *יָצָא* *yēṣē(ʔ)* and *יָרָא* *yirā(ʔ)*. In forms with vocalic suffix the ʔ is preserved as a consonant, e.g., *יָצָאוּ* and *יָרָאוּ*. In 2/3 f. pl. forms the vowels follow the pattern of IIIy verbs, e.g., *יָצְאָנָה* (2 f. pl.) *וַיִּרְאָנָה* (3 f. pl.) (cf. *וַיִּתְּלָיְנָה*). The forms of the inf. cs. are *יָצָאת* and *יָרָא* and *יָרָאָה*, respectively.

The verb *יָרָא* *to fear* is a stative verb with suffix conjugation forms like *יָרָא* (3 m. sg.), *יָרָאתִי* (1 c. sg.), *יָרָאתֶם* (2 pl.). The noun *יָרָאָה* functions as inf. cs. besides the rare *יָרָא*.

In the 2/3 f. pl. form *יָצְאָנָה* the vowel /a/ between the second and third root consonant is due to Philippi's Law (*i* > *a* in stressed closed syllable).

In *wayyiqṭol* forms of *a-i* type verbs without suffix (except in 1 c. sg. forms) the stress is moved to the prefix syllable and the thematic vowel is changed to /æ/, e.g., *וַיֵּלֶךְ*, *וַיֵּרָד*, *וַיֵּשֶׁב*, but in the 1 c. sg. the stress is on the last syllable *וַיֵּלֶכְךָ*, *וַיֵּרָדְךָ*, *וַיֵּשֶׁבְךָ*. In pausal forms stress does not move, e.g., *וַיֵּלֶךְ*, *וַיֵּרָד*. As retraction of stress in verbal forms only happens when the penultimate syllable is open and the final syllable is closed, stress does not move in forms of the verbs *יָצָא* and *יָרָא* due the quiescent /ʔ/ which results in an open final syllable.

Suffix-less jussive forms of Iy verbs of the *a-i* type are frequently stressed on the last syllable, e.g., *וַיֵּרָד אֵלַי* *and let him come to me* (1 Sam 17:8) but forms with stress on the penultimate syllable are also attested, e.g., *תֵּרָד אֵשׁ מִן־הַשָּׁמַיִם* *let fire come down from heaven* (2 Kgs 1:12).

Verbs Iy with *צ* as second root consonant have irregular prefix conjugation Qal forms with doubling of the *צ* as well as forms with a single /s/, e.g., *וַיִּצֹק* *and he poured* (Gen 28:18), *אֶצֹק* *I shall pour* (Isa 44:3) from the verb *יָצַק*.³

13.3 Numerals (I): Numbers 1–10

13.3.1 The Forms of Cardinal Numbers 1–10

The cardinal numbers from 1 to 10 have the following forms:⁴

³ At face value forms like *אֶצֹק* look like forms of Iy verbs, although they are indeed forms of Iy verbs.

⁴ In Modern Hebrew the numerals for *four* *אַרְבַּע* and *eight* *שְׁמוֹנֶה* are stressed on the penultimate syllable.

	With masc. nouns		With fem. nouns	
	abs. st.	cs. st.	abs. st.	cs. st.
1	אֶחָד	אֶחָד	אַחַת	אַחַת
2	שְׁנַיִם	שְׁנֵי	שְׁתֵּי	שְׁתֵּי
3	שְׁלֹשָׁה	שְׁלֹשָׁה	שְׁלוֹשׁ	שְׁלוֹשׁ
4	אַרְבָּעָה	אַרְבַּעַת	אַרְבַּע	אַרְבַּע
5	חֲמִשָּׁה	חֲמִשָּׁה	חֲמִשׁ	חֲמִשׁ
6	שֵׁשׁ	שֵׁשֶׁת	שֵׁשׁ	שֵׁשׁ
7	שִׁבְעָה	שִׁבְעַת	שִׁבְעַת	שִׁבְעַת
8	שְׁמוֹנָה	שְׁמוֹנַת	שְׁמוֹנָה	שְׁמוֹנָה
9	תְּשֻׁעָה	תְּשֻׁעַת	תְּשֻׁעַת	תְּשֻׁעַת
10	עֶשְׂרֵה	עֶשְׂרֵה	עֶשְׂרֵה	עֶשְׂרֵה

13.3.2 The Use of the Cardinal Numbers 1–10

The cardinal number for *one* אֶחָד and אַחַת, respectively, is an adjective. It has different uses in Biblical Hebrew:

- When it modifies a noun, it follows the noun and agrees with it in gender and number, e.g., אִישׁ־אֶחָד *one man* (in אֲנַחְנוּ בְּנֵי אִישׁ־אֶחָד *We are the sons of one man* Gen 42:13), אֶחָד בַּיּוֹם *on one day* (1 Sam 2:34), אֶבֶן אַחַת *one stone* (Josh 4:5).
- In cs. st. followed by a dependent noun, noun phrase or prepositional phrase with מִן, e.g., אֶחָד הַהָרִים *one of the mountains*, אַחַת עָרֶיךָ *one of your towns*, אֶחָד מֵהֶם *one of them*
- Like an indefinite article, e.g., אִישׁ אֶחָד *a man* (1 Sam 1:1), אִשָּׁה אַחַת *a woman* (2 Kgs 4:1)
- Like an ordinal number *first*, e.g., וְשֵׁם הַשְּׁנִיית רֹתַת *The name of the first one was Orpah and the name of the second Ruth* (Ruth 1:4)

The cardinal number for *two* agrees with the noun it modifies in number and gender, i.e., שְׁנַיִם is used with masculine nouns and שְׁתֵּי is used with feminine nouns.

13.3 Numerals (I): Numbers 1–10

The cardinal numbers 3–10 are characterized by gender inversion. This means that masculine nouns are used with number words with feminine ending whereas feminine nouns are used with masculine number words.

The numerals 2–10 may be used in three different ways when they are used as modifiers of nouns:

- In construct state before the counted noun, e.g., שְׁנֵי בָּנִים *two sons*, שְׁתֵּי בָּנוֹת *two daughters*, שְׁלֹשָׁת בָּנָיו *his three sons*, שְׁלֹשׁ קָאִים *three seahs* (sg. שָׂאָה, f.)
- In absolute state before the counted noun, e.g., שְׁנַיִם אַנָּשִׁים *two men*, שְׁתֵּים נָשִׁים *two women*, שְׁלֹשָׁה בָּנִים *three sons*, שְׁלֹשׁ עָרִים *three cities*
- In absolute state following the counted noun (especially in lists), e.g., עַמֻּדִים שְׁנַיִם *two pillars*, עָרִים שְׁתֵּים *two cities*, יָמִים שְׁלוֹשָׁה *three days*, עָרִים שְׁלֹשׁ *three cities*

Numerals may be used with enclitic pronouns, e.g., שְׁנֵיהֶם *the two of them*, שְׁלֹשָׁתָם *the three of them*, אַרְבַּעָתָם *the four of them*.

13.3.3 Ordinal Numbers 1–10

	masc.	fem.
1st	רִאשׁוֹן	רִאשׁוֹנָה
2nd	שֵׁנִי	שֵׁנִית
3rd	שְׁלִישִׁי	שְׁלִישִׁית
4th	רְבִיעִי	רְבִיעִית
5th	חֲמִישִׁי	חֲמִישִׁית
6th	שֵׁשִׁי	שֵׁשִׁית
7th	שְׁבִיעִי	שְׁבִיעִית
8th	שְׁמִינִי	שְׁמִינִית
9th	תְּשִׁיעִי	תְּשִׁיעִית
10th	עֲשִׂירִי	עֲשִׂירִית

Ordinal numbers are adjectives. As such, they follow the noun they modify and agree with it in number and gender. Dedicated forms of cardinal numbers exist only up to *10th*. For values above 10th cardinal numbers are used. With years and months, cardinal numbers are often used instead of ordinal numbers.

13.4 Adjectives with the Ending -ī

Adjectives with the ending -ī often indicate the belonging to an ethnic group, the origin from a country, area or city. This ending is therefore called *gentilic ending* (from Latin *gens* *tribe, people*). The ending -ī can also be used on regular adjectives like נָכְרִי *foreign*, נָקִי *free from guilt, innocent*. The different forms of עִבְרִי *Hebrew* are as follows:

	masc.	fem.
sg.	עִבְרִי	עִבְרִיָּה
pl.	עִבְרִים	עִבְרִיּוֹת

Notes

The plural form may have the ending -*īyyīm*, e.g., עִבְרִיִּים (only once in Exod 3:18), נִקְיִים.

The fem. sg. ending may also be -*īt*, e.g., שִׁפְחָה מִצְרַיִת *an Egyptian maidservant* (Gen 16:1), אֲרָמִית (adv., *in Aramaic*), יְהוּדִית (adv., *in Judean*).

The ordinal numbers *2nd* to *10th* belong to this category of adjectives.

13.5 Exercises

13.5.1 Translation of Verbal Forms

Translate the following verbal forms. Identify the gender (masc., fem., comm.) and number (sg., pl.) the forms of which the English translation is ambiguous (i.e., *you, they*). Mark the stressed syllable if stress is not on the last syllable.

1 אֵלֶךְ	2 נִלְךְ	3 תִּלְכוּ	4 לָכוּ	5 תִּטְמְאוּ	6 יִצְאָתִי	7 יִצְאוּ	8 יִצְאוּ
9 יִצְאִים	10 יִרְשְׁנוּ	11 תִּירְשׁוּ	12 נִירְשׁוּ	13 יִרְאָתִי	14 תִּירְאוּ	15 תִּירְאוּ	16 יִשְׁבוּ
17 נִישְׁבוּ	18 שְׁבֵה	19 שְׁבוּ	20 יִרְדְּתָה				

13.5.2 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: מְרִים, לוֹט, בֵּית-שֶׁמֶשׁ, שְׁמַעִי, רָמַת גִּלְעָד, קִין, קָדֵשׁ, צֹעֵר, סִינִי, נֹחַן.

1 וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶל־הַכֹּהֲנִים לֵאמֹר שְׂאוּ אֶת־אֲרוֹן הַבְּרִית וְעִבְרוּ לִפְנֵי הָעָם וַיֹּאמֶר אֶת־אֲרוֹן הַבְּרִית וַיֵּלְכוּ לִפְנֵי הָעָם 2 וַיִּקְרָא יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בֶּן־נוּן אֶל־הַכֹּהֲנִים וַיֹּאמֶר אֲלֵהֶם שְׂאוּ אֶת־אֲרוֹן הַבְּרִית וְשִׁבְעָה כֹהֲנִים יִשְׂאוּ שִׁבְעָה שׁוֹפְרוֹת יוֹבְלִים⁵ לִפְנֵי אֲרוֹן יְהוָה 3 וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה פֶּתְאִם⁶ אֶל־מֹשֶׁה וְאֶל־אַהֲרֹן וְאֶל־מִרְיָם צֹאוּ שְׁלֹשְׁתְּכֶם אֶל־אֹהֶל מוֹעֵד וַיִּצְאוּ שְׁלֹשָׁתָם 4 וַיֵּרֶד יְהוָה עַל־הָרֹם סִינַי אֶל־רֹאשׁ הָהָר וַיִּקְרָא יְהוָה לְמֹשֶׁה אֶל־רֹאשׁ הָהָר וַיַּעַל מֹשֶׁה 5 וַיַּעַל לוֹט מִצִּוְעֵר וַיֵּשֶׁב בְּהָר וּשְׁתֵּי בְנֵתָיו עִמּוֹ כִּי יָרָא לְשִׁבְתָּ בְּצִוְעֵר וַיֵּשֶׁב בְּמַעְרָה⁷ הוּא וּשְׁתֵּי בְנֵתָיו 6 וַיָּבֹא הָעָם בֵּית־אֵל וַיֵּשְׁבוּ שָׁם עַד־הָעֶרֶב לִפְנֵי הָאֱלֹהִים וַיִּשְׂאוּ קוֹלָם וַיִּבְכּוּ בְּכִי⁸ גָדוֹל 7 וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהֵי אֲל־תִּירָא כִּי לֹא תִמָּצָא יָד שְׂאוֹל אָבִי וְאַתָּה תִּמְלֹךְ עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאַנְכִי אֲהִי־לָךְ לְמִשְׁנָה⁹ וְגַם־שְׂאוֹל אָבִי יָדַע כֵּן 8 וַיִּשְׁלַח הַמֶּלֶךְ וַיִּקְרָא לְשִׁמְעִי וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ בְּנֵה־לָךְ בֵּית בִּירוּשָׁלַם¹⁰ וַיִּשְׁבֹּתָ שָׁם וְלֹא־תֵצֵא מִשָּׁם אָנֹכָה וְאַנְכִי¹¹ 9 וַיֹּאמְרוּ הֵבָה¹² נִבְנֶה־לָנוּ עִיר וּמִגְדָּל וְרֹאשׁוֹ בַּשָּׁמַיִם וְנַעֲשֶׂה־לָנוּ שֵׁם וַיֵּרֶד יְהוָה לִרְאוֹת אֶת־הָעִיר וְאֶת־הַמִּגְדָּל אֲשֶׁר בָּנוּ בְּנֵי הָאָדָם 10 וַאֲשַׁמֶּע אֶת־קוֹל אֲדָנִי אָמַר אֶת־מִי אֲשַׁלַּח וּמִי יֵלֶךְ־לָנוּ וַאֲמַר הֲנִי שְׁלַחְנִי 11 וַיֹּאמֶר אֲלֵהֶם הָאֵלֶךְ עַל־רִמָּת גִּלְעָד לְמַלְחָמָה אִם־אֶחָדָל 12 וַיַּדַּע קִין אֶת־אֲשֶׁתּוֹ וַתַּהַר¹³ וַתֵּלֶד אֶת־חֲנוּךְ וַיְהִי בְנֵה עִיר וַיִּקְרָא שֵׁם הָעִיר כְּשֵׁם בְּנוֹ חֲנוּךְ 13 וְכָל אֲשֶׁר־יִנְעֲבוּ הַטָּמֵא וְהַנִּפְשׁ הַנִּנְעָת תִּטְמָא עַד־הָעֶרֶב 14 כִּי־אַתָּה יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל גָּלִיתָה אֶת־אֲזִין עֲבָדֶיךָ לֵאמֹר בֵּית אֲבִנֵה־לָךְ עַל־כֵּן מֵצָא עֲבָדֶיךָ אֶת־לְבָבוֹ לְהִתְפַּלֵּל¹⁴ אֵלֶיךָ אֶת־הַתְּפִלָּה¹⁵ הַזֹּאת 15 וַיִּשְׁלַח מֹשֶׁה מַלְאָכִים מִקִּדְשׁ אֶל־מֶלֶךְ אֲדוֹם כֹּה אָמַר אֶחָיֶךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל אַתָּה יָדַעְתָּ אֶת כָּל־הַתְּלָאָה¹⁶ אֲשֶׁר מֵצָאֲתָנוּ. וַיִּרְדּוּ אֲבֹתֵינוּ מִצְרִימָה וַיֵּשֶׁב בְּמִצְרַיִם יָמִים רַבִּים וַיִּרְעוּ¹⁷ לָנוּ מִצְרַיִם וְלֹאֲבֹתֵינוּ. וְנִצְעַק אֶל־יְהוָה וַיִּשְׁמַע קוֹלָנוּ וַיִּשְׁלַח מַלְאָךְ וַיִּצְאָנוּ¹⁸ מִמִּצְרַיִם וְהִנֵּה אֲנִי בְּקִדְשׁ עִיר קִצֵּה גְבוּלָךְ. נַעֲבְרָה־נָא בְּאֶרֶצְךָ לֹא נַעֲבֹר בְּשָׂדֶה וּבְכֶרֶם וְלֹא נִשְׁתֶּה מִי בָּאֵר. דִּרְךְ הַמֶּלֶךְ גִּלְעָד. לֹא נִטָּה יָמִין

⁵ ram יובל⁶ פתאם suddenly, surprisingly⁷ מערה cave⁸ בכי weeping (noun)⁹ משנה here: second in command¹⁰ ירושלם to be read yərūšāláyim¹¹ וְאַנְכִי hither and thither (HALOT)¹² הֵבָה come! come on! (interjection; actually impv. of יָהֵב).¹³ הרה to be pregnant, become pregnant¹⁴ להתפלל to pray¹⁵ תפלה prayer¹⁶ התלאה tribulation, hardship¹⁷ וירעו and they treated badly¹⁸ ויצאנו and he lead us out (Hiphil יצא)

וּשְׂמֹאזֹל עַד אֲשֶׁר-נֶעְבַר גְּבוּלָךְ. וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלָיו אֲדָוָם לֹא תַעֲבֹר בִּי פֶן-¹⁹ בַּחֲרֹב אֵצְא
לְקִרְאָתְךָ. ¹⁶ וַיַּחַר-אַף יְהוָה בִּישְׂרָאֵל וַיִּתְּנֵם בְּיַד-שָׂסִים ²⁰ ¹⁷ וַתִּמְלֹךְ דָּוִד
שָׁמַע אֶת כָּל-הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה וַיַּחַר לוֹ מְאֹד ¹⁸ וַיֹּאמְרוּ אֲנָשֵׁי בֵית-שָׁמֶשׁ מִי יוּכַל
לַעֲמֹד לִפְנֵי יְהוָה הָאֱלֹהִים הַקָּדוֹשׁ הַזֶּה

¹⁹ פֶּן *lest, so that not*

²⁰ שָׂסִים *to plunder*

Chapter 14

14.1 Vocabulary

14.1.1 Verbs

בוא	Q. to come, to enter
בוש	Q. to be ashamed
בין	Q. to discern, understand
גור	Q. to sojourn, dwell as alien and dependent
מאס	Q. to reject, despise
מות	Q. to die (SC 3 m. sg. מָת; PC 3 m. sg. מָתוּת; part. m. sg. מָת)
נוס	Q. to flee, escape
סור	Q. to turn aside
קום	Q. to arise, stand up
רוץ	Q. to run
שים	Q. to put, to make into, to give (PC יָשִׁים)
שוב	Q. to turn back, return (intrans.)
שיר	Q. to sing (PC יָשִׁיר)
שית	Q. to set, put (PC יָשִׁית)

14.1.2 Nouns

אֲדָמָה	ground, land
אֵיל	ram
בְּהֵמָה	beast, animal, cattle
גֵּר	sojourner
חֲצֵר	court, enclosure
מִנְחָה	gift, tribute, offering
מִסְפָּר	number

פָּרָשׁ (פָּרָשִׁים)	horseman, charioteer; team of horses, horses for a chariot (pl.)
קָרַב (קָרְבוֹ with ePP)	inward part, midst
רֵעַ	friend, companion, fellow
רָשָׁע	wicked, guilty
שָׁמֶן	oil, fat, fatness
שָׁפֵט	judge, ruler, governor (part. act. Qal)

14.1.3 Other Parts of Speech

סָבִיב	around, round about (adv. and prep., as a noun surroundings)
סָבִיבוֹת (סָבִיבֵיהֶם with ePP)	around, round about (prep.; pl. of סָבִיב, with ePP)

14.2 Weak Verbs: II w/y Verbs

The verbs of the type II w/y have root consonants with only two consonants. Another term for II w/y verbs is *hollow roots*.

II w/y verbs are characterized by

- a vocalic element between the two radicals in all forms except some rare Hophal forms.
- vocalic suffixes on SC, PC and imperative are *not* stressed
- open prefix syllables in the prefix conjugation Qal

Unlike other verbs, II w/y verbs are listed in the lexicon with the infinitive construct (without vowel pointing; except BDB); e.g., בּוֹשׁ, מוֹת, בּוֹא, שִׁים, קוּם.

14.2 Weak Verbs: II w/y Verbs

			Fientive Verbs			Stative Verbs	
			קום	שים	בוא	מות	בוש
SC	sg.	3 m.	קם	שם	בא	מת	בוש
		3 f.	קמה	שמה	באה	מתה	בושה
		2 m.	קמת	שמת	באת		בושת
		2 f.	קמת	שמת	באת		בושת
	pl.	1 c.	קמתי	שמתי	באתי		בושתי
		3 c.	קמו	שמו	באו	מתו	בושו
		2 m.	קמתם	שמתם	באתם		
		2 f.	קמתן				
PC	sg.	3 m.	יקום	ישים	יבא	ימות	יבוש
		3 f.	תקום	תשים	תבא	תמות	תבוש
		2 m.	תקום	תשים	תבא	תמות	תבוש
		2 f.	תקומי	תשימי	תבואי	תמותי	תבושי
	pl.	1 c.	אקום	אשים	אבוא	אמות	אבוש
		3 m.	יקומו	ישימו	יבאו	ימותו	יבושו
		3 f.	תקמנה		תבאנה	תמותנה	תבושנה
		2 m.	תקומו	תשימו	תבאו	תמותו	תבושו
	sg.	3 m.	יקום	ישים	יבא	ימות	יבוש
		3 m.	ויקום	וישים	ויבא	וימת	ויבוש
Jussive	sg.	m.	קום	שים	בא	מת	בוש
wayyiqtol	sg.	m.	קומי	שימי	באי		בושי
Impv.	pl.	m.	קומו	שימו	באו		בושו
		f.	קמנה				
Inf. cs.			קום	שום	בא	מות	בוש
Inf. abs.			קום	שום	בא	מות	בוש
Part. act.	sg.	m.	קם	שם	בא	מת	בוש
Part. pass.	sg.	m.	מול	שים	—	—	—

Notes

The very frequent verb בוא is doubly weak with elision of the /ʔ/ at the end of a syllable (cf. the III^ʔ verbs).

In the suffix conjugation, three types of II *w/y* verbs can be distinguished:

- verbs with *ā* or *a* as stem vowel (e.g., קום to arise, stand up, שים to put, בוא to come and most other II *w/y*)
- verbs with *ē* (< **i*) as stem vowel (in Biblical Hebrew only the verb מות to die)
- verbs with *ō* as stem vowel (only a few stative verbs, e.g. ביש to be ashamed, טוב to be good)

In the prefix conjugation, there are three different types:

- verbs with the vowel pattern *a–u* based on the primitive forms *yaqtulu* with the prefix vowel /a/ and the thematic vowel /u/: **yaqūm* > *yāqūm* יקום (the majority of II *wy* verbs including the verb מות)
- verbs with the vowel pattern *a–i*: **yašīm* > *yāšīm* ישים (cf. the verbs ישב and נתן with the same vowel pattern in the prefix conjugation)
- verbs with the vowel pattern *i–a* for stative verbs with the change of the thematic vowel *ā* > *ō*: **yibāš* > *yēbōš* יבוש he will be ashamed

The original prefix vowels have been changed only slightly within the parameters of Biblical Hebrew (*a* > *ā* and *i* > *ē*, respectively).

In 3/2 f. pl. forms there are forms without and with connecting vowel, e.g., תשבנה without connecting vowel, תשבנה and תבאנה with connecting vowel and reduction of the prefix vowel).

II *w/y* verbs have distinct jussive forms in forms without vocalic suffix, e.g., יקם (but also יקם or יקם), ישב, ישים.

wayyiqtol forms of II *w/y* verbs without vocalic suffix are based on the corresponding jussive forms. In context forms, the stress is retracted to the penultimate syllable and the thematic vowel is shortened, e.g., יקם wayyāqom, יתשב wattāšab, ישים wayyāšam. In pausal forms, however, the stress is on the last syllable, e.g., יתשב wayyāšob. Retraction of stress does not happen in 1 c. sg. forms, e.g., יאקום and יאשים.

The 3 m. sg. *wayyiqtol* form of the verb סור is יסר with *pataḥ* because of the final consonant ר.

The impv. m. sg. may be expanded by the ending *-ā*, e.g., קומה arise! (Num 10:35)

Forms of the verb **בוא** are frequently spelled defectively. The 3/2 m. pl. forms with the ending *-ū* of the verbs **בוא** and **בוש** are usually spelled defectively, e.g., **יבִּבְּשׁוּ** to avoid the use of two vowel letters. Defective spelling of 3/2 m. pl. forms of the verbs **קום** and **שוב** is also common, e.g., **יִשְׁבּוּ**.

The inf. cs. of the verb **שים** is **שִׁים** in most cases, but the form **שִׂים** is attested as well.

14.3 Numerals (II): Numbers above 10

14.3.1 Numbers 11–19

The numbers 11–19 consist of the words for the units in the absolute state with masculine nouns and of the words for the units in the cs. st. with fem. nouns, respectively, and special forms of the word for ten **עָשָׂר**. Gender inversion occurs for the numbers 13–19.

	With masc. nouns	With fem. nouns
11	אֶחָד עָשָׂר / עֶשְׂתֵּי עָשָׂר	אֶחָת עָשָׂרָה / עֶשְׂתֵּי עָשָׂרָה
12	שְׁנַיִם עָשָׂר / שְׁנֵי עָשָׂר	שְׁתֵּים עָשָׂרָה / שְׁתֵּי עָשָׂרָה
13	שְׁלֹשָׁה עָשָׂר	שְׁלֹשׁ עָשָׂרָה
14	אַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר	אַרְבַּע עָשָׂרָה
15	חֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר	חֲמֹשׁ עָשָׂרָה
16	שֵׁשׁ עָשָׂר	שֵׁשׁ עָשָׂרָה
17	שִׁבְעָה עָשָׂר	שִׁבַּע עָשָׂרָה
18	שְׁמוֹנָה עָשָׂר	שְׁמוֹנֶה עָשָׂרָה
19	תִּשְׁעָה עָשָׂר	תִּשְׁעָה עָשָׂרָה

Note

Rarely, the cs. st. form is used for the units with masc. nouns, e.g., **חֲמִשָּׁת עָשָׂר** *fifteen*.

14.3.2 Numbers 20–90

The numeral for *twenty* is the plural form of **עָשָׂר**. The numerals for *thirty*, *forty* ... *ninety* are the plural forms of the respective words for the units.

20	עֶשְׂרִים
30	שְׁלֹשִׁים
40	אַרְבָּעִים
50	חֲמִשִּׁים
60	שִׁשִּׁים
70	שִׁבְעִים
80	שְׁמוֹנִים
90	תִּשְׁעִים

14.3.3 Numerals for 100 and above

The numeral for *one hundred* is the fem. noun מֵאָה, the numeral for *one thousand* is the masc. noun אֶלֶף. Both numerals are used in the dual for *two hundred* and *two thousand*, respectively.

מֵאָה	100
מֵאוֹת	200
שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת ... תִּשְׁעֵי מֵאוֹת	300 ... 900
אֶלֶף	1,000
אַלְפִים	2,000
שְׁלֹשָׁת אַלְפִים ... תִּשְׁעֵת אַלְפִים	3,000 ... 9,000
עֶשְׂרֵת אַלְפִים or רִבְבָּה or רַבּוּא / רַבּוּ	10,000
עֶשְׂרִים אֶלֶף or שְׁתֵּי רַבּוֹת / שְׁתֵּי רַבּוּא	20,000
שְׁלֹשִׁים אַלְפִים	30,000
מֵאָה אֶלֶף / מֵאוֹת אֶלֶף	100,000
מֵאוֹת אֶלֶף וּגוֹ	200,000 etc.
אֶלֶף אַלְפִים	1,000,000

14.3.4 Notes of the Use of Numerals above Ten

- Usually the numeral precedes the counted noun, e.g., שְׁנַיִם עָשָׂר אַנָּשִׁים *twelve men* (Deut 1:23), שְׁתֵּים עָשָׂר אֲבָנִים *twelve stones* (1 Kgs 18:31).

- The counted noun is in the plural except for nouns that are used with numerals frequently, e.g., יום *day*, שנה *year*, איש *man*, נפש *soul, person*, שבט *tribe*, but also with אמה *cubit*, שקל *sheqel*, e.g., יום וארבעים *forty days and forty nights* (Gen 7:12).
- Units and tens are connected with the conjunction ו, e.g., עשרים ושנים *twenty-two years* (1 Kgs 16:29).
- When units, tens and hundreds are used together, the higher numerals usually come first, e.g., וְאַרְבָּעִים אֶלֶף וְשֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת וְחֲמִשִּׁים *forty-five thousand, six hundred and fifty* (Num 1:25). Deviating sequences of the numerals, however, are attested as well, e.g., שְׁתַּיִם וְשִׁמּוֹנִים שָׁנָה וְשִׁבְעָה *seven hundred and eighty-two years* (Gen 5:26), אֶלֶף וְשִׁבְעָה מֵאוֹת *one thousand and seven hundred and seventy-five sheqel* (Exod 38:25).¹
- For ordinal numbers above *tenth* cardinal numbers are used.
- For indication of days and years, cardinal numbers may be used instead of ordinal numbers for *second* to *tenth*.

14.4 Exercises

14.4.1 Translation of Verbal Forms

Translate the following verbal forms. Identify the gender (masc., fem., comm.) and number (sg., pl.) of forms of which the English translation is ambiguous (i.e., *you, they*). Mark the stressed syllable if stress is not on the last syllable.

1 יָבֹשׁוּ 2 בָּשְׁנוּ 3 וַיָּבִינוּ 4 בָּאִי 5 נָרְתִי 6 נָרְ 7 תָּמֹת 8 וַיִּנָּסוּ
9 סוּרָה 10 סוּר 11 קָמוּ 12 וַיָּקֶם 13 רָצִים 14 רָצָתָה 15 שִׁמוּ
16 שָׁמְתָם 17 וַיֵּשֶׁב 18 וַאֲשׁוּב

14.4.2 Numerals

Read Ezra 2:2b–17 and record the number of the descendants of each person.

14.4.3 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: אַחִיטוֹב, אָחָז, אִירִיָּה.

¹ In the genealogies in Gen 5 and Gen 10 the smaller numerals always come before the higher numerals.

עֲרֶפֶה, גֵר, נַעֲמִי, גִב, מַחֲלוֹן, כְּלִיֹּן, יְהוּדָה, דְּמָשֶׁק, בֵּית לָחֶם, אֱלִימֶלֶךְ, אַחִימֶלֶךְ, רוּת.

1 וַיִּשְׁלַח הַמֶּלֶךְ לִקְרֹא אֶת־אֲחִימֶלֶךְ בֶּן־אֲחִישׁוֹב הַכֹּהֵן וְאֵת כָּל־בֵּית אָבִיו הַכֹּהֲנִים
אֲשֶׁר בְּגִב וַיָּבֹאוּ כָלֶם אֶל־הַמֶּלֶךְ 2 וַיֵּרָא דָּוִד כִּי עֲבָדָיו מִתְלַחֲשִׁים² וַיִּבֶן דָּוִד
כִּי מֵת הַיֵּלֶד וַיֹּאמֶר דָּוִד אֶל־עֲבָדָיו הַמֵּת הַיֵּלֶד וַיֹּאמְרוּ מֵת 3 וַיִּבֶן אוֹרְיָה הַכֹּהֵן
אֶת־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ כְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר־שָׁלַח הַמֶּלֶךְ אַחֲזוּ מִדְּמָשֶׁק בֶּן עֲשָׂה אוֹרְיָה הַכֹּהֵן עַד־בּוֹא
הַמֶּלֶךְ־אֲחֲזוּ מִדְּמָשֶׁק³ 4 וַיָּקָם דָּוִד וַיָּבֹא אֶל־הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר חָנָה־שָׁם שְׂאוּל וַיֵּרָא
דָּוִד אֶת־הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר שָׁכַב־שָׁם שְׂאוּל וְאֶבְנֵר בֶּן־נֵר שֶׁר־צָבָאוּ וְשְׂאוּל שָׁכַב בְּמַעְגָּל⁴
וְהָעָם חָנִים סָבִיבֹתָיו 5 וַיִּשְׁמַע יְהוָה בְּקוֹל אֱלִיָּהוּ וַתֵּשֶׁב נֶפֶשׁ־הַיֵּלֶד עַל־קִרְבּוֹ
וַיָּחִי 6 וְלָכֵן כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה הַמֶּטָּה⁵ אֲשֶׁר־עָלִיתָ שָׁם לֹא־תִרְדּוּ מִמֶּנָּה כִּי מוֹת
תָּמוּת 7 וַיֹּאמֶר שְׂמוּאֵל אֶל־שְׂאוּל לֹא אָשׁוּב עִמָּךְ כִּי מֵאֲסַתָּה אֶת־דָּבָר יְהוָה
וַיִּמְאַסְךָ יְהוָה מִהָיִוֹת מֶלֶךְ עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל 8 וַיְהִי אַחֲרֵי הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה וַיָּמָת יְהוֹשֻׁעַ
בֶּן־נוּן עֶבֶד יְהוָה בֶּן־מֶאֱחָה וְעֶשֶׂר שָׁנִים 9 וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה גִּטָּה אֶת־יָדְךָ
עַל־הָיִם וַיָּשְׁבוּ הַמַּיִם עַל־מִצְרַיִם עַל־רַכְבּוֹ וְעַל־פָּרָשָׁיו 10 וַעֲתָה קַחוּ לָכֶם שְׁנֵי
עֶשֶׂר אִישׁ מִשְׁבֹּטֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אִישׁ־אֶחָד אִישׁ־אֶחָד לְשֹׁבֶט⁶ 11 וַיִּצְוֶה יְהוָה אֱלֹהִים
עַל־הָאָדָם לֵאמֹר מִכָּל עֵץ־הַגֵּן⁸ אֲכַל תֹּאכַל. וַיִּמְעַן הַדָּעַת טוֹב וָרַע לֹא תֹאכַל מִמֶּנּוּ
כִּי בָיִם אֲכָלְךָ מִמֶּנּוּ מוֹת תָּמוּת 12 וַיְהִי בַיּוֹם שֶׁפֶט הַשִּׁפְטִים וַיְהִי רָעַב בָּאָרֶץ וַיֵּלֶךְ
אִישׁ מִבֵּית לָחֶם יְהוּדָה לְגוֹר בְּשָׂדֵי מוֹאָב הוּא וְאִשְׁתּוֹ וּשְׁנֵי בָנָיו. וְשָׁם הָאִישׁ אֱלִימֶלֶךְ
וְשָׁם אִשְׁתּוֹ נַעֲמִי וְשָׁם שְׁנֵי־בָנָיו מַחֲלוֹן וְכְלִיֹּן אֶפְרָתִים⁹ מִבֵּית לָחֶם יְהוּדָה וַיָּבֹאוּ
שָׂדֵי־מוֹאָב וַיְהִי־שָׁם. וַיָּמָת אֱלִימֶלֶךְ אִישׁ נַעֲמִי וַתִּשָּׂאֲרָ¹⁰ הִיא וּשְׁנֵי בָנֶיהָ. וַיִּשָּׂאוּ
לָהֶם נָשִׁים מוֹאבִיּוֹת¹¹ שָׁם הָאֶחָת עֲרֶפֶה וְשָׁם הַשֵּׁנִית רוּת וַיָּשְׁבוּ שָׁם כְּעֶשֶׂר שָׁנִים.
וַיָּמוּתוּ גַם־שְׁנֵיהֶם מַחֲלוֹן וְכְלִיֹּן וַתִּשָּׂאֲרָ¹² הָאִשָּׁה מִשְׁנֵי יְלָדֶיהָ וּמֵאִשָּׁה. וַתָּקָם הִיא
וְכַלְתִּיהָ¹³ וַתֵּשֶׁב מִשְׁדֵּי מוֹאָב כִּי שָׁמָּה בְּשָׂדֶה מוֹאָב כִּי־פָקֵד יְהוָה אֶת־עַמּוֹ לְתֵת

² (לחש were whispering to another (part. m. pl. Hitpa. לחש)

³ דְּמָשֶׁק pausal form of מִדְּמָשֶׁק

⁴ ring of wagons מַעְגָּל

⁵ couch, bed (root) מֶטָּה

⁶ שֹׁבֶט pausal form of שְׁבֵט

⁷ and he commanded (normally with direct object but also with prepositional object with וַיִּצְוֶה; 3 m. sg. waw-PC Piel צוה)

⁸ garden גֵּן

⁹ אֶפְרָתָה (which is here) בֵּית לָחֶם אֶפְרָתִי

¹⁰ and she was left behind (3 fem. sg. waw-PC Niphal וַתִּשָּׂאֲרָ)

¹¹ Moabite מוֹאבִי

¹² and she was left behind וַתִּשָּׂאֲרָ

¹³ daughter in law, bride כַּלָּה

לָהֶם לֶחֶם. וַתֵּצֵא מִן־הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר הָיְתָה־שָׁמָּה וּשְׁתֵּי כַלְתֶּיהָ¹⁴ עִמָּה וַתֵּלַכְנָה בְּדֶרֶךְ
לָשׁוּב אֶל־אֶרֶץ יְהוּדָה.

¹⁴ כַּלָּה *daughter in law, bride*

Chapter 15

15.1 Vocabulary

15.1.1 Verbs

חנן	Q. to show favor, be gracious
לבש	Q. to put on (a garment), to clothe oneself, clothe (stative verb; SC לְבַשׁ and לָבַשׁ, PC וַלְבֹשׁ)
לין	Q. to spend the night, stay overnight; to stay, dwell (cf. לִיְלֹא)
מדד	Q. to measure
משח	Q. to anoint, to smear
סבב	Q. to turn about, go around, surround
עזר	Q. to help
שדד	Q. to devastate, despoil, deal violently with
שמם	Q. to be uninhabited, be deserted; to shudder, be appalled
תמם	Q. to be complete, finished
תקע	Q. to give a blow, blast; clap; drive in

15.1.2 Nouns

חוץ	outside, street (m.; pl. חויצות)
חצי	half, middle
מדה	measured length; measurement
מות	death
נדד	vow
עון	iniquity, guilt (pl. עוונות)
פעם	foot; time; step, pace (fem.)
פתח	opening, doorway, entrance

קֶדֶם *front; east; [what was] before, earlier; prehistoric times, primeval times*

15.1.3 Other Parts of Speech

אם *if (conj.)*

15.2 Weak Verbs: Geminate Verbs

Geminate verbs are originally monosyllabic verbs with a doubled second root consonant. A number of the Qal forms of II gem. verbs are strong. The majority of forms, however, is weak.

			fientive	stative
SC	sg.	3 m.	קָבַב	קָל
		3 f.	קָבְבָה	קָלָה
		2 m.	קָבֹות	קָלֹות
		2 f.	קָבֹות	קָלֹות
		1 c.	קָבֹותִי	קָלֹותִי
	pl.	3 c.	קָבְבוּ	קָלוּ
		2 m.	קָבֹותֶם	קָלֹותֶם
		2 f.	קָבֹותֶן	קָלֹותֶן
		1 c.	קָבֹונוּ	קָלֹונוּ
PC	sg.	3 m.	יָסַב	יָקַל
		3 f.	יָסְבָה	יָקָלָה
		2 m.	יָסֹב	יָקָל
		2 f.	יָסְבִי	יָקָלִי
		1 c.	אָסַב	אָקַל

			fientive	stative
PC	pl.	3 m.	יָסְבוּ	יָקְלוּ
		3 f.	תִּסְבֶּינָה	תִּקְלִינָה
		2 m.	תִּסְבוּ	תִּקְלוּ
		2 f.	תִּסְבֶּינָה	תִּקְלִינָה
		1 c.	נָסַב	נָקַל
Jussive	sg.	3 m.	יִסֵּב	
<i>wayyiqtol</i>	sg.	3 m.	וַיִּסֵּב	
Impv.	sg.	m.	סֵב	
		f.	סִבִּי	
	pl.	m.	סִבּוּ	
		f.	סִבֶּינָה	
Inf. cs.			סֵב	
Inf. abs.			סִבּוּב	
Part. act.	sg.	m.	סֹבֵב	
Part pass.	sg.	m.	סִבּוּב	

Notes

In weak forms, vocalic suffixes are not stressed, e.g., וַיִּסְבוּ *and they marched around [the city]* (Josh 6:14), תִּמְּנוּ *they were complete* (Josh 4:1); but in strong forms they are stressed, e.g., סִבֶּבּוּ *they marched around* (Josh 6:15).

Fientive II gem. verbs have strong forms in the suffix conjugation Qal 3 m./f. and 3 c. pl. with dissociated second root consonant (e.g., סִבֶּבּוּ, סִבֶּבּוּ) while other forms are weak with a doubled second root consonant and a connecting vowel before the consonantal suffix (e.g., סִבֶּבּוּתָּ).

Stative II gem. verbs normally have weak forms with doubled second root consonant. There are, however, some strong suffix conjugation forms of stative II gem. verbs with dissociated second root consonant.

Instead of weak forms with connecting vowel between the second root consonant and the suffix there are also forms without connecting vowel, e.g., תִּגְּמְנוּ *we have been consumed* (1 c. pl. suffix conjugation Qal from חָמַם; Jer 44:18).

Prefix conjugation forms of II gem. verbs are characterized by an open prefix syllable. The vowel is preserved if the following syllable is stressed, e.g., יָסְבוּ.

As in geminate nouns, the gemination of the second root consonant is lost in forms without an ending. When an ending is added, the gemination is preserved.

Fientive verbs have the vowel pattern *a-u* of the fientive type of the strong verb **yaqtul(u)* with preservation of the vowel quality of the prefix vowel and slight adjustment of the vowel quality of the thematic vowel: **yasubbu* > **yasubb* > *yāsōb* יָסַב.

Stative II gem. verbs have the vowel pattern *i-a* **yikbad(u)* with change of the prefix vowel from /i/ to /ē/: **yiqallu* > **yiqall* > *yēqal* יָקַל.

In *wayyiqtol* forms without suffix, retraction of stress is attested, e.g., וַיֵּסְבּוּ *and we went around [Mount Seir]* (Deut 2:1); וַיְהִיָּם *and he brought into confusion* (Exod 14:24); but cf. וַיִּתְקַל *and she became insignificant* (Gen 16:4) with stress on the last syllable.

Alternative forms of the prefix conjugation have a geminated first root consonant and a simple second root consonant, e.g., 3 m. sg. יָסַב (instead of יָסַב), 3 m. pl. יָסְבוּ (instead of יָסְבוּ), 3 f. pl. תִּסְבְּנָה (instead of תִּסְבְּנָה). As this is normal in Aramaic, these forms are called *aramaizing forms*.

Participle forms of fientive verbs are strong. Stative verbs may have an adjective instead of a dedicated participle form, e.g., קָל *light, swift* (pl. קָלִים) from the root קָלָל.

The vowel pattern *a-i* in the prefix conjugation Qal is preserved with a few infrequent verbs, e.g., יִגֵּן *he will defend* from the verb גָּנָן (Isa 31:5).¹

In a few instances, the gemination of the second root consonant is lost, e.g., נָבְזָה *let us plunder* (1 Sam 14:36), נִבְלָה *let us confuse* (Gen 11:7) from the verbs בָּזַז and בָּלַל, respectively.

15.3 Conditional Clauses

A conditional clause indicates a condition that another action, event or state is subject to or contingent on. The condition and the contingent action, event or state may be simply be two clauses next to each other. Sometimes they are juxtaposed without the conjunction וַ (Neh 1:8) but normally they are joined by means of the conjunction וַ (1 Sam 16:2; Gen 44:22).

אִתְּם תִּמְעָלוּ אֲנִי אֶפְיץ *If you will act unfaithfully, I will disperse you*
 אֶתְכֶם בְּעַמִּים *among the nations.* (Neh 1:8)

¹ At face value, a form like this looks like a Hiphil form. In Rabbinic Hebrew Qal forms of the verb גָּנָן were indeed reanalyzed as Hiphil forms.

וַיֹּאמֶר שְׁמוּאֵל אִיךָ אֵלַי וְשָׁמַע שְׂאוּל וַהֲרַגְנִי	<i>And Samuel Said, “How can I go? If Saul hears about this, he will kill me.”</i> (1 Sam 16:2)
וְנֹאמַר אֶל-אֲדֹנִי לֹא-יִוָּכַל הַנֶּעַר לְעֹזֹב אֶת-אָבִיו וְעֹזֹב אֶת-אָבִיו וּמָת	<i>And we said to my lord, “The boy cannot leave his father. If he leaves his father, [his father] will die.”</i> (Gen 44:22)

Most commonly, however, conditional clauses are introduced by the conjunctions **אם** *if* and less frequently by **כִּי** *if*. With the conjunction **אם**:

אִם-טוֹב בְּעֵינֶיךָ לָבוֹא אִתִּי בְּכֹל בָּא וְאָשִׁים אֶת-עֵינִי עָלֶיךָ וְאִם-רָע בְּעֵינֶיךָ לָבוֹא-אִתִּי בְּכֹל חָדָל	<i>If it is good in your sight to come with me to Babylon, then come and I will take care of you. But if it is bad in your sight to come with me to Babylon, then don’t come</i> (Jer 40:4)
אִם-נָא מָצָאתִי חֵן בְּעֵינֶיךָ אֶל-נָא תַעֲבֹר מֵעַל עַבְדְּךָ	<i>If I have found favor in your sight, do not pass by your servant</i> (Gen 18:3)
אִם-אֶמְצָא בְּסֹדֶם חֲמִשִּׁים צְדִיקִים בְּתוֹךְ הָעִיר וְנִשְׁאַתִּי לְכָל-הַמָּקוֹם בְּעַבְדֹּרָם	<i>If I find in Sodom fifty righteous within the city, I will forgive the whole place for their sake</i> (Gen 18:26)

Examples with the conjunction **כִּי**:

כִּי-תִמְצָא אִישׁ לֹא תִבְרַכְנוּ	<i>If you meet anyone, do not greet him</i> (2 Kgs 4:29)
כִּי תֹאמַר בְּלִבְּךָ רַבִּים הַגּוֹיִם הָאֵלֶּה מִמֶּנִּי אֵיכָּה אֶכְסֹל לְהוֹרִישָׁם לֹא תִירָא מֵהֶם	<i>If you say in your heart, “These nation are more numerous than we; how could I dispossess them?” do not be afraid of them ...</i> (Deut 7:17–18)

Note In these examples the use of the conjunction **כִּי** comes close to its use as temporal conjunction with the meaning *when*.

The main clause may simply follow the *if*-clause (Exod 21:7) or it may be connected to the *if*-clause by means of the conjunction **וְ**, the so-called *waw* of apodosis (or *waw apodoseos*) (Exod 21:35).² At times, it may be difficult to identify the beginning of the main clause, but logic and the accents in a fully

² The technical term for the *if*-clause is *protasis* (from Greek *πρότασις*); the main clause is called *apodosis* (from Greek *ἀπόδοσις*).

pointed text make the identification certain in most cases. In the example Exod 21:35 the main clause begins with *וּמָכְרוּ* and *they shall sell*. (The conjunction *וְ* before the conditional conjunction *כִּי* connects this law with the preceding context.)

*וְכִי־יִמְכַר אִישׁ אֶת־בִּתּוֹ
לְאִמָּה לֹא תֵצֵא כְצֵאת
הָעֲבָדִים* And if someone sells his daughter as a slave,
she shall not go out as the [male] slaves do
(Exod 21:7)

*וְכִי־יִגָּף שׁוֹר־אִישׁ אֶת־שׁוֹר
רֵעֵהוּ וָמָת וּמָכְרוּ אֶת־הַשׁוֹר
הַחַי וְחָצּוּ אֶת־כֶּסְפוֹ וְגַם
אֶת־הַמָּת יַחְצִיזוּ* If the ox of a man injures the ox of his neigh-
bor and it dies, they shall sell the live ox and
divide its price and they shall also divide the
dead one (Exod 21:35)

15.4 Accents (Part I)

A fully pointed biblical text does not only include vowel signs and other reading signs as the *šwa* or the *meteg* but also accents. The original purpose of the accents was to regulate the musical recitation of the biblical text (JM § 15 e).

The accents can be divided into disjunctive accents and conjunctive accents. Whereas disjunctive accents separate words and phrases from each other, conjunctive accents join them to the following element or elements in a clause.

The majority of accents are on the stressed syllable of a word while a number of accents are on the last syllable of a word (*postpositive* accents) or on the first syllable of a word (*prepositive* accents). Therefore, postpositive and prepositive accents do not necessarily indicate the stressed syllable of the word. An exception is the disjunctive postpositive accent *pašta* which is repeated on the stressed syllable if it is the penultimate syllable, e.g., *מִלְּךָ, דָּבָר*.

In this chapter the four most important disjunctive accents are introduced and then used in the Hebrew reading (Section 15.6).

<i>דָּבָר silluq</i>	with the last word of the verse before : <i>sof pasuq</i> (end of the verse)
<i>דָּבָר atnah</i>	divides the verse into two parts
<i>דָּבָר segolta</i>	postpositive
<i>דָּבָר zaqef qaton</i>	

Accents serve two important functions for the study of the Hebrew Bible.

First, most accents indicate the position of stress which is helpful for the correct pronunciation especially of unfamiliar words. Second, accents help to identify grammatical relations between words. For example, in Exod 21:35 in Section 15.3 the *if*-clause ends with **וְנָתַתְּ** with *atnah*, thus marking the beginning of the main clause. In 1 Kgs 1:19 the *atnah* separates between the objects of the verbal predicates **וַיִּקְרָא** and **קָרָא**, respectively.

וַיִּזְבַּח שׁוֹר וּמְרִיא־וְצֹאן לָרֹב וַיִּקְרָא לְכָל־בְּנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ וּלְאַבְיָתָר הַכֹּהֵן וּלְיֹאָב שֶׁר הַצָּבָא וּלְשִׁלְמֹה עֶבְדֵּךְ לֹא קָרָא:	<i>And he sacrificed oxen, fattened calves and small cattle in abundance and invited all the sons of the king and Abiathar the priest and Joab the commander of the army; but he did not invite your servant Solomon (1 Kgs 1:19)</i>
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Pausal forms are used with *silluq* and *atnah*; but they can occur with other disjunctive accents as well.

15.5 Exercises

15.5.1 Translation of Verbal Forms

Translate the following verbal forms. Identify the gender (masc., fem., comm.) and number (sg., pl.) of forms of which the English translation is ambiguous (i.e., *you, they*). Mark the stressed syllable if stress is not on the last syllable.

1 וַיִּמְדּוּ	2 תִּמְדּוּ	3 וַיִּסְבוּ	4 וַיִּסֹּב	5 סָבוּ	6 וְסִבְתֶּם	7 סָבַב
8 תִּסְבִּינָה	9 וְנָסַב	10 שָׁדַר	11 יָשַׁם	12 יִשְׁמוּ	13 יִתְּמוּ	14 תִּתְּמוּ
15 תֵּם	16 יָחַן	17 וַיָּחֶן	18 אָחַן	19 וַחֲנֹתִי	20 חָנְנִי	

15.5.2 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: **בְּרֶק**, **מִצְפָּה**.

1 שָׁמַע־יְהוָה וַחֲנִינִי³ יְהוָה הָיָה־עֲזָר לִי 2 וַיְהִי כַּאֲשֶׁר־תָּמוּ כָל־חַגֹּי לַעֲבוֹר
אֶת־הַיַּרְדֵּן וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־יְהוֹשֻׁעַ לֵאמֹר קָחוּ לָכֶם מִן־הָעֵם שְׁנַיִם עָשָׂר אָנָּשִׁים
אִישׁ־אֶחָד אִישׁ־אֶחָד מִשִּׁבְט⁴ 3 וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־יְהוֹשֻׁעַ רְאֵה נָתַתִּי בְיָדְךָ אֶת־יְרִיחוֹ

³ Verbal form **יָחַן*** with enclitic person pronoun

⁴ **שִׁבְט** pausal form of **שִׁבְטָא**

וְאֶת־מִלְכָּה גְבוּרֵי הַחֵיל⁵ וְסִבְתָּם אֶת־הָעִיר כָּל אֲנָשֵׁי הַמִּלְחָמָה הִקִּיף⁶ אֶת־הָעִיר
 פַּעַם אַחַת⁷ כֹּה תַעֲשֶׂה שֵׁשֶׁת יָמִים. וְשִׁבְעָה כְהָנִים יִשְׂאוּ שִׁבְעָה שׁוֹפְרוֹת הַיּוֹבְלִים⁸
 לִפְנֵי הָאָרוֹן וּבַיּוֹם הַשְּׂבִיעִי תִסָּבּוּ אֶת־הָעִיר שִׁבְעַת פַּעֲמִים וְהַכְהָנִים יִתְקַעוּ בַשּׁוֹפְרוֹת.
 4 וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלֶיהָ בָּרַק אִם־תִּלְכִּי עִמִּי וְהִלַּכְתִּי וְאִם־לֹא תִלְכִּי עִמִּי לֹא אֵלַי⁵ וְעַתָּה
 אִם־שָׁמוּעַ תִּשְׁמָעוּ בְּקִלִּי וְשִׁמְרָתֶם אֶת־בְּרִיתִי וְהָיִיתֶם לִי סִגְלָה⁹ מִכָּל־הָעַמִּים כִּי־לִי
 כָּל־הָאָרֶץ וְאַתֶּם תִּהְיוּ־לִי מִמְּלֶכֶת כְּהָנִים וְגוֹי קָדוֹשׁ אֵלֶּה הַדְּבָרִים אֲשֶׁר תִּדְבָּר¹⁰
 אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל 6 וַיֹּאמֶר אִישׁ־הָאֱלֹהִים אֶל־הַמֶּלֶךְ אִם־תִּתֶּן־לִי אֶת־חֲצִי בֵיתְךָ
 לֹא אָבֹא עִמָּךְ וְלֹא־אֲכַל לֶחֶם וְלֹא אֶשְׁתֶּה־מִּיּוֹם בְּמָקוֹם הַזֶּה 7 וַיִּדְר¹¹ יַעֲקֹב נָדָר
 לֵאמֹר אִם־יִהְיֶה אֱלֹהִים עִמָּדִי וְשָׁמְרָנִי בַדֶּרֶךְ הַזֶּה אֲשֶׁר אֲנִכִּי הוֹלֵךְ וְנָתַן־לִי לֶחֶם
 לֶאֱכֹל וּבְגָד לְלַבֵּשׁ וְשִׁבְתִּי בְּשָׁלוֹם אֶל־בֵּית אָבִי וְהָיָה יְהוָה לִי לֵאלֹהִים 8 וַיִּקַּח
 שְׂמוּאֵל אֶבֶן אַחַת וַיִּשֶׂם בֵּין־הַמִּצְפֹּת וּבֵין הַשָּׁן¹² וַיִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמָהּ אֶבֶן הָעֶזֶר¹³ וַיֹּאמֶר
 עַד־הַנֶּה¹⁴ עֲזָרְנוּ יְהוָה 9 לֹא אֶת־אֲבֹתֵינוּ כָּרַת יְהוָה אֶת־הַבְּרִית הַזֹּאת כִּי אֲתֵנוּ
 אֲנַחְנוּ אֵלֶּה פֹה הַיּוֹם כָּלְנוּ חַיִּים 10 וַיָּבֹא־שָׁם אֶל־הַמְּעָרָה¹⁵ וַיֵּלֶן שָׁם וְהָיָה
 דְּבַר־יְהוָה אֵלָיו וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ מִה־לָּךְ פֹּה אֵלֶיהָ

15.6 Hebrew Reading: Genesis 12:4–9

Translate Gen 12:4–9 with the help of notes below the text. Names of persons and places are easily identifiable.

4 וַיֵּלֶךְ אַבְרָם כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר אֵלָיו יְהוָה וַיֵּלֶךְ אִתּוֹ לוֹט וְאַבְרָם בֶּן־חַמֶּשׁ שָׁנִים וְשִׁבְעִים
 שָׁנָה בְּצֵאתוֹ מִחָרָן: ⁵ וַיִּקַּח אַבְרָם אֶת־שָׂרִי אִשְׁתּוֹ וְאֶת־לוֹט בֶּן־אָחִיו וְאֶת־כָּל־רְכוּשָׁם
 אֲשֶׁר רָכְשׁוּ וְאֶת־הַנֶּפֶשׁ אֲשֶׁר־עָשׂוּ בְּחָרָן וַיֵּצְאוּ לְלֶכֶת אֶרֶצָה כְּנָעַן וַיָּבֹאוּ אֶרֶצָה כְּנָעַן:
 6 וַיַּעֲבֹר אַבְרָם בְּאֶרֶץ עַד מְקוֹם שָׁכָם עַד אֵלּוֹן מוֹרָה וְהַכְנַעֲנִי אָז בְּאֶרֶץ: ⁷ וַיִּרָא
 יְהוָה אֶל־אַבְרָם וַיֹּאמֶר לְזַרְעֲךָ אֲתָן אֶת־הָאָרֶץ הַזֹּאת וַיְבִין שָׁם מִזִּבְחַ לַיהוָה הַנִּרְאָה
 אֵלָיו: ⁸ וַיַּעֲתֵק מִשָּׁם הָהָרָה מִקְדָּם לְבֵית־אֵל וַיֵּט אֶת־הָאֵלָה בֵּית־אֵל מִיָּם וְהָעִי מִקְדָּם

⁵ חֵיל pausal form of חֵיל

⁶ הִקִּיף go around! (inf. abs. Hiphil of נָקַף used as impv.)

⁷ אַחַת pausal form of אחַת

⁸ יוֹבֵל ram

⁹ סִגְלָה (personal) property

¹⁰ תִּדְבָּר you shall speak

¹¹ וַיִּדְר and he performed a vow (נָדַר; often with the internal object נִדְרָה)

¹² הַשָּׁן name of a place

¹³ עֶזֶר help (noun)

¹⁴ עַד־הַנֶּה until now

¹⁵ מְעָרָה cave

וַיִּבְנֶן-שָׁם מִזְבֵּחַ לַיהוָה וַיִּקְרָא בְּשֵׁם יְהוָה: ⁹ וַיֵּסַע אַבְרָם הַלּוֹךְ וְנָסוּעַ תְּנִינֶכָה:

- 12:5 רְכוּשׁ *property, goods (movable possessions of all kind) (BDB)*
 רָכַשׁ *Q. collect, acquire*
- 12:6 אֵלֹון *tall tree, terebinth*
- 12:7 וַיֵּרָא *and he appeared (3 masc. sg. waw-PC Niphal רָאָה)*
 הַנִּרְאֶה *the one who had appeared (part. masc. sg. Niphal רָאָה)*
- 12:8 וַיַּעֲתֵק *and he moved forward*
 מִקְדָּם לְ *east of*
 אֶלְלָה *Ketiv – Qere אֶלְלָה*
 מִיָּם *on the west (יָם meaning west here)*
 מִקְדָּם *on the east (קֶדֶם meaning east here)*

Chapter 16

16.1 Vocabulary

16.1.1 Verbs

לחם	Ni. <i>to fight, do battle</i> (with prep. objects with בְּ , אִתּוֹ (<i>with</i>), עִם , אֶל or עַל)
כָּשַׁל	Q. and Ni. <i>to stumble, stagger</i>
מָלַט	Ni. <i>to escape, be delivered</i>
שָׁבַע	Ni. <i>to swear, take an oath</i>

16.1.2 Nouns

אֹצֵר	<i>treasure, supplies</i>
אַחֵר	<i>another, different</i> (m. pl. אַחֵרִים , f. sg. אַחֶרֶת , f. pl. אַחֵרוֹת)
אֱמוּנָה	<i>steadfastness; trustworthiness, faithfulness</i>
אַמֹּרִי	<i>Amorite</i>
אֱמֻתָּה	<i>firmness, trustworthiness; faithfulness; truth</i> (fem.; with ePP אֱמֻתּוֹ <i>ʾāmittō</i> < * <i>ʾāmintō</i> ; the root אָמַן , cf. אָמֵן <i>surely!</i>)
גִּבְעָה	<i>hill</i>
דּוֹר	<i>generation</i> (pl. דִּירוֹת)
יַיִן	<i>wine</i>
מְלָאכָה	<i>occupation, work</i> (<i>mālā(ʿ)kā</i> ; cs. st. מְלָאכֶת)
נָהָר	<i>river, stream</i> (pl. נְהָרוֹת ; נְהַר פָּרָת <i>Euphrates</i>)
נַחַל	<i>river valley, wadi; stream</i>
עֲבָדָה	<i>work, service</i>
עֵבֶר	<i>region across or beyond; side</i>
עֲדָה	<i>congregation</i>
צְדָקָה	<i>righteousness</i>

צָפוֹן	north
רַב	multitude, abundance, greatness (cf. רַב)
שִׁפָּה	lip, speech, edge (dual שִׁפְתַּיִם)
תָּמִים	complete; without fault; perfect; impeccable; honest, devout (adj.)

16.1.3 Other Parts of Speech

בְּעִבּוּר	because of, for the sake of (prep.); in order that (conj.) (prep. בְּ + noun עִבּוּר)
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16.2 The Niphal Binyan

16.2.1 The Forms of the Strong Verb in the Niphal

The Niphal is the fourth most frequent binyan behind the Qal, the Hiphil (→ 17.2) and the Piel (→ 19.2). It is attested about 4140 times in the Hebrew Bible. The Niphal has mainly reflexive-passive meaning. Morphologically, it is characterized by the additional element /n/ that is prefixed as the syllable *ni-* in the suffix conjugation and participle forms. In the other forms, it is placed as *-n* immediately before the first root consonant and subsequently assimilated to it: *-nC₁-* > *-C₁C₁-*. The suffixes and prefixes of the SC, PC and imperative indicating person, number and gender are identical to the suffixes and prefixes of the corresponding forms in the Qal.

SC	sg.	3 m.	נִכְתָּב
		3 f.	נִכְתְּבָה
		2 m.	נִכְתְּבָתָּ
		2 f.	נִכְתְּבָתֶּן
		1 c.	נִכְתְּבָתִי
	pl.	3 c.	נִכְתְּבוּ
		2 m.	נִכְתְּבָתֶם
		2 f.	נִכְתְּבָתֶינָן
		1 c.	נִכְתְּבָנוּ

PC	sg.	3 m.	יִכְתֹּב
		3 f.	תִּכְתֹּב
		2 m.	תִּכְתֹּב
		2 f.	תִּכְתְּבִי
		1 c.	אִכְתֹּב
	pl.	3 m.	יִכְתְּבוּ
		3 f.	תִּכְתְּבֶנָּה
		2 m.	תִּכְתְּבוּ
		2 f.	תִּכְתְּבֶנָּה
		1 c.	נִכְתֹּב
Jussive	sg.	3 m.	יִכְתֹּב
wayyiqtol	sg.	3 m.	וַיִּכְתֹּב
Impv.	sg.	2 m.	הִכְתֵּב
		2 f.	הִכְתְּבִי
	pl.	2 m.	הִכְתְּבוּ
		2 f.	הִכְתְּבֶנָּה
Inf. cs.			הִכְתֵּב
Inf. abs.			הִכְתֵּב
			נִכְתֵּב
			הִכְתֵּב
Part.	m.	sg.	נִכְתֵּב
		pl.	נִכְתְּבִים
	f.	sg.	נִכְתְּבָת
		pl.	נִכְתְּבוֹת

Notes

The forms of the Niphal have the following main characteristics:

- In the suffix conjugation and the participle and sometimes in the inf. abs., the syllable *ni-* is prefixed to the verbal form, e.g., נִשְׁבַּר *it has been broken* (SC); נִשְׁבָּר *broken* (part.).

- In the prefix conjugation forms the /n/ of the Ni. is assimilated to the first root consonant of the verb: **yinkatib* > *yikkātēb* יִכְתֹּב.
- In the imperative, the infinitive construct and some forms of the infinitive absolute a prosthetic consonant /h/ is added to the form in order to preserve the syllable structure and the assimilated /n/ as a sign of the Niphal.

The prefix vowel of the 1 c. sg. suffix conjugation can also be /i/ instead of /æ/, e.g., אֶשָּׁבַע *I will swear*. The prefix vowel of the cohortative 1 c. sg. is always /i/, e.g., אֶמְלֹטָה *let me escape*.

In *wayyiqtol* and imperative forms without suffix, retraction of stress may occur, e.g., וַיִּלָּחֶם *and he fought*, הִשָּׁמֶר *be careful!*.

In the participle f. sg., forms with the ending /-ā/ are attested as well, e.g., נִשְׁבָּרָה *broken*.

In pausal forms, reduced vowels are preserved as full vowels, e.g., נִלְקָחָה *it was taken*, נִלָּחֲמוּ *they fought*, יִפְרְדּוּ *they will separate from each other*.

At times, the vowel between R₁ and R₂ in pausal forms is /a/ instead of /ē/, e.g., וַיִּנְמֹל *and he was weaned* (Gen 21:8).

In the suffix conjugation, forms with paragogic Nun may occur, e.g., יִכָּרְתוּן *they will be cut off*.

The verb לָקַח, which behaves like a *In* verb in the Qal, has strong forms in all forms of the Ni., e.g., נִלְקָח *it was taken*, אֶלְקָח *I will be taken*.

The first root consonant of *Ir* verbs is not geminated in the prefix conjugation, the imperative and the infinitives. Instead of *hireq* these verbs have *šere* in the prefix syllable of the prefix conjugation, the imperative and the infinitive construct, e.g., וַיִּרְדָּם *and he fell asleep* (Jonah 1:5; pausal form).

The primitive form of the suffix conjugation of the strong verb **naqtala* is not preserved in the strong verb. Instead the form changed to **niqtala* which explains the forms of the I gutt. verbs (→ 16.2.3). The primitive form **naqtala* becomes relevant in the Niphal forms of Iy, II w/y and II gem. verbs. The same applies to the participle.

16.2.2 The Meaning of Verbs in the Niphal

Originally, the Niphal binyan had reflexive-middle meaning but assumed passive meaning over time when the original Qal passive, of which only vestiges are left in Biblical Hebrew, was being phased out (→ 26.3). As a consequence, the Niphal often serves as a passive to the Qal (and sometimes the Hiphil).

1. Passive: לָקַח Qal *take*, Ni. *to be taken* (The subject is acted upon.)

2. Reflexive meaning: שָׁמַר Qal *keep*, Ni. *keep oneself, be on one's guard* (The subject affects itself with the verbal action.)
3. Middle meaning: שָׁאַל Qal *ask*, Ni. *ask for oneself*; נָקַם Qal *avenge*, Ni. *avenge oneself* (The subject acts in its own interest.)
4. Reciprocal: שָׁפַט Qal *judge*, Ni. *enter into controversy* (Two or more entities are involved in the action of the verb.)
5. Tolerative: דָּרַשׁ Qal *seek, inquire*, Ni. *to let oneself be inquired of*
6. No obvious Niphal meaning: שָׁבַע Ni. *to take an oath* (no Qal equivalent)

If the meaning of a verb in the Qal (or sometimes the Hiphil) is known, these semantic categories should be considered for the translation of the verb in the Niphal. A lexicon will help in further specifying the meaning.

16.2.3 Guttural Verbs in the Niphal

Niphal forms of guttural verbs show the expected differences with the regular verb:

- change of vowel quality to /a/ or a vowel closer to /a/
- avoidance of silent šwa in the prefix syllable *ni-* of the suffix conjugation and use of *ḥatef šwa* instead
- use of *ḥatef šwa* instead vocal šwa
- loss of the gemination of R₁ in the prefix conjugation, the impv. and the infinitives and change of the preceding vowel from /i/ to /ē/ (this applies to all gutturals including ה and ח)

		I gutt.	II gutt.	III gutt.
SC	sg. 3 m.	נִשְׁחַט	נִשְׁחַט	נִשְׁלַח
	3 f.	נִשְׁחַטָּה	נִשְׁחַטָּה	נִשְׁלַחָה
	2 m.	נִשְׁחַטְּךָ	נִשְׁחַטְּךָ	נִשְׁלַחְּךָ
	2 f.	נִשְׁחַטְּכִי	נִשְׁחַטְּכִי	נִשְׁלַחְּכִי
	1 c.	נִשְׁחַטְּנוּ	נִשְׁחַטְּנוּ	נִשְׁלַחְּנוּ
pl.	3 c.	נִשְׁחַטּוּ	נִשְׁחַטּוּ	נִשְׁלַחוּ
	2 m.	נִשְׁחַטְּהֶם	נִשְׁחַטְּהֶם	נִשְׁלַחְּהֶם
	2 f.	נִשְׁחַטְּהֶנּוּ	נִשְׁחַטְּהֶנּוּ	נִשְׁלַחְּהֶנּוּ
	1 c.	נִשְׁחַטְּנוּ	נִשְׁחַטְּנוּ	נִשְׁלַחְּנוּ

			I gutt.	II gutt.	III gutt.
PC	sg.	3 m.	יַעֲזֹב	יִשְׁחַט	יִשְׁלַח
		3 f.	תַּעֲזֹב	תִּשְׁחַט	תִּשְׁלַח
		2 m.	תַּעֲזֹב	תִּשְׁחַט	תִּשְׁלַח
		2 f.	תַּעֲזֹבִי	תִּשְׁחָטִי	תִּשְׁלָחִי
		1 c.	אֶעֱזֹב	אֶשְׁחַט	אֶשְׁלַח
	pl.	3 m.	יַעֲזֹבוּ	יִשְׁחָטוּ	יִשְׁלָחוּ
		3 f.	תַּעֲזֹבְנָה	תִּשְׁחַטְנָה	תִּשְׁלַחְנָה
		2 m.	תַּעֲזֹבוּ	תִּשְׁחָטוּ	תִּשְׁלָחוּ
		2 f.	תַּעֲזֹבְנָה	תִּשְׁחַטְנָה	תִּשְׁלַחְנָה
		1 c.	נֶעֱזֹב	נִשְׁחַט	נִשְׁלַח
Jussive	sg.	3 m.	יַעֲזֹב	יִשְׁחַט	יִשְׁלַח
<i>wayyiqtol</i>	sg	3 m.	וַיַּעֲזֹב	וַיִּשְׁחַט	וַיִּשְׁלַח
Impv.	sg.	2 m.	הַעֲזֹב	הִשְׁחַט	הִשְׁלַח
		2 f.	הַעֲזֹבִי	הִשְׁחָטִי	הִשְׁלָחִי
	pl.	2 m.	הַעֲזֹבוּ	הִשְׁחָטוּ	הִשְׁלָחוּ
		2 f.	הַעֲזֹבְנָה	הִשְׁחַטְנָה	הִשְׁלַחְנָה
Inf. cs.			הַעֲזֹב	הִשְׁחַט	הִשְׁלַח
Inf. abs.			הַעֲזֹב	הִשְׁחָט	הִשְׁלַח
			נַעֲזֹב	נִשְׁחַט	נִשְׁלַח
Part.	m.	sg.	נַעֲזֹב	נִשְׁחַט	נִשְׁלַח
		pl.	נַעֲזֹבִים	נִשְׁחָטִים	נִשְׁלָחִים
	f.	sg.	נַעֲזֹבֶת	נִשְׁחָטֶת	נִשְׁלַחֶת
		pl.	נַעֲזֹבוֹת	נִשְׁחָטוֹת	נִשְׁלַחוֹת

Notes

Verbs I gutt. may have the vowel /a/ in the prefix syllable of the Ni. suffix conjugation and participle instead of /æ/, e.g., *נַעֲשָׂה* it was done (2 Kgs 23:22). This is often the case with the verb *עשה*.

Retraction of stress may occur in prefix conjugation and imperative forms without suffix, e.g., *וַיִּאֲסֹף* and he was gathered (Gen 25:8), *וַיִּנָּחַם* and he regretted (Gen 6:6).

The original vowel /ē/ between R₂ and R₃ is restored in pausal forms of the prefix conjugation, e.g., הַשָּׁבַע *you shall swear* (Deut 6:13), יִשָּׁבְעוּ *they swear* (Jer 5:2).

16.3 Oaths in Biblical Hebrew

Oaths and curses are frequently introduced either with the conditional conjunction אִם for a negative statement (“certainly not”) (1 Sam 3:14) or with אִם לֹא or כִּי for a positive statement (“certainly”) (Josh 14:9; 1 Kgs 1:13). This use of אִם, אִם לֹא, or כִּי is conditioned by the self-imprecation כִּהְיֵעֲשֶׂה לִּי אֱלֹהִים וְכִהְיֹסֶף *May God do so to me and add more also* (as, e.g., in 2 Kgs 6:31) which means that the person who takes an oath is willing to accept divine punishment in the case of non-realization of the oath.¹ The use of אִם or אִם לֹא in oaths or curses without the self-imprecation depends on its suppression or omission although it is implied. As oaths are also taken by God (cf. 1 Sam 3:14 above) “the consciousness of the real meaning of the formula was lost at an early period, and אִם לֹא simply came to express verily, אִם verily not” (GKC § 149 b).²

וְלָכֵן נִשְׁבַּעְתִּי לְבֵית עֲלִי
אִם־יִתְכַּפֵּר עֲוֹן בֵּית־עֲלִי
בְזָבַח וּבִמְנַחָה עַד־עוֹלָם
*Therefore I have sworn to the house of Eli
that the iniquity of the house of Eli shall not
be atoned for by sacrifice or offering forever
(1 Sam 3:14)*

וַיִּשָּׁבַע מֹשֶׁה בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא
לֵאמֹר אִם־לֹא הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר
דָּרַכָה רַגְלִי בָּהּ לְךָ תִּהְיֶה
לְנַחֲלָה וּלְבָנֶיךָ עַד־עוֹלָם
*And Moses swore on that day, “The land on
which your foot treads shall belong to you as
inheritance and to your sons forever” (Josh
14:9)*

הֲלֹא־אַתָּה אֲדֹנָי הַמֶּלֶךְ
נִשְׁבַּעְתָּ לְאַמְתְּךָ לֵאמֹר
כִּי־שְׁלֹמֹה בְנִי יִמְלֹךְ אַחֲרַי
וְהוּא יֵשֵׁב עַל־כִּסְאִי
*Did you not, my lord the king, swear to
your maidservant, “Your son Solomon shall
reign as king after me and he shall sit on my
throne?” (1 Kgs 1:13)*

וַיֹּאמֶר כִּהְיֵעֲשֶׂה לִּי אֱלֹהִים
וְכִהְיֹסֶף אִם־יִעֲמֹד רֹאשׁ
אֵלֶיךָ בֶּן־שָׁפָט עָלָיו הַיּוֹם
*And he said, “May God do so to me and
add more also, if the head of Elisha son of
Shaphat remains on him today” (2 Kgs 6:31)*

¹ The verbal form יֹסֶף is a Hiphil jussive form of the verb יָסַף meaning *to do again, continue doing something*.

² A different explanation is offered in JM § 165.

At times, the oath can be expressed as simple statements without **אִם** or **אֲלֵא** (Judg 21:1).

וַאִישׁ יִשְׂרָאֵל נִשְׁבַּע בַּמִּצְפָּה
לֵאמֹר אִישׁ מִמֶּנּוּ לֹא־יִתֵּן
בֵּתוֹ לְבָנִימָן לְאִשָּׁה
Now, the men of Israel had sworn in Mizpah,
“No one from us shall give his daughter to
Benjamin as a wife” (Judg 21:1)

An exclamatory formula with a form of **חַי** meaning *life* in this context may be used at the beginning of an oath. If followed by **יְהוּה** (pronounced *ʾădōnāy*) or the independent personal pronoun **אֲנִי** *I*, the form is **חַי** (1 Sam 19:6; Num 14:28). Followed by other nouns the form is **חַיִּי** (1 Sam 17:55; Gen 42:15).

וַיִּשְׁבַּע שָׁאוּל חַי־יְהוּה
אִם־יוּמָת
אֲמַר אֱלֹהִים חַי־אֲנִי
נֶאֱמַר־יְהוּה אִם־לֹא פָאֶשֶׁר
דְּבַרְתֶּם בְּאָזְנִי בִן אֶעֱשֶׂה
לָכֶם
And Saul swore, “As the Lord lives, he shall
not be put to death” (1 Sam 19:6)
Say to them, “As I live, says the Lord, I will
certainly do to you as you have spoken in my
hearing” (Num 14:28)

וַיֹּאמֶר אַבְנֵר חַי־נַפְשִׁי
הַמֶּלֶךְ אִם־יֵדְעֵתִי
בְּזֹאת תִּבְחָנוּ חַי פַּרְעֹה
אִם־תֵּצְאוּ מִזֶּה כִּי אִם־יָבֹוא
אֶחָיְכֶם הַקָּטָן הִנֵּה
And Abner said, “By your life, O king, I do
not know” (1 Sam 17:55)
By this you shall be tested: As Pharaoh lives,
you shall not go out from here unless your
youngest brother comes here (Gen 42:15)

Another way of introducing an oath is the interjection **חֲלִילָה** *far be it!* (literally *to the profane!*). Different constructions following **חֲלִילָה** are possible; the most common one is the construction with the preposition **לְ** and an enclitic personal pronoun and a following inf. cs. with the preposition **מִן** (Gen 44:17).

וַיֹּאמֶר חֲלִילָה לִי מַעֲשֹׂת
זֹאת
And he said, “Far be it from me that I should
do this”, i.e., I will not do this (Gen 44:17)

The deity by whom someone takes an oaths is expressed by a prepositional phrase with **בְּ** (1 Sam 28:10).

וַיִּשְׁבַּע לָהּ שָׁאוּל בַּיהוָה
לֵאמֹר חַי־יְהוּה אִם־יִקְרָךְ
עוֹן בְּדָבָר הַזֶּה
And Saul swore to her by the Lord, “As the
Lord lives, no punishment shall happen to you
because of this matter” (1 Sam 28:10)

16.4 Exercises

16.4.1 Translation of Verbal Forms

Translate the following verbal forms. Identify the gender (masc., fem., comm.) and number (sg., pl.) of forms of which the English translation is ambiguous (i.e., *you, they*). Mark the stressed syllable if stress is not on the last syllable.

- 1 נִלְחָם 2 נִלְחָמוּ 3 נִלְחָמוּ 4 נִלְחָמִי 5 יִלְחָם 6 וַיִּלְחָם 7 תִּלְחָמוּ
8 נִלְחָם 9 תִּלְחָמוּן 10 הִלְחָמוּ 11 נִמְלֹטִי 12 נִמְלָטוּ 13 אִמְלֹט
14 תִּמְלֹט 15 נִשְׁבַּעְתָּ 16 נִשְׁבַּעְתָּם 17 נִשְׁבַּעְנוּ 18 נִשְׁבַּעְתִּי 19 תִּשְׁבַּעוּ
20 וַיִּשְׁבַּע

16.4.2 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: חֲזָאֵל, גִּת, אֶחְזִיָּהוּ, אוּרִיָּה, שְׁמַעְיָה, רַחֲבֵעַם, קִישׁוֹן, כָּלֵב, יִפְנֶה, יְהוֹרָם, יְהוֹאָשׁ.

- 1 וַיִּשְׁמַע יְהוָה אֶת־קוֹל דְּבָרֵיכֶם וַיִּקְצֹף³ וַיִּשְׁבַּע לֵאמֹר אִם־יִרְאֶה אִישׁ בְּאֲנָשִׁים
הָאֵלֶּה הַדּוֹר הַרְעָה הַזֶּה אֶת הָאָרֶץ הַטּוֹבָה אֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּעְתִּי לָתֵת לְאַבְרָהָם וְיִצְחָק⁴
כָּלֵב בֶּן־יִפְנֶה הוּא יִרְאֶנָּה וְלֹא־אֶתֶּן אֶת־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר דִּרְדַּף־בָּהּ וּלְבָנָיו 2 וַיֹּאמֶר
לְאֲנָשָׁיו חֲלִילָה לִּי מִיְהוָה אִם־אֶעֱשֶׂה אֶת־הַדְּבָר הַזֶּה לְאָדָמִי לְמִשְׁיחַ⁵ יְהוָה לְשַׁלַּח
יָדִי בּוֹ כִּי־מִשְׁיחַ יְהוָה הוּא 3 וַיֹּאמֶר אוּרִיָּה אֶל־דָּוִד הָאָרֶץ וַיִּשְׁרָאֵל וַיְהוּדָה יֹשְׁבֵי
בְּסָבֻת⁶ נָאדָנִי יוֹאֵב וְעַבְדֵּי אָדָנִי עַל־פְּנֵי הַשָּׂדֶה חֲנִים וְאֲנִי אָבוֹא⁷ אֶל־בֵּיתִי לֶאֱכֹל
וְלִשְׁתּוֹת וּלְשָׁכַב עִם־אִשְׁתִּי חֲנִף וְחִי נַפְשֶׁךָ אִם־אֶעֱשֶׂה אֶת־הַדְּבָר הַזֶּה 4 וַיֹּאמֶר
אֵלָיו הֲלֵהֶם תִּפְשׁוּ אֶת־נַבִּיאֵי הַבַּעַל אִישׁ אֶל־יִמְלָט מֵהֶם וַיִּתְּפְשׂוּם וַיּוֹרְדוּם⁸ אֵלָיו
אֶל־נַחַל קִישׁוֹן וַיִּשְׁחָטֵם שָׁם 5 וְכִרְאוֹת שְׂאוּל אֶת־דָּוִד יֵצֵא לְקִרְאֵת הַפִּלִּשְׁתִּי
אָמַר אֶל־אַבְנֵר שֶׁר הַצָּבָא בֶּן־מִי־זֶה⁹ הִנֵּנִי אַבְנֵר וַיֹּאמֶר אַבְנֵר חִי־נַפְשֶׁךָ תִּמְלֹךְ¹⁰
אִם־יִדְּעִתִּי: 6 וַיִּתֵּן יְהוָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־כָּל־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּע לָתֵת לְאַבְרָהָם

³ וַיִּקְצֹף verb קִצַּף Q. *to be angry, to become angry*

⁴ וְיִצְחָק except (cs. st. of the noun וְיִצְחָק)

⁵ מִשְׁיחַ anointed

⁶ סָבֻת hut, booth (as a temporary shelter)

⁷ אָבוֹא should be translated as a rhetorical question *Shall I then ...?*

⁸ וַיּוֹרְדוּם and he brought them down (Hiphil of יָרַד)

⁹ זֶה often follows an interrogative pronoun or adverb “without any notable change in meaning” (JM § 143 g)

¹⁰ תִּמְלֹךְ O king. Nouns used in a direct address are used with the article.

וַיִּרְשׁוּהָ וַיָּשְׁבוּ בָּהּ 7 וַעֲתָה יִרְאוּ אֶת־יְהוָה וְעִבְדוּ אֹתוֹ בְּתַמִּים¹¹ וּבְאֵמֶת וְהִסִּירוּ¹² אֶת־אֱלֹהִים אֲשֶׁר עִבְדוּ אֲבוֹתֵיכֶם בְּעֶבֶר הַנֶּהָר וּבְמִצְרַיִם וְעִבְדוּ אֶת־יְהוָה וְאִם רָע בְּעֵינֵיכֶם לַעֲבֹד אֶת־יְהוָה בַּחֲרוּ לָכֶם הַיּוֹם אֶת־מִי תַעֲבֹדוּן אִם אֶת־אֱלֹהִים אֲשֶׁר־עִבְדוּ אֲבוֹתֵיכֶם אֲשֶׁר מִעֵבֶר הַנֶּהָר וְאִם אֶת־אֱלֹהֵי הָאֱמֹרִי אֲשֶׁר אַתֶּם יֹשְׁבִים בְּאֶרֶצָם וְאֲנֹכִי וּבֵיתִי נַעֲבֹד אֶת־יְהוָה וַיַּעַן הָעָם וַיֹּאמֶר חֲלִילָה לָנוּ מֵעֹזב אֶת־יְהוָה לַעֲבֹד אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים 8 וַיְהִי דְבַר הָאֱלֹהִים אֶל־שְׁמַעְיָה אִישׁ־הָאֱלֹהִים לֵאמֹר אֹמַר אֶל־רַחֲבֵעָם בֶּן־שְׁלֹמֹה מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה וְאֶל־כָּל־בֵּית יְהוּדָה וּבְנֵי־מִן וְיִתֵּר הָעָם לֵאמֹר כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה לֹא־תַעֲלוּ וְלֹא־תִלַּחֲמוּן עִם־אֲחֵיכֶם בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל. שׁוּבוּ אִישׁ לְבֵיתוֹ כִּי מֵאֲתִי נִהְיָה¹³ הַדָּבָר הַזֶּה וַיִּשְׁמְעוּ אֶת־דְּבַר יְהוָה וַיָּשְׁבוּ לָלֶכֶת כַּדָּבָר יְהוָה 9 אֲזַיַּעֲלָה חֲזָאֵל מֶלֶךְ אֲרָם וַיִּלְחָם עַל־נֹת וַיִּלְכְּדָהּ וַיָּשֶׂם חֲזָאֵל פָּנָיו לַעֲלוֹת עַל־יְרוּשָׁלַם: וַיִּקַּח יְהוֹאָשׁ מֶלֶךְ־יְהוּדָה אֶת כָּל־הַקִּדְּשִׁים אֲשֶׁר־הִקְדִּישׁוּ¹⁴ יְהוֹשָׁפָט וַיְהוֹרֶם וַאֲחִזְיָהוּ אֲבֹתָיו מִלְכֵי יְהוּדָה וְאֶת־קִדְּשָׁיו וְאֶת כָּל־הַזָּהָב הַנִּמְצָא בְּאֶצְרוֹת בֵּית־יְהוָה וּבֵית הַמֶּלֶךְ וַיִּשְׁלַח לְחֲזָאֵל מֶלֶךְ אֲרָם וַיַּעַל מֵעַל יְרוּשָׁלַם: 10 וַיֹּאמֶר חֲלִילָה לִּי מַעֲשׂוֹת זֹאת. הָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר נִמְצָא הַנְּבִיעַ¹⁵ בְּיָדוֹ הוּא יְהוָה־לִּי עֹבֵד וְאַתֶּם עָלוּ לְשָׁלוֹם אֶל־אֲבִיכֶם 11 דֶּרֶךְ רָשָׁעִים כָּאֲפֹלָה¹⁶ לֹא יָדְעוּ בְּמָה יִכָּשְׁלוּ

16.5 Hebrew Reading: Genesis 12:10–14

Translate Gen 12:10–14 with the help of notes below the text. Names of persons and places are easily identifiable; if not, they are included in the notes.

¹⁰ וַיְהִי רָעַב בְּאֶרֶץ וַיֵּרֶד אַבְרָם מִצְרַיִמָּה לְגִנּוֹר שָׁם כִּי־כָבֵד הָרָעַב בְּאֶרֶץ: ¹¹ וַיְהִי כֹאֲשֶׁר הִקְרִיב לָבוֹא מִצְרַיִמָּה וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל־שָׂרִי אֲשֶׁתּוֹ הִנֵּה־נָא יָדַעְתִּי כִּי אִשָּׁה יִפְתֹּ־מְרָאָה אָתָּה: ¹² וְהָיָה כִּי־יִרְאוּ אֹתָךְ הַמִּצְרַיִם וְאָמְרוּ אֲשֶׁתּוֹ זֹאת וְהָרְגוּ אֹתִי וְאַתָּה יַחֲיוּ: ¹³ אָמַר־נָא אַחֲתִי אָתָּה לְמַעַן יִיטַב־לִי בְּעִבְדוֹךָ וְחַיְתָּה נַפְשִׁי בְּגִלְלָךְ: ¹⁴ וַיְהִי כִּבּוֹא אַבְרָם מִצְרַיִמָּה וַיִּרְאוּ הַמִּצְרַיִם אֶת־הָאִשָּׁה כִּי־יֹפִיָּה הִיא מְאֹד:

12:10 מִצְרַיִמָּה The accent here is called Pašta. It is put on the last syllable of the word. If the last syllable is not stressed, it is repeated on the stressed syllable.

¹¹ בְּתַמִּים *in integrity*

¹² הִסִּירוּ *remove!* (impv. of סור Hiphil)

¹³ נִהְיָה *it happened* (היה Niphal)

¹⁴ הִקְדִּישׁוּ *they dedicated, they consecrated*

¹⁵ נְבִיעַ *cup, bowl*

¹⁶ אֲפֹלָה *darkness*

16.5 Hebrew Reading: Genesis 12:10–14

	כָּבֵד	<i>heavy, oppressing, severe</i>
12:11	הִקְרִיב	<i>he drew near, approached</i> (the intransitive meaning of the Hiphil form here is unusual)
	יָפָה	<i>beautiful, fair</i> (adj.)
12:12	מִצְרַיִם	<i>Egyptian</i>
	יְחִיּוּ	<i>they will let live</i> (Piel of the verb חָיָה)
12:13	בְּגִלַּל	<i>because of</i> (prep.)

Chapter 17

17.1 Vocabulary

17.1.1 Verbs

אמן	Hi. <i>to believe, think; to believe in; to have trust in</i> ; Ni. <i>to be reliable, faithful; to be permanent, endure</i>
חרם	Hi. <i>to put under a ban</i>
כעס	Hi. <i>to provoke to anger</i>
כרת	Q. <i>to cut</i> , Hi. <i>cut off, exterminate</i>
סגר	Q. <i>to shut, close</i> ; Hi. <i>to deliver, hand over; to shut</i>
צלח	Q. <i>to force entry to; to succeed, be successful</i> ; Hi. <i>to be successful; to make something a success</i>
שכל	Hi. <i>to understand; to have insight; to make wise, insightful; to achieve success</i>
שאר	Ni. <i>be left over, remain</i> ; Hi. <i>to leave over, spare</i>
שבת	Q. <i>to cease; to desist; to rest</i> ; Hi. <i>to cause to cease, put an end to; exterminate, destroy; to remove</i>
שחת	Hi. <i>to ruin, destroy; annihilate, exterminate</i>
שכם	Hi. <i>to do something early; to rise early</i>
שלך	Hi. <i>to throw</i>
שמד	Hi. <i>to annihilate, exterminate; destroy</i>

17.1.2 Nouns

אור	<i>light</i>
בְּכֹר	<i>firstborn</i>
חוֹמָה	<i>city wall, wall</i>
חֶמֶה	<i>heat; rage, wrath; poison</i>

חֲמֹר	<i>donkey, he-ass</i>
כֹּחַ	<i>strength, power</i>
נְחֹשֶׁת	<i>copper, bronze (fem. or masc.)</i>
נָשִׂיא	<i>chief, prince</i>
פָּר	<i>bull, steer (gem. noun; pl. פָּרִים)</i>
שְׂאֵרִית	<i>remainder; remnant (fem.)</i>
שֶׁכֶם	<i>shoulder, back</i>
שֶׁקֶר	<i>breach of faith, lie</i>

17.1.3 Other Parts of Speech

לִּי	<i>if (conj.); O that</i>
לִּי לֹא	<i>if not, unless (conj.)</i>

17.2 The Hiphil Binyan

17.2.1 The Forms of the Strong Verb in the Hiphil

With about 9300 occurrences, the Hiphil is the second most frequent binyan behind the Qal. The Hiphil is characterized by the additional element /h/ that is prefixed as the syllable *hi-* in the suffix conjugation or *ha-* in the imperative, infinitive construct and infinitive absolute. In the prefix conjugation and the participle the /h/ is elided between two vowels *CVha-* > *Ca*. The suffixes and prefixes of the SC, PC and imperative indicating person, number and gender are identical to the suffixes and prefixes of the corresponding forms in the Qal and the Niphal.

SC	sg.	3 m.	הִקְטִיב
		3 f.	הִקְטִיבָּה
		2 m.	הִקְטִבְתָּ
		2 f.	הִקְטִבְתְּ
		1 c.	הִקְטִבְתִּי

	pl.	3 c.	הִכְתִּיבוּ
		2 m.	הִכְתִּבְתֶּם
		2 f.	הִכְתִּבְתֶּן
		1 c.	הִכְתִּבָּנוּ
PC	sg.	3 m.	יִכְתִּיב
		3 f.	תִּכְתִּיב
		2 m.	תִּכְתִּיב
		2 f.	תִּכְתִּיבִי
		1 c.	אֶכְתִּיב
	pl.	3 m.	יִכְתִּיבוּ
		3 f.	תִּכְתִּבְנָה
		2 m.	תִּכְתִּיבוּ
		2 f.	תִּכְתִּבְנָה
		1 c.	נִכְתִּיב
Jussive	sg.	3 m.	יִכְתֹּב
<i>wayyiqtol</i>	sg.	3 m.	וַיִּכְתֹּב
Impv.	sg.	2 m.	הִכְתֵּב
		2 f.	הִכְתִּיבִי
	pl.	2 m.	הִכְתִּיבוּ
		2 f.	הִכְתִּבְנָה
Inf. cs.			הִכְתִּיב
Inf. abs.			הִכְתֵּב
Part.	m.	sg.	מִכְתִּיב
		pl.	מִכְתִּיבִים
	f.	sg.	מִכְתִּבָּת
		pl.	מִכְתִּיבוֹת

Notes

Vocalic suffixes are not stressed in Hiphil forms. Compare הִכְתִּיבוּ with the corresponding Qal form כָּתְבוּ.

In *wayyiqtol* forms and jussive forms without a suffix the thematic vowel is /ē/, e.g., *וַיִּשְׁלֵךְ* and *he threw* and *וַיִּשְׁלֵךְ* *let him throw*. With enclitic pronouns, however, these forms have the thematic vowel /ī/, e.g., *וַיִּשְׁלֵךְהוּא* and *he threw it [the staff]*.

In the imperative the /h/ of the Hiphil at the beginning of the forms is preserved. This applies to the infinitive construct and infinitive absolute as well.

The *šere* of the imperative m. sg. corresponds to the same vowel in *wayyiqtol* forms and jussive forms. With enclitic pronoun, however, this form has the thematic vowel /ī/, e.g., *הִשְׁלִיכֵהוּ* *throw it [the staff]*.

The longer forms of the imperative Hiphil is *הִשְׁמָעוּ*, e.g., *הִשְׁמָעוּ* *listen!* (Job 33:1).

The primitive form of the prefix conjugation was **yahaqtīl* or **yuhaqtīl*. The /h/ of the Hiphil was elided between vowels; the prefix vowel /a/ of the /*-ha-/ syllable is preserved as the vowel of the prefix syllable. The long vowel /ī/ is due to analogy with II w/y verbs.

The explanations about the prefix syllable of the prefix conjugation forms are to be applied to the prefix of the participles, too: *mVhaktīb* > *maktīb* > *maktīb* *מַכְתִּיב*.

The participle f. sg. is usually *מַכְתִּיבָה*; forms with the feminine ending -ā are attested, too, e.g., *מַכְתִּיבָהּ* *a woman giving birth for the first time* (Jer 4:31).

The primitive form of the suffix conjugation may have been **hiqtīl*. The long vowel /ī/ in forms without a suffix or forms with vocalic suffix is due to analogy with II w/y verbs (→ 24.2.1). The vowel /a/ in the second syllable of suffix conjugation forms with consonantal suffixes is the result of the sound change /i/ > /a/ in stressed closed syllables (so-called Philippi's Law). A different primitive form of the suffix conjugation **haqtal* may be assumed for some categories of weak verbs.¹

17.2.2 The Meaning of Verbs in the Hiphil

The Hiphil has the following main meanings:

- Causative (someone causes somebody to do something), e.g., *מִלַּךְ* Qal *to rule as king*, Hi. *to make somebody rule as king*; *רָאָה* Qal *to see*, Hi. *to show something to somebody*

¹ Some scholars assume **haqtal* to be the primitive form of the suffix conjugation forms of both strong and weak verbs. In this case the prefix vowel *hi-* is the result of attenuation /a/ > /i/ in an unstressed closed syllable. The long vowel /ī/ in forms without a suffix or forms with vocalic suffix is due to analogy with imperfect forms where its presence can be accounted for by analogy with II w/y verbs.

- Denominative (the verb is derived from a noun): noun אָזן *ear* → verb אָזן *Hi. to listen, hear*; noun שָׁרֵשׁ *root* → verb שָׁרֵשׁ *Hi. to put down roots*
- Declarative: רָשַׁע Qal *to be guilty*; Hi. *to declare guilty* (cf. רָשָׁע *guilty*)
- Intransitive (frequently from adjectives or stative verbs): שָׁמֵן *Hi. to make fat* (causative) or *to become fat* (intransitive; from שָׁמֵן *fat, robust*)
- Without obvious Hiphil meaning: שָׁלַךְ *Hi. to throw*
- Sometimes the Hiphil functions as a causative to the Niphal: שָׁבַע Ni. *to take an oath*, Hi. *to make somebody take an oath*; נָצַל Ni. *tear oneself away, deliver oneself*; Hi. *take away; rescue*

If the meaning of a verb in the Qal is known, these semantic categories should be considered for the translation of the verb in the Hiphil. A lexicon will help in further specifying the meaning of Hiphil forms.

17.2.3 Guttural Verbs in the Hiphil Binyan

Verbs I gutt.

In the suffix conjugation, the prefix vowel is changed to *səgol*: הִעֲמִיד, etc. (cf. the primitive form **hiqtil*).

The prefix syllable is usually closed by a *ḥaṭef* vowel: suffix conjugation הִעֲמִידָהּ, prefix conjugation הִעֲמִידִי, etc.

Verbs II gutt.

Verbs II gutt. don't show any differences to the regular strong verbs without gutturals because the second root consonant R₂ is always at the beginning of a syllable with a full vowel.

Verbs III gutt.

In forms of the suffix conjugation without suffix and in the prefix conjugation the long vowel /ī/ is followed by a furtive *pataḥ*, e.g., הִשְׁבִּיעַ *he made somebody swear*. The same applies to the /ē/ of the infinitive absolute, e.g., הִשְׁבַּע.

In *wayyiqtol* forms without suffix and forms of the jussive and the imperative without suffix the vowel /ē/ is replaced by /a/, e.g., וְאַל-יִבְטַח אֶתְכֶם (יִבְטַח) *Don't let Hezeqiah make you trust in the Lord*, 2 Kgs 18:30), וְיִבְטַח אֶתְכֶם *and he made you trust in a lie*, Jer 29:31). This vowel change is also attested in verbs IIIr, e.g., וַיִּתְּרָה *and she [Ruth] had left over* (3 f. sg. *wayyiqtol* of the verb יָתַר *Hi.*, Ruth 2:14), but preservation of the *šere* is attested as well, e.g., וַיִּבְעֵר *and he set to fire* (Judg 15:5).

In the participle f. sg. the vowel sequence of the ending is *a-a*, e.g., מִנֶּעַת (from the root נגע; 2 Chr 3:11).

17.3 Hypothetical Conditional Clauses with לו or לוֹלֵא

For hypothetical conditional clauses – the contents of both the *if*-clause and the main clause are unreal – the conjunctions לו *if* and לוֹלֵא or – with a different spelling and actually more frequent – לוֹלֵי *if not* are used (לוֹלֵא is dissimilated from *lūlō*(?), i.e., לו + לֵא).

וַיֹּאמֶר אַחֵי בְנֵי־אִמִּי הֵם
חַי־יְהוָה לֹו הַחַיִּיתֶם אוֹתָם
לֹא הֲרַגְתִּי אֶתְכֶם
And he said, “They are my brothers, the sons
of my mother. As the Lord lives, if you had
spared their their lives I would not kill you.”
(Judg 8:19)

וַיֹּאמֶר הָאִישׁ אֶל־יֹאָב וְלֹו
אֲנֹכִי שֹׁקֵל עַל־כַּפִּי אֶלֶף
כֶּסֶף לֹא־אֶשְׁלַח יָדִי
אֶל־בֶּן־הַמֶּלֶךְ
And the man said to Joab, “Even if I felt the
weight of a thousand shekels in my hands
I would not stretch out my hand against
the king’s son” (2 Sam 18:12 Qere Aleppo
Codex)

וַיֹּאמֶר לָהֶם לוֹלֵא חֲרַשְׁתֶּם
בְּעֹגְלָתִי לֹא מָצְאתֶם חֵידָתִי
And he said to them, “If you had not plowed
with my heifer you would not have solved my
riddle” (Judg 14:18)

Note

The conjunction לו is sometimes spelled לוֹא or even לֵא in the Ketiv.

Related to its use in hypothetical conditional clauses is the use of the suffix conjugation or *qatal* form in hypothetical main clauses (Gen 18:12; Gen 21:7).

וַתִּצְחַק שָׂרָה בְּקִרְבָּהּ לֵאמֹר
אַחֲרַי בָּלִיתִי הִיָּתָה־לִּי עֲדָנָה
And Sarah laughed to herself, “Shall I have
pleasure after I am worn out?” (Gen 18:12)

וַתֹּאמֶר מִי מִלֵּל לְאַבְרָהָם
הַיִּנִּיקָה בָּנִים שָׂרָה
And she said, “Who would have said to Abra-
ham that Sarah has nursed children?” (Gen
21:7)

17.4 Wishes with לו

As a particle, לו also introduces wishes (Gen 17:18). At times, these wishes are hypothetical (Num 14:2).

- וַיֹּאמֶר אַבְרָהָם אֶל־הָאֱלֹהִים And Abraham said to God, “O that Ishmael
 לוֹ יִשְׁמַעְאֵל יְחִיָּה לְפָנֶיךָ might live before you!” (Gen 17:18)
- וַיֹּאמְרוּ אֲלֵהֶם כָּל־הָעֵדָה And the whole congregation said to them, “If
 לוֹ־מָתָנוּ בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם אוֹ only we had died in Egypt or if only we had
 בַּמִּדְבָּר הַזֶּה לוֹ־מָתָנוּ died in this wilderness!” (Num 14:2)

17.5 Exercises

17.5.1 Translation of Verbal Forms

Translate the following verbal forms. Identify the gender (masc., fem., comm.) and number (sg., pl.) of forms of which the English translation is ambiguous (i.e., *you, they*). Mark the stressed syllable if stress is not on the last syllable.

- 1 הַשְּׂכִימוּ 2 יִאֲמִינוּ 3 מִשְׁחֲתִים 4 הָאֲמִין 5 אֲשֶׁלִּיךְ 6 וַיִּשְׁכֹּם
 7 הָאֲמִינוּ 8 הָאֲמִינוּ 9 תִּשְׁלִיךְ 10 הַשְּׁלִיכָה 11 הַשְּׁלִיךְ 12 וַיִּשְׁלִיכוּ
 13 הַשְּׁלִיכָתִי 14 הָאֲמִנָתָם 15 הַכְרָתִי

17.5.2 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: *בֵּית־חורן*, *בעל פעור*, *עֶזְקָה*, *לוֹט*, *חֲנָנִיָּה*, *זְמָרִי*, *בַּעֲשָׂא* (name of a place and of a deity), *תְּקוּעָה*.

- 1 וַיְהִי בִּנְסֻס מִפְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל – הֵם בְּמוֹרֶד² בֵּית־חורן – וַיַּחֲזֶה הַשְּׁלִיךְ עֲלֵיהֶם אֲבָנִים
 גְּדֹלוֹת מִן־הַשָּׁמַיִם עַד־עֶזְקָה וַיָּמָתוּ. רַבִּים אֲשֶׁר־מָתוּ בְּאֲבָנֵי הַבֶּרֶד³ מֵאֲשֶׁר הִרְגוּ בְּנֵי
 יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּחֶרֶב. 2 עֵינֵיכֶם הִרְאֵת אֶת אֲשֶׁר־עָשָׂה יְהוָה בְּבַעַל פְּעוֹר כִּי⁴ כָּל־הָאִישׁ
 אֲשֶׁר הָלַךְ אַחֲרֵי בַּעַל־פְּעוֹר הִשְׁמִידוּ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיךְ מִקֶּרְבְּךָ. 3 וַיֹּאמֶר יְרֵמְיָה
 הִנֵּבִיא אֶל־חֲנַנְיָה הַנָּבִיא שְׁמַעֲנָא חֲנַנְיָה לֹא־שָׁלַחךָ יְהוָה וְאַתָּה הַבְּטַחְתָּ אֶת־הָעָם
 הַזֶּה עַל־שִׁקְרִי⁵ 4 וְאֲנָשֵׁי־קִדְשׁ תִּהְיוּ לִי. וּבֶשֶׂר בִּשְׂדֵה – טֶרֶף⁶ – לֹא תֹאכְלוּ.
 לְכָל־בֶּן־תִּשְׁלַכְוּ אֹתוֹ 5 וְעַתָּה הִנֵּה יִדְעֹתִי כִּי מֶלֶךְ תִּמְלֹךְ וְקָמָה בְּיָדְךָ מַמְלָכָה
 יִשְׂרָאֵל וְעַתָּה הַשְּׁבַעָה לִּי בִיהוָה אִם־תִּכְרִית אֶת־זִרְעִי אַחֲרַי וְאִם־תִּשְׁמֹר אֶת־שְׁמִי

² מִמוֹרֶד *descent, slope* (from the root ירד with prefixed מ)

³ בֶּרֶד *hail*

⁴ כִּי here *that* (introducing a second object clause to הִרְאֵת)

⁵ שִׁקְרִי pausal form of שָׁקֶר

⁶ טֶרֶף *animal torn by wild beasts* (apposition to בִּשְׂדֵה)

⁷ כָּל־בֶּן *dog*

מבית אבי וישבע דוד לשאול ויגדף שאול אל-ביתו ודוד ואנשיו עלו על-המצודה⁸
 6 ויצא לוט וידבר אל-חתניו⁹ לקחי בנתיו ויאמר קומו צאו מן-המקום הזה
 כי-משחית יהנה את-העיר ויהי כמצחק¹⁰ בעיני חתניו 7 ויעש משה כאשר
 צוה¹¹ יהנה אותו ויקח את-יהושע ויעמדהו לפני אלעזר הכהן ולפני כל-העדה
 ויסמך¹² את-ידיו עליו ויצוהו¹³ כאשר דבר יהנה ביד-משה 8 וישמד יהוא
 את-הבעל מישראל 9 וישמד זמרי את כל-בית בעשא כדבר יהנה אשר דבר
 אל-בעשא ביד יהוא הנביא 10 ויאמר דוד אל-אבנר הלוא-איש אתה ומי
 כמוך בישראל ולמה לא שמרת אל-¹⁴ אדניך המלך כי-בא אחד העם להשחית
 את-המלך אדניך. לא-טוב הדבר הזה אשר עשית. חי-יהנה כי בני-מות אתם
 אשר לא-שמרתם על-אדניכם על-משיח¹⁵ יהנה 11 ויען משה ויאמר והן¹⁶
 לא-יאמינו לי ולא ישמעו בקלי כי יאמרו לא-נראה¹⁷ אליך יהנה. ויאמר אליו
 יהנה מה-זה בידך ויאמר מטה. ויאמר השליכהו ארצה. וישליכהו ארצה ויהי
 לנחש¹⁸ ויגס משה מפניו. 12 וישכימו בבקר ויצאו למדבר תקוע ובצאתם
 עמד יהושפט ויאמר שמעוני יהודה וישבי ירושלם האמינו ביהנה אלהיכם ותאמנו
 האמינו בנביאיו והצליחו

17.6 Hebrew Reading: Genesis 12:15–20

Translate Gen 12:15–20 with the help of notes below the text. Names of persons and places are easily identifiable.

15 ויראו אתה שרי פרעה ויהללו אתה אל-פרעה ותקח האשה בית פרעה:
 16 ולאברם היטיב בעבורה ויהי-לו צאן-ובקר וחמרים ועבדים ושפחות ואתנת
 וגמלים: ¹⁷ ויגוע יהנה את-פרעה ננעים גדלים ואת-ביתו על-דבר שרי אשת
 אברם: ¹⁸ ויקרא פרעה לאברם ויאמר מה-זאת עשית לי למה לא-הנדת לי כי
 אשתך הוא: ¹⁹ למה אמרת אחתי הוא ואקח אתה לי לאשה ועתה הנה אשתך
 קח ולך: ²⁰ ויצו עליו פרעה אנשים וישלחו אתו ואת-אשתו ואת-כל-אשר-לו:

⁸ mountain stronghold מצודה

⁹ son in law חתן

¹⁰ somebody who is joking (participle Pi.) מצחק

¹¹ he instructed (Pi.; verb צוה) צוה

¹² with יד and על to lay hand on (in consecration) ויסמך

¹³ and he gave him instructions (Pi.; verb צוה) ויצוהו

¹⁴ here for אל (cf. the continuation); the verb שמר normally governs a direct object.

¹⁵ anointed one משיח

¹⁶ if; the main clause is missing. והן

¹⁷ he appeared (Ni. of ראה) נראה

¹⁸ snake נחש

- 12:15 וַיְהַלְלוּ *and they praised* (Pi. of הָלַל)
 וַתִּקַּח *she was taken* (Qal passive of לָקַח → 26.3)
- 12:16 הֵיטִיב *he did well, he dealt well* (Hi. of יָטַב)
 אֶתֶּן *she-ass*
- 12:17 וַיַּנֶּעַ *he afflicted* (Pi. of נָנַע; cf. נָנַע)
 עַל־דָּבָר *because of*
- 12:18 מִה־זֹּאת *The demonstrative pronouns זֶה and זֹאת often follow an interrogative pronoun or adverb “without any notable change in meaning” (JM § 143 g)*
 הִנֵּדְתָּ *you told* (verb נָדַד Hi.)
 הָיָא *read* הָיָא
- 12:19 הָיָא *read* הָיָא
- 12:20 וַיִּצַּו *and he gave instructions*
 וַיִּשְׁלְחוּ *and they sent off* (Pi. of שָׁלַח)

Chapter 18

18.1 Vocabulary

18.1.1 Verbs

סתר	Hi. <i>to hide, conceal</i> (transitive); Ni. <i>to hide oneself; to be hid, concealed</i>
עזר	Q. <i>to help, assist</i>
ערך	Q. <i>to arrange, set in order; to draw up a battle formation</i>
פנה	Q. <i>to turn</i> (turn to one side, head in a particular direction; turn round; turn away and go on further)
פקד	Q. <i>to visit, attend to, muster, appoint</i> ; Hi. <i>to set (over), make overseer; commit, entrust; deposit</i>
רכב	Q. <i>to mount and ride, ride</i> ; Hi. <i>to cause ride, to make to ride</i> (PC יִרְכַּב)

18.1.2 Nouns

גִּזְרָל	<i>lot; allocation by lot</i>
חַיָּה	<i>animals</i> (usually collective)
יְשׁוּעָה	<i>help, salvation</i>
כַּנָּף	<i>wing; edge, extremity; skirt</i> (of a garment) (fem.)
לָשׁוֹן	<i>tongue; language</i> (m.; pl. לְשׁוֹנוֹת)
מִנְרֵשׁ	<i>pastureland</i> (belonging to a city); <i>outskirts</i>
מִקְנֵה	<i>livestock as property, cattle</i>
עַמּוּד	<i>pillar; column</i> (cf. עָמַד)
עָפָר	<i>dry earth; dust</i>
פֶּרִי	<i>fruit</i>
צֶדֶק	<i>rightness; righteousness</i>

שֶׂה	<i>a small livestock beast (sheep or goat; unitary noun for the collective noun צֹאן)</i>
שְׂעִיר	<i>billy-goat, buck</i>
שַׁבָּת	<i>Sabbath (f. or m.; pl. שַׁבָּתוֹת)</i>
שׂוֹר	<i>a single beast, bovid (bull, etc.; unitary noun for the collective noun בָּקָר)</i>
תּוֹעֵבָה	<i>abomination, abhorrence</i>

18.1.3 Other Parts of Speech

מֵעַל	<i>upwards, above (adv.) (noun מַעַל higher part)</i>
מִמֶּעַל	<i>above (adv.) (לְ prep. on top of, above)</i>

18.2 The Hophal Binyan

18.2.1 The Forms of the Strong Verb in the Hophal

The Hophal is the passive form to the Hiphil; e.g., הִשְׁלַכְתִּי *I threw* (Hi.) and הִשְׁלַכְתִּי *I was thrown* (Ho.). There are only about 380 occurrences of the Hophal in the Hebrew Bible with most forms from weak verbs. In Modern Hebrew, the Hophal is called Huphal.

The Hophal is characterized by the prefix syllable **hu-*. The vowel sequence *u-a* is characteristic of passive verbal forms. In Tiberian Hebrew the prefix vowel can be either /ɔ/ (< /u/) (*qameṣ ḥatuf*) or the original /u/ (*qibbuṣ*). In the participle /u/ is more frequent than /ɔ/ because of the preceding labial sound /m/.

SC	sg.	3 m.	הִקְטַב/הִקְטַבָּה
		3 f.	הִקְטַבְּהָ
		2 m.	הִקְטַבְתֶּם
		2 f.	הִקְטַבְתֶּי
		1 c.	הִקְטַבְתִּי

SC	pl.	3 c.	הִתְּבּוּ
		2 m.	הִתְּבַתְּם
		2 f.	הִתְּבַתְּנָן
		1 c.	הִתְּבַנּוּ
PC	sg.	3 m.	יִתְּב
		3 f.	תִּתְּב
		2 m.	תִּתְּב
		2 f.	תִּתְּבִי
		1 c.	אִתְּב
	pl.	3 m.	יִתְּבּוּ
		3 f.	תִּתְּבַנָּה
		2 m.	תִּתְּבּוּ
		2 f.	תִּתְּבַנָּה
		1 c.	נִתְּב
Jussive	sg.	3 m.	יִתְּב
<i>wayyiqtol</i>	sg.	3 m.	וַיִּתְּב
Impv.	sg.	2 m.	הִתְּב
		2 f.	הִתְּבִי
	pl.	2 m.	הִתְּבּוּ
		2 f.	הִתְּבַנּוּ
Inf. cs.			הִתְּב
Inf. abs.			הִתְּב
Part.	m.	sg.	מִתְּב
		pl.	מִתְּבִים
	f.	sg.	מִתְּבַת
		pl.	מִתְּבוֹת

Notes

In the suffix conjugation the primitive form was **huqtila*. The thematic vowel changed from **i* to *a* due to analogy to the prefix conjugation *yuqtal* and/or Philippi's Law (*i* > *a* in stressed closed syllable).

In the prefix conjugation the primitive form was **yuhuqṭalu* resulting in *yuqtal* or *yəqṭal* in Tiberian Hebrew after the loss of the short final vowel and the elision of the intervocalic /h/.

The imperative Ho. is attested only twice in the Hebrew Bible: הָפְנִי *be turned back* (from the root פנה, Jer 49:8), הִשְׁכַּבְּךָ *put yourself to bed* (Ezek 32:19).

18.2.2 Guttural Verbs in the Hophal

Verbs I gutt.

The prefix vowel of I gutt. verbs is always /ɔ/ (*qameṣ ḥatuf*). There are forms with *ḥatef qameṣ* and forms with silent *šwa* with the first root consonant, e.g., הִהָפֵךְ *it has been turned upon* (Job 30:15) יִעָמַד *it shall be placed* (Lev 16:10)

Verbs II gutt. and III gutt.

The forms that are attested in the Hebrew Bible do not show differences to the regular strong verb.

18.3 Wishes with מִי יִתֵּן

The interrogative pronoun מִי *who?* and the verbal form יִתֵּן (3 m. sg. prefix conjugation of נתן) are used idiomatically with the meaning *Would that it may be so!* to express wishes.

וַיֹּאמְרוּ אֶל־הֶם בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל
מִי־יִתֵּן מוֹתֵנוּ בְּיַד־יְהוָה
בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם

And the Israelites said to them, "Would that we had died through the hand of the Lord in the land of Egypt." (Exod 16:3)

בִּבְקֹר תֹאמַר מִי־יִתֵּן עֶרֶב
וּבְעֶרֶב תֹאמַר מִי־יִתֵּן בֹּקֶר

In the morning you will say, "If only it were evening", and in the evening you will say, "If only it were morning" (Deut 28:67)

18.4 The Forms וַיְהִי and וַיִּהְיֶה as Discourse Markers

The forms וַיִּהְיֶה (3 m. sg. *wayyiqtol*) and וְהָיָה (3 m. sg. *wəqataltí*) of the verb הָיָה may be used as ordinary verbs in normal verbal clauses with a subject and a predicate.

וַיְהִי רָעָב בְּאֶרֶץ
And there was a famine in the land (Gen 12:10)

וַיֹּאמֶר יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶל-יוֹסֵף הִנֵּה
אֲנִי מֵת וְהָיָה אֱלֹהִים עִמָּךְ

*And Israel said to Joseph, "I am about to die,
but God will be with you" (Gen 48:21)*

In many cases, however, the forms וַיְהִי and וַיְהִי־הָאֵל are not used as normal verb forms but as discourse markers to indicate the time reference for the following state of affairs as past with וַיְהִי or as future with וַיְהִי־הָאֵל. Usually these forms are followed by a temporal adverbial phrase or a temporal clause (Gen 26:32; Hos 1:5). There are quite many cases of וַיְהִי־הָאֵל in a future time discourse before a normal main clause (Gen 4:14).

When used as discourse markers, וַיְהִי and וַיְהִי should not be translated.

וַיְהִי בַיּוֹם הַהוּא וַיָּבֹאוּ עֲבָדֵי יִצְחָק

On that day the servants of Isaac came (Gen 26:32)

וְהָיָה בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא וְשָׁבַרְתִּי
אֶת־קֶשֶׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּעֵמֶק
יִזְרְעֵאל

*On that day I will break the bow of Israel in
the plains of Jezreel (Hos 1:5)*

וְהָיָה כָּל־מֹצְאִי יִהְרֹגִנִי And whoever finds me will kill me (Gen 4:14)

In line with the possible meanings of *waw*-SC (*wəqataltī*) forms, וְיָדִיךָ may be used as a discourse marker for the past time with iterative meaning (Exod 33:9; Judg 19:30).

וַיְהִי כִּבְּאֵה מֹשֶׁה הָאֹהֶל
יָרַד עַמּוּד הָעָנָן וַעֲמַד פֶּתַח
הָאֹהֶל וַיְדַבֵּר עִם־מֹשֶׁה

When Moses entered the tent, the pillar of cloud would come down and stand at the entrance of the tent and he [the Lord] would speak with Moses (Exod 33:9)

וְהָיָה כָּל-הָרָאָה וְאָמַר
לֹא-נִהְיָתָה וְלֹא-נִרְאָתָה
כְּזֹאת לְמִיּוֹם עָלוֹת
בְּנֵי-יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם
עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה

Anybody who saw it, would say “Something like this has not happened or been seen since the day the Israelites went up from the land of Egypt until this day” (Judg 19:30)

18.5 Exercises

18.5.1 Parsing of Verbal Forms

Parse the following verbal forms by identifying person, number, gender – if applicable – and the conjugation (PC, SC, jussive, *wayyiqtol*, impv., inf. cs., inf. abs., part.) and the binyan. Translate the finite forms. Mark the stressed syllable if stress is not on the last syllable.

1 יָחָרָם 2 הִפְקִיד 3 יַעֲמֹד 4 מִשְׁלָךְ 5 מִשְׁלָכָת 6 מַעֲמֹד 7 מִשְׁכָּב
8 הִשְׁלַכְתִּי 9 מִשְׁחָת 10 יִשְׁלָכוּ

18.5.2 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: יְהוֹרָם, גִּלְגָל, בֵּית-עֶקֶד, יוֹרָם.

1 וְהַשְׁעִיר אֲשֶׁר עָלָה עָלָיו הַגּוֹרֵל “לְעֶזְאֵזֶל”¹ יַעֲמֹד-חַי לְפָנַי יְהוָה 2 וַיָּבֹא אֱלִישָׁע
הַכִּיָּתָה וְהִנֵּה הַנַּעַר מֵת² מִשְׁכָּב עַל-מִטָּתוֹ³ 3 וַיִּרְבֹּז⁴ הַמֶּלֶךְ וַיַּעַל עַל-עֲלִית⁵
הַשָּׁעַר וַיִּבֶךְ וְכֹה אָמַר בְּלִכְתּוֹ בְּנֵי אֲבִשָׁלוֹם בְּנֵי אֲבִשָׁלוֹם מִי-יָתֵן מוֹתִי אֲנִי תַחְתִּיךָ
אֲבִשָׁלוֹם בְּנֵי בְנֵי 4 מִי יָתֵן מִצִּיּוֹן יְשׁוּעַת יִשְׂרָאֵל. בְּשׁוּב⁶ יְהוָה שְׁבוֹת עִמּוֹ.
יְגַל⁷ יַעֲקֹב. יִשְׁמַח יִשְׂרָאֵל. 5 וַיֹּאמֶר תַּפְשׁוּם חַיִּים וַיַּתְּפִשׁוּם חַיִּים וַיִּשְׁחָטוּם
אֶל-בּוֹר בֵּית-עֶקֶד אַרְבָּעִים וּשְׁנַיִם אִישׁ וְלֹא-הִשְׁאִיר אִישׁ מֵהֶם 6 וַיָּשָׁב הַמֶּלֶךְ

¹ לְעֶזְאֵזֶל *Azazel*, name of a demon in the wilderness (*HALOT*); לְעֶזְאֵזֶל is what was written on the גּוֹרֵל.

² מֵת *dead* (part. of מוֹת; → 14.2)

³ מִטָּה *couch, bed* (root נטה)

⁴ רָבַז *Qal to tremble* (with emotion)

⁵ עֲלִית *upper room, room in an upper story* (root עלה)

⁶ שׁוּב with the direct object שְׁבוֹת *to turn someone's fortune, bring about change* (*HALOT*)

⁷ יָגַל *Qal to shout in exultation, rejoice*

וַיָּבֹא עַד-הַנִּירְדָּן וַיְהוּדָה בָּא הַגְּלָנְלָה לְלָכֶת לִקְרֹאת הַמֶּלֶךְ לְהַעֲבִיר אֶת-הַמֶּלֶךְ
 אֶת-הַנִּירְדָּן 7 לֹא-תִסְגִּיר עֶבֶד אֶל-אֲדֹנָיו אֲשֶׁר-יִנְצֹל אֵלָיִךְ מֵעַם אֲדֹנָיו. עַמֶּךָ
 יֹשֵׁב בְּקִרְבְּךָ בַּמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר-יִבְחָר בְּאַחַד שְׁעָרֶיךָ בְּטוֹב לוֹ. לֹא תוֹנְנוּ⁸ 8 וַיַּחְרִימוּ
 אֶת-כָּל-אֲשֶׁר בְּעִיר מֵאִישׁ וְעַד-אִשָּׁה מִנָּעַר וְעַד-זָקֵן וְעַד שׂוֹר וְנִשָּׂה וְחֲמוֹר לְפִי-חֶרֶב
 9 שׁוֹבָה יִשְׂרָאֵל עַד יְהוּדָה אֶל-הַיָּד כִּי כָשְׁלֹת בַּעֲזוֹנָךְ 10 וַיֵּצֵא דָוִד, בְּכָל אֲשֶׁר
 יִשְׁלַחֲנוּ שְׂאוֹל וְשָׂכִיל וַיִּשְׁמְחוּ שְׂאוֹל עַל אֲנָשֵׁי הַמִּלְחָמָה וַיִּיטֹב בְּעֵינָיו כָּל-הָעָם וְגַם
 בְּעֵינָי עֶבְדֵי שְׂאוֹל 11 וַיְהִי יְהוּדָה אֶת-יֹסֵף וַיְהִי אִישׁ מִצְלִיחַ וַיְהִי בְּבֵית אֲדֹנָיו
 הַמִּצְרִי וַיֵּרָא אֲדֹנָיו כִּי יְהוּדָה אֶתּוֹ וְכָל אֲשֶׁר-הוּא עֹשֶׂה יְהוּדָה מִצְלִיחַ בְּיָדוֹ 12 וּבִשְׁנַת
 חָמֵשׁ לְיֹרָם בֶּן-אֲחִיזָב מֶלֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיְהוֹשֻׁפֹּט מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה מֶלֶךְ יְהוֹרָם בֶּן-יְהוֹשָׁפָט
 מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה. בֶּן-שְׁלֹשִׁים וּשְׁתַּיִם שָׁנָה הָיָה בְּמָלְכוֹ וַיִּשְׁמְנָה שָׁנִים מֶלֶךְ בִּירוּשָׁלַם.
 וַיָּלֶךְ בְּדֶרֶךְ מֶלְכֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל כַּאֲשֶׁר עָשׂוּ בֵּית אֲחִיזָב כִּי בֵּת-אֲחִיזָב הִתְחִלָּה לֹאֲשֹׁה
 וַיַּעַשׂ הָרַע בְּעֵינָי יְהוּדָה. וְלֹא-אָבָה יְהוּדָה לְהַשְׁחִית אֶת-יְהוּדָה לְמַעַן דָּוִד עֶבְדּוֹ כַּאֲשֶׁר
 אָמַר-לוֹ לְתַת לוֹ נִיר⁹ לְבָנָיו כָּל-הַיָּמִים.

18.6 Hebrew Reading: Genesis 13:1–7

Translate Gen 13:1–7 with the help of notes below the text. Names of persons and places are easily identifiable.

¹ וַיַּעַל אַבְרָם מִמִּצְרַיִם הוּא וְאִשְׁתּוֹ וְכָל-אֲשֶׁר-לוֹ וְלוֹט עִמּוֹ הַנֶּגְבָה: ² וְאַבְרָם
 כָּבֵד מְאֹד בַּמִּקְנֶה בַּכֶּסֶף וּבַזָּהָב: ³ וַיָּלֶךְ לְמִסְעָיו מִנֶּגֶב וְעַד-בֵּית-אֵל עַד-הַמָּקוֹם
 אֲשֶׁר-הָיָה שָׁם אֲחִילּוֹ בְּתַחֲלָה בֵּין בֵּית-אֵל וּבֵין הָעֵי: ⁴ אֶל-מָקוֹם הַמְּזֻבָּח אֲשֶׁר-עָשָׂה
 שָׁם בְּרֵאשִׁיטָה וַיִּקְרָא שָׁם אַבְרָם בְּשֵׁם יְהוָה: ⁵ וְגַם-לְלוֹט הָיָה אֶת-אַבְרָם הָיָה
 צֹאן-וּבָקָר וְאֵהָלִים: ⁶ וְלֹא-נָשָׂא אֶתֶם הָאָרֶץ לְשִׁבְתָּהּ וַיִּחְדְּדוּ כִּי-הָיָה רְכוּשָׁם רָב וְלֹא
 יָכְלוּ לְשִׁבְתָּהּ יַחְדָּם: ⁷ וַיְהִי-רִיב בֵּין רְעֵי מִקְנֵה-אַבְרָם וּבֵין רְעֵי מִקְנֵה-לוֹט וַיִּכְנַעֲנִי
 וַיִּפְרְזִי אִזִּי יֹשֵׁב בְּאָרֶץ:

13:2 כָּבֵד *heavy, weighty, rich*

13:3 לְמִסְעָיו *by stages (מִסַּע breaking camp; departure)*

תַּחֲלָה *beginning*

בְּרֵאשִׁיטָה *before, formerly*

⁸ לֹא תוֹנְנוּ *You shall not oppress him (verb יָנָה Hi.)*

⁹ נִיר *light, lamp*

Chapter 18

- | | | |
|------|---------------|--|
| 13:6 | וְלֹא-נִשָּׂא | lack of agreement in gender between the predicate and the subject
הָאֶרֶץ |
| | רְכוּשׁ | <i>possession; property; goods</i> |
| 13:7 | רֹעֶה | <i>shepherd</i> (participle of רָעָה) |

Chapter 19

19.1 Vocabulary

19.1.1 Verbs

אָרר	Q. <i>to curse</i>
בָּקַשׁ	Pi. <i>to seek</i>
בָּרַךְ	Pi. <i>to bless</i>
גָּדַל	Q. <i>to be great, become great, grow up</i> (stative verb; PC גָּדַל); Hi. <i>to make great; to make great things; Pi. to cause to grow; make great, powerful</i>
גָּרַשׁ	Pi. <i>to drive out</i>
דָּבַר	Pi. <i>to speak</i>
כָּבַס	Pi. <i>to wash</i> (normally clothes) (SC כָּבַס)
לָמַד	Q. <i>to learn; Pi. to teach</i>
מָאָן	Pi. <i>to refuse</i>
מָהֵר	Pi. <i>to hasten; to do something hastily</i>
סָפַר	Q. <i>to count; Pi. to report; tell; to make known, announce</i>
פָּתַח	Q. <i>to open; Pi. to let loose; to untie; to liberate</i>
קָדַשׁ	Q. <i>to be holy</i> (stative verb; SC pausal form קָדַשׁ; PC קָדַשׁ); Pi. <i>to sanctify, make holy; to declare holy; to dedicate; Hi. to set apart, devote, consecrate; regard or treat as sacred</i>
קָטַר	Hi. <i>to cause to go up in smoke; Pi. to make a sacrifice go up in smoke</i>
קָלַל	Q. <i>to be small, insignificant; to be swift; Pi. to curse</i>
שָׁחַת	Hi./Pi. <i>to ruin, destroy; annihilate, exterminate</i>
שָׁלַח	Q. <i>to send; Pi. to send off; to send out, forth; to let go, set free</i>
שָׁלַם	Pi. <i>to make whole or good, restore; make good, i.e., pay</i> (vows); <i>to requite, recompense, reward</i>

Chapter 19

שָׁפַךְ	Q. <i>to pour, pour out</i>
שָׁרַת	Pi. <i>to serve</i>

19.1.2 Nouns

אָרֶךְ	<i>length</i>
בְּרָכָה	<i>blessing</i> (cs. st. בְּרִכָּת, but with ePP בְּרִכְתִּי)
חֻקָּה	<i>statute</i>
טָהוֹר	<i>pure; ceremonially clean</i> (adj.)
יֵתֶר	<i>rest, remainder</i>
כֶּבֶשׂ	<i>young ram</i>
עוֹר	<i>skin; animal skin; leather</i>
קִטְרֶת	<i>smoke, odor of (burning) sacrifice; incense</i> (fem.)
רֹחַב	<i>breadth, width</i>
רָחוֹק	<i>distant, far</i> (adj.)
שִׂמְחָה	<i>joy, gladness</i>

19.1.3 Other Parts of Speech

מְהֵרָה	<i>quickly, speedily</i> (adv.; inf. abs. of מָהַר Pi. <i>to hasten</i>)
מָחָר	<i>tomorrow</i> (adv.)

19.2 The Piel Binyan

19.2.1 The Forms of the Strong Verb in the Piel

The Piel is characterized by the gemination (doubling) of the second root consonant R₂.

SC	sg.	3 m.	כָּתַב
		3 f.	כָּתְבָהּ
		2 m.	כָּתְבְּתָּ
		2 f.	כָּתְבְּתִי
		1 c.	כָּתְבֵנִי
	pl.	3 c.	כָּתְבוּ
		2 m.	כָּתְבֵהֶם
		2 f.	כָּתְבֵנָהּ
		1 c.	כָּתְבוּנוּ
PC	sg.	3 m.	יִכְתֹּב
		3 f.	תִּכְתֹּב
		2 m.	תִּכְתֹּב
		2 f.	תִּכְתְּבִי
		1 c.	אִכְתֹּב
	pl.	3 m.	יִכְתְּבוּ
		3 f.	תִּכְתְּבֵנָהּ
		2 m.	תִּכְתְּבוּ
		2 f.	תִּכְתְּבֵנָהּ
		1 c.	נִכְתֹּב
Jussive	sg.	3 m.	יִכְתֹּב
<i>wayyiqtol</i>	sg.	3 m.	וַיִּכְתֹּב
Impv.	sg.	2 m.	כָּתַב
			כָּתְבָהּ
	pl.	2 f.	כָּתְבִי
		2 m.	כָּתְבוּ
		2 f.	כָּתְבֵנָהּ

Inf. cs.			פָּתַב
Inf. abs.			פָּתַב/פָּתַב
Part.	m.	sg.	מָּפַתַב
		pl.	מָּפַתַבִּים
	f.	sg.	מָּפַתַבָּה/מָּפַתַבָּה
		pl.	מָּפַתַבּוֹת

Notes

In the second syllable of 3 m. sg. suffix conjugation forms three different vowels are attested:

- *šere* is the most common vowel, e.g., בָּקֵשׁ Pi. *he sought* (in pausal forms one only finds *šere*).
- *pataḥ* is less common, e.g., קִדֵּשׁ Pi. *he sanctified*.
- *səgol* with the three verbs יָדַבֵּר Pi. *he spoke*, כָּבַשׁ Pi. *he washed* (clothes) and כָּפַר Pi. *he appeased, made atonement*.

In *wayyiqṭol* forms 3 m. sg./pl. the prefix consonant /y/ loses its gemination because of the vocal *šwa*, e.g., יָדַבֵּר and *he spoke*.

Geminate verbs have strong Piel forms with consonants in all three slots, e.g., קָלַל (SC) *he cursed* (2 Sam 19:22), לָקַל (inf. cs.) *to curse* (Josh 24:9).

If R_2 is a sibilant (i.e., ס, צ, ש and ש) or מ, נ, ק, י, and ל and requires a vocal *šwa*, the gemination of R_2 is frequently lost. The following examples illustrate this phenomenon:

suffix conj.	בָּקֵשׁוּ	3 m. pl.
prefix conj	תִּבְקֹשׁי	2 f. sg.
<i>wayyiqṭol</i>	וַיִּבְקֹשׁוּ	3 m. pl.
impv.	בִּקְשׁוּ	m. pl.
inf. cs.	לִבְקֹשִׁי	with enclitic pronoun
participle	מִבְקָשִׁים	m. pl.

The primitive form of the suffix conjugation form was possibly **kattaba*. In the 3 m. sg. form the vowel *šere* of the second syllable is due to analogy to the prefix conjugation form יִכְתֹּב.¹

The primitive form of the prefix conjugation form was **yukattib* > **yakattib* which developed to יִכְתֹּב in Tiberian Masoretic Hebrew. The same primitive vowels were present in the forms of imperative, the inf. cs. and participle.

19.2.2 The Meanings of Verbs in the Piel

Piel verbs have the following main meanings compared to the Qal:

- *Factitive*: The Piel verb expresses that a state is brought about: גָּדַל Q. *to be, become great*; גָּדַל Pi. *to make great*. The factitive meaning is the most common one.
- *Intensive*: The Piel verb expresses an intensified action compared to the Qal: שָׁבַר Q. *to break*; שָׁבַר Pi. *to shatter, break*. (Sometimes, the difference in meaning may be difficult to discern.)
- *Iterative*: A repeated action or an action that affects a number of objects is expressed: קָבַר Q. *to bury*; קָבַר Pi. *to bury many*.
- *Declarative-estimative*: The Piel verb expresses that the object is in a certain state: קָדַשׁ Qal *to be holy*; קָדַשׁ Pi. *to declare holy*. (JM § 52 d: “This may be subsumed under factitive in the sense that, whilst the factitive denotes the generation of a state or quality actually and physically, the declarative-estimative does so mentally or verbally.”)
- *Denominative*: The verb expresses an event that is derived from a noun: כָּהֵן *priest*; כָּהֵן Pi. *to serve as priest*. Denominative verbs in the Piel may have privative meaning: רָשָׁן *fat*; רָשָׁן Pi. *to take away, clear the fat ashes* (besides the meaning *to make fat*).
- *Without obvious Piel meaning*: With a number of verbs, the Piel seems to be used without a particular Piel meaning, e.g., אָרַשׁ Pi. *to betroth*, צִוָּה Pi. *to command*.

If the meaning of a verb in the Qal is known, these semantic categories should be considered for the translation of the verb in the Piel. A lexicon will help in further specifying the meaning.

¹ Alternatively the primitive vowel may have been *kittibu* > *kittib* > *kittēb* with the vowel change **i* > *a* in forms with consonantal suffix due to Philippi’s law (**i* > *a* in closed stressed syllable), e.g., *kittab̥tæm* כְּתִיבָתֶם.

19.2.3 Verbs with Gutturals or /r/ in the Piel Binyan

Verbs with Gutturals or /r/ as R₂

In Biblical Hebrew as it has been transmitted by the Masoretes, the guttural consonants א /ʔ/, ה /h/, ח /ħ/ and ע /ʕ/ and the consonant ר /r/ are not geminated. At earlier stages of the Hebrew language, however, they could be doubled, but this possibility was lost in stages over time. Depending on when it was lost, Hebrew did either tolerate short syllables in now open unstressed syllables after the loss of the gemination or lengthened the vowel in the now open syllable.

The following verbs with gutturals as R₂ preserve the short vowels /i/ or /a/:

- Almost always: verbs with ח /ħ/, e.g., רַחֲמֵיךָ *I have compassion on you*, יִרְחֶם *he will have compassion*
- Mostly: verbs with ה /h/, e.g., נְהַגְתָּ *you led*, יִנְהֶג *he will lead*
- Frequently: verbs with ע /ʕ/, e.g., בָּעַרְתִּי *I have removed*, יִבְעֵר *he will remove*

The following verbs with gutturals or ר /r/ lengthen the vowels /i/ and /a/ to /ē/ and /ā/, respectively:

- Always: verbs with ר /r/, e.g., בִּרְכֵתִי *I have blessed*, תִּבְרַךְ *you bless*
- Relatively frequently: verbs with א /ʔ/, e.g., מָאָן *he refused* (suffix conj.), בִּאֵר *he explained* (suffix conj.), but בִּאֵר (inf. abs.) and נִאָצַּר *they disregarded*

Where the strong verb without gutturals requires a vocal šwa with R₂ (forms with vocalic suffixes or participles with plural ending) verbs with a guttural as R₂ have *ḥaṭef pataḥ*, e.g., נִאָפְּרָה *she committed adultery* as opposed to דִּבְרָה *she spoke*.

When the vowel between R₁ and R₂ is lengthened, stress moves to the penultimate syllable in *wayyiqṭol* forms, e.g., וַיְבָרֶךְ *and he blessed*. This is limited to context forms; retraction of stress does not occur in pausal forms.

Verbs with Gutturals as R₁ or R₃

Verbs with gutturals as R₁ do not have different vowels than the regular strong verb.

When R₃ is a guttural (except with weak verbs III ʾ), the vowel /e/ is replaced with /a/ between R₂ and R₃ in forms of the suffix conjugation, the prefix conjugation and the imperative, e.g., שְׁלַח *he let go*, וַיִּשְׁלַח *and he sent out*. In

pausal forms, however, *šere* is used (with furtive *pataḥ*), e.g., יִשְׁלַח *he will set free*.

19.3 Left Dislocation of Clause Constituents

Left dislocation is the placement of a constituent outside and in front of the clause in which it is represented by a pronominal element, the so-called resumptive pronominal element. As a result, the dislocated constituent is separated from the clause. In the following example from Gen 3:12, the subject of the clause הָאִשָּׁה אֲשֶׁר נָתַתָּה עִמָּדִי is dislocated and taken up by the resumptive pronoun הִיא in the clause itself.

הָאִשָּׁה אֲשֶׁר נָתַתָּה עִמָּדִי *The woman that you put at my side – she gave*
הִיא נִתְּנָה-לִי מִן-הָעֵץ *me from the tree (Gen 3:12 Qere)*

The dislocated element can have any syntactic function. In Gen 3:12 it is the subject (see above). In the case of Gen 28:13 it is the direct object, whereas in 2 Kgs 1:6 it is a local complement.

הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר אַתָּה שֹׁכֵב עָלֶיהָ *The land you lie on – I will give it to you and*
לְךָ אֶתְנֶנָּה וּלְזֶרְעֶךָ *to your offspring (Gen 28:13)*
לְכֵן תִּמָּטָה אֲשֶׁר-עָלִיתָ שָׁם *Therefore, the bed you went up – you will not*
לֹא-תִרְדּוּ מִמֶּנָּה כִּי-מוֹת *go down from it for you will surely die (2 Kgs*
תָּמוּת *1:6)*

The dislocated element may be marked for its syntactic function in the clause itself even in its position before the clause. In Gen 13:15 the dislocated element is marked as direct object; in Gen 2:17 it is a prepositional phrase.

כִּי אֶת-כָּל-הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר-אַתָּה *For the entire land that you see – I will give*
רֹאֶה לְךָ אֶתְנֶנָּה וּלְזֶרְעֶךָ *it to you and to your offspring forever (Gen*
עַד-עוֹלָם *13:15)*
וּמֵעֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וָרָע לֹא *But from the tree of the knowledge of good*
תֹּאכַל מִמֶּנּוּ *and evil – you shall not eat from it (Gen*
 2:17)

The dislocated element may even be followed by a *wayyiqtol* form.

וּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הַיֹּשְׁבִים בְּעָרֵי
יְהוּדָה וַיִּמְלֹךְ עֲלֵיהֶם
רְחַבְעָם (1 Kgs 12:17) *And the Israelites that lived in the cities of
Juda – Rehabeam became king over them*

Left dislocation may occur in all sorts of clauses. In Ps 11:4 it is a nominal clause.

יְהוָה בַּשָּׁמַיִם כִּסְאוֹ *The Lord – his throne is in heaven* (Ps 11:4)

Left dislocation is used to mark the dislocated element as salient for the clause, usually as the topic about which the predication is made.

The traditional term for left dislocation is the Latin expression *casus pendens* because the dislocated element seems to be suspended in front of the clause. The English term *left dislocation* is based on the left-to-right writing direction of English or modern transliterations of languages; it does not agree with the writing direction of Hebrew.

19.4 Exercises

19.4.1 Translation of Verbal Forms

Translate the following verbal forms. Identify the gender (masc., fem., comm.) and number (sg., pl.) of forms of which the English translation is ambiguous (i.e., *you, they*). Mark the stressed syllable if stress is not on the last syllable.

1 דִּבְרַתְּ	2 תִּדְבֹּר	3 דִּבְרוּ	4 יִדְבְּרוּ	5 דִּבְרֹתִי	6 תִּדְבְּרוּן
7 מוֹתֵרֶתָן	8 אֲדַבֵּר	9 לְדַבֵּר	10 דִּבְרוּ	11 מְדַבֵּר	12 דִּבְרָנוּ
13 יִדְבֹר	14 לְמִדָּת	15 יִשְׁרֹתוּ	16 תִּדְבְּרֶנָּה	17 תִּתְבַּכְּכוּ	18 וַיִּדְבְּרוּ
19 וַיִּבְרָךְ	19 וַיִּבְרָךְ	19 וַיִּבְקְשׁוּ			

19.4.2 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: זִיר, מִכְמֶשׁ, שְׁמִשׁוֹן.

1 וַיִּשְׁמַע פְּרָעָה אֶת־הַדִּבָּר הַזֶּה וַיִּבְקֹשׁ לַהֲרֹג אֶת־מֹשֶׁה וַיִּבְרַח מֹשֶׁה מִפְּנֵי פְרָעָה
וַיָּשָׁב בְּאֶרֶץ־מִדְיָן וַיֵּשֶׁב עַל־הַבְּעָאֵר: 2 וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה בְּמִדְיָן לֵךְ שָׁב

מִצְרַיִם כִּי־מָתוּ כָּל־הָאֲנָשִׁים הַמִּבְקָשִׁים אֶת־נַפְשָׁם: 3 וַיֹּאמְרוּ אִישׁ אֶל־רֵעֵהוּ² מִי עָשָׂה הַדָּבָר הַזֶּה וַיִּדְרָשׁוּ וַיִּבְקָשׁוּ וַיֹּאמְרוּ גֵרְעוֹן בֶּן־יִזְיָאֵשׁ עָשָׂה הַדָּבָר הַזֶּה: 4 וַיָּקָם שְׂאוּל וַיֵּרֶד אֶל־מִדְבַּר־זִיף וְאֹתוֹ שְׁלֹשֶׁת־אֲלָפִים אִישׁ בַּחוּרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לְבַקֵּשׁ אֶת־דָּוִד בְּמִדְבַּר־זִיף: 5 וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים אֶל־אַבְרָהָם שְׂרִי אֲשֶׁתְּךָ לֹא־תִקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמָהּ שְׂרִי כִּי־³ שָׂרָה שְׁמָהּ: וַיִּבְרַכְתִּי אֹתָהּ וְגַם נָתַתִּי מִמֶּנָּה לָּךְ בֶּן וַיִּבְרַכְתִּיהָ וְהָיְתָה לְגוֹיִם מְלָכִי עַמִּים מִמֶּנָּה יִהְיוּ: 6 וַתֵּלֶד הָאִשָּׁה בֶּן וַתִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמוֹ שְׁמֻשׁוֹן וַיִּגְדֵּל הַנְּעָר וַיִּבְרַכְהוּ יְהוָה: 7 וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה לֵךְ אֶל־הָעָם וְקִדְשָׁתָם הַיּוֹם וּמָחָר וּכְבָּסוּ שְׂמֹלֹתָם: 8 וַיֵּרֶד מֹשֶׁה מִן־הָהָר אֶל־הָעָם וַיְקַדֵּשׁ אֶת־הָעָם וַיְכַבְּסוּ שְׂמֹלֹתָם: 9 וְאַחֵר בָּאוּ מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן וַיֹּאמְרוּ אֶל־פָּרְעֹה כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל שְׁלַח אֶת־עַמִּי וַיְחַגּוּ⁶ לִי בַּמִּדְבָּר: וַיֹּאמֶר פָּרְעֹה מִי יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר⁷ אֲשַׁמַּע בְּקִלּוֹ לְשַׁלַּח אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל לֹא יָדַעְתִּי אֶת־יְהוָה וְגַם אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל לֹא אֲשַׁלַּח: 10 וַיִּבְחַר־לוֹ שְׂאוּל שְׁלֹשֶׁת אֲלָפִים מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל וַיְהִיו עִם־שְׂאוּל אֲלָפִים בְּמַכְמֹשׁ וַיִּבְהַר בֵּית־אֵל וְאֶלֶף הָיוּ עִם־יֹנָתָן בְּגִבְעַת בְּנִימִין וַיִּתֵּר הָעָם שְׁלַח אִישׁ לְאַהֲלָיו:

19.5 Hebrew Reading: Genesis 12:1–3

Translate Gen 12:1–3 with the help of notes below the text.

¹ וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־אַבְרָם לֵךְ־לָךְ מֵאֶרֶץ וּמִמּוֹלֶדְתְּךָ וּמִבֵּית אָבִיךָ אֶל־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר אֲרָאךָ: ² וְאָעֲשֶׂה לְגוֹי גָּדוֹל וְאַבְרָכְךָ וְאַנְדֹּלָה שְׁמִי וְהָיָה בְרָכָה: ³ וְאַבְרָכָה מִבְּרָכֶיךָ וּמִקְלָלְךָ אֲאָר וְנִבְרָכוּ בְּךָ כָּל מְשֻׁפָּחֵת הָאָרֶץ:

- | | | |
|------|--------------|---|
| 12:1 | מוֹלֶדֶת | <i>relations, the relatives</i> |
| | אֲרָאךָ | <i>I will show you (1 c. sg. PC Hi. of רָאָה with enclitic pronoun 2 m. sg.)</i> |
| 12:3 | וְנִבְרָכּוּ | <i>It is preferable to interpret וְנִבְרָכּוּ as a reflexive verbal form, e.g., to ask blessings for oneself by mentioning someone blessed as an example of divine blessing</i> |

² אִישׁ אֶל־רֵעֵהוּ *one to another* (typical reciprocal use of אִישׁ and רֵעַ with plural verb forms).

³ כִּי *but* (following a negative)

⁴ שְׂמֹלָה *outer garment, cloak, mantle*

⁵ שְׂמֹלָה *outer garment, cloak, mantle*

⁶ חָגַג *to celebrate a pilgrim's feast*

⁷ אֲשֶׁר *here that* (introducing a consecutive clause)

19.6 Hebrew Reading: Genesis 13:8–13

Translate Gen 13:8–13 with the help of notes below the text. Names of persons and places are easily identifiable.

⁸ וַיֹּאמֶר אַבְרָם אֶל-לוֹט אֶל-נָא תְּהִי מְרִיבָה בֵּינִי וּבֵינֶיךָ וּבֵין רְעִי וּבֵין רְעִיךָ כִּי-אֲנָשִׁים אַחִים אָנֹכְנוּ: ⁹ הֲלֹא כָל-הָאָרֶץ לְפָנֶיךָ הִפָּרֵד נָא מֵעָלַי אִם-הַשְׂמָאל וְאִמְנָה וְאִם-הַיָּמִין וְאִשְׁמְאֵילָה: ¹⁰ וַיֵּשֶׁא-לוֹט אֶת-עֵינָיו וַיֵּרָא אֶת-כָּל-כֶּכֶר הַיַּרְדֵּן כִּי כָלָה מִשְׁקָה לְפָנָיו וְשַׁחַת יְהוָה אֶת-סֹדֶם וְאֶת-עֲמֹרָה כִּגְוֹן-יְהוָה בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם בְּאַכָּה צֹר: ¹¹ וַיִּבְחַר-לוֹ לוֹט אֶת כָּל-כֶּכֶר הַיַּרְדֵּן וַיֵּסַע לוֹט מִקְדָּם וַיִּפְרְדּוּ אִישׁ מֵעַל אָחִיו: ¹² אַבְרָם יָשָׁב בְּאֶרֶץ-כְּנָעַן וְלוֹט יָשָׁב בְּעָרֵי הַכְּפֹר וַיֵּאָהֵל עַד-סֹדֶם: ¹³ וְאֲנָשֵׁי סֹדֶם רָעִים וְחַטָּאִים לַיהוָה מְאֹד:

- 13:8 מְרִיבָה *quarrel*
- 13:9 פָּרַד *to divide, separate* (intransitive)
Ni.
אִמְנָה *let me go to the right* (1 c. sg. cohortative Hi. יָמֵן)
אִשְׁמְאֵילָה *let me go to the left* (1 c. sg. cohortative Hi. שְׂמָאל)
- 13:10 מִשְׁקָה *well watered*
גֵּן *garden* (geminate noun)
בְּאַכָּה *as far as* (petrified inf. cs. of בּוֹא with enclitic pronoun)
צֹר *Zoar*
- 13:11 מִקְדָּם *here to the east*
- 13:12 אָהַל *to obtain grazing rights (HALOT); traditionally to tent*
Qal (BDB)
- 13:13 חַטָּא *sinful, sinner*
Qal

Chapter 20

20.1 Vocabulary

20.1.1 Verbs

הלך	Q. <i>to go</i> ; Hitpa. <i>to walk; to walk about; to move to and fro</i>
הלל	Pi. <i>to praise</i> ; Hitpa. <i>to boast</i>
הפך	Q. <i>to turn; to overthrow; to change</i>
חזק	Q. <i>to be firm, strong</i> (stative verb, PC יִחַזֵּק, but SC חָזַק); Pi. <i>to make firm, strong; repair</i> ; Hi. <i>to seize, grasp; to keep hold of</i> ; Hitpa. <i>to show oneself courageous; to prove oneself strong</i>
טהר	Q. <i>to be clean</i> (stative verb, SC טָהַר, PC יִטְהַר); Pi. <i>to cleanse; to pronounce clean</i>
כבד	Q. <i>to be heavy; to be insensitive, dull; to be honored</i> (stative verb, SC כָּבַד, PC יִכְבֵּד); Pi. <i>to make honorable, honor</i> ; Ni. <i>to be honored, enjoy honor</i>
פלל	Hitpa. <i>to pray</i>
שבע	Q. <i>be sated, to eat one's fill, satisfy oneself with</i> (stative verb, SC pausal form שָׂבַעַי, PC יִשְׁבַּע) (with noun phrase)

20.1.2 Nouns

הַמּוֹן	<i>sound, murmur, roar; crowd; abundance</i>
זָכָר	<i>male (adj.)</i>
זְרוּעַ	<i>arm, forearm (fem.)</i>
חֵלֶב	<i>fat; best, choice part</i>
חָלַל	<i>slain, pierced</i>
כְּרוּב	<i>cherub</i>
מַלְכוּת	<i>royalty; royal power; reign; kingdom</i>

עֲצָה	<i>counsel, advice; plan</i>
פֶּאֶה	<i>corner; side</i>
פֶּשַׁע	<i>transgression, crime</i>
צוּר	<i>rock; rocky hill, mountain</i>
רָעָה	<i>evil; distress; misery; disaster, calamity</i> (f. sg. of the adj. רָע <i>evil, bad</i>)
שִׁיר	<i>song</i>
שֶׁקֶל	<i>weight; shekel</i> (measurement of weight; about 11 g)
תְּהִלָּה	<i>glory, praise; song of praise</i>
תַּפִּלָּה	<i>prayer</i>

20.1.3 Other Parts of Speech

בְּעַד	<i>behind; through, out of; round about; for the benefit of, for</i> (prep.; cs. st. בְּעֵד, with ePP בְּעֵדוֹ)
הִן	<i>behold</i> (points to the word it precedes; cf. הִנֵּה); <i>if</i> (conditional conj.); <i>if</i> (for indirect questions)
כֵּן	<i>here, at this place; to here</i> (adv.)
כֵּן	<i>so that not, lest</i> (conj.)

20.2 The Pual and Hitpael Binyanim

20.2.1 The Forms of the Strong Verb in the Pual and Hitpael

The Pual and the Hitpael are the passive and the reflexive counterparts of the Piel. As the Piel, the Pual and the Hitpael are characterized by the gemination (doubling) of the second root consonant.

As a passive form, the Pual is marked by the vowel sequence *u-a*, e.g., נִתְּצָה *it was torn down* (Judg 6:26), וְכִבֵּשׁ *and it shall be washed* (Lev 15:17) (except in forms with vocal *šwa* with the second root consonant due to suffixation).

The Hitpael as a reflexive form is marked by a prefixed /t/ before the first root consonant.

20.2 The Pual and Hitpael Binyanim

			Pual	Hitpael
SC	sg.	3 m.	כָּתַב	הִתְכַּתֵּב
		3 f.	כָּתְבָה	הִתְכַּתְּבָה
		2 m.	כָּתְבָתָּ	הִתְכַּתְּבָתָּ
		2 f.	כָּתְבָתְּ	הִתְכַּתְּבְּתְּ
		1 c.	כָּתְבָתִּי	הִתְכַּתְּבִּיתִי
	pl.	3 c.	כָּתְבוּ	הִתְכַּתְּבוּ
		2 m.	כָּתְבוּם	הִתְכַּתְּבוּם
		2 f.	כָּתְבוּן	הִתְכַּתְּבוּן
		1 c.	כָּתְבוּנִי	הִתְכַּתְּבוּנִי
PC	sg.	3 m.	יָכַתַּב	יִתְכַּתֵּב
		3 f.	תָּכַתְּבָה	תִּתְכַּתֵּב
		2 m.	תָּכַתְּבָתָּ	תִּתְכַּתֵּב
		2 f.	תָּכַתְּבִי	תִּתְכַּתְּבִי
		1 c.	אָכַתְּבָה	אִתְכַּתֵּב
	pl.	3 m.	יָכְתְּבוּ	יִתְכַּתְּבוּ
		3 f.	תִּכְתְּבֶנָּה	תִּתְכַּתְּבֶנָּה
		2 m.	תִּכְתְּבוּ	תִּתְכַּתְּבוּ
		2 f.	תִּכְתְּבֶנָּה	תִּתְכַּתְּבֶנָּה
		1 c.	נִכְתְּבָה	נִתְכַּתֵּב
Jussive	sg.	3 m.	יָכַתַּב	יִתְכַּתֵּב
<i>wayyiqtol</i>	sg.	3 m.	וַיִּכְתֹּב	וַיִּתְכַּתֵּב
Impv.	sg.	2 m.		הִתְכַּתֵּב
				הִתְכַּתְּבָה
		2 f.		הִתְכַּתְּבִי
	pl.	2 m.		הִתְכַּתְּבוּ
Inf. cs.				הִתְכַּתֵּב
Inf. abs.				הִתְכַּתֵּב

			Pual	Hitpael
Part.	m.	sg.	מִכְתָּב	מִתְכַּתֵּב
		pl.	מִכְתָּבִים	מִתְכַּתְּבִים
	f.	sg.	מִכְתָּבַת	מִתְכַּתֶּבֶת
			מִכְתָּבָה	מִתְכַּתְּבָה
		pl.	מִכְתָּבוֹת	מִתְכַּתְּבוֹת

Notes Pertaining to Pual Forms

In *wayyiqṭol* forms 3 m. sg./pl. the prefix consonant /y/ loses its gemination because of the *dageš forte*, e.g., וַיִּבְקֹשׁ and [the matter] was investigated (Esth 2:32).

Pual imperative forms are not attested in Biblical Hebrew. The only attestation of an infinitive is עֲנוּתוֹ (inf. cs. with enclitic pronoun) *his being afflicted* in Ps 132:1 (from the verb עָנָה Pu. *to be afflicted*; Pi. *to humble, mishandle, afflict*).

As in the Piel, gemination of the second root consonant may be lost in certain consonants with vocal *šwa*. In Biblical Hebrew only three forms can be found: תִּבְקֹשׁ (PC 2 f. sg. Ezek 26:21), מִחְלִי (part. m. pl. cs. st. Ezek 32:26), מִקְצֹעַת (part. f. pl. cs. st. Exod 26:23; 36:28).

In pausal forms, the *pataḥ* is lengthened to *qameṣ*, e.g., שָׁלַח *he was sent* (Obad 1:1). Forms with vocal *šwa* with the second root consonant in the context forms have the original vowel /a/ as a *qameṣ*, e.g., חִבְּשָׁה *it was bound up* (Isa 1:6).

Geminate verbs have strong Pual forms with consonants in all three slots, e.g., יִקְלָל *he shall be considered cursed* (Isa 65:20; pausal form).

Notes pertaining to Hitpael Forms

As in the Piel, gemination of R₂ may be lost in forms with certain consonants as R₂ with vocal *šwa*, e.g., יִתְהַלְלוּ *they shall boast*, הַלְלוּ-יְיָ *Praise Yah!*.¹ Preservation of the gemination, however, appears to be frequent.

Seven verbs have the vowel /a/ as thematic vowel between R₂ and R₃, e.g., הִתְאַפַּךְ *he became angry* (so-called Hitpaal; cf. JM § 53 b).

Pausal forms have /a/ in intermediate pause and /ā/ in major pause instead of the /ē/ of the context forms, e.g., יִתְיַצֵּב and יִתְיַצֵּב.

¹In the Piel, this occurs with sibilants (i.e., ס, צ, ש and שׁ) or the consonants מ, נ, ק, י, and ל as R₂.

20.2.2 Hitpael Forms with Sibilants and Dentals as R₁

When R₁ is a sibilant, i.e., ס, צ, ש or שׁ, the prefix /t/ and the sibilant change position (*metathesis*), e.g., *mitsattēr > mistattēr מִסְתַּתֵּר [he is] *hiding himself* (1 Sam 23:19), wāʾəṣṣammārā > wāʾəštammārā וָאֶשְׁתַּמַּרְתִּי *and I kept myself* (2 Sam 22:24).

In the case of the emphatic sibilant ז as R₁, the /t/ of the prefix and R₁ do not only change position but the /t/ is assimilated to the emphatic sibilant ז becoming emphatic itself (/t/ > /ṭ/), e.g., *hiṣṣayyadnū > *hiṣṭayyadnū הִצִּטַּיְידְנוּ *we took [something] as provision with us* (Josh 9:12), הֵצִטְּנוּ *how shall we justify ourselves?* (Gen 44:16; pausal form).

In the case of the root זכח total assimilation of the prefix /t/ is attested: *hitzakkû > *hiztakkû > *hizdakkû > hizzakkû הִזְכּוּ *make yourselves clean* (Isa 1:16; the only example of this in the Hebrew Bible).

With dentals, the prefix /t/ of the Hitpael is usually assimilated to the dental R₁ of the root, e.g., *mitdabbēr > middabbēr מִדַּבֵּר *someone speaking* (Num 7:89), *hiṭṭaharnū > hiṭṭaharnū הִטְהַרְנוּ *we have cleansed ourselves* (Josh 22:17).

With /t/ as R₁, only one ת is written, e.g., הִתַּמַּם *tittammām you deal with integrity with [the blameless]* (2 Sam 22:26 par. Ps 18:26).

Assimilation of the /t/ to a following /n/ or even /k/ is attested, as well.

20.2.3 Verbs with Gutturals or /r/ in the Pual and Hitpael Binyanim

Verbs with Gutturals or /r/ as R₂

In the same way as in the Piel, the short vowel before R₂ may either be preserved despite being in an open unstressed syllable or it is lengthened /a/ > /ā/. The same tendencies for the preservation of the short vowel or the lengthening of the vowel can be observed in the Pual and the Hitpael (cf. Chapter 19). The following examples illustrate this:

With preservation of /a/ as a short vowel:

- suffix conj.: רָחַצַּת
- prefix conj.: יִרְחֹם
- inf. cs.: לְהִתְנַחֵם, הִתְנַחֵל
- imperative: הִטְהַרְוּ (m. pl., verb טהר)
- participle: מִתְנַחֵם (m. sg.)

Note

In pausal forms, the vowel /a/ between R₁ and R₂ may change to /æ/ because

of the *qameṣ* with the guttural as R₂, e.g., יִתְנַחֵם, יִהְיֶה רִי (compare the similar vowel change with the definite article and the interrogative He).

With lengthening of the short vowel to /ā/:

- suffix conj.: מַעֲכֹי (3 c. pl.), יִהְיֶה רִי (3 m. pl. with waw cons.)
- prefix conj.: יִנְעֲשׂוּ (3 m. pl.), יִתְפַּאֵר (3 m. sg.)
- wayyiqtol: וַיִּתְנַעֲשׂוּ (3 m. pl.)
- participle: מִתְפַּאֵר (m. sg.)

Where the strong verb without gutturals requires a vocal *šwa* with R₂, verbs with a guttural as R₂ have *ḥatef pataḥ*, e.g., וַיִּתְנַעֲשׂוּ.

Verbs with a guttural as R₁ do not have forms that deviate from the strong verb without gutturals.

In verbs with the gutturals ה, ח and ע as R₃ the vowel /ē/ between R₂ and R₃ is usually replaced by /a/, e.g., יִתְנַחֵם *he will engage in thrusting with someone*. In the inf. cs. and the participle the /ē/ may be preserved and a furtive *pataḥ* is inserted, e.g., הַשְׁתַּנַּע, מִשְׁתַּנַּע *someone behaving like a mad man*.

20.3 Accents (Part II)

The accents of the Masoretic Text were already briefly introduced in chapter 15. Here all the accents of the two accentuation systems for the three poetic books Psalms, Job, Proverbs (mnemonic word אָמַת for תְּהִלִּים, מִשְׁלֵי, וּפְסָלִים *Job, Proverbs, Psalms*) and the other 21 books are presented. It is not necessary to memorize the names and functions – conjunctive or disjunctive – of all the accents. The following tables help to identify accents and their functions.

Disjunctive Accents in the 21 Books

יְכַרְכֵּן :	<i>silluq</i> (always with : <i>sof pasuq</i>)
יְכַרְכֵּן	<i>atnah</i>
יְכַרְכֵּן	<i>segolta</i> (postpositive)
יְכַרְכֵּן	<i>šalšelet</i> (with the divider <i>paseq</i>)
יְכַרְכֵּן	<i>zaqef qaton</i>
יְכַרְכֵּן	<i>zaqef gadol</i>

תִּפְחָה	<i>tiḥa</i>
רַבִּיָּה	<i>rəḥia</i> ^c
זַרְקָה	<i>zarqa</i> (postpositive)
פַּשְׁטָה/פַּשְׁטָה	<i>pašta</i> (postpositive)
יָתִיב	<i>yətib</i> (prepositive)
תַּבִּיר	<i>təbir</i>
גֵּרֶשׁ	<i>gereš</i>
גֵּרְשָׁיִם	<i>geršayim</i>
פַּזֵּר	<i>pazer</i>
פַּזֵּר גָּדוֹל	<i>pazer gadol</i> or <i>qarne p̄ara</i>
תַּלִּישׁ גְּדוֹלָה	<i>təliša gədola</i> (prepositive)
לַגֶּרְמֶה	<i>lagarme</i> (with the divider <i>paseq</i>)

Conjunctive Accents in the 21 Books

מִנַּח	<i>munah</i>
מַחֲפָק	<i>məhuppak</i>
מֶרֶקָה	<i>merəka</i>
מֶרֶקָה קַפּוּלָה	<i>merəka kəpula</i>
דַּרְגָּה	<i>darga</i>
אַזְלָה	<i>azla</i>
תַּלִּישׁ קֶטַנָּה	<i>təliša qətanna</i> (postpositive)
גַּלְגַּל	<i>galgal</i> or <i>yeraḥ</i>
מַיְאֵלָה	<i>mayəla</i>

Note

The accent *mayəla* מַיְאֵלָה looks like *tiḥa* תִּפְחָה. It is used to mark secondary stress in words or groups with *silluq* or *atnaḥ*.

Disjunctive Accents in the Three Poetic Books

שִׁלּוּק :	<i>silluq</i> (always with : <i>Sof pasuq</i>)
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וַיָּבֹרֶךְ	‘ole wəyored
וַיִּבְרַח	atnaḥ
וַיִּבְרַח	rəḥia‘ gadol
וַיִּבְרַח	rəḥia‘ mugraš
וַיִּבְרַח	šalšelet gədola (with the divider paseq)
וַיִּבְרַח	šinnor or zarqa (postpositive)
וַיִּבְרַח	rəḥia‘ qatan (if followed by ‘ole wəyored)
וַיִּבְרַח	dəhi (prepositive)
וַיִּבְרַח	pazer qatan
וַיִּבְרַח	məhuppak ləgarne
וַיִּבְרַח	azla ləgarne

Conjunctive Accents in the Three Poetic Books

וַיִּבְרַח	munah
וַיִּבְרַח	merəka
וַיִּבְרַח	‘illuy
וַיִּבְרַח	tarḥa
וַיִּבְרַח	galgal or yeraḥ
וַיִּבְרַח	məhuppak
וַיִּבְרַח	azla
וַיִּבְרַח	šalšelet qətanna
וַיִּבְרַח/וַיִּבְרַח	šinnorit

Note

The accent *šinnorit* is used on open syllables before *merəka* or *məhuppak*.

20.4 Exercises

20.4.1 Translation of Verbal Forms

Translate the following verbal forms. Identify the gender (masc., fem., comm.) and number (sg., pl.) of forms of which the English translation is ambiguous (i.e., *you*, *they*). Mark the stressed syllable if stress is not on the last syllable.

- 1 שלחו 2 תברך 3 יבקש 4 תבקשי 5 ישלח 6 תקלל 7 התהלך
 8 התהלכתי 9 התהלכנו 10 התהלכו 11 ניתהלכו 12 יתפלל
 13 יתפלל 14 התפללתי 15 התקדשו

20.4.2 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: אֲזִיָּהוּ, אֲזִיבָל, אֲמִינוֹן, תָּמָר, עֲזַרְיָהוּ, נָבוֹת, מִצְפָּה, חֲנוּךְ.

- 1 יְהִי שֵׁם יְהוָה מְבָרָךְ מְעַתָּה וְעַד-עוֹלָם: 2 וַיָּבֹא [אֲזִיָּהוּ הַמֶּלֶךְ] אֶל-הִיכָל יְהוָה לְהִקְטִיר עַל-מִזְבֵּחַ הַקָּטָרֶת: וַיָּבֹא אַחֲרָיו עֲזַרְיָהוּ הַכֹּהֵן וְעַמּוֹ כֹּהֲנִים. לִיהוָה שְׂמוֹנִים בְּנֵי-חֵיל: וַיַּעֲמֵדוּ עַל-עֲזַרְיָהוּ הַמֶּלֶךְ וַיֹּאמְרוּ לוֹ לֹא-לָךְ עֲזַרְיָהוּ לְהִקְטִיר לִיהוָה כִּי לַכֹּהֲנִים בְּנֵי-אֹהֶרֶן הַמִּקְדָּשִׁים לְהִקְטִיר צָא מִן-הַמִּקְדָּשׁ כִּי מַעֲלָתָ² 3 וַיִּשְׁלְחוּ אֶל-אִיזָבֵל לֵאמֹר סֵקֶל³ נָבוֹת וַיָּמָת: וַיְהִי כִשְׁמַע אִיזָבֵל כִּי-סֵקֶל נָבוֹת וַיָּמָת וַתֹּאמֶר אִיזָבֵל אֶל-אַחְאָב קוּם רָשׁ אֶת-כָּרֶם יְהוָה הַיִּזְרְעָאֵלִי אֲשֶׁר מֵאֵן לְתַת־לָךְ בְּכֶסֶף כִּי אֵין נָבוֹת חַי כִּי-מָת: וַיְהִי כִשְׁמַע אַחְאָב כִּי מָת נָבוֹת וַיִּקֶּם אַחְאָב לְהָרִיד אֶת-כָּרֶם נָבוֹת הַיִּזְרְעָאֵלִי לְרִשְׁתּוֹ: 4 וַבֹּאֲהֶרֶן הַתַּאֲנִף⁴ יְהוָה מֵאֵד לְהַשְׁמִידוֹ וַאֲתַפְּלֵל גַּם-בְּעַד אֹהֶרֶן בַּעַת הַהִיא 5 הַתְּחִזְקוּ וְהָיוּ לְאֲנָשִׁים פְּלִשְׁתִּים⁵ 6 פֶּן תַּעֲבֹדוּ לְעִבְרִים כַּאֲשֶׁר עָבְדוּ לָכֶם וְהָיִיתֶם לְאֲנָשִׁים וְנִלְחַמְתֶּם: 6 וַיֹּאמֶר שְׁמוּאֵל קִבְּצוּ אֶת-כָּל-שְׂרָאֵל הַמִּצְפָּתָה וַאֲתַפְּלֵל בַּעֲדָכֶם אֶל-יְהוָה: 7 וַיֹּאמְרוּ כָל-הָעָם אֶל-שְׁמוּאֵל הַתַּפְּלֵל בְּעַד-עֲבָרֶיךָ אֶל-יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ וְאֶל-נָמוֹת כִּי-יִסְפְּנוּ⁶ עַל-כָּל-חַטֹּאתֵינוּ רָעָה לִשְׂאֵל לָנוּ מֶלֶךְ: 8 וַיַּתְּפֵל אֱלִישֶׁעַ וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה פָּקַח-נָא⁷ אֶת-עֵינָיו וַיִּרְאֵה וַיַּפְקַח יְהוָה אֶת-עֵינָיו הַזֶּעֶר וַיֵּרָא וַהֲגֵה הָהָר מֵלֹא סוּסִים וּרְכָב אֵשׁ סָבִיבֶת אֱלִישֶׁעַ: 9 וַיָּגֶשׁ הַנָּבִיא אֶל-מֶלֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ לֵךְ הַתְּחִזֵּק וְדַע וַיִּרְאֵה אֶת אֲשֶׁר-תַּעֲשֶׂה כִּי לְתִשׁוּבָתָ⁸ הַשָּׁנָה מֶלֶךְ אֲרָם עָלָה עֲלֶיךָ: 10 וַיַּתְּפֵל חֲזָקִיהוּ לִפְנֵי יְהוָה וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל יֵשֶׁב הַכּוֹרֵבִים אַתָּה-הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים לְבַדְּךָ לְכָל מַמְלָכוֹת הָאָרֶץ אַתָּה עֹשִׂיתָ אֶת-הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֶת-הָאָרֶץ: 11 וַיַּתְּהַלֵּךְ חֲנוּךְ אֶת-הָאֱלֹהִים וַאֲיָנָנוּ

² מעל Q. to be untrue, violate one's legal obligation

³ סקל Q. to stone; Pu. to be stoned

⁴ אנף Hitpa. to be, become angry

⁵ פלשתיים vocative (direct address)

⁶ יסף Q. to add

⁷ פקח Q. to open

⁸ תשובה return (noun)

כִּי־לָקַח אֹתוֹ אֱלֹהִים: 12 וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלָיָה אֲבִשְׁלוֹם אָחִיָּה הָאֲמִינֹן⁹ אָחִיָּה הִנֵּה עִמָּךְ
וְעָתָה אָחִיָּה הַחֲרִישִׁי¹⁰ אָחִיָּה הוּא אֶל־תִּשְׁתִּי אֶת־לִבְךָ לְדַבֵּר הַזֶּה וּתֵשֵׁב תֹּמַר
וְשִׁמְמוֹה בֵּית אֲבִשְׁלוֹם אָחִיָּה:

20.5 Hebrew Reading: Genesis 13:14–18

Translate Gen 13:14–18 with the help of notes below the text. Names of persons and places are easily identifiable.

14 וַיְהִי־הָאָמֶר אֶל־אַבְרָם אַחֲרֵי הַפָּרֶד־לוֹט מֵעֲמֹז שָׂא נָא עֵינֶיךָ וּרְאֵה מִן־הַמָּקוֹם
אֲשֶׁר־אַתָּה שָׂם צִפְנָה וְנִגְבָּה וְקָדְמָה וַיִּמָּנֶה: 15 כִּי אֶת־כָּל־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר־אַתָּה רֹאֶה
לִךְ אֶתְנַנָּה וּלְזֶרְעֶךָ עַד־עוֹלָם: 16 וְשִׁמְתִּי אֶת־זֶרְעֶךָ כְּעֶפֶר הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר ׀ אִם־יֻכַּל
אִישׁ לְמָנוֹת אֶת־עֶפֶר הָאָרֶץ גַּם־זֶרְעֶךָ יִמָּנֶה: 17 קוֹם הִתְהַלֵּךְ בָּאָרֶץ לְאַרְבָּעָה
וּלְרִחְבָּהּ כִּי לִךְ אֶתְנַנָּה 18 וַיֹּאחֲזֵל אַבְרָם וַיָּבֹא וַיֵּשֶׁב בְּאֵלְנֵי מַמְרֵא אֲשֶׁר בְּחֶבְרוֹן
וַיְבִין־שָׁם מִזְבֵּחַ לַיהוָה:

13:14	פרד	Ni. <i>to divide, separate</i> (intrans.)
13:16	אשר	here <i>so that</i>
	מנה	Q. <i>to count, number</i>
	ימנה	<i>it will be counted</i> (Ni. of מנה)
13:18	אהל	<i>to obtain grazing rights (HALOT); traditionally to tent</i> (BDB)
	אלון	<i>tall tree, terebinth</i>
	ממרא	place name <i>Mamre</i>

⁹ אמינון This form of the name אמינון is found only here in 2 Sam 13:20.

¹⁰ חרש Hi. *to be silent*

Chapter 21

21.1 Vocabulary

21.1.1 Verbs

נבט	Hi. <i>to look</i>
נגד	Hi. <i>to tell, inform, report</i>
נחל	Q. <i>to get a possession; to take a possession; to inherit</i>
נחם	Ni. <i>to regret; to be sorry; to console oneself</i> ; Pi. <i>to comfort</i>
נצב	Ni. <i>to take one's stand, to stand</i>
נצל	Hi. <i>to take away, snatch away; to rescue; to deliver from</i>
נשג	Hi. <i>to reach; to overtake</i>
קנה	Q. <i>to buy; to acquire; to create</i>

21.1.2 Nouns

און	<i>disaster; sin, injustice; deception, nothingness; idolatry</i>
ברזל	<i>iron</i>
היכל	<i>palace; temple</i>
חמס	<i>violence, wrong</i>
מזרח	<i>sunrise; east</i>
מקדש	<i>sacred place, sanctuary</i>
קיר	<i>wall</i> (pl. קירות)
קץ	<i>end</i> (gem. noun; with ePP קצו)
קרבן	<i>offering, gift</i> (only in Lev, Num, Ezek)
קרוב	<i>near</i>
קרן	<i>horn</i>
שלחן	<i>table</i>

שָׁלַל *spoil, plunder, booty*

21.1.3 Other Parts of Speech

יֵעַן אֲשֶׁר, יֵעַן *because*

עַל אֲשֶׁר *because*

21.2 Verbs I *n* and Verbs I *ʾ*: Derived Binyanim

21.2.1 General Overview of the Forms of Verbs I *n*

When the first root consonant /n/ is immediately followed by the second root consonant, the /n/ is assimilated to the following consonant. The result are weak forms. In the Qal, this could be observed in the forms of the prefix conjugation. The assimilation of the first root consonant /n/ happens in the Niphal in the suffix conjugation and the participle. In the Hiphil and Hophal it happens in *all* forms. The Piel, Pual and Hitpael forms of I *n* verbs are always strong as the first root consonant /n/ is never immediately followed by a consonant.

			Niphal	Hiphil	Hophal
			נָגַף	נָגַד	נָגַד
SC	sg.	3 m.	נָגַף	הִנָּדִי	הִנָּדֵה
		3 f.	נָגְפָה	הִנָּדִיָּה	הִנָּדֵהָ
		2 m.	נָגַפְתָּ	הִנָּדַתָּ	הִנָּדַתָּ
		2 f.	נָגַפְתְּ	הִנָּדַתְּ	הִנָּדַתְּ
		1 c.	נָגַפְתִּי	הִנָּדַתִּי	הִנָּדַתִּי
	pl.	3 c.	נָגְפוּ	הִנָּדִיּוּ	הִנָּדִיּוּ
		2 m.	נָגַפְתֶּם	הִנָּדַתֶּם	הִנָּדַתֶּם
		2 f.	נָגַפְתֶּן	הִנָּדַתֶּן	הִנָּדַתֶּן
		1 c.	נָגַפְנוּ	הִנָּדַתְנוּ	הִנָּדַתְנוּ

21.2 Verbs I n and Verbs I ך: Derived Binyanim

			Niphal	Hiphil	Hophal
			נִגַּף	נָגַד	נָגַד
PC	sg.	3 m.	יִנָּגֵף	יְנַיֵּד	יִנָּד
		3 f.	תִּנָּגֵף	תַּנְיִד	תִּנָּד
		2 m.	תִּנָּגְךָ	תַּנְיִדְךָ	תִּנָּדְךָ
		2 f.	תִּנָּגְפִי	תַּנְיִדִּי	תִּנָּדִי
		1 c.	אִנָּגֵף	אֶנְיִד	אִנָּד
	pl.	3 c.	יִנָּגְפוּ	יְנַיִדוּ	יִנָּדוּ
		3 f.	תִּנָּגְפֶנָּה	תַּנְיִדְנָה	תִּנָּדְנָה
		2 m.	תִּנָּגְבוּ	תַּנְיִדוּ	תִּנָּדוּ
		2 f.	תִּנָּגְפֶנָּה	תַּנְיִדְנָה	תִּנָּדְנָה
		1 c.	נִנָּגֵף	נָנַד	נָנַד
Jussive	sg.	3 m.	יִנָּגֵף	יִנָּד	יִנָּד
wayyiqtol	sg.	3 m.	וַיִּנָּגֵף	וַיִּנָּד	וַיִּנָּד
Impv.	sg.	m.	הִנָּגֵף	הַנְיִד	
		f.	הִנָּגִפִּי	הַנְיִדִּי	
	pl.	m.	הִנָּגְבוּ	הַנְיִדוּ	
		f.	הִנָּגְפֶנָּה	הַנְיִדְנָה	
Inf. cs.			הִנָּגֵף	הַנְיִד	הִנָּד
Inf. abs.			הִנָּזֵר	הַנְד	הִנָּד
			נִגּוֹף		
Part.	sg.	m.	נִגָּף	מִנָּיִד	מִנָּד
		f.	נִגָּפֶת	מִנָּיִדַת	מִנָּדַת
	pl.	m.	נִגָּפִים	מִנָּיִדִים	מִנָּדִים
		f.	נִגָּפּוֹת	מִנָּיִדוֹת	מִנָּדוֹת

Notes

The endings marking person, gender and number are the same as the endings of the corresponding forms of the strong verb including the reduction of vowels.

In the suffix conjugation and participle forms of the Niphal, the first root consonant /n/ is assimilated to the second root consonant: *ningaṗ* > *niggaṗ* נִגְּאָה.

In the prefix conjugation, the /n/ infix of the Niphal merges with the first root consonant: *yin-nāgēṗ* יִנְּגְּאָה.

As with the strong verb, a prosthetic /h/ is added to the form to preserve the structure of the imperative and infinitives in the Niphal.

For the Niphal infinitive absolute only forms that are attested in the Hebrew Bible are mentioned.

In all forms of the Hiphil, the first root consonant /n/ closes the prefix syllable and is assimilated to the second root consonant: **hingida* > **higgid* > *higgīd* הִגְּיֵד.

In the Hophal, the first root consonant /n/ is assimilated to the second root consonant, e.g., **hungad* > *huggad* הֻגְּגַד. The prefix vowel is always /u/.

21.2.2 Verbs I n and II Guttural: Derived Binyanim

In the Niphal, the /n/ of the root is assimilated to the second root consonant. The result are weak forms, e.g., *ninḥam* > *niḥḥam* > *niḥam* (with loss of the gemination and preservation of the vowel /i/).

In the Hiphil, however, the /n/ is not assimilated to the second root consonant resulting in strong forms.

The forms of the verbs נחם and נחל in the following table illustrate this.

			Niphal	Hiphil	Hophal
SC	sg.	3 m.	נָחַם		
		1 c.	נָחַמְתִּי	הִנְחַלְתִּי	הֻנְחַלְתִּי
PC	sg.	3 m.	יִנְחֶם	יִנְחִיל	
		wayyiqtol	וַיִּנְחֶם		
Inf. cs.			הִנְחֶם	הִנְחִיל	
Part.		m. sg.	נָחֵם	מִנְחִיל	

21.2.3 Verb I ʾ: Exceptional Forms in the Derived Binyanim

The forms of I ʾ verbs in the Piel, Pual and Hitpael are always strong. In the Niphal, Hiphil and Hophal binyanim they are usually strong displaying only the

regular vowel changes of guttural verbs, e.g. PC Ni. יֵאָכַל *it will be eaten* with loss of the gemination (cf. יִכָּתֵב). In rare cases, exceptions to this occur with forms with quiescent א. The following examples illustrate this:

- Niphal: נִאָּחֲזוּ *they have settled* (Josh 22:9) and וְנִאָּחֲזוּ *and they will settle* (Num 32:30); cp. the strong form נִאָּחֲזָה *it was caught* (Gen 22:13)
- Hiphil: אֲבִידָה *let me destroy* (verb אָבַד; Jer 46:8); cp. the strong form וְהָאָבַדְתָּ *and you shall destroy* (Deut 7:24)

21.3 Causal Constructions

Causal constructions indicate the cause of or the reason for a state of affairs. They can be expressed as subordinate clauses or as prepositional phrases.

Frequently used causal conjunctions in Biblical Hebrew are: כִּי *because, for*, יַעַן אֲשֶׁר *because*, עַל אֲשֶׁר *because*. The causal subordinate clause may precede the main clause (Gen 3:14; 1 Kgs 20:28) or it may follow it (Gen 5:24; Exod 32:35).

כִּי עָשִׂיתָ זֹאת אָרוּר אַתָּה מִכָּל-הַבְּהֵמָה וּמִכָּל חַיַּת הַשָּׂדֶה	<i>Because you have done this, you are cursed among all the cattle and all the animals of the field</i> (Gen 3:14)
וַיִּתְהַלֵּךְ חֲנוּךְ אֶת-הָאֱלֹהִים וַאֲיָנֵנוּ כִּי-לָקַח אֱתָנוּ אֱלֹהִים	<i>Enoch walked with God and he was no more because God had taken him</i> (Gen 5:24)
כֹּה-אָמַר יְהוָה יַעַן אֲשֶׁר אָמְרוּ אַרְמֵי אֱלֹהֵי הָרִים יְהוָה וְלֹא-אֱלֹהֵי עֲמָקִים הוּא וְנִתַּתִּי אֶת-כָּל-הַתְּמוֹן תְּהוֹל הַזֶּה בְּיָדְךָ וַיִּדְעֻם כִּי-אֲנִי יְהוָה	<i>Thus says the Lord: Because the Arameans said that the Lord is a god of mountains and not a god of plains, I will give this entire great multitude in your hand so that you know that I am the Lord</i> (1 Kgs 20:28)
וַיִּגַּף יְהוָה אֶת-הָעָם עַל אֲשֶׁר עָשׂוּ אֶת-הָעֵגֹל אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה אַהֲרֹן	<i>The Lord struck the people because they had made the calf that Aaron had made</i> (Exod 32:35)

Infrequent causal prepositions are: מֵאֲשֶׁר, בְּאֲשֶׁר, אֲשֶׁר, עַל-דָּבָר, יַעַן כִּי, מֵאֲשֶׁר, בְּאֲשֶׁר, אֲשֶׁר. תַּחַת אֲשֶׁר and עַקֵּב כִּי, עַקֵּב אֲשֶׁר, עַקֵּב, עַל כִּי, אֲשֶׁר.

The following prepositions are frequently used with causal meaning:

- בְּ *because of*, e.g., בְּצִדְקָתִי *because of my righteousness* (Deut 9:4),
בְּחַטָּאוֹ *because of his [own] sin* (Deut 24:16)
- לְמַעַן *because of, for the sake of, on account of*, e.g., לְמַעַן יָדוּר עַבְדִּי *because of David, my servant, and*
לְמַעַן יְרוּשָׁלַם אֲשֶׁר בָּחַרְתִּי *because of Jerusalem that I have chosen* (1 Kgs 11:13), לְמַעַן
לְמַעַן בֵּית־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ *for the sake of the house of the Lord our God*
(Ps 122:9)
- מִן *because of*, e.g., מִן־מַרְאֵה עֵינֶיךָ אֲשֶׁר תִּרְאֶה lit. *because of the*
sight of your eyes that you will see (Deut 28:34), מִרְעַת יֹשְׁבֵי־בָהּ *because of the evil of those who dwell in it* (Jer 12:4)
- מִפְּנֵי *because of*, e.g., מִפְּנֵי הָרָעָב *because of the famine* (Gen 47:13),
מִפְּנֵי רָעַת עַמִּי יִשְׂרָאֵל *because the evil of my people Israel* (Jer
7:12)
- עַל *because of*, e.g., עַל־כָּל־הָרָעָה אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה *because of all the*
evil that [the people] has done (Deut 31:18), עַל־הַשְׁבוּעָה *because of the oath that we swore to them*
(Josh 9:20)

21.4 Impersonal Constructions (Vague Subject)

The vague subject (as *one* in the English clause *One never knows*) is used when the identification of the agent of the action is impossible or irrelevant. In Biblical Hebrew, the vague subject is expressed often by 3 c./m. pl. verbal forms (2 Sam 19:9), 3 m. sg. verbal forms (Num 35:30) or passive verbal forms (Gen 27:42). In English, passive verbal forms are often employed to translate these impersonal constructions.

- וּלְכָל־הָעָם הִגִּידוּ לֵאמֹר
הִנֵּה הַמֶּלֶךְ יוֹשֵׁב בַּשַּׁעַר
כָּל־מֹכֵחַ־נַּפֶּשׁ לְפִי עֲדִים
יִרְצַח אֶת־הָרֹצֵחַ *And all the people were told, “Behold, the*
king is sitting in the gate” (2 Sam 19:9)
- Everyone who kills a person – one shall kill*
the murderer on the evidence of witnesses
(Num 35:30)

וַיִּגֵּד לְמֶלֶךְ מִצְרַיִם כִּי בָרַח הָעָם *And it was reported to the king of Egypt that the people had fled (Exod 14:5)*

21.5 Exercises

21.5.1 Translation of Verbal Forms

Translate the following verbal forms. Identify the gender (masc., fem., comm.) and number (sg., pl.) of forms of which the English translation is ambiguous (i.e., *you, they*). Mark the stressed syllable if stress is not on the last syllable.

- 1 הָבִיטוּ 2 הַבְּטֵתֶם 3 אָבִיט 4 יָבִיטוּ 5 הִנָּדְתִּי 6 הִנָּדוּ 7 הִנָּדָה
8 הִנָּדָה 9 וַיִּגֵּד 10 תִּנָּדֶרְי 11 תִּנָּדְרוּ 12 אָנִיד 13 נִיֵּד 14 וַיִּנָּדוּ
15 תִּנָּדָה 16 תִּגֵּד 17 נִחַמְתִּי 18 וַיִּנְחַמוּן 19 וַיִּנְחֶם 20 הִצִּילוּ
21 הִצִּילֵנוּ 22 וַיִּצֵּל 23 הִצִּילוּ 24 יִשְׁיִנוּ

21.5.2 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: *בת־שָׁבַע, גִּשְׁן, לָכֵן, מִלְכָּה, נָחוֹר, תַּמְנָה, שְׁמֹשׁוֹן, נָחוֹר*

- 1 וַיֹּאמֶר אֲנֹכִי אֶלְתִּי אֲבִיךָ אֶלְתִּי אֲבָרְהָם אֶלְתִּי יִצְחָק וְאֶלְתִּי יַעֲקֹב וַיִּסְתֵּר מֹשֶׁה פָּנָיו כִּי יָרָא מִהָבֵיט אֶל־הָאֱלֹהִים: 2 וַיִּקְרָא פֶּרְעֹה לְאַבְרָם וַיֹּאמֶר מַה־זֹּאת¹ עֲשִׂיתָ לִּי לָמָּה לֹא־הִגַּדְתָּ לִּי כִּי אֲשַׁתְּךָ הִוא: 3 וַיֹּאמֶר יוֹסֵף אֶל־אֶחָיו וְאֶל־בְּנֵי אָבִיו אֵעֵלָה וְאֶנִּידָה לְפֶרְעֹה וְאָמַרְתָּ אֵלָיו אֲחִי וּבֵית־אָבִי אֲשֶׁר בְּאֶרֶץ־כְּנָעַן בָּאוּ אֵלָי: 4 וַיָּבֹא יוֹסֵף וַיִּגֵּד לְפֶרְעֹה וַיֹּאמֶר אָבִי וְאֲחִי וְצֹאנָם וּבְקָרָם וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר לָהֶם בָּאוּ מֵאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן וְהֵנִם בְּאֶרֶץ גִּשְׁן: 5 וַיֵּרֶד שְׁמֹשׁוֹן תַּמְנָתָה וַיֵּרָא אִשָּׁה בְּתַמְנָתָה מִבָּנוֹת פְּלִשְׁתִּים: וַיַּעַל וַיִּגֵּד לְאָבִיו וּלְאִמּוֹ וַיֹּאמֶר אִשָּׁה רָאִיתִי בְּתַמְנָתָה מִבָּנוֹת פְּלִשְׁתִּים וְעַתָּה קָחוּ־אוֹתָהּ לִי לְאִשָּׁה: וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ אָבִיו וְאִמּוֹ הֲאִין בָּבָנוֹת אַחֶיךָ וּבְכָל־עַמִּי אִשָּׁה כִּי־אָתָּה הוֹלֵךְ לְקַחַת אִשָּׁה מִפְּלִשְׁתִּים הָעַרְלִים³ וַיֹּאמֶר שְׁמֹשׁוֹן אֶל־אָבִיו אוֹתָהּ קַח־לִי כִּי־הִיא יְשָׁרָה בְּעֵינַי: 6 וַיְהִי בַיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי וַיָּמָת הַיָּלֶד וַיֵּרָאוּ עַבְדֵי דָוִד לַהֲגִיד לוֹ כִּי־מָת הַיָּלֶד כִּי אָמְרוּ הִנֵּה בְהִיּוֹת הַיָּלֶד חַי וְבָרְנוּ

¹ מה־זֹּאת The demonstrative pronouns זֶה and זאת often follow an interrogative pronoun or adverb “without any notable change in meaning” (JM § 143 g)

² הִוא to be read as הִיא

³ עָרֵל uncircumcised (adj.)

אליו ולא־שמע בקולנו ואיך נאמר אליו מת הילד ועשה רעה: ויגרא דוד כי עבדיו מתלחשים⁴ ויבן דוד כי מת הילד ויאמר דוד אל־עבדיו המת הילד ויאמרו מת: 7 ויהי אחרי הדברים האלה ויגד לאברהם לאמר הנה ילדה מלכה גם־הוא⁵ בנים לנחור אחיך: 8 ויגד ללבן ביום השלישי כי ברח יעקב: 9 ויהי דבר־יהוה אל־שמואל לאמר: נחמתי כי־המלכתי את־שאוֹל לַמֶּלֶךְ כִּי־שָׁב מֵאַחֲרֵי וְאַת־דָּבָרִי לֹא הָקִים⁶ ויחר לשמואל ויזעק אל־יהוה כֹּל־הַלַּיְלָה: 10 ויגרא יהוה כי רבה רעת האדם בארץ וכל־יִצֹר מִחֻשְׁבֶּת⁷ לִבּוֹ רָק רָע כָּל־הַיּוֹם: וינחם יהוה כִּי־עָשָׂה אֶת־הָאָדָם בָּאָרֶץ ויִתְעַצֵּב⁸ אֶל־לִבּוֹ: 11 ויאמר משה אל־יהושע בחר־לנו אנשים וצא הלחם בעמלק מחר אנכי נצב על־ראש הנבעה ומטה האלהים בידי: 12 ויאמר דוד יהוה אשר הצלני מיד הארי⁹ ומיד הדב¹⁰ הוא יצילני מיד הפלשתי תגה ויאמר שאול אל־דוד לך ויהוה ויהיה עמך: 13 וישאל דוד ביהוה לאמר ארדף אחרי הגדוד¹¹־תגה האשגנו ויאמר לוֹ רֹדֵף כִּי־הֲשֹׁג תִּשָּׁג וְהִצַּל תִּצִּיל: 14 וינחם דוד את בת־שבע אשתו ויבא אליה וישכב עמה ותלד בן ותקרא את־שמו שלמה ויהוה אהבו:

21.6 Hebrew Reading: Genesis 16:1–6

Translate Gen 16:1–6 with the help of notes below the text.

¹ ושרי אשת אברהם לא ילדה לו ולה שפחה מצרית ושמה הגר: ² ותאמר שרי אל־אברהם הנה־נָא עֲצָרְנִי יְהוָה מִלֶּדֶת בֶּן־נָא אֶל־שִׁפְחָתִי אוֹלִי אֲבִנָה מִמֶּנָּה וישמע אברהם לקול שרי: ³ ותקח שרי אשת־אברהם את־הגר המצרית שפחתה מקץ עשר שנים לשבת אברהם בארץ כנען ותתן אתה לאברהם אישה לו לאשה: ⁴ ויבא אל־הגר ותהר ותרא כי הרתה ותקל גברתה בעיניה: ⁵ ותאמר שרי אל־אברהם חמסי עליך אנכי נתתי שפחתי בחיקך ותרא כי הרתה ואקל בעיניה וישפט יהוה ביני וביניך: ⁶ ויאמר אברהם אל־שרי הנה שפחתך בידך עש־לה הטוב בעיניך ותענה שרי ותברח מפניה:

⁴ Hitpa. to whisper one to another לחש

⁵ היא to be read as הוא

⁶ he kept; he carried out הקים

⁷ inclination, striving, thought, intent יצר

⁸ Hitpa. to be deeply worried (HALOT) עצב

⁹ lion ארי

¹⁰ bear דב

¹¹ marauding band גדוד

21.6 Hebrew Reading: Genesis 16:1–6

16:1	מִצְרִי	<i>Egyptian</i>
16:2	עֲצֹר	<i>Q. to restrain; to retain</i>
	אִילִי	<i>perhaps</i>
	אֶבְנָה	1 c. sg. PC Ni. בָּנָה
16:4	הָרָה	<i>Q. to conceive, become pregnant</i>
	גְּבִירָה	<i>mistress; lady</i> (title of the queen mother) (cs. st. נְבִירָה)
16:5	חֵיק	<i>lap; fold</i> (of the garment)
	בֵּינִי	The form בֵּינִי (pausal form of בֵּינִי) is expected here (cf. 1 Sam 20:42). The sign above the second yod of בֵּינִי in the Masoretic Text is called <i>extraordinary point</i> (from Latin <i>punctum extrordinarium</i> , pl. <i>puncta extraordinaria</i>). In manuscripts from Qumran dots above letters indicated that the letters had to be erased (cf. Emanuel Tov, <i>Textual Criticism of the Hebrew Bible</i> , 4th ed., 2022, p. 43).
16:6	וַתַּעֲנֶה	3 f. sg. wayyiqtol עָנָה Pi. <i>to oppress</i> with ePP 3 f. sg.

Chapter 22

22.1 Vocabulary

22.1.1 Verbs

זנה	Q. <i>to commit fornication; to be unfaithful</i> (in a relationship with God)
חזה	Q. <i>to see, behold</i> (almost always poetic)
חפץ	Q. <i>to take pleasure in, desire; to delight in</i> (freq. with prep. obj. with בְּ)
טמא	Q. <i>to be unclean, become unclean</i> (stative verb, SC טָמֵא); Pi. <i>to defile; to desecrate</i>
כלה	Q. <i>to be complete, at an end, finished, accomplished, spent</i> ; Pi. <i>to complete, bring to an end, finish; to accomplish; to cause to cease</i>
כסה	Pi. <i>to cover</i>
נבא	Ni. <i>to be in a prophetic trance, behave like a נָבִיא</i> ; Hitpa. <i>to exhibit the behavior of a נָבִיא</i>
נטה	Q. <i>to stretch out, spread out, extend, bend, turn, incline</i> ; Hi. <i>to turn, incline</i>
נכה	Hi. <i>to smite, to strike; to strike dead</i>
ענה ₂	Q. <i>to be bowed down; to be downcast, afflicted</i> ; Pi. <i>to oppress; to mishandle, humble, afflict</i>
פדה	Q. <i>to buy out, redeem, ransom</i>
פלא	Ni. <i>to be surpassing, extraordinary</i>
צוה	Pi. <i>to give an order, to command; to order, to instruct; to charge, to commission</i> (cf. the noun מִצְוָה)
ראה	Q. <i>to see</i> ; Ni. <i>to appear, become visible; to present oneself</i> ; Hi. <i>to show, let someone see something</i>

רָבָה	Q. <i>to become numerous, increase; to become great</i> ; Hi. <i>to make numerous; to make great</i>
רָצָה	Q. <i>to be pleased with; to accept favorably</i>
שָׁקָה	Hi. <i>to give to drink; to cause to drink water</i> (causative counterpart to the verb שָׁתָה Q. <i>to drink</i>)

22.1.2 Nouns

בֶּטֶן	<i>belly; internal organs</i> (fem.)
חֶרְפָּה	<i>disgrace, shame; reviling, taunt</i>
מַכָּה	<i>blow; wound; plague</i>
עוֹף	<i>birds, fowl; winged insects</i> (everything that flies) (coll.)
עָנִי	<i>poor; afflicted; humble</i>
רְצוֹן	<i>goodwill; favor; acceptance</i>
תְּרוּמָה	<i>contribution, offering</i>

22.1.3 Other Parts of Speech

טָרָם	<i>not yet</i> (adv.); <i>before</i> (conj.)
בְּטָרָם	<i>before</i> (conj. or prep.)

22.2 Verbs III_y and Verbs III_ʾ: Derived Binyanim

22.2.1 Preliminary Remarks

Weak verbs of the type III_y and III_ʾ have a weak third root consonant, either in the form of a vocalic element in the case of III_y verbs or in the form of a quiescent **ʾ** if it is at the end of the syllable. The main features of all the derived binyanim, however, are located at the beginning of the verbal form in the Niphal, Hiphil, Hophal and Hitpael or in the form of gemination in the second root consonant in the Piel, Pual and Hitpael with the exception of the long vowel /ī/ in a number of Hiphil forms. As a consequence the main features of the derived binyanim do not interact with the weak element of III_y and III_ʾ verbs.

22.2.2 General Overview of the Forms of Verbs III y

Verbs of the III y type are characterized by the long final vowels /ā/ (*qameš*), /ā̃/ (*səgol*) /ē/ (*šere*) in many forms. These vowels remain the same in all binyanim. Before consonantal suffixes in the suffix conjugation the forms vary between the vowels /ī/ (*hireq*) and /ē/ (*šere*). These vowels are usually spelled with the vowel letter ם. Vocalic suffixes always follow the second root consonant directly.

			Qal	Niphal	Hiphil	Hophal
SC	sg.	3 m.	נָלָה	נִנְלָה	הִנְלָה	הִנְלָה
		3 f.	נָלְתָה	נִנְלְתָה	הִנְלְתָה	הִנְלְתָה
		2 m.	נָלִיתָ	נִנְלִיתָ	הִנְלִיתָ	הִנְלִיתָ
		2 f.	נָלִיתְּ	נִנְלִיתְּ	הִנְלִיתְּ	הִנְלִיתְּ
		1 c.	נָלִיתִי	נִנְלִיתִי	הִנְלִיתִי	הִנְלִיתִי
	pl.	3 c.	נָלוּ	נִנְלוּ	הִנְלוּ	הִנְלוּ
		2 m.	נָלִיתֶם	נִנְלִיתֶם	הִנְלִיתֶם	הִנְלִיתֶם
		2 f.	נָלִיתֶן	נִנְלִיתֶן	הִנְלִיתֶן	הִנְלִיתֶן
		1 c.	נָלִינוּ	נִנְלִינוּ	הִנְלִינוּ	הִנְלִינוּ
PC	sg.	3 m.	יָנָה	יִנְנָה	יִנְנָה	יִנְנָה
		3 f.	תָּנָה	תִּנְנָה	תִּנְנָה	תִּנְנָה
		2 m.	תָּנָה	תִּנְנָה	תִּנְנָה	תִּנְנָה
		2 f.	תָּנִי	תִּנְנִי	תִּנְנִי	תִּנְנִי
		1 c.	אָנָה	אִנְנָה	אִנְנָה	אִנְנָה
	pl.	3 c.	יָנוּ	יִנְנוּ	יִנְנוּ	יִנְנוּ
		3 f.	תָּנִינָה	תִּנְנִינָה	תִּנְנִינָה	תִּנְנִינָה
		2 m.	תָּנוּ	תִּנְנוּ	תִּנְנוּ	תִּנְנוּ
		2 f.	תָּנִינָה	תִּנְנִינָה	תִּנְנִינָה	תִּנְנִינָה
		1 c.	נָנָה	נִנְנָה	נִנְנָה	נִנְנָה
Juss.	sg.	3 m.	יָנֵל			
waw-PC	sg.	3 m.	וַיָּנֵל	וַיִּנְנֵל	וַיִּנְנֵל	

			Qal	Niphal	Hiphil	Hophal
Impv.	sg.	m.	גִּלְה	הִגְלָה	הִגְלֵה	
		f.	גְּלִי	הִגְלִי	הִגְלִי	
	pl.	m.	גִּלוּ	הִגְלוּ	הִגְלוּ	
		f.	גְּלִינָה	הִגְלִינָה	הִגְלִינָה	
Inf. cs.			גִּלוֹת	הִגְלוֹת	הִגְלוֹת	
Inf. abs.			גִּלְה	הִגְלָה נִגְלָה	הִגְלֵה	הִגְלָה
Part.	sg.	m.	גֻּלְה	נִגְלָה	מִגְלָה	מִגְלָה
		f.	גְּלָה	נִגְלָה	מִגְלָה	
	pl.	m.	גֻּלִּים	נִגְלִים	מִגְלִים	
		f.	גֻּלוֹת	נִגְלוֹת	מִגְלוֹת	

			Qal	Piel	Pual	Hitpael
SC	sg.	3 m.	גִּלְה	גִּלָּה	גִּלָּה	הִתְגַּלָּה
		3 f.	גִּלְתָּה	גִּלְתָּה	גִּלְתָּה	הִתְגַּלְתָּה
		2 m.	גִּלִּיתָ	גִּלִּיתָ	גִּלִּיתָ	הִתְגַּלִּיתָ
		2 f.	גִּלִּית	גִּלִּית	גִּלִּית	הִתְגַּלִּית
		1 c.	גִּלִּיתִי	גִּלִּיתִי	גִּלִּיתִי	הִתְגַּלִּיתִי
	pl.	3 c.	גִּלוּ	גִּלוּ	גִּלוּ	הִתְגַּלוּ
		2 m.	גִּלִּיתֶם	גִּלִּיתֶם	גִּלִּיתֶם	הִתְגַּלִּיתֶם
		2 f.	גִּלִּיתֶן	גִּלִּיתֶן	גִּלִּיתֶן	הִתְגַּלִּיתֶן
		1 c.	גִּלִּינוּ	גִּלִּינוּ	גִּלִּינוּ	הִתְגַּלִּינוּ

22.2 Verbs III y and Verbs III ʿ: Derived Binyanim

			Qal	Piel	Pual	Hitpael
PC	sg.	3 m.	יִגְלֶה	יִגְלֶה	יִגְלֶה	יִתְגַּלֶּה
		3 f.	תִּגְלֶה	תִּגְלֶה	תִּגְלֶה	תִּתְגַּלֶּה
		2 m.	תִּגְלֶה	תִּגְלֶה	תִּגְלֶה	תִּתְגַּלֶּה
		2 f.	תִּגְלִי	תִּגְלִי	תִּגְלִי	תִּתְגַּלִּי
		1 c.	אִגְלֶה	אִגְלֶה	אִגְלֶה	אִתְגַּלֶּה
	pl.	3 c.	יִגְלוּ	יִגְלוּ	יִגְלוּ	יִתְגַּלוּ
		3 f.	תִּגְלִינָה	תִּגְלִינָה	תִּגְלִינָה	תִּתְגַּלִּינָה
		2 m.	תִּגְלוּ	תִּגְלוּ	תִּגְלוּ	תִּתְגַּלוּ
		2 f.	תִּגְלִינָה	תִּגְלִינָה	תִּגְלִינָה	תִּתְגַּלִּינָה
		1 c.	נִגְלֶה	נִגְלֶה	נִגְלֶה	נִתְגַּלֶּה
Juss.	sg.	3 m.	יִגְלֵ	יִגְלֵ		
waw-PC	sg.	3 m.	וַיִּגְלֵ	וַיִּגְלֵ	וַיִּתְגַּלֵּ	
Impv.	sg.	m.	גְּלֶה	גִּלֵּ		הִתְגַּלֶּה
		f.	גְּלִי			הִתְגַּלִּי
	pl.	m.	גְּלוּ	גִּלוּ		הִתְגַּלוּ
		f.	גְּלִינָה			
Inf. cs.			גָּלוּת	גָּלוּת	גָּלוּת	הִתְגַּלוּת
Inf. abs.			גָּלָה	גָּלָה גָּלָה	גָּלָה	הִתְגַּלָּה
Part.	sg.	m.	גָּלָה	מְגָלָה	מְגָלָה	מִתְגַּלָּה
		f.	גָּלָה	מְגָלָה		
	pl.	m.	גָּלִים	מְגָלִים		
		f.	גָּלוּת	מְגָלוּת		

Notes

Variation between the vowels /ī/ (*hireq*) and /ē/ (*şere*) after the second root consonant in suffix conjugation forms is attested even within one and the

same verse, e.g., וְהִכִּיתִי and וְהִכִּיתָ in 1 Sam 23:2 וַיִּשְׁאַל דָּוִד בַּיהוָה לֵאמֹר (וַיִּשְׁאַל דָּוִד בַּיהוָה לֵאמֹר וְהִכִּיתִי בַּפִּלְשְׁתִּים וְהוֹשַׁעְתָּ הָאֶלֶף וְהִכִּיתִי בַּפִּלְשְׁתִּים הָאֵלֶּה וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־דָּוִד לֵךְ וְהִכִּיתָ בַּפִּלְשְׁתִּים וְהוֹשַׁעְתָּ אֶת־קַיִלָּה David asked the Lord, “Shall I go and attack these Philistines?” And the Lord said to David, “Go and attack the Philistines and save Keilah”).

Verbs that are both I gutt. and III y (e.g., עָשָׂה) have the same vowel changes before the first root consonant as the strong verb, e.g., נַעֲשֶׂה Ni. *it was done* (with *pataḥ* in the prefix), נַעֲשִׂיתָ Ni. *it was done* (with *segol* in the prefix), יַעֲשֶׂה Ni. *it is done* etc. The same applies to the verb רָאָה in the Niphal, e.g., יֵרָאֶה he *shall appear* (Exod 23:17).

As in the Qal, III y verbs may lose the long final vowel in jussive and *wayyiqtol* forms without an ending, e.g., וַיִּגְלֵ and he *uncovered* (Pi.), וְהִתְגַּלֵּ and she *uncovered* (Pi.), וַיִּתְכַּסֵּ and he *covered himself* (Hitpa.).

The verb עָלָה is used both in the Qal and in the Hiphil (558 and 250 times in the Hebrew Bible, respectively). Because of the guttural as first root consonant, prefix conjugation forms of the Qal and the Hiphil are identical, e.g., יַעֲלֶה Q. *he will go up* or Hi. *he will bring up*, וַיַּעַל Q. *he went up* or Hi. *he brought up*. As the verb עָלָה is intransitive in the Qal and transitive in the Hiphil, the presence or absence of a direct object makes it possible to distinguish between these forms. (Ellipsis of direct objects is frequent in Biblical Hebrew.)

The verb הִיָּה has suffix conjugation and participle forms in the Ni. with the prefix vowel /i/, e.g., נִהְיָתָה (SC 3 f. sg.) *it happened*, נִהְיָה (part. f. sg.)

The verbs נָטָה Hi. *to turn, incline* and נָכָה Hi. *to smite, strike* are doubly weak: In and III y. The rules regarding sound changes of both weak verb categories In and III y are applied. As a result, Hiphil forms of these two verbs show only R₂ while R₁ /n/ is only present in the gemination of R₂ in non-apocopate forms. The following characteristic Hiphil forms are attested:

SC	הִטָּה	הִכָּה
PC	יִטֶּה	יִכֶּה
Juss.	תֵּט	תֵּךְ
waw-PC	וַיִּט, וַיִּטֵּ	וַיִּכ, וַיִּכֵּ
Impv.	הִטָּה, הֵט	הִכָּה, הֵךְ
Inf. cs.	הִטּוֹת	הִכּוֹת
Part.	מִטָּה	מִכָּה

The verb נָכָה is also attested in the Pual, e.g., הִכָּה (SC), מִכָּה (part.).

As in the strong verb, assimilation of R₁ to R₂ does not happen in the case of a guttural as R₂, e.g., יְנַהֵי *he leads me* (Ps 23:3; verb נָהַה Hi. with ePP).

The infinitive absolute הִרְבֵּה of the verb רָבַה Hi. is used as an adverb with the meaning *greatly, exceedingly*. The form הִרְבָּה is used as a substitute for the infinitive absolute, but the form הִרְבֵּה is used as infinitive absolute as well.

22.2.3 General Overview of the Forms of Verbs III ʿ

As in the Qal, the weak consonant ʾ becomes silent at the end of a syllable and, therefore, is not a consonant anymore. However, it is preserved in writing in most cases. When vocalic suffixes or enclitic pronouns are added, the ʾ is retained as a consonant.¹

			Qal	Niphal	Hiphil	Hophal
SC	sg.	3 m.	מָצָא	נִמְצָא	הִמְצִיא	הִמְצָא
		3 f.	מָצְאָה	נִמְצְאָה	הִמְצִיָּאָה	הִמְצָאָה
		2 m.	מָצַאתָ	נִמְצַאתָ	הִמְצִאתָ	הִמְצָאתָ
		2 f.	מָצַאתְּ	נִמְצַאתְּ	הִמְצַאתְּ	הִמְצָאתְּ
		1 c.	מָצַאתִי	נִמְצַאתִי	הִמְצַאתִי	הִמְצָאתִי
	pl.	3 c.	מָצְאוּ	נִמְצְאוּ	הִמְצִיאוּ	הִמְצָאוּ
		2 m.	מָצַאתֶם	נִמְצַאתֶם	הִמְצַאתֶם	הִמְצָאתֶם
		2 f.	מָצַאתֶן	נִמְצַאתֶן	הִמְצַאתֶן	הִמְצָאתֶן
		1 c.	מָצַאנוּ	נִמְצַאנוּ	הִמְצַאנוּ	הִמְצָאנוּ
PC	sg.	3 m.	יָמָצָא	יִמְצָא	יִמְצִיא	יָמָצָא
		3 f.	יָמָצְאָה	יִמְצְאָה	יִמְצִיָּאָה	
		2 m.	יָמָצַאתָ	יִמְצַאתָ	יִמְצִאתָ	
		2 f.	יָמָצַאתְּ	יִמְצַאתְּ	יִמְצִאתְּ	יָמָצַאתְּ
		1 c.	יָמָצַאתִי	יִמְצַאתִי	יִמְצִאתִי	

¹ In the tables below, the verb מָלַא is used for the Piel, Pual and Hitpael forms because it is actually used in these binyanim. In forms where the ל has vocal šwa it loses the *dages forte*.

			Qal	Niphal	Hiphil	Hophal
PC	pl.	3 c.	יִמְצְאוּ	יִמְצְאוּ	יִמְצְאוּ	יִמְצְאוּ
		3 f.	תִּמְצְאנה	תִּמְצְאנה	תִּמְצְאנה	
		2 m.	תִּמְצְאוּ	תִּמְצְאוּ	תִּמְצְאוּ	תִּמְצְאוּ
		2 f.	תִּמְצְאנה	תִּמְצְאנה	תִּמְצְאנה	
		1 c.	נִמְצָא	נִמְצָא	נִמְצָא	
Juss.	sg.	3 m.	יִמְצָא	יִמְצָא	יִמְצָא	
waw-PC	sg.	3 m.	וַיִּמְצָא	וַיִּמְצָא	וַיִּמְצָא	
Impv.	sg.	m.	קִמְצָא	הִקְמֶצֵא	הִקְמֶצֵא	
		f.	קִמְצְאִי	הִקְמֶצְאִי	הִקְמֶצְאִי	
	pl.	m.	קִמְצְאוּ	הִקְמֶצְאוּ	הִקְמֶצְאוּ	
		f.	קִמְצְאוּן	הִקְמֶצְאנה	הִקְמֶצְאנה	
Inf. cs.			מִצָּא	הִמְצָא	הִמְצָא	
Inf. abs.			מִצְאוֹ	הִמְצָא	הִמְצָא	
Part.	sg.	m.	מִצָּא	נִמְצָא	מִמְצָא	מִמְצָא
		f.	מִצָּאת	נִמְצָאת		
	pl.	m.	מִצָּאִים	נִמְצָאִים		
		f.	מִצָּאוֹת	נִמְצָאוֹת		

			Qal	Piel	Pual	Hitpael
SC	sg.	3 m.	מָצָא	מָלֵא	מָלֵא	הִתְמָלֵא
		3 f.	מָצְאָה	מָלְאָה	מָלְאָה	הִתְמָלְאָה
		2 m.	מָצְאתָ	מָלַאתָ		הִתְמָלַאתָ
		2 f.	מָצְאת	מָלַאת		הִתְמָלַאת
		1 c.	מָצַאתִי	מָלַאתִי		הִתְמָלַאתִי

22.2 Verbs III y and Verbs III ʿ: Derived Binyanim

			Qal	Piel	Pual	Hitpael
SC	pl.	3 c.	מֵצְאוּ	מִלְאוּ	מִלְאוּ	הִתְמַלְאוּ
		2 m.	מֵצְאתֶם	מִלְאתֶם		הִתְמַלְאתֶם
		2 f.	מֵצְאתֶן	מִלְאתֶן		הִתְמַלְאתֶן
		1 c.	מֵצְאֵנוּ	מִלְאֵנוּ		הִתְמַלְאֵנוּ
PC	sg.	3 m.	יִמְצֵא	יִמְלֵא	יִמְלֵא	יִתְמַלֵּא
		3 f.	תִּמְצֵא	תִּמְלֵא	תִּמְלֵא	תִּתְמַלֵּא
		2 m.	תִּמְצֵא	תִּמְלֵא	תִּמְלֵא	תִּתְמַלֵּא
		2 f.	תִּמְצְאִי	תִּמְלְאִי	תִּמְלְאִי	תִּתְמַלְאִי
		1 c.	אֶמְצֵא	אֶמְלֵא	אֶמְלֵא	אֶתְמַלֵּא
	pl.	3 c.	יִמְצְאוּ	יִמְלְאוּ	יִמְלְאוּ	יִתְמַלְאוּ
		3 f.	תִּמְצְאֶנָּה	תִּמְלְאֶנָּה	תִּמְלְאֶנָּה	תִּתְמַלְאֶנָּה
		2 m.	תִּמְצְאוּ	תִּמְלְאוּ	תִּמְלְאוּ	תִּתְמַלְאוּ
		2 f.	תִּמְצְאֶנָּה	תִּמְלְאֶנָּה	תִּמְלְאֶנָּה	תִּתְמַלְאֶנָּה
		1 c.	נִמְצֵא	נִמְלֵא	נִמְלֵא	נִתְמַלֵּא
Juss.	sg.	3 m.	יִמְצֵא	יִמְלֵא	יִמְלֵא	יִתְמַלֵּא
waw-PC	sg.	3 m.	וַיִּמְצֵא	וַיִּמְלֵא	וַיִּמְלֵא	וַיִּתְמַלֵּא
Impv.	sg.	m.	מֵצֵא	מִלֵּא מִלְּאָה		הִתְמַלֵּא
		f.	מֵצְאִי	מִלְּאִי		הִתְמַלְאִי
	pl.	m.	מֵצְאוּ	מִלְאוּ		הִתְמַלְאוּ
		f.	מֵצְאֶנָּה	מִלְּאֶנָּה		הִתְמַלְאֶנָּה
Inf. cs.			מֵצֵא	מִלֵּא		הִתְמַלֵּא
Inf. abs.			מֵצֹא	מִלֹּא מִלֵּא		
Part.	sg.	m.	מֵצֵא	מִמְלֵא	מִמְלֵא	מִתְמַלֵּא
		f.	מֵצֵאת			
	pl.	m.	מֵצֵאִים	מִמְלָאִים		
		f.	מֵצֵאוֹת			

Notes

In the suffix conjugation of the derived binyanim, the vowel between the second root consonant and a consonantal suffix is always *ṣere*, whereas the Qal has *qameṣ*.

The 3/2 f. pl. forms of the prefix conjugation with the vowel /ā/ are due to analogy to III^y verbs, e.g., תִּמְצְאוּנָה *they will be found*. Sometimes, forms of III^y verbs follow the pattern of III^y completely, e.g., נְבִיתָ *you have prophesied* (verb נִבֵּא; Jer 26:9) as opposed to the expected form נִבֵּאתָ (Jer 20:6; 28:6).

22.3 Temporal Subordinate Clauses

Temporal subordinate clauses locate in time a state of affair in relation to another state of affairs. The event can be either anterior, simultaneous or posterior to the other event. Frequently used temporal conjunctions are: אַחֲרֵי אֲשֶׁר *after*, כַּאֲשֶׁר *when, after*, בְּתוֹרָם *before*, עַד *until, when*, עַד אֲשֶׁר *until*, כִּי *when*.

The temporal subordinate clause either precedes the main clause (Josh 9:16) or it follows the main clause (2 Sam 19:31).

וַיְהִי מִקְצֵה שְׁלֹשֶׁת יָמִים
אֲחֵרֵי אֲשֶׁר-כָּרְתוּ לָהֶם
בְּרִית וַיִּשְׁמְעוּ כִּי-קָרְבִּים הֵם
אֵלָיו וּבִקְרָבוֹ הֵם יֹשְׁבִים
At the end of three days after they had made a covenant with them, they heard that they were from close by and that they were living among them (Josh 9:16)

וַיֹּאמֶר מִפִּיבֹשֶׁת אֶל-הַמֶּלֶךְ
גַּם אֶת-הַכֹּל יֵקַח אַחֲרַי
אֲשֶׁר-בָּא אֲדֹנִי הַמֶּלֶךְ
בְּשָׁלוֹם אֶל-בֵּיתוֹ
Mephibosheth said to the king, "He may take it all after my lord the king has come to his house in peace" (2 Sam 19:31)

וְהָיָה טָרֶם-יִקְרָאוּ וְאֲנִי אֶעֱנֶה
שֶׂאֵל מָה אֶעֱשֶׂה-לָּךְ בְּטָרֶם
אֶלְקָח מֵעִמָּךְ
*Before they call, I will answer (Isa 65:24)
Ask what I shall do for you, before I am taken from you (2 Kgs 2:9)*

וַיְהִי כַּאֲשֶׁר קָרַב אֶל-הַמַּחֲנֶה
וַיֵּרָא אֶת-הָעֵגֹל וּמַחֲלֹלָת
When he came near the camp, he saw the calf and the dancing (Exod 32:19)

וַיֵּלְכוּ וַיָּבֹאוּ הָהָרָה וַיֵּשְׁבוּ
שָׁם שְׁלֹשֶׁת יָמִים עַד-שָׁבוּ
הָרֹדְפִים
They left and came to the hills and stayed there for three days, until the pursuers returned (Josh 2:22)

וְלֹא-הֵאֱמַנְתִּי לְדְבָרִים עַד
אֲשֶׁר-בָּאתִי וַתֵּרָאֵינָה עֵינַי
I did not believe the words, until I came and my eyes saw it (1 Kgs 10:7)

כִּי נַעַר יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאֶהְבֵּהוּ *When Israel was a child, I loved him* (Hos 11:1)

Similar to temporal subordinate clauses with a finite verb as predicate are constructions with a preposition and an infinitive construct.

אֶמּוּתָהּ הַפֶּעַם אַחֲרֵי רְאוּתִי *I can die now after I have seen your face*
 אֶת־פָּנֶיךָ (Gen 46:30)

וְאַלֶּה הַמְּלָכִים אֲשֶׁר מָלְכוּ *These are the kings that ruled in the land of*
 בְּאֶרֶץ אֲדוֹם לִפְנֵי *Edom before a king of the Israelites ruled as*
 מֶלֶךְ־מֶלֶךְ לְבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל *king* (Gen 36:31)

כִּי לֹא־יֹאכַל הָעָם עַד־בֹּאוֹ *... for the people do not eat before he*
 [Samuel] comes (1 Sam 9:13)

For the use of the inf. cs. with the prepositions **כִּי** and **בְּ** as temporal adverbial expressions see section 9.3.3

22.4 Exercises

22.4.1 Translation of Verbal Forms

Translate the following verbal forms. Identify the gender (masc., fem., comm.) and number (sg., pl.) of forms of which the English translation is ambiguous (i.e., *you, they*). Mark the stressed syllable if stress is not on the last syllable.

1 כָּלָה 2 כָּלוּ 3 כָּלִיתֶם 4 כָּלִיתִי 5 אָכַלָה 6 יָכְלוּ 7 כָּסְתָה
 8 תִּכְסִּי 9 נָבֵא 10 נִבְּאוּ 11 נִבְּאתָ 12 תִּנָּבֵא 13 הִכִּיתָ 14 הִכָּה
 15 הִכּוּ 16 הִכִּיתִי 17 הִכִּיתֶם 18 יָכָה 19 יָכוּ 20 אָכָה 21 וַיָּכּוּ
 22 וַיָּךְ 23 נִרְאוּ 24 יִרְאוּ 25 הִרְאָה 26 צִוִּיתִי 27 צִוִּיתָ 28 וַיִּצּוּ
 29 הָעָלוּ 30 הָעֲלִיתִי

22.4.2 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: אֶלְיָקִים, אֲמוֹץ, אִשְׁעִיהוּ, שִׁבְנָא, עֶבֶד אָדָם.

1 וַיַּעַשׂ מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן כְּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יְהוָה אֹתָם בְּנֵי עֲשׂוֹ: 2 וַיִּגַּד מֹשֶׁה לְאַהֲרֹן
 אֵת כָּל־דִּבְרֵי יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר שָׁלַח וְאֵת כָּל־הָאֲתָת אֲשֶׁר צִוָּהוּ: 3 וַיִּבֶן שְׁלֹמֹה

אֶת־הַבַּיִת וַיִּכְלְהוּ: 4 וַיָּכַל אֱלֹהִים בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי מְלֹאכֶתוֹ אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה וַיִּשְׁבֹּת בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי מִכָּל־מְלֹאכֶתוֹ אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה: 5 וַיִּשְׁלַח שְׁאוּל מַלְאָכִים לִקְחַת אֶת־דָּוִד וַיֵּרָא² אֶת־לִהְקֵת³ הַנְּבִיאִים נִבְאִים וּשְׁמוֹאֵל עַמְדָּה נֹצֵב עֲלֵיהֶם וַתְּהִי עַל־מִלְאָכֵי שְׁאוּל רִיחַ אֱלֹהִים וַיִּתְּנֻבָּאוּ גַם־הֵמָּה: 6 וַיִּלְחֲמוּ בְנֵי־יְהוֹדָה בִּירוּשָׁלַם וַיִּלְכְּדוּ אוֹתָהּ וַיִּכּוּתָּהּ לַפִּי־חֶרֶב וְאֶת־הָעִיר שָׁלְחוּ בָאֵשׁ: 7 כָּל־הַמְּצֹנָה אֲשֶׁר אָנֹכִי מְצֹנֶה הַיּוֹם תִּשְׁמְרוּן לַעֲשׂוֹת לְמַעַן תַּחֲיוּן וּרְבִיתֶם וּבְאֵתֶם וִירִשְׁתֶּם אֶת־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר־נִשְׁבַּע יְהוָה לְאַבְרָהָם: 8 וְעַתָּה מִמְּלִכְתְּךָ לֹא־תָקִים בְּקֶשׁ יְהוָה לוֹ אִישׁ כְּלָבָבוֹ וַיִּצְוּהוּ יְהוָה לְנָגִיד עַל־עַמּוֹ כִּי לֹא שָׁמַרְתָּ אֶת אֲשֶׁר־צִוְּךָ יְהוָה: 9 וַיֵּרָא אֵלָיו יְהוָה בַּלַּיְלָה הַהוּא וַיֹּאמֶר אָנֹכִי אֱלֹהֵי אַבְרָהָם אַבְרָהָם אָבִיךָ אֶל־תִּירָא כִּי־אֲתָתְךָ אֲנִי וּבְרַכְתִּיךָ וְהָרַבִּיתִי אֶת־זַרְעֶךָ בְּעֶבֶר אַבְרָהָם עַבְדִּי: וַיָּבֵן שָׁם מִזְבֵּחַ וַיִּקְרָא בְּשֵׁם יְהוָה וַיִּטֶּשֶׁם אֶהְלֹו וַיִּכְרוּ⁴־שָׁם עַבְדֵי־יִצְחָק בָּאָר: 10 וַיַּעַל מֹשֶׁה אֶל־הָהָר וַיִּכַּסּ הָעָנָן אֶת־הָהָר: וַיִּשְׁכֵּן כְּבוֹד־יְהוָה עַל־הָרֹם סִינַי וַיִּכַּסּהוּ הָעָנָן שְׁשֶׁת יָמִים וַיִּקְרָא אֶל־מֹשֶׁה בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי מִתּוֹךְ הָעָנָן: וּמָרָאֵה כְבוֹד יְהוָה כָּאֵשׁ אֲכָלַת בְּרָאשׁ הָהָר לְעֵינֵי בְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל: וַיָּבֹא מֹשֶׁה בְּתוֹךְ הָעָנָן וַיַּעַל אֶל־הָהָר וַיְהִי מֹשֶׁה בְּהָר אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם וָאַרְבָּעִים לַיְלָה: 11 וַיְהִי כִשְׁמַע הַמֶּלֶךְ חִזְקִיָּהוּ וַיִּקְרַע אֶת־בְּגָדָיו וַיִּתְּכַסּ בַּשֶּׁקֶם⁵ וַיָּבֹא בֵּית יְהוָה: וַיִּשְׁלַח אֶת־אֱלִיקִים אֲשֶׁר־עַל־הַבַּיִת וּשְׁבַנָּה הַסֹּפֵר וְאֵת זִקְנֵי הַכֹּהֲנִים מִתְּפִסִּים בַּשִּׁקִּים אֶל־יִשְׁעֵיהֶם הַנְּבִיא בֶן־אֲמוּץ: 12 כִּי כֹה אָמַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֵלַי קָח אֶת־כּוֹס⁶ כִּי כֹה אָמַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֵלַי קָח אֶת־כּוֹס הַחֲמָה הַזֹּאת מִיַּדִּי וְהִשְׁקִיתָהּ אֶתֹל אֶת־כָּל־הַנּוֹזִים אֲשֶׁר אָנֹכִי שֹׁלַח אוֹתָתְךָ אֲלֵיהֶם: ... וְאַקַּח אֶת־הַכּוֹס מִיַּד יְהוָה וְאַשְׁקֶה אֶת־כָּל־הַנּוֹזִים אֲשֶׁר־שָׁלַחְתִּי יְהוָה אֲלֵיהֶם: 13 וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אָנֹכִי הָעֹלִיתִי אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמִּצְרָיִם וְאַצִּיל אֶתְכֶם מִיַּד מִצְרָיִם וּמִיַּד כָּל־הַמְּמַלְכוֹת הַלְחָצִים⁷ אֶתְכֶם: 14 וַיִּגְדּוּ לַמֶּלֶךְ דָּוִד לֵאמֹר בְּרַח יְהוָה אֶת־בַּיִת עַבְדֹּם וְאֶת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ בְּעֶבֶר אֶרֶץ הָאֱלֹהִים וַיִּגְלֶה דָּוִד וַיַּעַל אֶת־אֶרְצוֹן הָאֱלֹהִים מִבַּיִת עַבְדֹּם אֶרֶץ עִיר דָּוִד בְּשִׁמְחָה:

22.5 Hebrew Reading: Genesis 16:7–10

Translate Gen 16:1–6 with the help of notes below the text.

² Instead of וַיֵּרָא the form וַיֵּרָאֵי is expected.

³ לִהְקֵת band, company

⁴ כרה Q. to hollow out, dig

⁵ שֶׁק sack, sackcloth (gem. noun)

⁶ כוס cup

⁷ לחץ Q. to oppress

⁷ וַיִּמְצָאָהּ מִלְאָךְ יְהוָה עַל־עֵין הַמַּיִם בְּמִדְבָּר עַל־הָעֵין בְּרֶרֶךְ שׁוּר׃ ⁸ וַיֹּאמֶר
הָנֹר שְׂפָתַי שָׁרִי אִי־מִזָּה בָּאת וְאַנָּה תִּלְכִּי וְהָאֹמֶר מִפִּי שָׁרִי גְבֵרָתִי אֲנֹכִי בִרְחֹת׃
⁹ וַיֹּאמֶר לָהּ מִלְאָךְ יְהוָה שׁוּבִי אֶל־גְּבִרְתְּךָ וְהִתְעַנִּי תַּחַת יָדֶיהָ׃ ¹⁰ וַיֹּאמֶר לָהּ
מִלְאָךְ יְהוָה הֲרֵבָה אֲרֻבָּה אֶת־זִרְעֲךָ וְלֹא יִסְפָּר מִרְבּוֹ׃

- | | | |
|------|------------|--|
| 16:7 | שׁוּר | <i>name of a place or region near the eastern border of Egypt</i> |
| 16:8 | אִי־מִזָּה | <i>where from?</i> |
| | גְּבִרָה | <i>mistress; lady</i> (title of the queen mother) (cs. st. גְּבִרָת) |
| 16:9 | עָנָה | <i>Hitpa. to submit (HALOT), to humble oneself (BDB)</i> |

Chapter 23

23.1 Vocabulary

23.1.1 Verbs

חלה	Q. <i>to be or become weak; become sick, ill</i>
חלק	Q./Pi. <i>to divide, apportion</i>
חרש	Hi. <i>to be silent</i>
יבש	Q. <i>to be dry, dried up</i> (stative verb; SC יִבֵּשׁ; PC יִיבֵּשׁ); Hi. <i>to dry up, make dry</i>
יָדָה ²	Hi. <i>to praise</i> ; Hitpa. <i>to confess</i> (SC הִתְיַדָּה)
יטב	Q. <i>to be good, well, glad, pleasant</i> ; Hi. <i>to do good to, deal well with; to do well; to make something good</i>
יכח	Hi. <i>to rebuke, reproach; to decide</i>
יסף	Q. <i>to add</i> ; Hi. <i>to add</i>
יצב	Hitpa. <i>to set oneself, to station oneself; to take one's stand</i> (cf. נִצַּב Ni./Hi.)
ישע	Hi. <i>to help, save</i> ; Ni. <i>to receive help; to be victorious</i>
יתר	Ni. <i>to be left over, remain</i> ; Hi. <i>to leave over, leave</i>
רפא	Q. <i>to heal</i> ; Ni. <i>to be healed</i>

23.1.2 Nouns

אָדָם	<i>man</i>
זָר	<i>strange, foreign</i>
כַּתֵּף	<i>shoulder; side; mountain slope</i>
עֵמֶק	<i>valley, vale, lowland</i>

עֶרְבָּה *desert-plain, steppe* (with the article הָעֶרְבָּה usually a part of the arid region between the Sea of Galilee and the Gulf of Aqaba)

שְׁאוֹל *underworld* (fem.)

23.2 Verbs I y: Derived Binyanim

23.2.1 Verbs I y: Niphal, Hiphil and Hophal

Verbs of the type Iy are verbs with originally either /y/ or /w/ as first root consonant. In the Niphal, Hiphil and Hophal most Iy verbs behave like having /w/ as first root consonant. Only few exceptions to this are found in Biblical Hebrew. As the weakness of Iy verbs is in first position, the vowels of the prefix syllables in the Niphal, Hiphil and Hophal interact with the first root consonant in the following ways:

1. In the suffix conjugation and participle Niphal: **nawšab* > *nōšab* נוֹשֵׁב in the suffix conjugation (from a primitive form **naqtala*) and **nawšab* > *nōšāb* נוֹשֵׁב in the participle
2. In the Hiphil of most verbs: **hawšaba* > *hōšib* הוֹשִׁיב (SC) (from a primitive form **haqtala*), **yuhawšib* > *yōšib* יוֹשִׁיב (PC) (the same applies to the other Hi. forms)
3. In the Hiphil of a few verbs: **haytaba* > *hētib* הִיטִיב (SC) (from a primitive form **haqtala*), **yuhaytib* > *yētib* יִיטִיב (PC) (the same applies to the other Hi. forms)
4. In the Hophal: **huwrad* > *hūrad* הוּרַד (SC), **yuwrad* > *yūrad* יוּרַד (PC) (the same applies to the other Ho. forms)

			Niphal	Hiphil		Hophal
SC	sg.	3 m.	נוֹשֵׁב	הוֹשִׁיב	הִיטִיב	הוּרַד
		3 f.	נוֹשְׁבָה	הוֹשִׁיבָה	הִיטִיבָה	
		2 m.	נוֹשְׁבָתָּ	הוֹשִׁיבָתָּ	הִיטִיבָתָּ	
		2 f.	נוֹשְׁבָתְּ	הוֹשִׁיבְתְּ	הִיטִיבְתְּ	
		1 c.	נוֹשְׁבָתִי	הוֹשִׁיבָתִי	הִיטִיבָתִי	

23.2 Verbs I y: Derived Binyanim

			Niphal	Hiphil		Hophal
SC	pl.	3 c.	נוֹשְׁבוּ	הוֹשִׁיבוּ	הִיטְיִבוּ	
		2 m.	נוֹשְׁבָתָם	הוֹשִׁבָתָם	הִיטְבָתָם	
		2 f.	נוֹשְׁבָתֶיךָ	הוֹשִׁבָתֶיךָ	הִיטְבָתֶיךָ	
		1 c.	נוֹשְׁבָנוּ	הוֹשִׁבָנוּ	הִיטְבָנוּ	
PC	sg.	3 m.	יֹושֵׁב	יֹושִׁיב	יִיטֵיב	יֹושֵׁב
		3 f.	תֹּושֵׁב	תוֹשִׁיב	תִּיטֵיב	
		2 m.	תֹּושֵׁב	תוֹשִׁיב	תִּיטֵיב	
		2 f.	תֹּושְׁבִי	תוֹשִׁיבִי	תִּיטֵיבִי	
		1 c.	אֹושֵׁב	אוֹשִׁיב	אִיטֵיב	
	pl.	3 m.	יֹושְׁבוּ	יֹושִׁיבוּ	יִיטְיִבוּ	
		3 f.	תֹּושְׁבָנָה	תוֹשִׁיבָנָה	תִּיטְבָנָה	
		2 m.	תֹּושְׁבוּ	תוֹשִׁיבוּ	תִּיטְיִבוּ	
		2 f.	תֹּושְׁבָנָה	תוֹשִׁיבָנָה	תִּיטְבָנָה	
		1 c.	נֹושֵׁב	נוֹשִׁיב	נִיטֵיב	
Juss.	sg.	3 m.	יֹושֵׁב	יֹושִׁב		
waw-PC	sg.	3 m.	וַיֹּושֵׁב	וַיֹּושִׁב	וַיִּיטֵב	
Impv.	sg.	m.	הֹושֵׁב	הוֹשֵׁב	הִיטְיִיבָה	
		f.	הֹושְׁבִי	הוֹשִׁיבִי		
	pl.	m.	הֹושְׁבוּ	הוֹשִׁיבוּ		
Inf. cs.			הֹושֵׁב	הוֹשִׁיב	הִיטֵיב	הוֹשֵׁב
Inf. abs.				הוֹשֵׁב	הִיטֵב	
Part.	sg.	m.	נוֹשֵׁב	מוֹשִׁיב	מִיטֵיב	מוֹשֵׁב
		f.	נוֹשֶׁבֶת	מוֹשֶׁבֶת	מִיטִיבָה	
	pl.	m.	נוֹשְׁבִים	מוֹשִׁיבִים	מִיטִיבִים	
		f.	נוֹשְׁבוֹת	מוֹשִׁיבוֹת	מִיטִיבוֹת	

Notes

The primitive forms for the suffix conjugation **naqṭal* (Ni.) and **haqṭal* (Hi.) are different from the primitive forms for the corresponding forms of the strong verbs **niqṭal* and **hiqṭil*, respectively (cf. Chapters 16 and 17).

In the Niphal prefix conjugation, imperative and infinitives the first root consonant is /w/ in most cases. The /n/ of the Niphal is assimilated to the /w/, e.g., *yinwašī*^c > *yiwwāšē*^c יִשָּׁע he will be saved (pausal form; Prov 28:18). At times, the first root consonant /y/ is preserved, e.g., יִיָּרֶה he shall be shot (Exod 19:13).

Five Iy verbs have Hiphil forms that are based on an original /y/ as R₁: יָטַב Hi. to do good (74 ×), יָלַל Hi. to howl (30 ×), יָנַק Hi. to nurse, suckle (9 ×), יָמַן Hi. to go to the right (5 ×), יָשַׁר Hi. to make even (2 ×).

In *wayyiqṭol* forms the long vowel /ī/ as thematic vowel is replaced by /ē/ (except in pausal forms), e.g., יָיָשַׁב he settled (transitive; Gen 47:11).

In *wayyiqṭol* verbs without suffix, stress is frequently retracted to the penultimate syllable with shortening of the thematic vowel /ē/ > /æ/, e.g., יָיָשַׁב, נִיָּשַׁב. But forms without retraction of stress are attested, too, e.g., יָיָשַׁב (Gen 47:11). With a guttural as third root consonant the vowel /ē/ is shortened to /a/, e.g., יָיָשַׁע and he saved (Exod 14:30).

The verb הִלַּךְ follows the pattern of the verbs יָשַׁב, יָרַד, etc., in the Hiphil forms. Illustrative Forms are the following:

SC	sg.	3 m.	הוֹלִיךְ
	pl.	3 c.	הוֹלִיכּוּ
PC	sg.	3 m.	יוֹלִיךְ
	pl.	3 m.	יוֹלִיכּוּ
Inf. cs.			הוֹלִיךְ

Frequent doubly weak verbs are יָצָא Hi. to bring out, lead out, יָדָה Hi. to praise and יָרָא Ni. to be feared, terrible, awesome. The verb יָרָא Ni. is almost exclusively attested in the participle נֹרָאָה, נֹרָאָה etc. The verbs יָצָא Hi. and יָדָה Hi. have the following characteristic forms:

SC	sg.	3 m.	הוֹצִיא	
	pl.	3 c.	הוֹצִיאוּ	הוֹדוּ
PC	sg.	3 m.	יוֹצִיא	יוֹדֶה
	pl.	3 m.	יוֹצִיאוּ	יוֹדוּ
Inf. cs.			הוֹצִיא	הוֹדוּת

The verb **יָסַף** *to add* is used in the Qal only in the suffix conjugation (28 ×), the inf. cs. (only 1 ×) and the part. (only 1 ×). In the Hiphil it is used in all forms (except the inf. abs.; 171 times in total), e.g., הוֹסִיפָהּ (SC), יוֹסִיף (PC), וַיֹּסֶף (*wayyiqtol*).

Verbs of the type Iy with **צ** as second root consonant have forms with a geminated **צ** in the Hi. and Ho., e.g., וַיִּצְיִנוּ *and they placed* (1 Sam 5:2), וַיִּצְקוּ *and they poured them out* (with ePP; Josh 7:23), תַּצִּיתוּ *you shall set on fire* (Josh 8:8). Although forms like these look like forms of In verbs, they are derived from the verbs יָצַן, יָצַק and יָצַת, respectively.

The verb **יָלַד** has inf. cs. forms in the Hophal with a geminated second root consonant instead of a long vowel /ū/ in the prefix syllable: הוּלְלַדְתָּ or הוּלְלַדְתָּ *hullædæt* in the constructions יוֹם הַלְּלָדָת *birthday* (Gen 40:20) or יוֹם הוּלְלָדָת *day of birth* (Ezek 16:4).

23.2.2 Verbs I y: Piel, Pual and Hitpael

In the Piel, Pual and Hitpael Iy have strong forms in the entire paradigms. In the Piel and Pual the first root consonant /y/ is preserved. In the Hitpael of some verbs the first root consonant is changed to /w/ while in the majority of verbs the /y/ is preserved. Important forms are included in the following table (only attested forms are included).

			Piel	Pual	Hitpael	
SC	sg.	3 m.	יָסַר	יָסַר	הִתְיַצַּב	הִתְנַדָּה
	pl.	3 m.	יָסְרוּ		הִתְיַצְּבוּ	הִתְנַדְּדוּ
PC	sg.	3 m.	יִסֵּר		יִתְיַצֵּב	
	pl.	3 m.			יִתְיַצְּבוּ	וַיִּתְנַדְּדוּ
Inf. cs.			יָסַר		הִתְיַצֵּב	הִתְנַדָּת
Part.	sg.	m.	מִיָּסַר	מִיָּסַר		מִתְנַדָּה

23.3 Modifying verbs

Some verbs may be used together with another verb as modifying verbs. When used in this way, they function as adverbial modifiers, i.e., the modifying verb expresses only an adverbial idea whereas the other verb expresses the main verbal idea. Verbs that are frequently used as modifying verbs are:

	Normal meaning	Meaning as modifying verb
יִסַּף Q./Hi.	<i>to add</i>	<i>to do something again, continue doing something; with a negative: to stop doing something; to not do something anymore</i>
שׁוּב Q.	<i>to return</i>	<i>to do something again</i>
מָהֵר Pi.	<i>to hurry</i>	<i>to do something quickly</i>
רַבָּה Hi.	<i>to multiply, increase</i>	<i>to do something many times</i>
שָׁכַם Hi.	<i>to rise early</i>	<i>to do something early (in the morning)</i>

In many cases, the modifying verb precedes the modified verb which is in the infinitive construct, usually with the preposition לְ (1 Sam 7:13) but also without (Gen 8:12).

וַיִּכְנְעוּ הַפְּלִשְׁתִּים וְלֹא־יָסֻפוּ עוֹד לָבוֹא בְּגִבּוֹל יִשְׂרָאֵל	<i>And the Philistines were subdued and did not come into the territory of Israel again (1 Sam 7:13)</i>
וְלֹא־יָסְפָה שׁוּב־אֵלָיו עוֹד	<i>[The dove] did not return to him anymore (Gen 8:12)</i>
לֹא־יֻכַּל בַּעֲלָהּ הָרִאשׁוֹן אֲשֶׁר־שָׁלְחָהּ לָשׁוּב לְקַחְתָּהּ לִהְיוֹת לוֹ לְאִשָּׁה	<i>Her first husband, who sent her away, cannot take her back again to be his wife (Deut 24:4)</i>
וַיֹּאמֶר יִצְחָק אֶל־בְּנוֹ מֶה־זֶּה מְהֵרָתָ לְמָצָא בְּנִי	<i>And Isaac said to his son, "How did you find it so quickly, my son?" (Gen 27:20)</i>
וַיִּשְׁכֶּם מִנְּשֵׁרֶת אִישׁ הָאֱלֹהִים לְקוֹם	<i>And the servant of the man of God got up early in the morning (2 Kgs 6:15)</i>

Instead of a verbal form and an infinitive construct two finite verbal forms

may be joined together, either in a syndetic construction with the conjunction וְ (2 Sam 18:22; 1 Sam 25:23) or in an asyndetic construction without וְ (Isa 52:1). The first verb is used as the modifying verb.

וַיֹּסֶף עוֹד אַחִימַעַז בֶּן-צָדוֹק And Ahimaaz son of Zadok said again to
וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל-יֹאבָב ... Joab (2 Sam 18:22)

וַתֵּרָא אַבִּיגַיִל אֶת-דָּוִד And Abigail saw David and quickly got off the
וַתִּמְהַר וַתֵּרֶד מֵעַל הַחֲמֹר donkey (1 Sam 25:23)

... כִּי לֹא יוֹסִיף יָבֵא-בָךְ ... for no uncircumcised or unclean will come
עוֹד עִרְלָ וְטָמֵא into you anymore (Isa 52:1)

23.4 Exercises

23.4.1 Translation of Verbal Forms

Translate the following verbal forms. Identify the gender (masc., fem., comm.) and number (sg., pl.) of forms of which the English translation is ambiguous (i.e., *you, they*). Mark the stressed syllable if stress is not on the last syllable.

1 אוֹדָה 2 נוֹדָה 3 הִתְנוּדוּ 4 הִיטִיבוּ 5 הִיטְבָתָ 6 יִיטִיב 7 הוֹסִפְתִּי
8 תְּסִיפוּ 9 יוֹסְפוּ 10 הִתִּיצְבוּ 11 יִתִּיצֵב 12 הוֹשַׁעְתָם 13 הוֹשַׁעְתִּי
14 תוֹשִׁיעַ 15 הִכּוּ 16 נֹאֲלָךְ 17 נִילְכוּ 18 תִּחְרִשִׁי

23.4.2 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible.

1 רָפְאֲנִי יְהוָה וְאַרְפָּא הוֹשִׁיעֲנִי וְאַוְשָׁעָה כִּי תִהְלֹתִי אִתָּה: 2 הִנֵּה שָׂבַע שָׁנִים
בָּאוֹת שָׂבַע¹ גָּדוֹל בְּכָל-אֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם: וְקָמוּ שָׂבַע שָׁנֵי רָעָב אַחֲרֵיהֶן וְנִשְׁכַּח כָּל-הַשָּׂבַע
בָּאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם וְכָלָה הָרָעָב אֶת-הָאֶרֶץ: וְלֹא-יִוָּדַע הַשָּׂבַע בָּאֶרֶץ מִפְּנֵי הָרָעָב הַהוּא
אַחֲרֵי-כֵן כִּי-כָבֵד הוּא מְאֹד: 3 וַיֵּצֵא בְנֵי חָשׂוֹן וְהִנֵּה שְׁנֵי-אֲנָשִׁים עֹבְרִים² נָצִים³
וַיֹּאמֶר לְרֹשֶׁעַ לָמָּה תִּכָּה רַעֲךָ: וַיֹּאמֶר מִי שְׁמוֹךְ לְאִישׁ שָׂר וְשֹׁפֵט עָלֵינוּ הִלְחִירְנוּ אִתָּה
אֲמַר כְּאֲשֶׁר הִרְגִּיתָ אֶת-הַמִּצְרִי⁴ וַיִּירָא מֹשֶׁה וַיֹּאמֶר אָכֵן⁵ נִוָּדַע הַדָּבָר: 4 וְעַתָּה

¹ שָׂבַע *satiation, sufficiency; plenty*

² עֹבְרִי *Hebrew*

³ נָצַח *Ni. to fight*

⁴ מִצְרִי *Egyptian*

⁵ אָכֵן *surely*

לָכֵה וְאֶשְׁלַחְךָ אֶל־פַּרְעֹה וְהוֹצֵא אֶת־עַמִּי בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמִּצְרָיִם׃ וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה אֶל־
הָאֱלֹהִים מִי אֲנִכִּי כִּי אֵלֶיךָ אֶל־פַּרְעֹה וְכִי אוֹצִיא אֶת־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמִּצְרָיִם׃ וַיֹּאמֶר
כִּי־אֶתִּינָה עִמָּךְ וְזֶה־לְךָ הָאוֹת כִּי אֲנִכִּי שְׁלַחְתִּיךָ בְּהוֹצִיאָךְ אֶת־הָעָם מִמִּצְרָיִם תַּעֲבֹדוּן
אֶת־הָאֱלֹהִים עַל הַהָר הַזֶּה׃ 5 וַיְדַבֵּר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה וְאֶל־אַהֲרֹן וַיֹּצִיאוּם אֶל־בְּנֵי
יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאֶל־פַּרְעֹה מֶלֶךְ מִצְרָיִם לְהוֹצִיא אֶת־בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרָיִם׃ 6 וַיְדַבֵּר
אֱלֹהִים אֶת כָּל־הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה לְאֹמֶר׃ אֲנִכִּי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ אֲשֶׁר הוֹצֵאתִיךָ מֵאֶרֶץ
מִצְרָיִם מִבֵּית עַבְדִּים׃ 7 וַיִּשְׁלַח יְהוָה אִישׁ נָכִיא אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיֹּאמֶר לָהֶם
כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה ׀ אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲנִכִּי הָעֲלִיתִי אֶתְכֶם מִמִּצְרָיִם וְאֹצִיא אֶתְכֶם מִבֵּית
עַבְדִּים׃ 8 וְעַתָּה יִשְׂרָאֵל שְׁמַע אֶל־הַחֲקִים וְאֶל־הַמִּשְׁפָּטִים אֲשֶׁר אֲנִכִּי מִלְּמֹד
אֶתְכֶם לַעֲשׂוֹת לְמַעַן תַּחֲיוּ וּבֹאתֶם וִירִשְׁתֶּם אֶת־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי אֲבֹתֵיכֶם
נָתַן לָכֶם׃ לֹא תִסְפוּ עַל־הַדְּבָר אֲשֶׁר אֲנִכִּי מִצִּוְהָ אֶתְכֶם וְלֹא תִגְרְעוּ⁶ מִמֶּנּוּ לְשֹׁמֵר
אֶת־מִצְוֹת יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם אֲשֶׁר אֲנִכִּי מִצִּוְהָ אֶתְכֶם׃ 9 וַיִּסְפוּ בְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לַעֲשׂוֹת
הָרַע בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה וַיִּתְּנֵם יְהוָה בְּיַד־פְּלִשְׁתִּים אֲרָבָעִים שָׁנָה׃ 10 וַיִּשְׁלַח שְׁאוּל
מִלֵּאכִים לִקְחַת אֶת־דָּוִד וַיֵּרָא אֶת־לַחֲקֹת⁷ הַנְּבִיאִים נִבְאִים וּשְׁמוּאֵל עֹמֵד נֹצֵב עֲלֵיהֶם
וַתְּהִי עַל־מִלְּאכֵי שְׁאוּל רוּחַ אֱלֹהִים וַיִּתְּנִבְאוּ גַם־הֵמָּה׃ וַיִּגְדּוּ לְשְׁאוּל וַיִּשְׁלַח מִלֵּאכִים
אַחֲרֵיהֶם וַיִּתְּנִבְאוּ גַם־הֵמָּה וַיִּסָּף שְׁאוּל וַיִּשְׁלַח מִלֵּאכִים שְׁלִשִׁים וַיִּתְּנִבְאוּ גַם־הֵמָּה׃
11 וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה הֵן קָרְבוּ יָמַיךָ לְמוֹת קָרָא אֶת־יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וְהַתִּיצְבוּ בְּאֹהֶל
מוֹעֵד וְאֹצִינוּ וַיֵּלֶךְ מֹשֶׁה וַיְהוֹשֻׁעַ וַיִּתִּיצְבוּ בְּאֹהֶל מוֹעֵד׃ וַיֵּרָא יְהוָה בְּאֹהֶל בְּעֶמּוּד עָנָן
וַיַּעֲמֵד עֹמֵד הָעָנָן עַל־פֶּתַח הָאֹהֶל׃ 12 וַיְהִי ׀ כַּכְּלוֹת דָּוִד לְדַבֵּר אֶת־הַדְּבָרִים
הָאֵלֶּה אֶל־שְׁאוּל וַיֹּאמֶר שְׁאוּל הֲקִלְךָ זֶה בְּנִי דָוִד וַיִּשָּׂא שְׁאוּל קִלּוֹ וַיִּבְכֶּה׃ 13 כָּל־
הַמִּצְוָה אֲשֶׁר אֲנִכִּי מִצִּוְהָ הַיּוֹם תִּשְׁמְרוּן לַעֲשׂוֹת לְמַעַן תַּחֲיוּ וּרְבִיתֶם וּבֹאתֶם וִירִשְׁתֶּם
אֶת־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר־נִשְׁבַּע יְהוָה לְאַבְרָהָם׃ וְזָכַרְתָּ אֶת־כָּל־הַדְּבָר אֲשֶׁר הִלְכִיךָ יְהוָה
אֱלֹהֶיךָ זֶה׃⁹⁸ לְדַעַת אֶת־אֲשֶׁר בָּלְבַבְךָ הִתְשַׁמֵּר מִצִּוְתִּי אִם־לֹא׃ 14 כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה
הַנְּנִי נָתַן אֶת־הָעִיר הַזֹּאת בְּיַד מֶלֶךְ־בָּבֶל וּלְכַדְהָ׃ וְצִדְקִיהוּ מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה לֹא יִמְלֹט
מִיַּד הַכַּשְׂדִּים¹⁰ כִּי הִנֵּתָן וְנָתַן בְּיַד מֶלֶךְ־בָּבֶל וְדַבַּר־פִּי עִם־פִּי וְעֵינָיו אֶת־עֵינָיו
תִּרְאִינָה׃ וּבָבֶל יוֹלֶךְ אֶת־צִדְקִיהוּ וְשָׁם יִהְיֶה עַד־פָּקְדִי אֹתוֹ נְאֻם־יְהוָה כִּי תִלְחֲמוּ
אֶת־הַכַּשְׂדִּים לֹא תִצְלִיחוּ׃ 15 וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלִיהוּ אֶל־הָעָם אֲנִי נֹתַרְתִּי נָכִיא לִיהוָה
לְבָדִי וְנִבְיְאֵי הַפֶּעַל אַרְבַּע־מֵאוֹת וַחֲמִשִּׁים אִישׁ׃ 16 וַיָּבֹא־שָׁם אֶל־הַמַּעְרָה¹¹ וַיֵּלֶן
שָׁם וְהִנֵּה דְבַר־יְהוָה אֵלָיו וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ מַה־לְּךָ כֹּה אֱלִיהוּ׃ וַיֹּאמֶר קִנְאָה¹² קִנְאָתִי לִיהוָה

⁶ Q. to take; to diminish גרע

⁷ band, company (BDB) לַחֲקָה

⁸ here as adv. now, here זֶה

⁹ Pi. to put to the test, try נסה

¹⁰ Chaldeans (the people ruling over Babylon since 626/5 BCE) (HALOT) כַּשְׂדִּים

¹¹ cave מַעְרָה

¹² Pi. to be jealous; to be zealous קנא

אֶלְתִּי צָבָאוֹת כִּי־עָזְבוּ בְרִיתִךָ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־מִצְבְּחֶיךָ הָרְסוּ¹³ וְאֶת־נְבִיאֶיךָ
הָרְנוּ בַּחֶרֶב וְאֶתְּרָא אֲנִי לְבָדִי וַיִּבְקְשׁוּ אֶת־נַפְשִׁי לְקַחְתָּהּ: 17 וַיְהִי הַמָּוָה בַּדֶּרֶךְ
וַהֲשִׁמְעָה¹⁴ כָּאֵה אֶל־דָּוִד לֵאמֹר הִנֵּה אֲבָשָׁלוֹם אֶת־כָּל־בְּנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ וְלֹא־נֹתַר מֵהֶם
אֶחָד: 18 וַיִּשְׁמַע יְהוָה אֶת־קוֹל דְּבָרֵיכֶם בְּדַבְּרְכֶם אֵלַי וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֵלַי שְׁמַעְתִּי
אֶת־קוֹל דְּבָרֵי הָעָם הַזֶּה אֲשֶׁר דִּבְּרוּ אֵלַיךָ הִיטִיבוּ כָל־אֲשֶׁר דִּבְּרוּ: 19 הוֹדִינוּ
לִיהוָה כִּי־טוֹב כִּי לַעֲוֹלָם חֲסִדּוֹ: 20 אוֹרְתָה יְהוָה בְּכָל־לֵב אֲסַפְּרָה כָל־נַפְלְאוֹתֶיךָ:

23.5 Hebrew Reading: Genesis 16:11–16

Translate Gen 16:11–16 with the help of notes below the text.

11 וַיֹּאמֶר לָהּ מִלְאָךְ יְהוָה הִנֵּה הָרָה וְיִלְדֶּת בֶּן וְקָרָאת שְׁמוֹ יִשְׁמָעֵאל כִּי־שָׁמַע יְהוָה
אֶל־עֲנִיָּךְ: 12 וְהוּא יְהִי־הוּא פָּרָא אָדָם יָדוּ בְּכָל יוֹד כָּל בּוֹ וְעַל־פָּנָי כָּל־אֲחָיו יִשְׁכָּן:
13 וַתִּקְרָא שֵׁם־יְהוָה הַדֹּבֵר אֵלֶיהָ אֵתָה אֵל רָאִי כִי אֲמַלְחָה הַגִּם הַלֵּם רָאִיתִי אַחֲרֵי
רָאִי: 14 עַל־כֵּן קָרָא לְבָאָר בָּאָר לַחִי רָאִי הַנָּה בֵּין־קָדֵשׁ וּבֵין פָּרָד: 15 וַתֵּלֶד
הָגֵר לְאַבְרָם בֶּן וַיִּקְרָא אֲבָרָם שֵׁם־בְּנוֹ אֲשֶׁר־יִלְדָה הָגֵר יִשְׁמָעֵאל: 16 וְאַבְרָם
בֶּן־שְׁמֹנִים שָׁנָה וַיֵּשֶׁב שָׁנִים בְּלֶדֶת־הָגֵר אֶת־יִשְׁמָעֵאל לְאַבְרָם:

- 16:11 *הָרָה *pregnant* (adj.)
וְיִלְדֶּת This appears to be a *lectio mixta*. One can either read וְיִלְדֶּת or וְיִלְדֶּת (JM §§ 89j, 16g). The vowel signs of the Masoretic Text combine both forms. Other grammars accept this forms as participle fem. sg. without a helping vowel to break up the final consonant cluster.
- עָנִי *affliction, misery, oppressed situation*
- 16:12 פָּרָא *wild ass; פָּרָא אָדָם a man like a wild ass (HALOT)*
עַל־פָּנָי *in front of, east of (BDB); at the expense of; to the disadvantage of (HALOT)*
- 16:13 דִּבֵּר The verb דִּבֵּר is used in the Qal here (part. in 39 of the 41 cases of the verb in Qal)

¹³ הרס Q. to tear down

¹⁴ שְׁמוּעָה report, news (part. pass. f. sg. שָׁמַע to hear)

Chapter 23

	רָאִי	<i>seeing (rî)</i>
	הֵלֶם	<i>here</i>
16:14	קָדֶשׁ	(and בְּרִד) names of places

Chapter 24

24.1 Vocabulary

24.1.1 Verbs

בוא	Q. <i>to come, to enter</i> ; Hi. <i>to bring, bring in</i>
בין	Q. <i>to discern, understand</i> ; Hi. <i>to understand; to give understanding, teach</i>
כון	Ni. <i>to be established; to be steadfast; to be permanent; to be ready</i> ; Hi. <i>to establish, set up; to make ready, prepare; to direct</i> ; Polel <i>to set up, establish</i>
מות	Q. <i>to die</i> ; Hi. <i>to kill, put to death</i>
נוח	Q. <i>to rest; to settle down; to have rest</i> ; Hi. A <i>to cause to rest, give rest</i> ; Hi. B <i>to lay, set down; to leave, let remain</i>
סור	Q. <i>to turn aside</i> ; Hi. <i>to cause to turn aside, depart; to remove, take away</i>
עור	Q. <i>to awake; to stir</i> ; Hi. <i>to wake up; to excite; to put into motion</i>
פוז	Q. <i>to be dispersed; disperse (intr.)</i> ; Ni. <i>be scattered</i> ; Hi. <i>to scatter</i>
קום	Q. <i>to arise, stand up, stand</i> ; Hi. <i>to raise, raise up</i>
רום	Q. <i>to be high; to be raised, uplifted; to rise (intrans.)</i> ; Hi. <i>to raise, lift up; to exalt; to set up</i> ; Polel <i>to raise, lift up; to exalt</i>
ריב	Q. <i>to strive, contend</i>
שוב	Q. <i>to turn back, return</i> ; Hi. <i>to bring back, return (trans.)</i>

24.1.2 Nouns

אֶבְיוֹן	<i>needy, poor (adj.)</i>
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אַחֲרֵית	end; future; descendants (fem.)
אֶרֶץ	way, path
חֶזֶק	strong; heavy, severe; firm, hard (adj.)
יָאֵר	the Nile (usually with the article הַיָּאֵר, pl. יְאֵרִים; Nile-arms, Nile-canals) river, stream
יֵעָר	wood; forest; thicket
כָּסִיל	fool
מִזְמוֹר	psalm
מָלֵא	full (adj.)
מַצָּה	unleavened bread, matzah (matzo)
מָרוֹם	height, elevated place
מִשְׁמֶרֶת	guard, watch; charge, injunction; function, office
צָרָה	need; distress; anxiety
שָׁלֵם	a kind of offering: conclusion offering; salvation offering
שֵׁן	tooth, ivory (gem. noun; dual שְׁנַיִם)

24.2 Verbs II w/y: Derived Binyanim

24.2.1 Verbs II w/y: Niphal, Hiphil and Hophal

			Niphal כּוֹן	Hiphil קוּם בּוּא		Hophal קוּם
SC	sg.	3 m.	נִכּוֹן	הִקִּים	הִבִּיא	הוֹשִׁב
		3 f.	נִכְוְנָה	הִקִּימָהּ	הִבִּיאָהּ	
		2 m.		הִקִּימוֹתָ	הִבִּאתָ	
		2 f.		הִקִּימוֹתְ	הִבִּאתְ	
		1 c.		הִקִּימוֹתִי	הִבִּאתִי	
	pl.	3 c.	נִכְוְנוּ	הִקִּימוּ	הִבִּיאוּ	
		2 m.		הִקִּימוּתֶם	הִבִּאתֶם	
		2 f.		הִקִּימוּתֶן	הִבִּאתֶן	
		1 c.		הִקִּימוּנוּ	הִבִּאֵנוּ	

24.2 Verbs II w/y: Derived Binyanim

			Niphal כּוֹן	Hiphil בּוּא קוּם		Hophal קוּם
PC	sg.	3 m.	יָכוֹן	יָקִים	יִבְיֵא	יּוֹשֵׁב
		3 f.	תִּכּוֹן	תִּקְיֵם	תִּבְיֵא	תּוֹמֵת
		2 m.	תִּכּוֹן	תִּקְיֵם	תִּבְיֵא	
		2 f.		תִּקְיָמִי	תִּבְיָאִי	
		1 c.		אָקִים	אִבְיֵא	
	pl.	3 m.	יִכְנוּ	יִקְיֵמוּ	יִבְיֵאוּ	יּוֹמְתוּ
		3 f.		תִּקְיָמֶינָה	תִּבְיָאֶינָה	
		2 m.		תִּקְיֵמוּ	תִּבְיֵאוּ	
		2 f.		תִּקְיָמֶינָה	תִּבְיָאֶינָה	
		1 c.		נָקִים	נִבְיֵא	
Juss.	sg.	3 m.		יָקֵם	יִבֵּא	וַיּוֹשֵׁב
waw-PC	sg.	3 m.		וַיִּקֶּם	וַיִּבֵּא	
Impv.	sg.	m.	הַכּוֹן	הָקֵם	הִבֵּא	
		f.		הָקִימָה	הִבְיֵאָה	
	pl.	m.		הָקִימִי	הִבְיֵאִי	
		f.		הָקִימוּ	הִבְיֵאוּ	
Inf. cs.			הַכּוֹן	הָקִים	הִבְיֵא	
Inf. abs.			הַכּוֹן	הָקֵם	הִבֵּא	
Part.	sg.	m.	נִכּוֹן	מִקְיֵם	מִבְיֵא	מוֹשֵׁב
		f.	נִכּוֹנָה	מִקְיָמָה		
	pl.	m.	נִכְּנִים	מִקְיָמִים	מִבְיָאִים	מוֹשְׁבִים
		f.		מִקְיֵמוֹת		

Notes

In the Niphal, the open prefix syllable in the suffix conjugation and the participle needs to be noted. In the prefix conjugation the /n/ of the Ni. is assimilated to the first root consonant, e.g., **yinkōn* > *yikkōn* יָכוֹן.

Hiphil forms are characterized by an open prefix syllable. If the prefix syllable immediately precedes the stressed syllable, it has a full vowel. Otherwise the

vowel is reduced.

In the suffix conjugation Hiphil and the participle, the vowel of the prefix syllable is /ē/ (*šere*) (cf. the Hiphil form of the strong verb **הִקְטִיב**). In the other forms, i.e., the prefix conjugation, the imperative, and the infinitives, it is /ā/ (*qameš*) (cf. the Hiphil prefix conjugation form of the strong verb **יִקְטִיב** etc.)

Before consonantal suffixes a long, unchanging connecting vowel /ō/ is usually inserted between the second root consonant and the suffix which carries the stress, e.g., **הִקְיֵמְתִי** *I have carried out* (1 Sam 15:13). However, forms without connecting vowel are attested, too, e.g., **הִנָּפַתְּ** (root **נִפַּח**) *you have swung [your tool above it]* (Exod 20:25).

In the prefix conjugation, 3/2 f. pl. forms without connecting vowel are attested, too, e.g., **תִּשְׁבְּנָה** (verb **שָׁבַח**), **תִּקְיִמְנָה** (verb **קָם**).

The doubly weak verb **בִּוֵּא** is frequently used in the Hiphil. As can be expected, the /ʔ/ is silent at the end of a syllable, but it functions as a consonant when a vowel follows. In the suffix conjugation Hiphil, the verb **בִּוֵּא** has usually forms without connecting vowel, e.g., **הִבֵּאתְּ** *you have brought*. But with enclitic personal pronouns forms with connecting vowel are used, e.g., **הִבֵּיאֲתָנִי** *you have brought me* (2 Sam 7:18).

In forms without suffix, II w/y verbs have distinct jussive and *wayyiqtol* forms in the Hiphil, e.g., **יָקֵם** *may he set up* as opposed to **יִקְיֵם** *he will set up*. waw-PC forms (*wayyiqtol*) show retraction of stress and shortening of the thematic vowel, e.g., **וַיָּקֶם** *wayyāqæm*; **וַיִּשָּׁב** *wayyāšæb*.

Long imperative forms of II w/y verbs have the long vowel /ī/ between the first and second root consonant in the Hiphil, e.g., **הִקְיִמָּה** and **הִבֵּיאָה**.

In the Hiphil, all II w/y verbs have the same thematic vowel irrespective of their thematic vowel in the Qal.

Suffix Conjugation

	$\bar{a}$ (< *a)	$\bar{e}$ (< *i)	$\bar{o}$ (< *u)
Q.	קָם	יָמַת	בִּוֵּשׁ
Hi.	הִקְיֵם	הִקְיֵמַת	הִבֵּיאוֹת

Prefix Conjugation

	$\bar{u}$	$\bar{i}$	$\bar{o}$ (< *ā)
Q.	יָקֵם	יָבִין	יָבִישׁוּ
Hi.	יִקְיֵם	יִבְיִן	יִבְיִשׁוּ

The verb **נָוַח** Q. *to rest* has two distinct sets of Hiphil forms with different meanings. Hiphil A follows the pattern of the verb **קָם** in the Hiphil. In Hiphil

B the first root consonant is geminated. The meaning of נִוּחַ in Hiphil A is *to cause to rest, to give rest*. In Hiphil B the meaning is *to lay, set down; to leave, let remain*. The verb נִוּחַ occurs in Hiphil A about 34 times and in Hiphil B about 69 times.

			Hiphil A	Hiphil B
SC	sg.	3 m.	הִנִּיחַ	הִנִּיחַ
PC	sg.	3 m.	יָנִיחַ	יָנִיחַ
waw-PC	sg.	3 m.	וַיָּנִיחַ	וַיָּנִיחַ
Impv.	sg.	m.		הִנֵּחַ
	pl.	m.	הִנְיִחוּ	הִנְיִחוּ
Inf. cs.			הִנִּיחַ	הִנִּיחַ
Part.	sg.	m.	מִנִּיחַ	מִנִּיחַ

In forms of the waw-PC and the imperative without suffixes the vowel between the two root consonants is /a/ (*pataḥ*) because of the guttural /ḥ/ ח. The Hiphil A waw-PC form וַיָּנִיחַ is identical to the corresponding Qal form; the context helps to distinguish the two forms.

The verb בּוֹשׁ Q. *to be ashamed* has two distinct Hiphil forms with different meanings. There are forms that follow the other II w/y verbs such as קוּם, e.g., הִתְבַּשְׁתָּ, הִתְבַּשְׁתָּ. These forms have the meaning *to put to shame*. The variant forms follow the Iy verbs, e.g., הִבְשִׁינוּ, הִבְשִׁינוּ. These forms have the meaning *to be put to shame, be ashamed*.

Hophal forms of II w/y verbs follow the pattern of Iy verbs. Originally the Hophal forms had a short vowel in the prefix syllable, e.g., **huqam*. As the short vowel /u/ in the open syllable had to be reduced, the characteristic vowel of the passive would have been lost. The short vowel was therefore lengthened **huqam* > *hūqam* by analogy with the Iy verbs.

Hophal forms with a vocalic suffix like הִמָּוֶתוּ *they were killed* (2 Sam 21:9) and הוּבְאוּ *they were brought in* (Gen 43:18) are the only forms of II w/y verbs without a vowel between the first and the second root consonant in Masoretic Hebrew.

24.2.2 Verbs II w/y: Polel, Polal and Hitpolel

With very few (and late) exceptions, II w/y verbs are not used in the Piel, Pual or Hitpael, e.g., לְקַיֵּם *to confirm* (Esth 9:29). Instead, they are used in the Polel, Polal and Hitpolel. These binyanim are characterized by a long unchangeable

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vowel /ō/ after the first root consonant and reduplication of the second root consonant. As a result, forms of these binyanim are easy to identify. The vowel /ō/ after the first root consonant is often spelled plene but may be spelled defectively, too. The meaning of the Polel, Polal and Hitpolel corresponds with the Piel, Pual and Hitpael, respectively. In Biblical Hebrew, there are 172 instances of Polel forms, 13 Polal forms and 70 Hitpolel forms.

The following table contains characteristic forms. For Polal the verb כּוּן *Po. to set up, establish* is used and for the Hitpolel the verb בִּין *Hitpo. to behave intelligently*, because these verbs are relatively frequent. Forms of other verbs supplement the two verbs, when important forms are missing.

			Polel	Polal	Hitpolel
SC	sg.	3 m.	כּוּן		הִתְבּוֹנֵן
		2 m.	כּוֹנֵן	חֹלֵלֶת	הִתְבּוֹנֶת
	pl.	3 c.	כּוֹנְנוּ	כּוֹנְנוּ	הִתְבּוֹנְנוּ
PC	sg.	3 m.	יְכּוֹן		יְתְּבּוֹן
		pl.	יְכּוֹנְנוּ*	יְחַלְלוּ	יְתְּבּוֹנְנוּ
Impv.	sg.	2 m.	כּוּן		הִתְבּוֹן
		pl.	כּוֹנְנוּ		הִתְבּוֹנְנוּ
Inf.	cs.		כּוֹנֵן		
Part.	sg.	m.	מְכּוֹן*	מְרוֹם	מְתְּבוֹרֵר
		pl.	מְכּוֹנִים*		מְתְּקוֹמִים

Notes

The immediate context helps to distinguish between ambiguous forms of the Polel (active) and Polal (passive).

Participles have a /m/ מְ as prefix consonant.

In the Polel and Hitpolel, the vowel /e/ after the second root consonant is changed to /a/ in suffix conjugation forms with consonantal suffix due to Philippi's Law.

In the Hitpolel, pausal forms have the vowel /ā/ between the reduplicated root consonant.

24.3 Exercises

24.3.1 Translation of Verbal Forms

Translate the following verbal forms. Identify the gender (masc., fem., comm.) and number (sg., pl.) of forms of which the English translation is ambiguous (i.e., *you, they*). Mark the stressed syllable if stress is not on the last syllable.

- 1 הָבִיא 2 תָּבִיא 3 הִבֵּאתָ 4 יָבִיאוּ 5 תִּכּוֹן 6 יִפְנוּ 7 נִכּוֹנוּ
8 הִמִּיתוּ 9 הִמָּתָם 10 וַיִּמִּיתוּ 11 הִסְרֵתִי 12 הִסִּירוּ 13 יָסִיר
14 יָסַר 15 הִשִּׁיבוּתָ 16 נָשִׁיב 17 הִנִּיחוּ 18 וַיִּנִּיחוּ

24.3.2 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: אֲמֹנֹן, חֲפְנִי, יְהוֹאָחָז, מְגִדּוֹ, שִׁישַׁק, קִיָּן, פִּינְחָס, נָכָה.

- 1 וַיָּבִיאוּ אֶת־אֲרֹן יְהוָה וַיַּצִּגּוּ¹ אֹתוֹ בַּמָּקוֹמוֹ בְּתוֹךְ הָאֹהֶל אֲשֶׁר נָטָה־לּוֹ דָּוִד וַיַּעַל דָּוִד עֲלוֹת לִפְנֵי יְהוָה וּשְׁלָמִים²: 2 וַיְהִי מִקֵּץ יָמִים³ וַיָּבֵא קִיָּן מִפְּרֵי הָאֲדָמָה מִנְחָה לַיהוָה: 3 וַיִּקְרָא אַבְימֶלֶךְ לְאַבְרָהָם וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ מָה־עָשִׂיתָ לָנוּ וְמָה־חָטָאתִי לָךְ כִּי־הִבֵּאתָ עָלַי וְעַל־מַמְלַכְתִּי חֲטָאָה⁴ גְּדֹלָה מֵעַשִׂים אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יַעֲשׂוּ עֲשִׂיתָ עִמָּדִי: 4 וַיֹּאמֶר רָאוּבֵן אֶל־אָבִיו לֹא־אָמַר אֶת־שְׁנֵי בְנֵי תַמִּית אִם־לֹא אַבְיָאנוּ אֵלֶיךָ תִּנָּה אֹתוֹ עַל־יָדַי וְאֲנִי אֲשִׁיבֶנּוּ אֵלֶיךָ: 5 כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה הִנְנִי מֵבִיא רָעָה אֶל־הַמָּקוֹם הַזֶּה וְעַל־יֹשְׁבָיו אֵת כָּל־דְּבָרֵי הַסֵּפֶר אֲשֶׁר קָרָא מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה: 6 וַיִּבְקֹשׁ שְׁלֹמֹה לְהַמִּית אֶת־יִרְבֵּעָם וַיִּקָּם יִרְבֵּעָם וַיִּבְרַח מִצָּרִים אֶל־שִׁישַׁק מֶלֶךְ־מִצְרַיִם וַיְהִי בַּמִּצְרַיִם עַד־מוֹת שְׁלֹמֹה: 7 בְּיָמָיו עָלָה פָּרְעֹה נָכָה מֶלֶךְ־מִצְרַיִם עַל־מֶלֶךְ אֲשׁוּר עַל־נְהַר־פָּרָת וַיִּלְךְ הַמֶּלֶךְ יֹאשִׁיָּהוּ לִקְרָאתוֹ וַיִּמִּיתֵהוּ בַּמְּגִדּוֹ כִּרְאֹתוֹ אֹתוֹ: וַיִּרְכְּבֵהוּ עֲבָדָיו מֵת מִמְּגִדּוֹ וַיָּבִיאוּהוּ יְרוּשָׁלַם וַיִּקְבְּרֵהוּ בַּקְּבֻרָתוֹ⁵ וַיִּקַּח עִם־הָאָרֶץ אֶת־יְהוֹאָחָז בֶּן־יֹאשִׁיָּהוּ וַיִּמְשְׁחוּ אֹתוֹ וַיִּמְלִיכוּ אֹתוֹ תַּחַת אָבִיו: 8 וַיֵּצֵא אַבְשָׁלוֹם אֶת־נַעֲרָיו לֵאמֹר רְאוּ נָא כָּטוֹב לִב־אֲמֹנֹן בְּלִין וְאִמְרֵתִי אֲלֵיכֶם הֲכֹן אֶת־אֲמֹנֹן וְהִמָּתָם אִתּוֹ אֶל־תִּירָאוּ הֲלֹא כִּי אֲנֹכִי צִנִּיתִי אֶתְכֶם חֲזָקוֹ וְהָיוּ לְבְנֵי־חֵיל: 9 מִכָּה אִישׁ וְמֵת מוֹת יוֹמֵת:

¹ יצג Hi. to set, place

² שְׁלָמִים a kind of offering: conclusion offering, salvation offering (see HALOT for details)

³ מִקֵּץ יָמִים after some time, literally after the end of days

⁴ חֲטָאָה sin, guilt

⁵ קְבֻרָה grave, burial

10 לא־יוֹמְתוּ אָבוֹת עַל־בָּנִים וּבָנִים לֹא־יוֹמְתוּ עַל־אָבוֹת אִישׁ בְּחַטָּאוֹ⁶ יוֹמְתוּ:
 11 וְזֶה־לֵךְ הָאוֹת אֲשֶׁר יָבֹא אֶל־שְׁנֵי בָנֶיךָ אֶל־חֲפָנִי וּפְיִנְחָס בְּיוֹם אֶחָד יָמוּתוּ
 שְׁנֵיהֶם: וְהִקְיַמְתִּי לִי כֹהֵן נֶאֱמָן כַּאֲשֶׁר בְּלִבִּי וּבְנַפְשִׁי יַעֲשֶׂה וּבְנִיתִי לוֹ בֵּית נֶאֱמָן
 וְהִתְהַלֵּךְ לִפְנֵי־מְשִׁיחִי⁷ כָּל־הַיָּמִים: 12 וְהָיָה אֲנִי עִמָּךְ וּשְׁמִרְתִּיךָ בְּכָל אֲשֶׁר־תֵּלֵךְ
 וְהִשְׁבַּתִּיךָ אֶל־הָאֲדָמָה הַזֹּאת כִּי לֹא אֶעֱזָבְךָ עַד אֲשֶׁר אִם־עָשִׂיתִי אֶת אֲשֶׁר־דִּבַּרְתִּי
 לָךְ: 13 וַיֹּאמֶר אֲלֵהֶם וְרַאיוּבֵן אֶל־תִּשְׁפְּכוּ־דָם הַשְּׁלִיכוּ אֹתוֹ אֶל־הַבּוֹר הַזֶּה אֲשֶׁר
 בְּמִדְבָּר וַיֵּד אֶל־תִּשְׁלַח־כּוֹזֵב לְמַעַן הַצִּיל אֹתוֹ מִיָּדָם לְהַשִּׁיבוֹ אֶל־אָבִיו: 14 וַיִּשְׁכְּמוּ
 אֲשֶׁדּוּדִים⁸ מִמַּחֲרָת⁹ וְהָיָה דָגוֹן¹⁰ נָפַל לִפְנֵי אֶרְצָה לִפְנֵי אֶרֶץ וַיְהִי וַיִּקְחוּ אֶת־דָּגוֹן
 וַיִּשְׁבּוּ אֹתוֹ לְמִקְוָמוֹ: 15 וַיִּקַּח יְהוָה אֱלֹהִים אֶת־הָאֲרָם וַיַּנְתְּהוּ בְּגֶן־עֵדֶן¹¹ לְעִבְדָּהּ
 וּלְשִׁמְרָהּ: 16 וַיַּדְבֵּר שְׂמוּאֵל אֶל־הָעָם אֵת מִשְׁפַּט הַמֶּלֶכְהָ¹² וַיִּכְתֹּב בַּסֵּפֶר וַיִּנַּח
 לִפְנֵי יְהוָה וַיִּשְׁלַח שְׂמוּאֵל אֶת־כָּל־הָעָם אִישׁ לְבֵיתוֹ: 17 זְכוּר¹³ אֶת־הַדְּבָר אֲשֶׁר
 צִוָּה אֶתְכֶם מִשָּׁה עֶבֶד־יְהוָה לֵאמֹר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם מְנִיחַ לָכֶם וְנָתַן לָכֶם אֶת־הָאָרֶץ
 הַזֹּאת: 18 וַיִּשְׁכַּב דָּוִד עִם־אֲבֹתָיו וַיִּקְבֹּר בְּעִיר דָּוִד: וְהַיָּמִים אֲשֶׁר מָלַךְ דָּוִד
 עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה בְּחִבְרוֹן מָלַךְ שִׁבְעַת שָׁנִים וּבִירוּשָׁלַם מָלַךְ שְׁלֹשִׁים וְשֵׁשׁ
 שָׁנִים: וּשְׁלֹמֹה יָשָׁב עַל־פֶּסֶא דָּוִד אָבִיו וַתִּכֶּן מַלְכָּתוֹ מֵאֵד: 19 וַיֹּאמֶר שְׂמוּאֵל
 אֶל־כָּל־בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל לֵאמֹר אִם־בְּכָל־לִבְבְּכֶם אַתֶּם שָׁבִים אֶל־יְהוָה הִסִּירוּ אֶת־אֱלֹהֵי
 הַנֶּכֶר¹⁴ מִתּוֹכְכֶם וְהַעֲשִׂתֶם עִשְׂתֵּרוֹת¹⁵ וְהָכִינוּ לִבְבְּכֶם אֶל־יְהוָה וְעִבְדֶּהוּ לְבִדּוֹ וַיֵּצֵל אֶתְכֶם
 מִיַּד פְּלִשְׁתִּים: וַיִּסִּירוּ בְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־הַבַּעַלִּים וְאֶת־הָעִשְׂתֵּרוֹת וַיַּעֲבְדוּ אֶת־יְהוָה
 לְבִדּוֹ: 20 כִּי יִמְלְאוּ יָמֶיךָ וְשִׁכַּבְתָּ אֶת־אֲבֹתֶיךָ וְהִקְיַמְתִּי אֶת־זֶרְעֶךָ אַחֲרֶיךָ
 אֲשֶׁר יֵצֵא מִמֶּעֶיךָ¹⁶ וְהָכִינֹתִי אֶת־מַמְלַכְתּוֹ: הוּא יְבַנֶּה־בֵּית לְשִׁמִּי וְכִנֵּנֹתִי אֶת־פֶּסֶא
 מִמְלַכְתּוֹ עַד־עוֹלָם: אֲנִי אֶהְיֶה־לּוֹ לְאָב וְהוּא יִהְיֶה־לִּי לְבֵן אֲשֶׁר בְּתַעֲוֹתוֹ¹⁷ וְהִכַּחֲתִיו
 בְּשִׁבְטֵי אֲנָשִׁים וּבְנִי אָדָם: וְחִסְדִּי לֹא־יִסּוּר מִמֶּנּוּ כַּאֲשֶׁר הִסְדֵּתִי מִעַם שְׂאוּל
 אֲשֶׁר הִסְדֵּתִי מִלִּפְנֵיךָ: וְנֶאֱמָן בֵּיתְךָ וּמִמְלַכְתְּךָ עַד־עוֹלָם לִפְנֵיךָ כִּסְאֶךָ יִהְיֶה נָכוֹן
 עַד־עוֹלָם:

⁶ חטא *hēt(?) sin, guilt*

⁷ משיח *anointed*

⁸ אשדודי *person from Ashdod* (one of the five cities of the Philistines)

⁹ מִמַּחֲרָת *mimmachrāt on the following day*

¹⁰ דָּגוֹן *Philistine deity*

¹¹ גֶּן־עֵדֶן *Garden of Eden*

¹² מְלֹכָה *kingship, kingdom*

¹³ זְכוּר *here used as an imperative*

¹⁴ נֶכֶר *foreignness*

¹⁵ עִשְׂתֵּרוֹת *Astarte* (name of a female deity); pl.

¹⁶ מִמֶּעִים *internal organs, inward parts* (intestines, bowels), *belly*, here as source of procreation

(BDB)

¹⁷ עוה *Hi. to go astray*

24.4 Hebrew Reading: 1 Kings 19:1–8

Translate 1 Kings 19:1–8 with the help of notes below the text.

¹ וַיִּגְדֹּ אַחֲאָב לְאִיזָבֵל אֶת כָּל-אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה אֱלֹהֵיוּ וְאֶת כָּל-אֲשֶׁר הָרַג אֶת-הַנְּבִיאִים בְּחָרֹב: ² וַתִּשְׁלַח אִיזָבֵל מַלְאָךְ אֶל-אֱלֹהֵיוּ לֵאמֹר כֹּה-יַעֲשׂוּן אֱלֹהִים וְכֹה יוֹסֶפוּן כִּי-כָעַת מִחֹר אָשִׁים אֶת-נַפְשְׁךָ בְּנֶפֶשׁ אֶחָד מֵהֶם: ³ וַיָּרָא וַיִּקָּם וַיֵּלֶךְ אֶל-נַפְשׁוֹ וַיָּבֹא בְּאֵר שָׁבַע אֲשֶׁר לַיהוֹדָה וַיִּנַּח אֶת-נַעְרֹ שָׁם: ⁴ וְהוּא-הָלַךְ בְּמִדְבַּר הַדֶּרֶךְ יוֹם וַיָּבֹא וַיֵּשֶׁב תַּחַת רֶתֶם אֶחָד וַיִּשְׁאַל אֶת-נַפְשׁוֹ לָמוּת וַיֹּאמֶר רַב עֲתָה יְהוָה קָח נַפְשִׁי כִּי-לֹא-טוֹב אֲנִכִּי מֵאֲבֹתַי: ⁵ וַיִּשְׁכַּב וַיִּישָׁן תַּחַת רֶתֶם אֶחָד וַהֲנִה-זֶה מַלְאָךְ נֹגֵעַ בּוֹ וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ קוּם אֲכֹל: ⁶ וַיָּט וַהֲנִה מִרְאֲשֵׁתוֹ עֵגֶת רָצָפִים וְצִפְחַת מִיָּם וַיֹּאכַל וַיִּשֶׁת וַיֵּשֶׁב וַיִּשְׁכַּב: ⁷ וַיִּשָּׁב מַלְאָךְ יְהוָה וַיִּנְעֵ-בּוֹ וַיֹּאמֶר קוּם אֲכַל כִּי רַב מִמֶּךָ הַדֶּרֶךְ: ⁸ וַיִּקָּם וַיֹּאכַל וַיִּשְׁתֶּה וַיֵּלֶךְ בְּכַח הָאֲכִילָה הַהִיא אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם וְאַרְבָּעִים לַיְלָה עַד הָר הָאֱלֹהִים חָרֹב:

19:3	בְּאֵר שָׁבַע	name of a place in the Negev (cf. Gen 21:31; 26:33)
19:4	רֶתֶם	broom-plant (<i>Retama raetam</i>) (m. or f.)
	רַב	here enough!
19:5	יָשָׁן	Q. to sleep
	וַהֲנִה-זֶה	and look, there!
19:6	מִרְאֲשֵׁתוֹ	as a local adverbial phrase <i>at his head-place</i> (of someone lying down) (BDB) from the noun מִרְאֲשֹׁת
	עֵגֶה	round flat loaf (of bread, which is quickly baked in ashes or on glowing baking stones; HALOT)
	רָצָף	glowing coal
	צִפְחַת	pitcher
19:8	אֲכִילָה	meal, food

Chapter 25

25.1 Vocabulary

25.1.1 Verbs

ברא	Q. <i>to create</i>
חלל	Hi. <i>to begin</i> ; Pi. <i>to profane</i> ; <i>to put into use</i>
חתת	Ni. <i>to be dismayed</i> ; <i>to be terrified</i> ; Q. <i>to be shattered</i> ; <i>to be filled with terror</i>
יעץ	Q. <i>to advice, counsel</i> ; Ni. <i>to consult together</i> ; <i>to exchange council</i>
פעל	Q. <i>to do</i> ; <i>to make</i>
פרר	Hi. <i>to break, violate</i> ; <i>to frustrate, make ineffectual</i>
רחק	Q. <i>to be far, distant</i> ; Hi. <i>to remove</i> ; <i>to depart, withdraw, distance oneself</i>
רעע	Q. <i>to be bad, evil, displeasing</i> ; Hi. <i>to do evil</i> ; <i>to treat badly</i>
שםם	Q. <i>to be uninhabited, be deserted</i> ; <i>to shudder, be appalled</i> ; Ni. <i>to be made uninhabited, deserted</i> ; <i>to be made to tremble</i>

25.1.2 Nouns

אלמנה	widow
דבש	honey
חץ	arrow (gem. noun; pl. חצים)
מחשבה	thought; device, plan, purpose
עמל	trouble; labor; toil
ערונה	nakedness; genital area
צל	shadow, shade (gem. noun; with ePP צלף)

קָטַן	<i>small; young; unimportant</i> (adj.; cs. st. קָטַן; only in m. sg., other forms from קָטַן)
קָטַן	<i>small; young; unimportant</i> (adj.; pl. קָטָנִים)
קָצִיר	<i>harvest; harvest crops</i>
שָׁוְא	<i>emptiness; nothingness</i>
שְׁמָמָה	<i>desolation; devastation; waste</i>

25.2 Verbs II Geminate: Derived Binyanim

25.2.1 Verbs II Geminate: Niphal, Hiphil and Hophal

The Niphal forms are characterized by an open prefix syllable in the suffix conjugation and the participle. In the prefix conjugation, the imperative and infinitives the /n/ is assimilated to the first root consonant, e.g., *yinsab* > *yissab* יִסַּב.

In the Hiphil, many forms are characterized by open prefix syllables. In prefix conjugation forms, the prefix syllable may be open. In this case, the second root consonant is geminated when suffixes are attached. But the first root consonant may be doubled in prefix conjugation forms, as well (so-called aramaizing forms).

Hophal forms follow the pattern of Iy verbs in order to preserve the original short vowel /u/ in the prefix syllable: **husab* > *hūsab* הוּסַב.

As in the Qal, vocalic suffixes are not stressed. A connecting vowel is inserted between the geminated second root consonant and a consonantal suffix. The connecting vowel bears the stress.

When suffixes are added, the gemination of the second root consonant is preserved.

The following table only contains selected forms because of the relative infrequency of II gem. verbs in the derived binyanim.

25.2 Verbs II Geminate: Derived Binyanim

			Niphal	Hiphil	Hophal
SC	sg.	3 m.	נָסַב	הִסֵּב	הוּסַב
		3 f.	נָסְבָּה		
		2 m.		הִסְבֹּתָ	
		1 c.	נָסַבְתִּי	הִסְבֹּתִי	
		pl. 3 c.	נָסְבוּ	הִסְבוּ	
PC	sg.	3 m.	יָסַב	יָסַב/יָסַב	יּוּסַב
		pl. 3 m.	יָסְבוּ	יָסְבוּ/יָסְבוּ	
		3 f.		תִּסְבִּינָה	
Juss.	sg.	3 m.		יָסַב	
waw-PC	sg.	3 m.		וַיָּסַב/וַיָּסַב	וּיּוּסַב
Impv.	sg.	m.		הִסֵּב	
		pl. m.		הִסְבוּ	
Inf. cs.			הִסֵּב	הִסֵּב	
			הִסְבֵּ		
Part.	sg.	m.	נָסַב	מִסֵּב	
		f.	נָסְבָּה		
	pl.	m.	נָסְבִים		
		f.	נָסְבוֹת		

Notes

In the suffix conjugation Niphal, the thematic vowel between the first and second root consonant may be /ō/ or /ē/ instead of /a/, e.g., וְנִבְּיוּ *and they will be plundered*, וְנִמָּס *it is melted* (but as a pausal form נִמָּס).

The I gutt. and II gem. verb חָתַת has Niphal prefix conjugation forms with a lengthened prefix vowel as result of the loss of the gemination, e.g., יַחַת (**yinhāt* > **yihhāt* > *yēhāt*). In the suffix conjugation, the 3 m. sg. form נָחַת is attested once.

In the Hiphil the thematic vowel of the 3 f. sg. and 3 c. pl. forms may be either /a/ or /ē/, e.g., הִסְבּוּ *they brought round* (1 Sam 5:9–10), הִחֲלָה *she/it began* (Judg 20:40), הִחֲלִי *they began* (1 Sam 3:2).

With a guttural or /r/ as second root consonant the thematic vowel may be

lengthened when suffixes are added, e.g., **וְהִצַּרְתִּי** *and I will cause distress* (Jer 10:18), **הָרַעְתָּם** *you have done something bad* (Gen 43:6).

Forms without a connecting vowel between the second root consonant and the consonantal suffix are also found, e.g., **וְהִפְרַתָּהּ** *and you shall make ineffectual* (2 Sam 15:34). In this form the gemination of the second root consonant is lost.

Aramaizing forms with a geminated first root occur a number of times, e.g., **וַיִּסָּב** *and he caused to go around* (Josh 6:11), **וַיִּסְבּוּ** *and they brought* (1 Sam 5:8), **יָתֵם** *let him count out the entire amount* (2 Kgs 22:4), **יִהְיֶה** (with loss of the gemination of the /h/ and preservation of the short vowel) *let him [not] make invalid* (Num 30:3).

In rare cases, the gemination of the second root consonant is missing, e.g., **וַיִּבְקַהּ** *and it shall be disturbed* (3 fem. sg. waw-SC Ni. from the verb **בָּקַק**; Jes 19:3), **וַיַּעֲזֶהָ** *she made [her face] bold* (3 fem. sg. SC Hi. from the verb **עָזָה**; Prov 7:13).

Contamination with forms of II w/y verbs may happen occasionally, e.g., **תִּבְּזֹז** (verb **עָזָה** Ni.) *[the earth] will be plundered* (Isa 24:3), **יִשְׁיִם** (שָׁמַם Hi.) *he will devastate* (Jer 49:20). Other deviating forms are attested as well.

25.2.2 Verbs II Geminate: Polel, Polal and Hitpolel

Verbs II gem. are used in the Piel, Pual and Hitpael relatively frequently. Like II w/y verbs, they are used in the Polel, Polal and Hitpolel, binyanim, which are characterized by a long unchangeable vowel /ō/ after the first root consonant and reduplication of the second root consonant. These binyanim correspond with the Piel, Pual and Hitpael in terms of their meaning.

The following table contains characteristic forms. The verb **עָלָל** Polel *to act arbitrarily (toward)* is used, because it occurs in all three binyanim Polel, Polal and Hitpolel. Forms of other verbs supplement this verb, when important forms are missing.

			Polel	Polal	Hitpolel
SC	sg.	3 m.	עוֹלֵל	עוֹלֵל	הִתְהוֹלָלוּ
		3 f.			
	pl.	2 m.	עוֹלְלִים		הִתְהוֹלְלוּ
		3 c.	עוֹלְלִים		

			Polel	Polal	Hitpolel
PC	sg.	3 m.	יִשְׁדֹּר		יִתְגַּדֵּר
	pl.	3 c.	יַעֲלִלּוּ	יִרְפְּפוּ	יִתְהַלְלוּ
Impv.	sg.	2 m.	עוֹלֵל		
	pl.	2 m.			הִתְקוּשְׁשׁוּ
Inf. cs.			קָשַׁשׁ		הִתְעוֹלֵל
			עוֹלֵל		
Part.	sg.	m.	מְקַשֵּׁשׁ	מְהוֹלֵל	מְתַגַּדֵּל
	pl.	m.	מְחַקְקִים		מְתַגַּדְדִּים

Notes

The immediate context helps to distinguish between ambiguous forms of the Polel (active) and Polal (passive).

Participles have a /m/ מְ as prefix consonant.

In pausal forms of the Hitpolel /ā/ is found instead of /ē/, e.g., יִתְגַּדְּרִי *you cut yourself* (Jer 47:5).

25.3 The Marker of Subordination · שְׁ

The marker of subordination שְׁ is placed in front of the following word with a *dageš forte* in the first consonant of this word. At times, one finds *pataḥ* instead of *segol*, i.e., שֶׁ. Before /r/ and /ʕ/ the vowel is changed to /ā/ and the *dageš forte* is lost leading to שֵׁ

The particle שְׁ functions similarly to the much more frequent אֲשֶׁר. Important functions are:

- marking relative clauses, e.g., כַּחֲלוֹל שְׁעַל-שְׂפַת הַיָּם *as the sand which is upon the shore of the sea* (Judg 7:12; cf. אֲשֶׁר עַל-שְׂפַת הַיָּם in Gen 22:17)
- as an alternative construction for a construct chain or an enclitic personal pronoun, e.g., בְּרִמִּי שְׁלִי *my vineyard* (Song 1:6)
- introducing an object clause, e.g., וְעֲשִׂיתָ לִּי אוֹת שְׁאֵתָהּ מִדְּבַר עָמִי *and give me a sign that it is you who speak with me* (Judg 6:17); וַיִּדְעֵתִי גַם-אֲנִי שְׁמִקְרָהּ *Yet I know that one fate will befall them all* (Qoh 2:14)

- introducing a causal subordinate clause, e.g., פִּתְחִי־לִי אֶחָתִי רְעִיתִי יוֹנָתִי, *Open to me, my sister, my beloved, my dove, my perfect one, for my head is filled with dew* (Song 5:2)
- introducing a final subordinate clause, e.g., וַהֲאֱלֹהִים עָשָׂה שִׁירָאוֹ מִלְּפָנָיו, *and God has done this so that one would fear him* (Qoh 3:14)
- with prepositions in various functions

The subordination marker ׀ occurs 138 times in the Hebrew Bible and is mainly used in Late Biblical Hebrew or in a few earlier texts of northern origin. It is especially frequent in Song of Songs and Qohelet.

25.4 Asyndetic Relative Clauses

Relative clauses are usually introduced with the subordination marker אֲשֶׁר or much less frequently ׀. They are then called *syndetic* relative clauses. It is possible, however, to attach a relative clause directly to the antecedent without a subordination marker. Both verbal clauses (Jer 13:20; Deut 32:17; Exod 18:20; Jer 5:15) and verbless clauses (Isa 51:7) may function as *asyndetic* relative clauses.

אֵיזָה הָעֶדֶר נָתַן־לָךְ	<i>Where is the flock that was given to you?</i> (Jer 13:20)
וְהוֹדַעְתָּ לָהֶם אֶת־הַדֶּרֶךְ יֵלְכוּ בָּהּ וְאֶת־הַמַּעֲשֵׂה אֲשֶׁר יַעֲשׂוּן	<i>... and you shall make known to them the way in which they must walk and what they must do</i> (Exod 18:20; followed by a noun with a syndetic relative clause)
יִזְבְּחוּ לַשִּׂדִּים לֹא אֱלֹהִים אֱלֹהִים לֹא יָדְעוּם	<i>They sacrificed to demons that were no god, [to] gods they did not know</i> (Deut 32:17)
גֹּיִל־לֹא־תִדְעֶה לְשׁוֹנוֹ	<i>a people whose language you do not know</i> (Jer 5:15)
עַם תּוֹרָתִי בְּלִבָּם	<i>the people in whose heart is my instruction</i> (Isa 51:7)

25.5 Exercises

25.5.1 Translation of Verbal Forms

Translate the following verbal forms. Identify the gender (masc., fem., comm.) and number (sg., pl.) of forms of which the English translation is ambiguous (i.e., *you, they*). Mark the stressed syllable if stress is not on the last syllable.

- 1 החלו 2 החלתי 3 ויחלו 4 ויחל 5 יחתו 6 תחתו 7 הפר
8 הפרתה 9 הפרו 10 תפרו 11 הרעתם 12 הרעתה 13 נירעו
14 מרעים 15 ישם 16 שממו 17 בראתי 18 תטמאו 19 יונעצו
20 נועצו

25.5.2 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: **אחיתפל**, **גלעד**, **חוש**, **ע**, **צדוק**, **עמרי** (almost always with the article).

- 1 ויאמר יהוה אל־יהושע היום הזה אחל גדלך בעיני כל־ישראל אשר ידעון כי פאשר הייתי עם־משה אהיה עמך: 2 ויאמרו העם שרי גלעד איש אל־רעהו מי האיש אשר יחל להלחם בבני עמון יהיה לראש לכל ישרי גלעד: 3 אדני יהוה אתה החלית להראות את־עבדך את־גדלך¹ ואת־ידך החזקה אשר מי־אל בשמים ובארץ אשר יעשה כמעשיך וכגבורתך: 4 ותחלינה שבע שני הרעב לבוא פאשר אמר יוסף ויהי רעב בכל־הארצות ובכל־ארץ מצרים היה לחם: 5 ראה נתן יהוה אליהך לפניך את־הארץ עליה רש פאשר דבר יהוה אליהי אבתיך לך אל־תירא ואל־תחת: 6 ויאמר יהוה אל־יהושע אל־תירא ואל־תחת קח עמך את כל־עם המלחמה וקום עליה העי ראה ונתתי בידך את־מלך העי ואת־עמו ואת־עירו ואת־ארצו: 7 ויאמר חושי אל־אבשלום לא־טובה העצה אשר יעץ אחיתפל בפעם הזאת: 8 ויאמר אבשלום וכל־איש ישראל טובה עצת חושי הארכי² מעצת אחיתפל ויהנה צוה להפך את־עצת אחיתפל הטובה לבעבור הביא יהוה אל־אבשלום את־הרעה: 9 ויאמר יהוה אל־משה הן קרבו ימיה למות קרא את־יהושע והתיצבו באהל מועד ואציגו וילך משה ויהושע ויתיצבו באהל מועד: וירא יהוה באהל בעמוד ענן ויעמוד עמוד הענן על־פתח האהל: ויאמר יהוה אל־משה הנה שכב עם־אבתיך וקם העם הזה וינה ו אחרי ו אליהי

¹ גדל greatness

² ארכי Archite (gentilic noun)

נִכְרָ³ הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר הוּא בֹא-שְׁמָהּ בְּקִרְבּוֹ וַעֲזָבֵנִי וְהִפֵּר אֶת-בְּרִיתִי אֲשֶׁר כָּרַתִּי אִתּוֹ:
 וְחָרָה אַפִּי בּוֹ בַּיּוֹם-הַהוּא וַעֲזָבֹתַיִם וְהִסְתֵּרְתִּי פָנַי מִהֶם וְהָיָה לֵאכֹל וּמִצָּאָהוּ רָעוֹת
 רַבּוֹת וּצְרוֹת וְאָמַר בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא הֲלֹא עַל כִּי-אֵין אֱלֹהֵי בְּקִרְבִּי מִצָּאוֹנִי הָרָעוֹת הָאֵלֶּה:
 וְאֲנֹכִי הִסְתֵּר אֶסְתִּיר פָּנַי בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא עַל כֹּל-הָרָעָה אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה כִּי פָנָה אֶל-אֱלֹהִים
 אֲחֵרִים: ¹⁰ וַיַּעֲשֶׂה עִמָּרִי הָרַע בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה וַיִּרַע מְכֹל אֲשֶׁר לִפְנָיו: ¹¹ וַיֹּאמֶר
 הַמֶּלֶךְ לְצִדִּיק הִשָּׁב אֶת-אֲרוֹן הָאֱלֹהִים הָעִיר אִם-אֲמָצָא חַן בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה וְהִשָּׁבִי
 וְהִרְאֵנִי אִתּוֹ וְאֶת-נֹנְהוּ: ⁴ ¹² וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלָיו הֶעָבֵד אֵילֵל לֹא-תֹאכְלָה הָאִשָּׁה לָלֶכֶת
 אַחֲרַי אֶל-הָאָרֶץ הַזֹּאת הִהְשֵׁב אֲשִׁיב אֶת-בְּנִיךָ אֶל-הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר-יֵצֵאתָ מִשָּׁם: וַיֹּאמֶר
 אֵלָיו אֲבִרְהֶם הַשָּׁמֶר⁵ לְךָ פֶּן-תִּשָּׁיב אֶת-בְּנִי שְׁמָה:

25.6 Hebrew Reading: 1 Kings 19:9–14

Translate 1 Kings 19:9–14 with the help of notes below the text.

⁹ וַיָּבֹא-שָׁם אֶל-הַמְעָרָה וַיֵּלֶן שָׁם וַהֲנִה דְּבַר-יְהוָה אֵלָיו וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ מַה-לָּךְ פֹּה
 אֵלֶיָּהוּ: ¹⁰ וַיֹּאמֶר קָנָא קָנָאתִי לַיהוָה | אֵלֹהֵי צִבְאוֹת כִּי-עָזָבוּ בְּרִיתְךָ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל
 אֶת-מִזְבְּחֶיךָ הָרְסוּ וְאֶת-נְבִיאֶיךָ הָרְגוּ בַּחֶרֶב וְאֹתָתְךָ אֲנִי לְבִדִּי וַיִּבְקֶשׁוּ אֶת-נַפְשִׁי
 לְקַחְתָּהּ: ¹¹ וַיֹּאמֶר צֵא וְעִמַּדְתָּ בְּהָר לִפְנֵי יְהוָה וַהֲנִה יְהוָה עִבֵּר וְרוּחַ גְּדוּלָּה
 וְחֹזֶק מִפְּרֹק הָרִים וּמִשִּׁבְרֵי סִלְעִים לִפְנֵי יְהוָה לֹא כָרוּחַ יְהוָה וְאַחֲרֵי הָרוּחַ רָעַשׁ לֹא
 בָּרֶעַשׁ יְהוָה: ¹² וְאַחֲרֵי הָרֶעַשׁ אֵשׁ לֹא בָאָשׁ יְהוָה וְאַחֲרֵי הָאֵשׁ קוֹל דְּמָמָה דִּקְקָה:
¹³ וַיְהִי | כִּשְׁמַע אֵלֶיָּהוּ וַיִּגַּלֵּט פָּנָיו בְּאֹדְרֹתָיו וַיֵּצֵא וַיַּעֲמֵד פֶּתַח הַמְעָרָה וַהֲנִה אֵלָיו קוֹל
 וַיֹּאמֶר מַה-לָּךְ פֹּה אֵלֶיָּהוּ: ¹⁴ וַיֹּאמֶר קָנָא קָנָאתִי לַיהוָה | אֵלֹהֵי צִבְאוֹת כִּי-עָזָבוּ
 בְּרִיתְךָ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת-מִזְבְּחֶיךָ הָרְסוּ וְאֶת-נְבִיאֶיךָ הָרְגוּ בַּחֶרֶב וְאֹתָתְךָ אֲנִי לְבִדִּי
 וַיִּבְקֶשׁוּ אֶת-נַפְשִׁי לְקַחְתָּהּ:

19:9	מְעָרָה	cave
19:10	קָנָא	Pi. to be jealous; to be zealous
	הָרַס	Q. to tear down; to throw down
19:11	פָּרַק	Pi. to tear off; to tear out
	שָׁבַר	Pi. to shatter; to break

³ נִכְרָ foreignness; foreign

⁴ נֹנְהָ grazing place; stopping place, settlement (HALOT)

⁵ שָׁמֶר Ni. to be on one's guard

25.6 Hebrew Reading: 1 Kings 19:9–14

	רַעַשׁ	<i>earthquake</i>
19:13	דָּמָמָה	<i>calm</i> (cessation of strong movement of air) (<i>HALOT</i>)
	דָּק	<i>thin; scarce; fine; here: small, soft</i>
	לוּט	Hi. <i>to wrap</i>
	אֶדְרֶת	<i>cloak, robe</i> (fem.)
	מַעְרָה	<i>cave</i>
19:14	קָנָא	Pi. <i>to be jealous; to be zealous</i>
	הָרַס	Q. <i>to tear down; to throw down</i>

Chapter 26

26.1 Vocabulary

26.1.1 Verbs

חווה	Hištaphel <i>to bow down, prostrate; to worship</i>
יָרָה ₃	Hi. <i>to instruct, teach</i> (cf. תּוֹרָה)
נָרַח	Hi. <i>to thrust; thrust out; thrust away</i>

26.1.2 Nouns

אַחֲרֵי	<i>last, latter</i> (temp.); <i>at the back; western</i> (local) (adj.)
אָנוּשׁ	<i>mankind, (all) human beings, man; (some) men; single human being</i> (mostly poet.)
אַרְיֵה/אַרְיָה	<i>lion</i>
בְּתוּלָה	<i>virgin</i>
נֵיָא	<i>valley</i> (gay(?); pl. נֵאִיּוֹת)
מְדִינָה	<i>province</i>
מוֹסָר	<i>discipline; training; exhortation, warning</i>
עֲלִיּוֹן	<i>highest, most high</i>
פֶּסַח	<i>Passover, Pesach</i>
רֵאשִׁית	<i>beginning; first, chief</i>
רָחֹב	<i>broad open place, plaza</i>

26.1.3 Other Parts of Speech

הוּי	<i>ah! alas! ha!</i> (interjection expressing usually dissatisfaction and pain)
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26.2 The Verb חוה Hištaphel

The III_y verb חוה *to bow down, prostrate; to worship* occurs about 170 times in the Hebrew Bible. It is only used in the Hištaphel (or more precisely Hištap̄'el), a binyan that is characterized by a causative prefix consonant /š/, the consonant /t/ which marks reflexivity and, in the suffix conjugation, the imperative and the infinitive construct, a prosthetic /h/. At the same time, חוה is the only verb used in the Hištaphel.

The following forms can be mentioned as examples:

SC	sg.	3 m.	הִשְׁתַּחֲוָה
		2 m.	הִשְׁתַּחֲוִיתָ
		1 c.	הִשְׁתַּחֲוִיתִי
	pl.	3 c.	הִשְׁתַּחֲווּ
		2 m.	וְהִשְׁתַּחֲוִיתֶם
PC	sg.	3 m.	יִשְׁתַּחֲוָה
		2 m.	תִּשְׁתַּחֲוָה
		1 c.	אֲשְׁתַּחֲוָה
	pl.	2 m.	תִּשְׁתַּחֲווּ
		1 c.	נִשְׁתַּחֲוָה
waw-PC	sg.	3 m.	וַיִּשְׁתַּחֲוּ
	pl.	3 m.	וַיִּשְׁתַּחֲווּ
Impv.	pl.	m.	הִשְׁתַּחֲווּ
Inf. cs.			הִשְׁתַּחֲוֹת
Part.	sg.	m.	מִשְׁתַּחֲוָה
	pl.	m.	מִשְׁתַּחֲוִים

Notes

The verb shows the morphological features of III_y verbs.

In the *wayyiqṭol*-form without suffixes (3 m./f. sg.) the apocopate forms have a long vowel /ū/ at the end: *wayyištaḥw > wayyištaḥuw > wayyištāhū וַיִּשְׁתַּחֲוּ. In pausal forms the *pataḥ* is lengthened to *qameṣ*, e.g., וַיִּשְׁתַּחֲוּ.

Traditionally, these forms were considered Hitpa'lel forms of a verb שחה with metathesis of the /t/ and the /š/ and reduplication of the third element of the root, first as a semivowel /w/ and then as a vocalic element as usual with III_y

verbs.¹

Since the Ugaritic language, a Central Semitic language from the period of 1400–1200 BCE that is similar to Hebrew, was deciphered in 1930, most scholars analyze these forms as Hištap‘el of a root חוה, because in Ugaritic a Hištap‘el binyan including forms of a verb ḥwy with similar forms and identical meaning as the Hebrew verb חוה is clearly attested, e.g., *tšḥwy she prostrates herself*.

26.3 The Qal Passive

Some verbal forms appear to be Pual or Hophal forms. It can be shown, however, that these forms are remnants of a Qal passive binyan which is the passive counterpart to the Qal in the same way as the Hophal and the Pual are the passive counterparts to the Hiphil and the Piel. The Qal passive was being phased out during the period of Biblical Hebrew but the existing forms in the biblical texts were preserved. The following arguments for the existence of the Qal passive can be mentioned:

1. These alleged Pual or Hophal forms do not have active counterparts in the Piel or Hiphil, respectively.
2. These forms have a meaning that serves as the passive to the meaning of the verbs in question in the Qal.
3. The verb לקח has suffix conjugation forms that are vocalized as Pual and prefix conjugation forms that look like Hophal forms, e.g., לָקַחְתָּ (3 m. sg. SC), יִקָּח (3 m. sg. PC; with assimilation of the /l/). Yet, the meaning of the verb is identical, namely passive to Qal forms: *to be taken*. This situation would be unusual for how the binyanim function in Biblical Hebrew without the assumption of a Qal passive.
4. Classical Arabic has passive forms in Stem I, the equivalent of the Qal binyan in Hebrew, e.g., *fu‘ila it was done* as opposed to the active form *fa‘ala he did*. Internal passive forms are also attested in Old Aramaic and Biblical Aramaic.

Qal passive forms are characterized by the vowel sequence *u–a* which is characteristic of passive forms. The following examples are illustrative:

- suffix conjugation: לָקַחְתָּ (3 m. sg.), לָקַחְתָּהּ (3 f. sg.), יִלְדוּ (3 c. pl.)
- prefix conjugation: יִקָּח (verb לקח), יִתֵּן (verb נתן), יִוָּשֶׁה (verb ישית), וְתִקָּח (verb לקח; 3 f. sg. waw-PC)

¹ Cf. GKC § 75 *kk*; BDB 1005a.

- participle: אֶכֶּל (m. sg.; Exod 3:2); לִקַּח (2 Kgs 2:10)

These forms show the characteristics of weak verbs like the assimilation of /n/ or /l/ as in the case of the verb לִקַּח. The following illustrate the use of the Qal passive:

וַיִּשְׁלַחְהוּ יְהוָה אֱלֹהִים מִן־עֵדֶן לַעֲבֹד אֶת־הָאֲדָמָה אֲשֶׁר לָקַח מִשָּׁם	<i>And the Lord God sent him away from the garden of Eden to work the ground from which he had been taken (Gen 3:23)</i>
זֹאת יִקְרָא אִשָּׁה כִּי מֵאִישׁ לִקְחָהּ־זֹאת	<i>This one shall be called woman because from man she has been taken (Gen 2:23b)</i>
וַתִּקַּח הָאִשָּׁה בֵּית פַּרְעֹה	<i>And the woman was taken into Pharaoh's house (Gen 12:15)</i>

Qal passive forms were already recognized as such by Jewish grammarians during the Middle Ages. In the middle of the 19th century they were rediscovered as Qal passive forms by western scholars and not considered Pual or Hophal forms anymore. Modern lexica recognize Qal passive forms to different degrees. For the identification of Qal passive forms it is recommended to consult *HALOT* or Wilhelm Gesenius, *Hebräisches und aramäisches Handwörterbuch über das Alte Testament*, ed. H. Donner, 18th ed. (Berlin: Springer, 2013). BDB does *not* recognize the Qal passive and therefore should not be consulted for this matter. Electronic versions of the Hebrew Bible with morphological tags recognize only a part of all (possible) Qal passive forms. According to the Westminster Hebrew Morphology tagging, the Qal passive is attested 87 times in the Hebrew Bible. The most frequent verbs in the Qal passive are יָלַד (27 times), לָקַח (15 times) and נָתַן (8 times).²

26.4 Rare Binyanim

The following rare binyanim in Biblical Hebrew need to be mentioned:

- Po‘el (with the passive Po‘al and the reflexive Hitpo‘el), e.g., שָׁרַשׁ *it took root* (Isa 40:24)
- Pa‘lel (with the passive Pu‘lal), e.g., שָׁאֵן *he was at ease* (root שָׁאן; Jer 48:11), passive אָמַל *it became feeble* (root אָמַל; Joel 1:10)

² Hebrew Masoretic Text with Westminster Hebrew Morphology (HMT-W4), Groves-Wheeler Westminster Hebrew Morphology, v. 4.22, version 3.1 in Accordance 14.0.11.

- Pilpel (with the passive Polpal and the reflexive Hitpalpel), e.g., כָּלַל *he sustained* (with /a/ in the second syllable; 2 Sam 19:33); וְכָלְלוּ *and they were supplied with food* (1 Kgs 20:27)

The forms of these binyanim are not easily recognizable as verbal forms, unless they have the familiar verbal suffixes or prefixes. The lexicon will help to identify these forms as verbal forms.

Pilpel forms occur 50 times in the Hebrew Bible. No less than 24 of these occurrences are from the verb כוּל *Pilpel to sustain* (with food). Pilpel forms are easy to identify because of the reduplication of the two root consonants. The vowel structure of Pilpel forms is identical to Piel forms. The difference with Piel forms is that Pilpel forms have two different consonants where Piel forms have the geminated second root consonant. In the same way, the vowel structure of Polpal and Hitpalpel forms is identical to Hitpael and Pual forms, respectively. Pilpel forms are mainly derived from II gem. verbs and less frequently from II w/y verbs, if roots are counted and not occurrences of Pilpel forms.³

Characteristic Pilpel forms of the verb כוּל are כָּלַל (SC), יְכַלֵּל (PC), וְיַכְלִיל (waw-PC), וְיַכְלִילֵתִי (waw-SC), כָּלַל (inf. cs.), מְכַלֵּל.

In terms of vowel structure, Pilpel forms are identical to the forms of quadriliteral verbs with four root consonants. In the Hebrew Bible only very few forms of quadriliteral verbs attested. One verb that is worth mentioning is the verb תָּרַגַּם. In the Hebrew Bible, it is attested only once as a participle Polpal מְתָרְגֵּם *translated* (Ezra 4:7). It is the normal word for *to translate* from post-biblical Hebrew to Modern Israeli Hebrew (cf. the noun תִּרְגוּם *translation; Targum*).

26.5 Final and Consecutive Constructions

Final and consecutive constructions indicate the purpose or the consequence or result of a state of affairs, respectively. They can be expressed by subordinate clauses, the use of indirect volitive forms and prepositions.

A frequently used conjunction introducing final subordinate clauses is אֲשֶׁר (Exod 19:9). Less frequent are the conjunctions כֵּן (Deut 8:1; Josh 3:4). For negative final subordinate clauses the conjunction פֶּן is used (Exod 20:19).

³ Alternatively, Pilpel forms can be derived from biconsonantal roots with reduplication of both root consonants. BDB and HALOT do this only for the verb טָאָט.

כָּל־הַמִּצְוָה אֲשֶׁר אֲנִי מֻצְוֶה הַיּוֹם תִּשְׁמְרוּן לַעֲשׂוֹת לְמַעַן תִּחְיִין וְרַבִּיתֶם וּבִאתֶם וִירִשְׁתֶּם אֶת־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר־נִשְׁבַּע יְהוָה לַאֲבֹתֵיכֶם: אַל־תִּקְרְבוּ אֵלָיו לְמַעַן אֲשֶׁר־תֵּדְעוּ אֶת־הַדֶּרֶךְ אֲשֶׁר תֵּלְכוּ־בָהּ	<i>You shall carefully keep all the instruction that I command you today, in order that you will live and become numerous and go in and take possession of the land that the Lord swore to your fathers (Deut 8:1)</i>
וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה הִנֵּה אֲנִי בָּא אֵלֶיךָ בְּעַב־הָעֶנָן בְּעִבּוֹר יִשְׁמַע הָעָם בְּדַבְרִי עִמָּךְ	<i>Do not come close to [the ark], in order that you know the way which you shall go (Josh 3:4)</i>
וְשָׁמַרְתָּ אֶת־חֻקֵּי וְאֶת־מִצְוֹתָיו אֲשֶׁר אֲנִי מֻצְוֶה הַיּוֹם אֲשֶׁר יִיטֵב לָךְ וּלְבִנְיֶיךָ אַחֲרֶיךָ	<i>The Lord said to Moses, “Behold, I am coming to you in the thick cloud, in order that the people may hear when I speak with you” (Exod 19:9)</i>
וְאַל־יְדַבֵּר עִמָּנוּ אֱלֹהִים פֶּן־נָמוּת	<i>... and you shall keep his statutes and his commandments that I command you today, in order that it may be well with you and you children after you (Deut 4:40)</i>
	<i>... but do not let God speak with with us, lest we die (Exod 20:19)</i>

Consecutive subordinate clauses are mostly introduced with **כִּי** (Exod 3:11) and only rarely with the conjunctions **לְמַעַן** (Jer 27:15) and **אֲשֶׁר** (Gen 13:16).

מִי אֲנִי כִּי אֵלֶךְ אֶל־פַּרְעֹה וְכִי אוֹצִיא אֶת־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמִּצְרָיִם	<i>Who am I that I should go to Pharaoh and that I should lead the Israelites out of Egypt (Exod 3:11)</i>
כִּי לֹא שְׁלַחְתִּים נְאֻם־יְהוָה וְהֵם נִבְּאִים בְּשְׁמִי לִשְׁקֹר לְמַעַן תִּדְּיַחֵי אֶתְכֶם	<i>For I have not sent them, and yet they proph- esy in my name falsely, with the result that I will drive you out (Jer 27:15)</i>
וְשָׁמַתִּי אֶת־זֶרְעֶךָ כְּעָפָר הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר אִם־יִוָּכַל אִישׁ לִמְנוֹת אֶת־עָפָר הָאָרֶץ נִם־זֶרְעֶךָ יִמָּנֶה	<i>And I will make your descendants as the dust of the earth, so that if someone can count the dust of the earth, your descendants too can be counted (Gen 13:16)</i>

Two clauses that are coordinated with **וְ** with an indirect volitive mood in the second the clause are also frequently used to express a final or consecutive relation. In the second clause, a cohortative (Gen 27:4), an imperative (2 Sam 21:3) or a third person jussive form (Judg 6:30) may be used.

וַעֲשֶׂה-לִּי מִטַּעַמִּים כַּאֲשֶׁר אֶהְיֶה וְהֵבִיֵּאתָ לִּי וְאָכְלָה	... and make for me tasty food as I like [it] and bring it to me so that I may eat [it] (Gen 27:4)
מָה אֶעֱשֶׂה לָּכֶם וּבְמָה אֲכַפֵּר וּבְרָכוּ אֶת-נַחֲלַת יְהוָה	What shall I do for you and with what shall I make atonement so that you may bless the heritage of the Lord (2 Sam 21:3)
הוֹצֵא אֶת-בְּנוֹךְ יִזְמֹת	Bring out your son that he may die (Judg 6:30)

As prepositions with final meaning can be mentioned לְ (Exod 16:15) and – followed by the inf. cs. – לְמַעַן (1 Sam 17:28), בְּעֵבוּר (Exod 20:20) and with negative meaning לְבִלְתִּי (1 Kgs 15:17).

הוּא הַלֶּחֶם אֲשֶׁר נָתַן יְהוָה לָכֶם לְאָכְלָה	That is the bread that the Lord has given you to eat (i.e., with the intention that you may eat it; Exod 16:15)
כִּי לְמַעַן רָאוֹת תִּמְלָחְמָה יֵרָדָתָּ	... for you came down to see the battle (1 Sam 17:28)
וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה אֶל-הָעָם אַל-תִּירָאוּ כִּי לְבַעֲבוֹר נִסּוֹת אֶתְכֶם בָּא הָאֱלֹהִים	And Moses said to the people, “Do not be afraid, for God has come to test you” (Exod 20:20)
וַיְבִן אֶת-הָרָמָה לְבִלְתִּי תֵּת יֵצֵא וּבָא לְאַסָּא מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה	And he fortified Ramah in order to not allow anyone belonging to Asa king of Judah to go out [for battle] or go in (1 Kgs 15:17)

The preposition לְ is also used with consecutive meaning (Ps 78:25).

צִיָּדָה שָׁלַח לָהֶם לְשָׂבַע	... he sent them provisions with satiety as result (Ps 78:25)
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26.6 Concessive Subordinate Clauses

A concessive subordinate clause expresses a condition that even if it is fulfilled, does not lead to the result that is expressed in the main clause. In English, the conjunction *although* among others introduces concessive subordinate clauses. In Biblical Hebrew, the most frequent concessive conjunctions are כִּי (Exod 13:17), גַּם (Ps 23:4a) and וְגַם (Jer 36:25).

וַיְהִי בְשַׁלַּח פָּרְעֹה אֶת־הָעָם וְלֹא־נָחֵם אֱלֹהִים דֶּרֶךְ אֶרֶץ פְּלִשְׁתִּים כִּי קָרֹב הוּא	<i>When Pharaoh let the people go, God did not lead them by way of the land of the Philistines, although it was near (Exod 13:17)</i>
גַּם כִּי־אֵלֶךְ בְּגִיא צְלֻמוֹת לֹא־אִירָא רָע	<i>Even though I walk in the valley of deep dark- ness, I do not fear evil (Ps 23:4)</i>
וְגַם אֶלְנָתָן וּדְלִיָּהּ וּגְמַרְיָהּ הִפְּנֵעוּ בַּמֶּלֶךְ לְבַלְתִּי שָׂרֵף אֶת־הַמִּגִּלָּה וְלֹא שָׁמַע אֱלֹהִים	<i>Even though Elnathan and Delaiah and Gemariah urged the king not to burn the scroll, he did not listen to them (Jer 36:25)</i>

26.7 Exercises

26.7.1 Translation of Sentences

Translate the following sentences from the Hebrew Bible. Less frequent names of persons and geographical names in these sentences: אֲדֹנִיָּהּ, אָדָם, אַבְנִיֵל, שֵׁשֶׁת, שִׁישַׁק, קִיָּן, מְפִיבִשֶׁת, הֶבֶל, בֶּת־שֶׁבַע, אֲנֹשׁ.

1 בְּזַעַת⁴ אִפְיֹךְ תֹּאכַל לֶחֶם עַד שׁוֹבְךָ אֶל־הָאָדָמָה כִּי מִמֶּנָּה לָקַחְתָּ כִּי־עֶפְרָא אֶתָּה וְאֶל־עֶפְרָא תָשׁוּב: 2 וַיִּשְׁלַחְהוּ יְהוָה אֱלֹהִים מִגִּן־עֵדֶן⁵ לְעֹבֵד אֶת־הָאָדָמָה אֲשֶׁר לָקַח מִשָּׁם: 3 וַיֵּדַע אָדָם עוֹד אֶת־אִשְׁתּוֹ וַתֵּלֶד בֵּן וַתִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמוֹ שֵׁשֶׁת כִּי שָׁת־לִי אֱלֹהִים זָרַע אַחֵר תַּחַת הֶבֶל כִּי הָרְגוּ קִיָּן: וְלִשְׁת גַּם־הוּא יֵלֵד בֵּן וַיִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמוֹ אֲנֹשׁ אֵז הוֹחֵל לִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם יְהוָה: 4 וַיָּבֹא מְפִיבִשֶׁת בֶּן־יְהוֹנָתָן בֶּן־שָׁאוּל אֶל־דָּוִד וַיִּפֹּל עַל־פָּנָיו וַיִּשְׁתַּחוּ וַיֹּאמֶר דָּוִד מְפִיבִשֶׁת וַיֹּאמֶר הִנֵּה עֲבָדְךָ: 5 וַתֵּרָא אַבְנִיֵל אֶת־דָּוִד וַתִּמְחֶה וַתִּרְדּוּ מֵעַל הַחֲמוֹר וַתִּפֹּל לְאַפִּי דָוִד עַל־פָּנָיָהּ וַתִּשְׁתַּחוּ אֶרֶץ: 6 וַתָּבֹא בֶת־שֶׁבַע אֶל־הַמֶּלֶךְ שְׁלֹמֹה לְדַבֵּר־לוֹ עַל־אֲדֹנֵיהּ וַיִּקֶּם הַמֶּלֶךְ לִקְרֹאתָהּ וַיִּשְׁתַּחוּ לָהּ וַיָּשֶׁב עַל־כִּסְאוֹ וַיָּשֶׂם כִּסֵּא לְאַחַם הַמֶּלֶךְ וַתֵּשֶׁב לִימִינוֹ: 7 וַיַּחֲלֶם⁶ עוֹד חֲלוֹם אַחֵר וַיִּסְפֹּר אֹתוֹ לְאַחֵיו וַיֹּאמֶר הִנֵּה חֲלֹמְתִי חֲלוֹם עוֹד וְהִנֵּה הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ וְהַיָּרֵחַ⁷ וְאַחַד עֶשֶׂר כּוֹכָבִים⁸ מִשְׁתַּחֲוִים לִי: וַיִּסְפֹּר אֶל־אֲבִיו וְאֶל־אֶחָיו וַיִּגְעֹר⁹ בָּם אֲבִיו וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ מָה הַחֲלוֹם הַזֶּה אֲשֶׁר חֲלַמְתָּ הֲבֹא נִבּוֹא אֲנִי וְאַחֵיךָ לְהַשְׁתַּחֲוֹת לָךְ

⁴ זַעַת sweat

⁵ גִּן־עֵדֶן Garden of Eden

⁶ חֵלֶם Q. to dream

⁷ יָרֵחַ moon

⁸ כּוֹכָב star

⁹ גִּעֹר Q. to rebuke

אֲרָצָה: 9 וַיְהִי בַּהֲנוֹת יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בִּירִיחוֹ וַיֵּשָׂא עֵינָיו וַיֵּרָא וַהֲנֵה-אִישׁ עֹמֵד לְנִגְדּוֹ
 וַחֲרָבוֹ שְׁלוּפָה¹⁰ בְּיָדוֹ וַיִּלָּךְ יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֵלָיו וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ הֲלָנוּ אִתָּה אִם-לְצָרֵינוּ: וַיֹּאמֶר
 לֹא כִי אֲנִי שֶׁר-צָבָא-יְהוָה עִתָּה בָּאתִי וַיַּפֵּל יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶל-פָּנָיו אֲרָצָה וַיִּשְׁתַּחוּ וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ
 מָה אֲדֹנִי מְדַבֵּר אֵל-עַבְדּוֹ: וַיֹּאמֶר שֶׁר-צָבָא יְהוָה אֶל-יְהוֹשֻׁעַ שֶׁל¹¹ נַעֲלָךְ¹² מֵעַל
 רִגְלֶךָ כִּי הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר אִתָּה עֹמֵד עָלָיו קָדֹשׁ הוּא וַיַּעַשׂ יְהוֹשֻׁעַ כֵּן: 10 הַדָּבָר אֲשֶׁר
 הָיָה אֶל-יִרְמְיָהוּ מֵאֵת יְהוָה לֵאמֹר: עֹמֵד בְּשַׁעַר בֵּית יְהוָה וְקִרְאתָ שָׁם אֶת-הַדָּבָר
 הַזֶּה וְאָמַרְתָּ שְׁמַעוּ דְּבַר-יְהוָה כָּל-יְהוּדָה הַבָּאִים בְּשַׁעְרֵים הָאֵלֶּה לְהִשְׁתַּחֲוֹת לַיהוָה:
 כֹּה-אָמַר יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הֵיטִיבוּ דְרָכֵיכֶם וּמַעַלְלֵיכֶם¹³ וְאַשְׁכְּנָה¹⁴ אִתְּכֶם
 בַּמָּקוֹם הַזֶּה: 11 וַיִּכְרַת יְהוָה אֶתֶם בְּרִית וַיְצַנֵּם לֵאמֹר לֹא תִירָאוּ אֱלֹהִים
 אֲחֵרִים וְלֹא-תִשְׁתַּחֲוּוּ לָהֶם וְלֹא תַעֲבֹדוּם וְלֹא תִזְבְּחוּ לָהֶם: כִּי אִם-אֶת-יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר
 הָעִלָּה אִתְּכֶם מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם בְּכַח גָּדוֹל וּבְזֹרֹעַ נְטוּיָה אֹתוֹ תִירָאוּ וְלוֹ תִשְׁתַּחֲוּוּ
 וְלוֹ תִזְבְּחוּ: 12 וַיִּבְקֹשׁ שְׁלֹמֹה לְהַמִּית אֶת-יִרְבְּעָם וַיִּגַּם יִרְבְּעָם וַיִּבְרַח מִצְרַיִם
 אֶל-שִׁישַׁק מֶלֶךְ-מִצְרַיִם וַיְהִי בַּמִּצְרַיִם עַד-מוֹת שְׁלֹמֹה:

26.8 Hebrew Reading: 1 Kings 19:15–21

Translate 1 Kings 19:15–21 with the help of notes below the text.

15 וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֵלָיו לֵךְ שׁוּב לְדָרֶכֶךָ מִדְּבָרָה רַמְשֶׁק וּבָאתָ וּמִשְׁחַתָּ אֶת-חִזְאוֹל
 לְמַלְךְ עַל-אֲרָם: 16 וְאֵת יְהוּא בֶן-נִמְשִׁי תִמְשַׁח לְמַלְךְ עַל-יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאֶת-אֱלִישָׁע
 בֶּן-שַׁפְטָן מֵאֵבֶל מַחֻלָּה תִמְשַׁח לְנָבִיא תַחְתִּיךָ: 17 וְהָיָה הַנִּמְלֵט מִחֶרֶב חִזְאוֹל יָמִית
 יְהוּא וְהַנִּמְלֵט מִחֶרֶב יְהוּא יָמִית אֱלִישָׁע: 18 וְהִשְׁאֲרֵתִי בְיִשְׂרָאֵל שְׁבַעַת אֲלֹפִים
 כָּל-הַבְּרָכִים אֲשֶׁר לֹא-כָרְעוּ לַבָּעַל וְכָל-הַפָּה אֲשֶׁר לֹא-נִשָּׁק לוֹ: 19 וַיִּלָּךְ מִשָּׁם
 וַיִּמָּצָא אֶת-אֱלִישָׁע בֶּן-שַׁפְטָן וְהוּא חָרַשׁ שְׁנִים-עָשָׂר צִמְדִּים לַפָּנָיו וְהוּא בִּשְׁנַיִם הָעֹשֵׂר
 וַיַּעֲבֹר אֵלָיו וַיִּשְׁלָךְ אַדְרֵתּוֹ אֵלָיו: 20 וַיַּעֲזֹב אֶת-הַבָּקָר וַיֵּרֶץ אַחֲרָיו אֵלָיו
 וַיֹּאמֶר אֲשַׁקֶּה-נָּא לְאָבִי וּלְאִמִּי וְאֶלְכָה אַחֲרָיָה וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ לֵךְ שׁוּב כִּי מִה-עֲשִׂיתִי לָךְ:
 21 וַיָּשָׁב מֵאַחֲרָיו וַיִּקַּח אֶת-צֹמֶד הַבָּקָר וַיִּזְבְּחֵהוּ וַיִּבְכְּלִי הַבָּקָר בְּשָׁלֹם הַבָּשָׂר וַיִּתֵּן
 לָעָם וַיֹּאכְלוּ וַיִּגַּם וַיִּלָּךְ אַחֲרָיו אֵלָיו וַיִּשְׁרַתְּהוּ:

¹⁰ שלף Q. to draw out, off

¹¹ נשל Q. loosen (sandal)

¹² נעל sandal

¹³ מעללים deeds

¹⁴ שכן Pi. to cause to dwell

Chapter 26

19:15	דַּמָּשֶׁק	<i>Damascus</i>
19:16	אֶבֶל מְחוּלָה	name of a place
19:18	בִּרְךָ Q. כָּרַע	<i>knee</i> <i>to bow down, kneel</i>
	Q. נָשַׁק	<i>to kiss</i>
19:19	Q. חָרַשׁ	<i>to plow</i>
	צֶמֶד	<i>couple, pair (of oxen)</i>
	אֶדְרֶת	<i>cloak, robe</i>
19:20	Q. נָשַׁק	see 19:18
19:21	צֶמֶד	see 19:19
	בָּשַׁל Pi.	<i>to cook</i>

Ketiv and Qere in the Hebrew Bible

The text of the Hebrew Bible was finalized at the end of the 1st century and the early 2nd century CE. Since the 2nd century CE, the then still unpointed text was transmitted with great conservatism, such that changes to the text were avoided. As a consequence, a system was developed by the Masoretes that allowed for alternative readings.

For this purpose, the alternative reading was put in the margin of the biblical text in the manuscript. This is called *Qere* קִרְיָ, Aramaic for (*what is to be*) read. A small ק with a dot on top (an abbreviation for קִרְיָ) under the alternative reading indicates it as a Qere.

The reading for which there is an alternative reading is indicated by a small circle (in Latin *circellus*) that is placed on top of the Hebrew word or words in the main text. This word or these words are called *Ketiv* כְּתִיב (*what is*) written.

The vowel signs of the Qere and the accents are placed with the Ketiv in the main text and not with the Qere in the margin. When the vowels are incompatible with the word they are placed with (as in 2 Kgs 18:27 for example), it is an indication that there is a Qere in the margin. Otherwise, one always needs to look for a Qere in the margin, when there is a small circle on a word or words in the main text, in order to not miss a Qere.

In reading tradition, the Qere replaces the Ketiv; however, for textual criticism and historical linguistics, the Ketiv often preserves older or otherwise significant forms.

Qere may be found in the following circumstances in the Hebrew Bible:

- Adjustment to spelling conventions, e.g., Ketiv וּתְלוּשׁ and *she kneaded* with an exceptional vowel letter ו for a short vowel with the Qere וַתְּלֹשׁ *wattālōš* and *she kneaded* (2 Sam 13:8)
- Adjustments to grammatical norms, e.g., Ketiv בַּהֲשֵׁרָה with unusual preservation of the article after the proclitic preposition בְּ with the Qere בַּשֶּׂדֶה *in the field* (2 Kgs 7:12)
- Correction of mistakes, e.g., Ketiv אֵל תַּחַס עֵינֵיכֶם with the Qere אַל תַּחַס עֵינֵיכֶם that corrects the preposition אֵל to the negative אַל and the subject עֵינֵי to the required singular form (Ezek 9:5); Ketiv עֲבַרְנוּ *our crossing* with the Qere עֲבָרָם *their crossing* (Josh 5:1)

- Preferred readings, e.g., Ketiv הִבָּאִישׁ (vocalized הִבָּאִישׁ) *he became hated* with the Qere הִבְשִׁישׁ *he became ashamed* (Isa 30:5)

A Qere may be even found where there is no word in the main text that it is meant to replace. This is a case of קרי ולא כתיב¹ *read but not written*, e.g., Ketiv הִנֵּה יָמִים *and see, days* with the Qere הִנֵּה יָמִים בָּאִים *and see, days are coming* including the required predicate בָּאִים (Jer 31:38). The opposite, an element in the main text that is not to be read, thus dropped, is called כתיב ולא קרי² *written but not read*, e.g., Ketiv יסלח נא *may he forgive* with the particle נא with the Qere יסלח without the particle (2 Kgs 5:18).

With some frequent or recurring instances of Ketiv and Qere, the Masoretes did not put the Qere in the margin. They only put the vowels of the Qere with the Ketiv in the main text. This phenomenon is called perpetual Qere (in Latin *Qere perpetuum*). The following cases of perpetual Qere can be mentioned:

1. The name of God is יהוה in the Ketiv. According to Jewish tradition, the name of God is not to be pronounced. Instead, one reads אֲדֹנָי *ʾādōnāy Lord* (in English Bibles). However, the Masoretes did not put the complete vowels of אֲדֹנָי with the Ketiv but adjusted them. In some manuscripts like the Leningrad Codex one only finds *šwa* and *qāmæṣ*, while in others one finds *šwa*, *holem* and *qāmæṣ*. If יהוה is immediately preceded or followed by אֲדֹנָי, one reads the Qere אֱלֹהִים *God* instead. In most cases one finds only *šwa* (or *hatef segol*) and *hireq* with the Ketiv *šwa*, but *šwa* (or *hatef segol*), *holem* and *hireq* are attested, as well (e.g., Deut 3:24; Gen 15:2; 1 Kgs 2:26; Judg 16:28).
2. Jerusalem is ירושלם in the Ketiv with the Qere יְרוּשָׁלַיִם *yərūšālāyīm* (cf. ירושלים in IQIsa^a 30:15 [Isa 37:10]). The Ketiv should probably be vocalized as יְרוּשָׁלַם.
3. In the Torah, the 3rd person fem. sg. independent personal pronoun הִיא is הוּא in the Ketiv (like the masc. form). More information about this can be found in JM § 39c.
4. The noun נַעֲרָה *girl, young woman* in the absolute state has the Ketiv נער without the feminine ending ה-.
5. Issachar, the name of the ninth son of Jacob, is יששכר in the Ketiv and יִשָּׁכָר in the Qere.

¹ Vocalized קרי ולא כתיב.

² Vocalized כתיב ולא קרי.

Key to the Exercises in Chapter 2–26

Chapter 2

Proper Nouns with Vowel Pointing

1 *yisrā'el* (*yis/rā/'el*) 2 *dāwid* (*dā/wid*) 3 *yəhūdā* (*yə/hū/dā*) 4 *mōšē* (*mō/šē*) 5 *šā'ul* (*šā/'ul*) 6 *lēwī* (*lē/wī*) 7 *ya'āqōḇ* (*ya'ā/qōḇ*) 8 *'ahārōn* (*'ahā/rōn*) 9 *šālōmō* (*šā/lō/mō*) 10 *yəhōšūa'* (*yə/hō/šūa'*) 11 *yōsēp* (*yō/sēp*) 12 *'əpráyim* (*'əp/rá/yim*) 13 *'abrāhām* (*'ab/rā/hām*) 14 *binyāmīn* (*bin/yā/mīn*) 15 *mənaššē* (*mə/naš/šē*) 16 *yō'āḇ* (*yō/'āḇ*) 17 *šəmu'el* (*šə/mū/'el*) 18 *yirməyāhū* (*yir/mə/yā/hū*) 19 *'abšālōm* (*'ab/šā/lōm*) 20 *yīḥāq* (*yīḥ/hāq*) 21 *yārḇā'm* (*yā/rḇā/'ām*) 22 *'ēšāw* (*'ē/šāw*) 23 *'ah'āḇ* (*'ah/'āḇ*) 24 *yəhōšāpāt* (*yə/hō/šā/pāt*) 25 *yəhōnātān* (*yə/hō/nā/tān*) 26 *ḥizqīyāhū* (*ḥiz/qiy/yā/hū*) 27 *rə'ūḇēn* (*rə/'ū/ḇēn*) 28 *gād* (*gād*) 29 *'əl'āzār* (*'əl/'ā/zār*) 30 *dān* (*dān*) 31 *'āḥīmélæk* (*'ā/ḥī/mél/læk*) 32 *'ēliyyāhū* (*'ē/liy/yā/hū*) 33 *'abnēr* (*'ab/nēr*) 34 *bil'am* (*bil/'ām*) 35 *'abrām* (*'ab/rām*) 36 *'əlīšā'* (*'ē/li/šā'*) 37 *yēhū(?)* (*yē/hū(?)*) 38 *'āsā(?)* (*'ā/sā(?)*) 39 *'iyyōḇ* (*'iy/yōḇ*) 40 *šidqīyāhū* (*šid/qiy/yā/hū*) 41 *'əstēr* (*'əs/tēr*) 42 *yō(?)šīyāhū* (*yō(?)šiy/yā/hū*) 43 *šāray* (*šā/ray*) 44 *šārā* (*šā/rā*) 45 *riḇqā* (*riḇ/qā*) 46 *lē'ā* (*lē/'ā*) 47 *rāḥēl* (*rā/hēl*)

Geographical Terms

1 *bāḇāel* 2 *yardēn* 3 *mō'āḇ* 4 *šīyyōn* 5 *'aššūr* 6 *šōmārōn* 7 *'ārām* 8 *'ammōn* 9 *gil'ād* 10 *'əḏōm* 11 *kəná'an* 12 *šəḵæm* 13 *bēt 'el* 14 *ləḇānōn* 15 *ḥəḇrōn* 15 *midyān* 15 *yəriḥō*

Proper Nouns (Segolate Nouns or Segolate Endings)

1 *'āḇīgáyil* 2 *'āḥīmélæk* 3 *'āḥīnō'am* 4 *'izéḇāel* 5 *'əlī'ézæc* 6 *bō'az* 7 *həḇāel* 8 *yāḇāet* 9 *yərubbá'al* 10 *lāmæk* 11 *péqah* 12 *qáyin*

Less Frequent Proper Nouns

1 ʿādām 2 ʾāhāz 3 ʾāmōš 4 ʾāsāp 5 ʾāšēr 6 bārāq 7 gidʿōn 8 golyāt
9 hāgār 10 hōšēaʿ 11 zəḥūlūn 12 ḥaggay 13 yōnā 14 yiṭtāḥ 15 kālēḥ
16 lāḇān 17 mənahēm 18 miryām 19 nəḥæmyā 20 naʿāmān 21 naṭtālī
22 nātān 23 natanʾēl 24 ʿēlī 25 ʿmrī 26 rūt 27 rəḥabʿām 28 šēm
29 šimʿon 30 tāmār

Chapter 3

Frequent Verbal Forms

1. Judg 6:29 2. 2Sam 23:22 3. Gen 29:22 4. Gen 29:28 5. Judg 3:16
6. Judg 14:10 7. 2Kgs 23:34 8. Gen 20:2 9. Gen 24:61 10. Exod 24:8
11. Num 22:41 12. Judg 9:43 13. 1Sam 31:4 14. 1Kgs 17:23 15. 2Kgs
23:35 16. Gen 21:27 17. 2Kgs 13:5 18. 1Sam 9:17 19. Gen 6:12
20. Gen 29:2 21. Judg 9:36 22. 2Kgs 16:12 23. Gen 22:4 24. Exod
2:15

Exercises with the Article

הָאֵב הָאִישׁ הָאֱלֹהִים הָאָרֶץ הֵבֶן הַבָּקָר הַדָּבָר הַדָּם הַזֶּהָב חֶחֶרֶב הַיּוֹם הַיָּלֵד הַכֶּסֶף
הַמִּזְבֵּחַ הַמִּלֵּךְ הַמָּקוֹם הַמְשֻׁתָּה הַעֶבֶד הַעֵיִן הָעִיר הָעָם הַצֹּאֵן הַשָּׂדֶה

Chapter 4

Frequent Verbal Forms

1. 1Kgs 22:27 1. 1Sam 17:27 3. Num 23:2 4. 1Sam 18:24 5. Exod
6:13 6. 1Kgs 19:4 7. Gen 28:9 8. Gen 26:17 9. Gen 28:10 10. Judg
16:1 11. 2Sam 3:21 12. 2Kgs 2:25 13. Gen 19:23 14. Num 22:36
15. 2Sam 3:23 16. 1Sam 4:7 17. Gen 30:16 18. Gen 20:3 19. Exod
3:1 20. Exod 7:10 21. Exod 24:18 22. Num 22:20 23. Judg 13:9
24. 1Sam 2:27 25. Judg 9:51 26. Judg 11:1 27. Gen 12:10

Chapter 5

Translation of Verbal Forms

1. *they said*, comm. 2. *I went*, comm. הָלַכְתִּי 3. *he took*, masc. 4. *she took*, fem. 5. *I sent*, comm. שָׁלַחְתִּי 6. *you know/knew*, masc. יָדַעְתָּ 7. *they sat*, comm. 8. *we went*, comm. הָלַכְנוּ 9. *you heard*, fem. 10. *he fell*, masc. 11. *you kept*, masc. 12. *you asked*, fem. 13. *you bore*, fem. 14. *you ate*, masc. 15. *you became king*, masc. מָלַכְתָּ 16. *you know/knew*, fem. 17. *she said*, fem. 18. *they gave*, comm. 19. *you gave*, masc. נָתַתָּה 20. *you gave*, masc. נָתַתָּ

Translation of Sentences

1. Deut 29:5 2. 2 Kgs 1:14 3. 1 Sam 5:1 4. 1 Kgs 8:39 5. Deut 5:28
6. 2 Kgs 5:6 7. Josh 2:9 8. 2 Kgs 20:14 9. Exod 2:25 10. Gen 21:17
11. 1 Sam 17:11 12. Judg 11:15 13. 1 Kgs 15:20 14. Exod 5:1

Chapter 6

Translation of Verbal Forms

1. *you will remember*, masc. pl. 2. *I will cut*, comm. 3. *you/she will serve*, masc. sg./fem. sg. 4. *you will keep*, masc. pl. 5. *you/she will draw near*, masc. sg./fem. sg. 6. *you will remember*, fem. sg. 7. *we will listen* 8. *I will send* 9. *they shall reign*, masc. pl. יִמְלִכוּ 10. *they/you will send*, fem. pl. תִּשְׁלַחְנָה

Translation of Sentences

1. 1 Sam 13:13 2. Gen 21:1 3. Judg 7:24 4. Judg 11:28 5. Exod 14:29
6. 1 Kgs 4:1 7. 1 Sam 4:1 8. Gen 41:56 9. 1 Kgs 2:30 10. Judg 21:8
11. 2 Kgs 21:21 12. Exod 4:30 13. 2 Chr 23:3 14. Judg 6:8
15. 1 Kgs 20:2 16. 1 Sam 11:3 17. Exod 4:31 18. Gen 16:2 19. 2 Kgs 18:31
20. 1 Sam 8:21 21. Exod 7:13 22. Judg 10:16 23. 1 Sam 14:36
24. Exod 3:12

Chapter 7

Translation of Sentences

1. Gen 21:32 2. 1 Sam 16:10 3. Exod 18:25 4. Judg 8:18 5. 1 Sam 22:21
6. 1 Kgs 19:1 7. Judg 8:17 8. 2 Kgs 23:20 9. Josh 21:45 10. Gen 19:29
11. Gen 42:9 12. Judg 2:13 13. Josh 10:22 14. 1 Kgs 22:37 15. 1 Sam
14:36 16. Lev 9:8 17. 1 Sam 11:15 18. 1 Sam 16:4 19. Gen 20:14

Chapter 8

Translation of Sentences

1. Ps 106:48 2. Jos. 6:20 3. 2 Sam. 11:2 4. Gen 19:17 5. Gen 24:30
6. Deut 4:11 7. Josh 10:19 8. 1 Kgs 8:22 9. 1 Sam 26:5 10. 1 Sam
3:15 11. 1 Sam 16:22 12. 1 Kgs 3:15 13. 1 Kgs 10:8 14. 2 Kgs 5:9
15. Judg 12:4 16. 1 Sam 7:5 17. 1 Sam 30:3 18. Exod 24:16 19. Judg
9:36 20. 2 Sam 7:2 21. Deut 28:3 22. Ps 106:48

Chapter 9

Translation of Sentences

1. 1 Kgs 22:19 2. 1 Kgs 18:19–20 3. 2 Kgs 18:5 4. Gen 22:10 5. Gen
24:30 6. Gen 27:34 7. Gen 35:22 8. Gen 36:31 9. Num 21:23
10. Deut 5:23 11. Josh 24:22 12. Ruth 1:1 13. 1 Sam 15:1 13. 1 Sam
15:1 15. 2 Kgs 23:20 15. 1 Kgs 5:21 16. 1 Kgs 21:27 17. 1 Sam 24:21
18. Deut 6:17 19. 1 Kgs 11:11 20. 2 Sam 5:10

Chapter 10

1. 2 Kgs 10:18 2. 1 Kgs 13:31 3. 2 Kgs 13:9 4. 1 Sam 3:4 5. 2 Sam 15:10
6. Gen 42:2 7. Gen 37:29 8. Gen 20:11 9. Josh 1:3 10. Judg 8:14
11. 2 Kgs 10:9 12. Josh 9:26 13. 2 Sam 7:8 14. Josh 10:8 15. 2 Kgs
10:14 16. 2 Sam 20:1 17. Deut 14:27 18. Gen 28:16 19. Deut 29:13–14
20. Jer 31:31–33

Chapter 11

Translation of Verbal Forms

1. *and they ate*, fem. pl. 2. *eat!* or *eating*, impv. m. sg. or inf. cs. 3. *eat!*, impv. masc. pl. 4. *I said* אָמַרְתִּי 5. *I will say* 6. *saying*, part. act. m. sg. 7. *you will draw near* m. pl. 8. *draw near* impv. m. sg. 9. *and I fell* 10. *I fell* נָפַלְתִּי 11. *and he grasped* 12. *and he touched*

Translation of Sentences

1. Gen 37:8 2. Gen 43:27 3. 2 Sam 13:4 4. Gen 29:22–25 5. Exod 4:29–30 6. Gen 45:4 7. Josh 3:9 8. Josh 14:6 9. 2 Kgs 2:5 10. Gen 12:9 11. Gen 46:1 12. Prov 3:1 13. Gen 1:31 14. Gen 24:7 15. Gen 28:13

Chapter 12

Translation of Verbal Forms

1. *they built* 2. *I will uncover* 3. *you found* מָצָאתָ 4. *I was not willing* אָבִיתִי 5. *you will sin* m. pl. 6. *you will live* m. pl. 7. *and they camped* 8. *fill!* impv. m. pl. 9. *and he stretched* 10. *and they carried* 11. *and she went up, and you went* m. sg. יָרָעַל 12. *you answered* 13. *someone calling* 14. *drink!* 15. *we will drink*

Translation of Sentences

1. Gen 26:30 2. Gen 4:9 3. 1 Sam 10:24 4. 2 Kgs 2:3 5. Josh 7:20 6. 1 Sam 29:9 7. 1 Sam 11:1 8. Gen 50:7 9. 2 Kgs 22:8 10. Josh 5:13

Chapter 13

Translation of Verbal Forms

1. *I will go* 2. *we will go* 3. *you will go* m. pl. 4. *go!* m. sg. 5. *she will be unclean/you will be unclean* fem. sg./m. sg. 6. *I went out* יָצֵאתִי 7. *they went out* 8. *they will go out* 9. *people going out* m. pl. 10. *we took possession of* 11. *you will take possession of* m. pl. 12. *and they took possession of answered* m. pl. 13. *I am/was afraid* יִרְאַתִּי 14. *you will be afraid* m. pl. 15. *you*

Key to the Exercises in Chapter 2–26

will see m. pl. 16. they sat down 17. and they sat down 18. sit down! m. sg. 19. sit down! m. pl. 20. you went down m. sg. יָרַדְתָּ

Translation of Sentences

1. Josh 3:6 2. Josh 6:6 3. Num 12:4 4. Exod 19:20 5. Gen 19:30
6. Judg 21:2 7. 1 Sam 23:17 8. 1 Kgs 2:36 9. Gen 11:4–5 10. Isa 6:8
11. 1 Kgs 22:6 12. Gen 4:17 13. Num 19:22 14. 2 Sam 7:27 15. Num
20:14–18 16. Judg 2:14 17. 2 Sam 13:21 18. 1 Sam 6:20

Chapter 14

Translation of Verbal Forms

1. they shall be ashamed (m. pl.) יִבְשּׁוּ 2. we were ashamed בָּשָׁנוּ 3. and they understood (m. pl.) וַיֵּבִינּוּ 4. come! (f. sg.) בָּאִי 5. I have sojourned גִּרְתִּי 6. sojourner (part.) or he sojourned (SC 3 m. sg.) 7. you will die (m. sg.) or she will die 8. and they fled (m. pl.) 9. turn aside! (m. sg.) סוּרָה 10. turn aside! (m. sg.) or turning aside (inf. cs.) 11. they stood up קָמוּ 12. and he stood up וַיָּקָם 13. runners (m. pl.) 14. you ran (m. sg.) רָצַתָּה 15. put! (m. pl.) שִׁימוּ 16. you put (m. pl.) 17. and he returned וַיָּשָׁב 18. and I returned

Numerals

Ezra 2:3 פְּרָעֶשׁ 2,172 Ezra 2:4 שְׁפָטִיָּה 372 Ezra 2:5 פַּחַת מוֹאָב 2,812
Ezra 2:7 עֵילָם 1,254 Ezra 2:8 זִתּוּא 945 Ezra 2:9 זָכִי 760 Ezra
2:10 בְּנֵי 642 Ezra 2:11 בְּכֵי 623 Ezra 2:12 עֲזֹנָד 1,222 Ezra
2:13 אֲדַנִּיקָם 666 Ezra 2:14 בְּנֵי 2,056 Ezra 2:15 עֲדִין 454 Ezra
2:16 אֶטֶר 98 Ezra 2:17 בְּצִי 323

Translation of Sentences

1. 1 Sam 22:11 2. 2 Sam 12:19 3. 2 Kgs 16:11 4. 1 Sam 26:5 5. 1 Kgs
17:22 6. 2 Kgs 1:4 7. 1 Sam 15:26 8. Josh 24:29 9. Exod 14:26
10. Josh 3:12 11. Gen 2:16–17 12. Ruth 1:1–7

Chapter 15

Translation of Verbal Forms

1. *and they measured* (m. pl.) וַיִּמְדְּדוּ 2. *you will measure* (m. pl.) תִּמְדְּדוּ 3. *and they surrounded* (m. pl.) וַיִּסְבְּבוּ 4. *and he surrounded* 5. *go around!* (m. pl.) סִבְבוּ 6. *and you shall go around* (m. pl.) 7. *and he went around* 8. *they will surround* (fem. pl.) תִּסְבְּבִינָה 9. *and we went around* (m. pl.) וַנִּסְבֹּב 10. *someone devastating* (m. sg.) 11. *he will be desolate* 12. *they will be desolate* (m. pl.) יִשְׁמֹו 13. *they will be complete* (m. pl.) יִתְמֹו 14. *they were complete* (m. pl.) תִּמְו 15. *he was complete* 16. *he will show favor* 17. *and he showed favor* וַיִּחַן 18. *I will show favor* 19. *and I will show favor* (m. pl.) 20. *have mercy on me!* (m. sg.) חַנּוּנִי

Translation of Sentences

1. Ps 30:11 2. Josh 4:1–2 3. Josh 6:2–4 4. Judg 4:8 5. Exod 19:5–6
6. 1 Kgs 13:8 7. Gen 28:20–21 8. 1 Sam 7:12 9. Deut 5:3 10. 1 Kgs 19:9

Chapter 16

Translation of Verbal Forms

1. *he fought* 2. *they fought* (m. pl.) 3. *they fought* (m. pl.) נִלְחֲמוּ 4. *I fought* 5. *he will fight* 6. *and he fought* וַיִּלָּחֶם 7. *fight!* (m. pl.) 8. *(we will fight* 9. *you will fight* (m. pl.) 10. *fight!* (m. pl..) 11. *I escaped* נִמְלָטְתִּי 12. *they escaped* (m. pl.) 13. *I will escape* 14. *she will escape/you will escape* (m. sg.) 15. *you swore* (m. sg.) נִשְׁבַּעְתָּ 16. *you swore* (m. pl.) 17. *we swore* וַיִּחַן 18. *I swore* 19. *you will swear* (m. pl.) 20. *and he swore* (m. sg.) חַנּוּנִי

Translation of Sentences

1. Deut 1:34–36a 2. 1 Sam 24:7 3. 2 Sam 11:11 4. 1 Kgs 18:40 5. 1 Sam 17:55
6. Josh 21:43 7. Josh 24:14–16 8. 1 Kgs 12:22–24 9. 2 Kgs 12:18–19 10. Gen 44:17 11. Prov 4:19

Chapter 17

Translation of Verbal Forms

1. *they rose early* הִשְׁכִּיחוּ 2. *they will believe* יֵאֱמִינוּ 3. *[people] destroying* הֹאֲמִינֵי 4. *he believed* 5. *I will throw* 6. *and he rose early* 7. *they believed* הֵאֱמִינוּ 8. *believe! (impv. masc. pl.)* הֵאֱמִינוּ 9. *she will throw/you will throw (masc. sg.)* 10. *she threw* הִשְׁלִיכָהּ 11. *throw!/throwing (inf. cs.)* 12. *and they threw* וַיִּשְׁלִיכוּ 13. *I threw* הִשְׁלַכְתִּי 14. *you believed* 15. *I cut off* הִכְרַתִּי

Translation of Sentences

1. Josh 10:11 2. Deut 4:3 3. Jer 28:15 4. Exod 22:30 5. 1 Sam 24:21–23 6. Gen 19:14 7. Num 27:22–23 8. 2 Kgs 10:28 9. 1 Kgs 16:12 10. 1 Sam 26:15–16a 11. Exod 4:1–3 12. 2 Chr 20:20

Chapter 18

Translation of Verbal Forms

1. 3 masc. sg. PC Ho. *he will be put under a ban* 2. 3 masc. sg. PC Ho. *he was visited* 3. 3 masc. sg. PC Ho. *he shall be placed* 4. ptc. masc. sg. Ho. 5. ptc. fem. sg. Ho. 6. ptc. masc. sg. Ho. 7. ptc. masc. sg. Ho. 8. 1 comm. sg. SC Ho. *I was thrown* הִשְׁלַכְתִּי 9. ptc. masc. sg. Ho. 10. 3 masc. sg. PC Ho. *they will be thrown* יִשְׁלָכוּ

Translation of Sentences

1. Lev 16:10 2. 2 Kgs 4:32 3. 2 Sam 19:1 4. Ps 14:7 5. 2 Kgs 10:14 6. 2 Sam 19:16 7. Deut 23:16–17 8. Josh 6:21 9. Hos 14:2 10. 1 Sam 18:5 11. Gen 39:2–3 12. 2 Kgs 8:16–19

Chapter 19

Translation of Verbal Forms

1. *you spoke* דִּבַּרְתָּ 2. *you will speak* 3. *they spoke* 4. *they will speak* יִדְבְּרוּ 5. *I spoke* דִּבַּרְתִּי 6. *you will speak (masc. pl.)* 7. *you hasten* 8. *I will speak* 9. *to speak (inf. cs.)* 10. *speak! (impv. masc. pl.)* 11. *someone*

speaking (ptc. masc. sg.) 12. we spoke דִּבַּרְנוּ 13. he will speak 14. you taught 15. they will serve 16. they/you will speak (fem. pl.) תְּדַבְּרֶנָּה 17. you will bless 18. and they spoke וַיְדַבְּרוּ 19. and he blessed וַיְבָרֶךְ 20. and they sought

Translation of Sentences

1. Exod 2:15 2. Exod 4:19 3. Judg 6:29 4. 1 Sam 26:2 5. Gen 17:15–16
6. Judg 13:24 7. Exod 19:10 8. Exod 19:14 9. Exod 5:1–2 10. 1 Sam 13:2

Chapter 20

Translation of Verbal Forms

1. they were sent 2. she will be blessed (fem. sg.)/you will be blessed (masc. sg.) 3. he will be sought 4. you will be sought (fem. sg.) 5. he will be sent 6. she will be cursed (fem. sg.)/you will be cursed (masc. sg.) 7. he walked around/walk about! (impv. masc. sg.) 8. I walked about הִתְהַלַּכְתִּי 9. we walked about הִתְהַלַּכְנוּ 10. they walked about 11. and they walked about 12. he will pray 13. and she prayed (fem. sg.)/and you prayed (masc. sg.) 14. I prayed הִתְפַּלֵּלְתִּי 15. they sanctified themselves/sanctify yourselves (impv. masc. pl.)

Translation of Sentences

1. Ps 113:2 2. 2 Chr 26:16b–18 3. 1 Kgs 21:14–16 4. Deut 9:20 Qere
5. 1 Sam 4:9 6. 1 Sam 7:5 7. 1 Sam 12:19 8. 2 Kgs 6:17 9. 1 Kgs 20:22
10. 2 Kgs 19:15 11. Gen 5:24 12. 2 Sam 13:20

Chapter 21

Translation of Verbal Forms

1. they looked הִבִּיטוּ 2. you looked (m. pl.) 3. I will look 4. they will look (m. pl.) יִבִּיטוּ 5. I told 6. they told הִגִּידוּ 7. you told (m. sg.) תִּגְדֹּר 8. (she told הִגִּידָה 9. and he told 10. you will tell (f. sg.) תִּגְדְּרִי 11. you will tell (m. pl.) תִּגְדְּרוּ 12. I will tell 13. we will tell 14. and they told/ (m. pl.) וַיִּגְדְּרוּ 15. tell! (m. sg.) תִּגְדְּרִי 16. tell! (m. sg.) 17. I

Key to the Exercises in Chapter 2–26

regretted (Ni.)/I comforted (Pi.) נִחַמְתִּי 18. they will comfort 19. and he comforted 20. they rescued הִצִּילוּ 21. we rescued הִצַּלְנוּ 22. and he rescued 23. rescue! (m. pl.) הִצִּילוּ 24. they will reach יָשִׁיגוּ

Translation of Sentences

1. Exod 3:6 2. Gen 12:18 3. Gen 46:31 4. Gen 47:1 5. Judg 14:1–3
6. 2 Sam 12:18–19 7. Gen 22:20 8. Gen 31:22 9. 1 Sam 15:10–11
10. Gen 6:5–6 11. Exod 17:9 12. 1 Sam 17:37 13. 1 Sam 30:8 14. 2 Sam 12:24 Qere

Chapter 22

Translation of Verbal Forms

1. he finished 2. they finished 3. you finished (masc. pl.) 4. I finished בִּלְיִתִּי 5. I will finish 6. they will finish 7. she covered 8. you will cover (fem. sg.) 9. he prophesied, someone prophesying 10. they prophesied 11. you prophesied נִבֵּאתָ 12. she will prophecy (fem. sg.)/you will prophecy (masc. sg.) 13. you struck הִכִּיתָ 14. he struck 15. they struck 16. I struck הִכֵּיתִי 17. you struck (masc. pl.) 18. he will strike 19. they will strike 20. I will strike 21. and they struck (masc. pl.) 22. and we struck 23. they appeared 24. they will appear (masc. pl.) 25. he showed 26. I commanded צִוֵּיתִי 27. you commanded צִוִּיתָ 28. and he commanded 29. they brought up 30. I brought up הֶעֱלֵיתִי

Translation of Sentences

1. Exod 7:6 2. Exod 4:28 3. 1 Kgs 6:14 4. Gen 2:2 5. 1 Sam 19:20 6. Judg 1:8 7. Deut 8:1 8. 1 Sam 13:14 9. Gen 26:24–25
10. Exod 24:15–18 11. 2 Kings 19:1–2 12. Jer 25:15, 17 13. 1 Sam 10:18 14. 2 Sam 6:12

Chapter 23

Translation of Verbal Forms

1. I will praise 2. we will praise 3. they confessed/confess! (impv. masc. pl.) 4. they did good/do good! (impv. masc. pl.) הִיטִיבוּ 5. you did good

(masc. sg.) הִיטְבָּתָּ 6. *he will do good* 7. *I added* הוֹסַפְתִּי 8. *you will add* (masc. pl.) תֹּסִיפוּ 9. *they will add* (masc. pl.) יוֹסִיפוּ 10. *they took their stand/take your stand* 11. *he will take his stand* 12. *you rescued* 13. *I rescued* הוֹשַׁעְתִּי 14. *she will rescue* (fem. sg.)/*you will rescue* (masc. sg.) 15. *they struck* 16. *and I led* 17. *and they led* (masc. pl.) וַיֵּלְכוּ 18. *you will be silent* (fem. sg.) תִּחַרְרִישִׁי

Translation of Sentences

1. Jer 17:14 2. Gen 41:29–31 3. Exod 2:13–14 4. Exod 3:10–12 5. Exod 6:13 6. Exod 20:1–2 7. Judg 6:8 8. Deut 4:1–2 9. Judg 13:1 10. 1 Sam 19:20–21 11. Deut 31:14–15 12. 1 Sam 24:17 13. Deut 8:1–2 Qere 14. Jer 32:3b–5 Qere 15. 1 Kgs 18:22 16. 1 Kgs 19:9–10 17. 2 Sam 13:30 18. Dtn 5:28 19. Ps 136:1 20. Ps 9:2

Chapter 24

Translation of Verbal Forms

1. *he brought* 2. *she will bring/you will bring* (2 f. sg./ 2 m. sg.) 3. *you brought* (m. sg.) הֵבֵאתָ 4. *they will look* (m.) יִבְיֹאוּ 5. *she will be established/you will be established* 6. *they will be established* יִכָּנְנוּ 7. *they were established* (c. pl.) נִכְנְנוּ 8. *they killed* הִמָּיתוּ 9. *you killed* (m. pl.) 10. *and they killed* (m. pl.) וַיִּמָּיתוּ 11. *you removed* (m. sg.) הִסְרֵתִי 12. *remove!* הִסְרִירוּ 13. *he will remove* 14. *may he remove* 15. *you brought back* (2 m. sg.) הֵשִׁיבוֹתָ 16. *we will bring back* 17. *they set* הִנִּיחוּ 18. *they will set* (2 m. pl.) יִנְיִחוּ

Translation of Sentences

1. 2 Sam 6:17 2. Gen 4:3 3. Gen 20:9 4. Gen 42:37 5. 2 Kgs 22:16 6. 1 Kgs 11:40 7. 2 Kgs 23:29–30 8. 2 Sam 13:28 9. Exod 21:12 10. Deut 24:16 11. 1 Sam 2:34–35 12. Gen 28:15 13. Gen 37:22 14. 1 Sam 5:3 15. Gen 2:15 16. 1 Sam 10:25 17. Josh 1:13 18. 1 Kgs 2:10–12 19. 1 Sam 7:3–4 20. 2 Sam 7:12–16

Chapter 25

Translation of Verbal Forms

1. *they began* הֵחֵלּוּ 2. *I began* הֵחֵלֵּתִי 3. *and they began* וַיֵּחֵלּוּ 4. *and he began* וַיֵּחֵל 5. *they will be dismayed* (m. pl.) יִחְתּוּ 6. *you/they will be dismayed* (2 m. pl./3 f. pl.) יִחְתּוּ 7. *they violated* 8. *you violated* (m. sg.) הִפְרִיתָהּ 9. *they violated* (m. pl.) הִפְרִיּוּ 10. *you/they will violate* (2 m. pl./3 f. pl.) הִפְרִיּוּ 11. *you did evil* (m. pl.) 12. *you did evil* (m. sg.) הִרְעָתָהּ 13. *and they did evil* (m. pl.) וַיִּרְעוּ 14. *evildoers* (m.) 15. *he will shudder* 16. *they shuddered* 17. *I created* בָּרָאתִי 18. *you/they will desecrate* (2 m. pl./3 f. pl.) 19. *they will consult together* (m.) 20. *they consulted together*

Translation of Sentences

1. Josh 3:7 2. Judg 10:18 3. Deut 3:24 4. Gen 41:54 5. Deut 1:21
6. Josh 8:1 7. 2 Sam 17:7 8. 2 Sam 17:14 9. Deut 31:14-1-8 10. 1 Kgs 16:25
11. 2 Sam 15:25 12. Gen 24:4-5

Chapter 26

Translation of Sentences

1. Gen 3:19 2. Gen 3:23 3. Gen 4:25-26 4. 2 Sam 9:6 5. 1 Sam 25:23
6. 1 Kgs 2:19 7. Gen 37:9-10 8. Josh 5:13-15 9. Josh 5:13-15 10. Jer 7:1-3
11. 2 Kgs 17:35-36 12. 1 Kgs 11:40

Vocabulary in Alphabetical Order

א

אב	<i>father</i>	אח	<i>brother</i>
אבר	Q. <i>to perish</i>	אחות	<i>sister</i>
אבה	Q. <i>to be willing, consent</i> (almost always with a negative)	אחז	Q. <i>to grasp, take hold, take possession</i>
אביון	<i>needy, poor</i> (adj.)	אחזה	<i>possession, property</i>
אבן	<i>stone</i> (f., pl. אבנים)	אחר	<i>behind, afterwards</i> (adv.), <i>behind, after</i> (prep.)
אדון	<i>lord</i> (with ref. to God אדני <i>my Lord</i>)	אחר	<i>another, different</i> (m. pl. אחרים, f. sg. אחרת, f. pl. אחרות)
אדם	<i>man, mankind</i>	אחרון	<i>last, latter</i> (temp.); <i>at the back; western</i> (local)
ארמה	<i>ground, land</i>	אחרי	<i>after, behind</i> (local and temporal)
אהב	Q. <i>to love</i> (stative verb, PC אהב; SC pausal form אהב 3 masc. sg. אהב)	אחריכון	<i>afterwards</i> (adv.)
אהל	<i>tent</i>	אחרית	<i>end; future; descendants</i> (fem.)
או	<i>or</i>	אי	<i>where?</i>
און	<i>disaster; sin, injustice; deception, nothingness; idolatry</i>	איב	<i>enemy</i>
אוצר	<i>treasure, supplies</i>	איה	<i>where?</i>
אור	<i>light</i>	איל	<i>ram</i>
אות	<i>sign</i> (fem., pl. אותות)	אין	<i>there is not</i> (particle of non-existence)
אז	<i>then, at that time</i> (often with a PC form with past tense meaning)	איש	<i>man</i>
אזן	<i>ear</i> (du. אזניים 'aznáyim)	אך	<i>yea, surely, only</i>
		אכל	Q. <i>to eat</i>

Vocabulary in Alphabetical Order

אֵל	<i>not</i> (with the jussive or cohortative)	אָסַף	Q. <i>to gather, remove</i>
אֵל	<i>to, towards</i> (spatial), <i>at, by</i> (local), <i>against, according to</i>	אָסַר	Q. <i>to tie, bind, imprison</i>
אֵל	<i>God, god</i>	אֵף	<i>also, even</i> (adv.)
אֵלֶּה	<i>these</i> (comm.)	אֵף	<i>nose, anger, nostrils</i> (gem. noun; dual אֵפִים)
אֱלֹהִים	<i>God, god, gods</i>	אֵפִים	<i>face</i> (dual of אֵף)
אֱלֹהִי	<i>god, God</i>	אֵצֶל	<i>in proximity to, beside</i> (prep.)
אֵלְמָנָה	<i>widow</i>	אָרוֹן	<i>chest, ark</i> (with the article הָאָרוֹן)
אִם	<i>if</i> (conj.)	אֲרָז	<i>cedar</i>
אִמָּה	<i>slave, handmaid</i>	אֲרַח	<i>way, path</i>
אִמָּה	<i>cubit</i>	אֲרִי	<i>lion</i>
אִמּוּנָה	<i>steadfastness; trustworthiness, faithfulness</i>	אֲרִיָּה	<i>lion</i>
אִמֵּן	Hi. <i>to believe, think; to believe in; to have trust in</i> , Ni. <i>to be reliable, faithful; to be permanent, endure</i>	אֲרָךְ	<i>length</i>
אָמַר	Q. <i>to say</i>	אֲרֶץ	<i>earth, land</i> (fem.) (pl. אֲרָצוֹת; with the article הָאָרֶץ, pausal form אֶרֶץ)
אִמְרִי	<i>Amorite</i>	אָרַר	Q. <i>to curse</i>
אֵנָּה	<i>where to?</i> (interrogative adverb אֵן <i>where to?</i> with directional He)	אֵשׁ	<i>fire</i> (fem.)
אָנוּשׁ	<i>mankind, (all) human beings, man; (some) men; single human being</i> (mostly poet.)	אִשָּׁה	<i>woman</i>
		אֵת	<i>with, close to, beside</i>
		אֵת	object marker indicating the direct object

ב

בִּ	<i>in, at, with</i> (local and temporal)	בְּאֵר	<i>well</i> (of underground water), <i>watering place</i> (fem.)
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בְּגָד	garment, clothing
בְּהֵמָה	beast, animal, cattle
בוא	Q. to come, to enter; Hi. to bring, bring in
בֹּר	cistern, pit
בוש	Q. to be ashamed
בחר	Q. to choose (with prepositional object with בָּ or direct object)
בטח	Q. to trust, be confident
בֶּטֶן	belly; internal organs (fem.)
בִּטְרָם	before (conj. or prep.)
בין	Q. to discern, understand; Hi. to understand; to give understanding, teach
בין	between (prep., usually (בין ... or בין ... יבין))
בית	house
בכה	Q. to weep, weep for
בְּכֹר	firstborn
בֹּל	not (negative used in poetry)
בְּלִי	not; without
בְּמָה	hill, high place (often as place of worship)
בֵּן	son

בנה	Q. to build
בְּעִבּוּר	because of, for the sake of (prep.): in order that (conj.) (prep. בָּ + noun (עִבּוּר))
בְּעַד	behind; through, out of; round about; for the benefit of, for (prep.; cs. st. (בְּעַד, with ePP בְּעַד))
בַּעַל	owner, lord, Baal
בער	Q. to burn (intransitive)
בָּקָר	cattle, herd (coll.)
בֹּקֶר	morning
בקש	Pi. to seek
ברא	Q. to create
בַּרְזֵל	iron
ברח	Q. to run away, flee
בְּרִית	covenant, agreement, contract (fem.)
ברך	Pi. to bless (in the Q. only part. pass.)
בְּרָכָה	blessing (cs. st. בְּרָכָה, but with enclitic pronoun בְּרָכָתִי)
בָּשָׂר	flesh, meat
בת	daughter
בְּתוּלָה	virgin

ג

גאל	Q. to redeem
גְּבוּל	border, boundary, territory

גִּבּוּר	hero (as substantive), strong, mighty (adj.)
גְּבוּרָה	strength, might

Vocabulary in Alphabetical Order

גִּבְעָה	hill	גֹּרַר	Q. to sojourn, dwell as alien and dependent
גִּבּוֹר	man	גֹּרֶל	lot; allocation by lot
גָּדוֹל	great	גִּלָּה	Q. to uncover, remove, go into exile
גָּדַל	Q. to be great, become great, grow up (stative verb); Hi. to make great; to make great things; Pi. to cause to grow; make great, powerful	גַּם	also, even
גּוֹי	nation, people (pl. גּוֹיִם)	גִּמְלָה	camel (pl. גִּמְלִים)
		גִּפְּן	vine (fem.)
		גֵּר	sojourner
		גִּרַּשׁ	Pi. to drive out

ד

דָּבַק	Q. to cling, cleave, keep close	דָּם	blood
דִּבֵּר	Pi. to speak	דַּעַת	knowledge (inf. cs. Q. יָדַע)
דְּבָר	word, matter, thing	דָּרַךְ	Q. to tread
דְּבַשׁ	honey	דֶּרֶךְ	way, road; distance, journey (sg. mostly fem., pl. masc.)
דּוֹר	generation (pl. דִּירוֹת)	דָּרַשׁ	Q. to seek, resort to
דֶּלֶת	door (fem., du. דְּלֵתַיִם, pl. דְּלֵתוֹת)		

ה

הוּי	ah! alas! ha! (interjection expressing usually dissatisfaction and pain)	הִלֵּל	Pi. to praise; Hitpa. to boast
הָיָה	Q. to be, to become	הֶמְנוֹן	sound, murmur, roar; crowd; abundance
הֵיכָל	palace; temple	הִנֵּן	behold (points to the word it precedes; cf. הִנֵּה); if (conditional conj.); if (for indirect questions)
הִלָּךְ	Q. to go; Hitpa. to walk; to walk about; to move to and fro		

הִנֵּה	look, behold	הַרְבֵּה	greatly, exceedingly, much (adv.; orig. inf. abs. Hi. of רבה)
הִפֵּךְ	Q. to turn; to overthrow; to change	הָרַג	Q. to kill, slay
הָר	mountain, hill, hill- country		

ז

זֶה, זֹאת	this (masc., fem.)	זָעַק	Q. to cry, cry out, call (cf. צִעַק)
זָבַח	Q. to slaughter for sacri- fice, slaughter	זָקֵן	old, old man (הַזְקֵנִים the elders)
זִבְחָה	sacrifice	זָר	strange, foreign
זָהָב	gold	זְרוּעַ	arm, forearm (fem.)
זָכַר	Q. to remember	זָרַע	Q. to sow, scatter seed
זָכָר	male (adj.)	זָרַע	seed, sowing, offspring, descendants
זָנָה	Q. to commit fornication; to be unfaithful (in a rela- tionship with God)		

ח

חָג	festival, festival-gathering, pilgrim-feast (pl. חֲגִיִּים; abs. st. also חָג)	חוּץ	outside, street (m.; pl. חוּצוֹת)
חָדַל	Q. to cease, come to an end; to cease, leave off	חִזָּה	Q. to see, behold (almost always poetic)
חֲדָשׁ	new	חִזַּק	Q. to be firm, strong (sta- tive verb, PC יִחַזֵּק but SC חִזַּק); Pi. to make firm, strong; repair; Hi. to seize, grasp; to keep hold of; Hitpa. to show oneself courageous; to prove one- self strong
חֲדָשׁ	new moon, month		
חוּה	Hištaphel to bow down, prostrate; to worship		
חוֹמָה	city wall, wall		

Vocabulary in Alphabetical Order

חָזָק	<i>strong; heavy, severe; firm, hard (adj.)</i>	חָנָה	<i>Q. to encamp</i>
חָטָא	<i>Q. to sin</i>	חָנַן	<i>Q. to show favor, be gracious</i>
חַטָּאת	<i>sin, sin offering</i>	חֻסָּד	<i>joint obligation, loyalty, faithfulness, goodness, graciousness</i>
חַי	<i>alive, living (pl. חַיִּים)</i>	חָפֵץ	<i>Q. to take pleasure in, desire; to delight in (freq. with prep. obj. with בְּ)</i>
חַיָּה	<i>Q. to be alive, stay alive, revive, recover, return to life</i>	חֵץ	<i>arrow (gem. noun; pl. חֲצִים)</i>
חַיָּה	<i>animals (usually collective)</i>	חֲצִי	<i>half, middle</i>
חֵיל	<i>strength, wealth, army</i>	חֲצֵר	<i>court, enclosure</i>
חָכָם	<i>wise</i>	חֹק	<i>statute (pl. חֻקִּים)</i>
חָכְמָה	<i>wisdom</i>	חֻקָּה	<i>statute</i>
חֶלֶב	<i>fat; best, choice part</i>	חֶרֶב	<i>sword (fem.)</i>
חָלָה	<i>Q. to be or become weak; become sick, ill</i>	חָרָה	<i>Q. to burn, kindle (of anger אַף)</i>
חֲלוֹם	<i>dream (masc.; pl. חֲלֻמוֹת)</i>	חָרַם	<i>Hi. to put under a ban</i>
חָלַל	<i>Hi. to begin; Pi. to profane; to put into use</i>	חֲרָפָה	<i>disgrace, shame; reviling, taunt</i>
חָלָל	<i>slain, pierced</i>	חָרַשׁ	<i>Hi. to be silent</i>
חָלַק	<i>Q./Pi. to divide, apportion</i>	חָשַׁב	<i>Q. to think, consider, regard, plan, devise</i>
חֶלֶק	<i>portion, share, possession</i>	חֹשֶׁךְ	<i>darkness</i>
חֶמָּה	<i>heat; rage, wrath; poison</i>	חָתַת	<i>Ni. to be dismayed; to be terrified; Q. to be shattered; to be filled with terror</i>
חֲמוֹר	<i>donkey, he-ass</i>		
חָמָס	<i>violence, wrong</i>		
חֵן	<i>favor, grace</i>		

ט

טָהוֹר	<i>pure; ceremonially clean (adj.)</i>	טָהַר	<i>Q. to be clean (stative verb, SC טָהַר, PC יִטְהַר); Pi. to cleanse; to pronounce clean</i>
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טוֹב *good*
 טמא *Q. to be unclean, become unclean (stative verb, SC טָמֵא); Pi. to defile; to desecrate*

טָמֵא *unclean (adj., m. pl. טָמְאִים)*
 טָרָם *not yet (adv.); before (conj.); בְּטָרָם before (conj. or prep.)*

י

יָאֵר *the Nile (usually with the article הַיָּאֵר, pl. יָאֵרִים; Nile-arms, Nile-canals) river, stream*
 יָבֵשׁ *Q. to be dry, dried up (stative verb; SC יָבֵשׁ; PC יִיבֵשׁ); Hi. to dry up, make dry*
 יָד *hand (fem.; dual יָדַיְתִים hands, pl. יָדוֹת only with figurative meanings)*
 יָדָה² *Hi. to praise; Hitpa. to confess (SC הִתְנַדָּה)*
 יָדַע *to know*
 יוֹם *day (הַיּוֹם as adv. today)*
 יוֹמָם *by day (adv.)*
 יָטַב *Q. to be good, well, glad, pleasant; Hi. to do good to, deal well with; to do well; to make something good*
 יַיִן *wine*
 יָכַח *Hi. to rebuke, reproach; to decide*
 יָלַד *Q. to bear, beget*
 יָלֹד *boy*
 יָם *sea, west (pl. יָמִים)*

יָמִין *right side, right hand, south*
 יָסַף *Q. to add; Hi. to add*
 יָעַן, יָעַן אֲשֶׁר *because*
 יַעֲץ *Q. to advice, counsel; Ni. to consult together; to exchange council*
 יַעַר *wood; forest; thicket*
 יָצָא *Q. to go out, come out*
 יָצַב *Hitpa. to set oneself, to station oneself; to take one's stand (cf. נָצַב Ni./Hi.)*
 יָצַק *Q. to pour out*
 יָרָא *Q. to fear, be afraid (stative verb, SC יָרָא; with direct object or prep. מִן or מִפְּנֵי indicate the object)*
 יָרַד *Q. to go down, come down, descend*
 יָרָה³ *Hi. to instruct, teach (cf. תּוֹרָה)*
 יָרַשׁ *to take possession of, inherit, dispossess*

Vocabulary in Alphabetical Order

יָשַׁב	Q. to sit, remain, dwell	יָשָׁר	straight, right
יְשׁוּעָה	help, salvation	יָתַר	Ni. to be left over, remain; Hi. to leave over, leave
יָשַׁע	Hi. to help, save; Ni. to receive help; to be victorious	יָתֵר	rest, remainder

כ

כִּי	like, as, according to	כִּי	for, because (causal), if (conditional), when (temporal), that, etc. (conj.)
כַּאֲשֶׁר	as, according to (modal), when (temporal), because (causal) (conj.)	כֶּכֶר	round loaf, talent, vicinity (esp. the region of the Jordan) (fem.)
כָּבֵד	Q. to be heavy; to be insensitive, dull; to be honored (stative verb, SC כָּבֵד, PC יְכַבֵּד); Pi. to make honorable, honor; Ni. to be honored, enjoy honor	כֹּל	the whole, every, all
כָּבֵד	heavy; oppressing; weighty (adj.)	כִּלָּה	Q. to be complete, at an end, finished, accomplished, spent; Pi. to complete, bring to an end, finish; to accomplish; to cause to cease
כְּבוֹד	glory, honor	כֵּלִי	article, utensil, vessel, weapon
כִּבֵּס	Pi. to wash (normally clothes) (SC כִּבֵּס)	כֵּן	so, thus (Modern Hebrew: yes)
כֶּבֶשׂ	young ram	כֶּנֶף	wing; edge, extremity; skirt (of a garment) (fem.)
כֹּה	thus, here (adv.)	כִּסֵּא	seat, chair, throne
כֹּהֵן	priest	כִּסָּה	Pi. to cover
כּוֹן	Ni. to be established; to be steadfast; to be permanent; to be ready; Hi. to establish, set up; to make ready, prepare; to direct; Polel to set up, establish	כֶּסֶל	fool
כֹּחַ	strength, power	כֶּסֶף	silver
		כִּעַס	Hi. to provoke to anger

כף	<i>the hollow, flat of the hand, hand, sole (of the foot) (dual כַּפַּיִם)</i>
כְּרוּב	<i>cherub</i>
כֶּרֶם	<i>vineyard</i>
כרת	<i>Q. to cut, Hi. cut off, exterminate</i>

כשל	<i>Q. and Ni. to stumble, stagger</i>
כתב	<i>Q. to write</i>
כַּתֵּף	<i>shoulder; side; mountain slope</i>

ל

לְ	<i>to, for, regarding, also indicating indirect objects</i>
לא	<i>not, no</i>
לְאמֹר	<i>introduction of direct speech</i>
לֵב	<i>heart (pl. לְבוֹת)</i>
לֵבָב	<i>heart (cs. st. לֵבָב)</i>
לְבַד	<i>alone, by itself (with ePP לְבַדּוֹ; prep. לְ with noun בַּד separation)</i>
לְבַלְתִּי	<i>not (negative used with the inf. cs.; לְ + בַלְתִּי)</i>
לבש	<i>Q. to put on (a garment), to clothe oneself, clothe (stative verb, SC לְבַשׁ, PC יִלְבֹּשׁ)</i>
לוּ	<i>if (conj.); O that</i>
לֹא־לֵא	<i>if not, unless (conj.)</i>
לחם	<i>Ni. to fight, do battle (with prep. objects)</i>
לֶחֶם	<i>bread, food</i>

לַיְלָה	<i>night</i>
לַיִן	<i>Q. to spend the night, stay overnight; to stay, dwell</i>
לכד	<i>Q. to capture, seize, take</i>
לָכֵן	<i>therefore (לְ + כֵּן)</i>
למד	<i>Qal to learn; Pi. to teach</i>
לָמָּה	<i>why? (preposition לְ + מָה)</i>
לְמַעַן	<i>in order to, so that (conj.); on account of, for the sake of (prep.) (לְ + מַעַן; prep. and conj.)</i>
לפני	<i>in front of, before (local and temporal) (prep. לְ + פָּנִים)</i>
לקח	<i>Q. to take</i>
לְקִרְאָת	<i>toward, against (prep.; לְ + inf. cs. of the verb קרא₂ encounter)</i>
לָשׁוֹן	<i>tongue; language (m.; pl. לְשָׁנוֹת)</i>

מ

מְאֹד	very (degree particle); as a noun <i>strength, power</i>	מִזְבֵּחַ	altar (pl. מִזְבְּחוֹת)
מֵאַיִן	whence? where from? (prep. מִן + אֵין)	מִזְמוֹר	psalm
מֵאן	Pi. to refuse	מִזְרַח	sunrise; east
מֵאס	Q. to reject, despise	מַחֲנֶה	camp
מִגְדָּל	tower	מָחָר	tomorrow (adv.)
מִגֶּן	shield (pl. מִגְנִים)	מַחְשָׁבָה	thought; device, plan, purpose
מִגְרֵשׁ	pastureland (belonging to a city); outskirts	מִטָּה	staff, tribe
מִדְבָּר	wilderness, desert	מִי	who?
מִדֵּד	Q. to measure	מִים	water
מִדָּה	measured length; measurement	מִכָּה	blow; wound; plague
מִדּוּעַ	why?	מָכַר	Q. to sell
מִדְיָנָה	province	מָלֵא	Q. to be full (stative verb; SC מָלֵא; with noun to indicate the substance)
מָה	what?	מָלֵא	full (adj.)
מַהֲרָה	Pi. to hasten; to do something hastily	מַלְאָךְ	messenger, angel
מַהֲרָה	quickly, speedily (adv.; inf. abs. of מַהֲרָה Pi. to hasten)	מַלְאָכָה	occupation, work (mālā(')kā; cs. st. מַלְאָכָה)
מוֹסָר	discipline; training; exhortation, warning	מִלְחָמָה	battle, war
מוֹעֵד	appointed time, appointed place, meeting (אָהֵל)	מָלַט	Ni. to escape, be delivered
מוֹת	Q. to die (SC 3 m. sg. מָוֹת; PC 3 m. sg. מָוֹת; part. m. sg. מָוֹת); Hi. to kill, put to death	מָלַךְ	Q. to reign (as king) to become king
מָוֶת	death	מֶלֶךְ	king
		מַלְכוּת	royalty; royal power; reign; kingdom
		מַמְלָכָה	kingdom, sovereignty, dominion, reign (cs. st. מַמְלָכָה)
		מִמָּעַל	above (adv.) (מִמָּעַל לְ) prep. on top of, above)

מִן	<i>from, away from, out of; in comparisons: (more) than</i>	מָקוֹם	<i>place (masc., pl. מְקוֹמוֹת)</i>
מִנְחָה	<i>gift, tribute, offering</i>	מִקְנֵה	<i>livestock as property, cattle</i>
מִסְפָּר	<i>number</i>	מִרְאָה	<i>sight, appearance, vision</i>
מְעַט	<i>a little, fewness, a few</i>	מְרוֹם	<i>height, elevated place</i>
מַעְלָה	<i>upwards, above (adv.) (noun מַעַל higher part)</i>	מָשַׁח	<i>Q. to anoint, to smear</i>
מַעֲשֵׂה	<i>deed, work</i>	מִשְׁכָּן	<i>dwelling-place, abode</i>
מֵצָא	<i>Q. to find</i>	מָשַׁל	<i>Q. to rule, reign</i>
מִצָּה	<i>unleavened bread, matzah (matzo)</i>	מִשְׁמָרֶת	<i>guard, watch; charge, injunction; function, office</i>
מִצְוָה	<i>commandment</i>	מִשְׁפָּחָה	<i>extended family, clan</i>
מִקְדָּשׁ	<i>sacred place, sanctuary</i>	מִשְׁפָּט	<i>judgment</i>
		מִשְׁתָּה	<i>feast, banquet</i>
		מָתִי	<i>when?</i>

נ

נֹאם	<i>utterance, declaration, announcement</i>	נָגַשׁ	<i>Qal/Ni. to draw near, approach</i>
נָבִיא	<i>Ni. to be in a prophetic trance, behave like a נְבִיא; Hitpa. to exhibit the behavior of a נְבִיא</i>	נִדָּר	<i>vow</i>
נִבֵּט	<i>Hi. to look</i>	נָהָר	<i>river, stream (pl. נְהָרוֹת; נָהָר נְהָר Euphrates)</i>
נְבִיא	<i>prophet</i>	נָרַח	<i>Hi. to thrust; thrust out; thrust away</i>
נֶגֶב	<i>south-country, Negev, south</i>	נָוַח	<i>Hi. A to cause to rest, give rest; Hi. B to lay, set down; to leave, let remain</i>
נִגַּד	<i>Hi. to tell, inform, report</i>	נוֹס	<i>Q. to flee, escape</i>
נִגַּד	<i>in front of, in sight of, opposite to</i>	נָחַל	<i>Q. to get a possession; to take a possession; to inherit</i>
נָגַע	<i>Q. to touch, reach, strike</i>	נַחֲלִי	<i>river valley, wadi; stream</i>
נִגַּע	<i>Q. stroke, plague, blow, mark</i>		

Vocabulary in Alphabetical Order

נַחֲלָה	possession, property, inheritance	נַעֲרָה	young woman, girl; maid, attendant, servant
נָחַם	Ni. to regret; to be sorry; to console oneself; Pi. to comfort	נָפַל	to fall
נְחֹשֶׁת	copper, bronze	נֶפֶשׁ	soul, self, life, living being, person, desire, throat (f.)
נָטָה	Q. to stretch out, spread out, extend, bend, turn, incline; Hi. to turn, incline	נָצַב	Ni. to take one's stand, to stand
נָטַע	Q. to plant	נָצַל	Hi. to take away, snatch away; to rescue; to deliver from
נָכָה	Hi. to smite, to strike; to strike dead	נָצַר	Q. to watch, guard, keep
נָסַע	to pull up or out, set out, journey	נָשָׂא	Q. to lift, carry, take
נָעַר	boy, lad, youth	נָשַׁג	Hi. to reach; to overtake
		נָשִׂיא	chief, prince
		נָתַן	Q. to give, to put, to make into, to allow

ס

סָבַב	Q. to turn about, go around, surround	סֹרַר	Q. to turn aside; Hi. to cause to turn aside, depart; to remove, take away
סָבִיב	around, round about (adv. and prep., as a noun surroundings)	סֶלַע	rock, cliff
סְבִיבוֹת	around, round about (prep.; pl. of סָבִיב, with ePP סְבִיבֵיהֶם)	סָפַר	Q. to count; Pi. to report; tell; to make known, announce
סָנַר	Q. to shut, close; Hi. to deliver, hand over; to shut	סֵפֶר	something written, letter, scroll
סוּס	horse	סֹפֵר	secretary, scribe
		סָתַר	Hi. to hide, conceal (transitive); Ni. to hide oneself; to be hid, concealed

ע

עבר	Q. to serve, work	עֵין	eye, spring (fem.)
עֶבֶד	slave, servant	עִיר	city, town (fem.)
עֲבָדָה	work, service	עַל	on, upon, above, at, by, against, on account of, because of, about, concerning
עבר	Q. to pass over, through, by, pass on	עַל אֲשֶׁר	because
עֵבֶר	region across or beyond; side	עֲלֶה	Q. to go up, ascend
עַד	up to, as far as, until (local and temporal)	עֲלֶה	(whole) burnt offering
עֵד	witness	עֲלִיוֹן	highest, most high
עֲדָה	congregation	עַל־כֵּן	therefore
עֵדוּת	witness, testimony, pl. laws, legal provisions (pl. עֵדוּת;	עַם	people, nation (also עַם)
	with ePP also עֵדוּתָיו 'ēd-wōtāw his legal provisions, etc.)	עִם	with, close to, beside
עוד	still, yet, again, besides (adv.)	עָמַד	Q. to take one's stand, stand
עוֹלָם	long time, duration, future time, long time back	עָמוּד	pillar; column (cf. עָמַד)
עוֹן	iniquity, guilt (pl. עֲוֹנוֹת)	עָמַל	trouble; labor; toil
עוֹף	birds, fowl; winged insects (everything that flies) (coll.)	עָמָק	valley, vale, lowland
עור	Q. to awake; to stir; Hi. to wake up; to excite; to put into motion	עֲנֶה	Q. to answer, respond
עור	skin; animal skin; leather	עֲנֶה ₂	Q. to be bowed down; to be downcast, afflicted; Pi. to oppress; to mishandle, humble, afflict
עֹז	might, strength	עָנִי	poor; afflicted; humble
עזב	Q. to leave, forsake	עָנָן	cloud, cloud-mass
עזר	Q. to help, assist	עָפָר	dry earth; dust
		עֵץ	tree, wood, sometimes trees (coll.) (pl. עֵצִים)
		עֲצָה	counsel, advice; plan
		עָצָם	bone (m. or f.; pl. עֲצָמוֹת)
		עָרֵב	evening

Vocabulary in Alphabetical Order

עֲרֶבָה *desert-plain, steppe* (with the article הָעֲרֶבָה usually a part of the arid region between the Sea of Galilea and the Gulf of Aqaba)
עֲרֹנָה *nakedness; genital area*

עֲרָךְ *Q. to arrange, set in order; to draw up a battle formation*
עָשָׂה *Q. to do, to make*
עֵת *time* (f.; gem. noun; with enclitic pronoun עִתּוֹ)
עַתָּה *now* (adv. of time)

פ

פֶּאֶה *corner; side*
פָּדָה *Q. to buy out, redeem, ransom*
פֶּה *mouth*
פֹּה *here* (adv.)
פּוּץ *Q. to be dispersed; disperse; Ni. be scattered; Hi. to scatter*
פֹּלָא *Ni. to be surpassing, extraordinary*
פָּלַל *Hitpa. to pray*
פִּלְשְׁתִּים *Philistines* (sg. פִּלְשְׁתִּי)
כֵּן *so that not, lest* (conj.)
פָּר *bull, steer* (gem. noun; pl. פָּרִים)
פֵּרִי *fruit*
פָּרַעַה *Pharao*
פָּרַר *Hi. to break, violate; to frustrate, make ineffectual*
פָּרַשׁ *Q. to spread out, spread*

פָּנָה *Q. to turn* (turn to one side, head in a particular direction; turn round; turn away and go on further)
פָּנִים *face, surface* (only pl.)
פֶּסַח *Passover, Pesach*
פָּעַל *Q. to do; to make*
פַּעַם *step, pace; foot; time* (Tagalog beses)
פָּקַד *Q. to visit, attend to, muster, appoint; Hi. to set (over), make oversee; commit, entrust; deposit*
פָּרָשׁ *horseman, charioteer; team of horses, horses for a chariot* (pl. פָּרָשִׁים)
פֶּשַׁע *transgression, crime*
פָּתַח *Q. to open; Pi. to let loose; to untie; to liberate*
פֶּתַח *opening, doorway, entrance*

צ

צאן	<i>small cattle, sheep and goats, flock, flocks (coll., fem.)</i>	צור	<i>rock; rocky hill, mountain</i>
צבא	<i>army, host, war, warfare (pl. צבאות)</i>	צל	<i>shadow, shade (gem. noun; with ePP צלִי)</i>
צדיק	<i>just, righteous</i>	צלח	<i>Q. to force entry to; to succeed, be successful; Hi. to be successful; to make something a success</i>
צדק	<i>rightness; righteousness</i>	צעק	<i>Q. to cry, cry out, call</i>
צדקה	<i>righteousness</i>	צפון	<i>north</i>
צוה	<i>Pi. to give an order, to command; to order, to instruct; to charge, to commission (cf. the noun מצוה)</i>	צר	<i>enemy (pl. צרים)</i>
		צרה	<i>need; distress; anxiety</i>

ק

קבץ	<i>Q. to gather, collect</i>	קהל	<i>assembly</i>
קבר	<i>Q. to bury</i>	קול	<i>voice, sound (masc., pl. קלות)</i>
קבר	<i>grave</i>	קום	<i>Q. to arise, stand up, stand; Hi. to raise, raise up</i>
קדוש	<i>holy</i>	קטן	<i>small; young; unimportant (adj.; cs. st. קטן; only in m. sg., other forms from קטן)</i>
קדים	<i>East; east wind</i>	קטן	<i>small; young; unimportant (adj.; pl. קטנים)</i>
קדם	<i>front; east; before, earlier; prehistoric times, primeval times</i>	קטר	<i>Hi. to cause to go up in smoke; Pi. to make a sacrifice go up in smoke</i>
קדש	<i>Q. to be holy (stative verb; SC pausal form קדש; PC קדש); Pi. to sanctify, make holy; to declare holy; to dedicate; Hi. to set apart, devote, consecrate; regard or treat as sacred</i>	קטרת	<i>smoke, odor of (burning) sacrifice; incense (fem.)</i>
קדש	<i>holiness</i>	קיר	<i>wall (pl. קירות)</i>

Vocabulary in Alphabetical Order

קלל	Q. to be small, insignificant; to be swift; Pi. to curse	קרב	Q. to draw near, approach (stative verb; SC קָרַב and קָרַב; PC יִקְרַב)
קנה	Q. to buy; to acquire; ; to create	קָרַב	inward part, midst (with ePP קָרְבוּ)
קִנְיָה	stalk, reed	קָרְבָּן	offering, gift (only in Lev, Num, Ezek)
קֵץ	end (gem. noun; with ePP קִצּוֹ)	קָרוֹב	near
קֶצֶה	edge, end, extremity	קָרֵן	horn
קָצִיר	harvest; harvest crops	קרע	Q. to tear
קרא	Q. to call, proclaim, read	קִשָּׁת	bow (fem.)

ר

ראה	Q. to see; Ni. to appear, become visible; to present oneself; Hi. to show, let someone see something	רוץ	Q. to run
ראש	head	רחב	breadth, width
רֵאשִׁית	beginning; first, chief	רחב	broad open place, plaza
רב	much, many, great (pl. רַבִּים)	רחוק	distant, far (adj.)
רב	multitude, abundance, greatness	רחץ	Q. to wash, bathe
רבה	Q. to become numerous, increase; to become great; Hi. to make numerous; to make great	רחק	Q. to be far, distant; Hi. to remove; to depart, withdraw, distance oneself
רדף	to pursue, chase, persecute	ריב	Q. to strive, contend
רוח	spirit, wind (fem. or masc.)	ריב	dispute, lawsuit, quarrel
רום	Q. to be high; to be raised, uplifted; to rise (intrans.); Hi. to raise, lift up; to exalt; to set up; Polel to raise, lift up; to exalt	רכב	Q. to mount and ride, ride; Hi. to cause ride, to make to ride (PC יִרְכַּב)
		רִכְבָּ	chariotry, chariots (collective), chariot (rare meaning)
		רע	bad, evil (pl. רָעִים; gem. adj.)

רֵעַ *friend, companion, fellow*
 רָעָב *famine, hunger*
 רָעָה Q. *to pasture, tend, graze*
 (part. רֹעֶה *shepherd*)
 רָעָה *evil; distress; misery; disaster, calamity* (root רעע)
 רעע Q. *to be bad, evil, displeasing; Hi. to do evil; to treat badly*

רפא Q. *to heal; Ni. to be healed*
 רצה Q. *to be pleased with; to accept favorably*
 רְצוֹן *goodwill; favor; acceptance*
 רק *only, still, but, however, nevertheless, surely*
 רָשָׁע *wicked, guilty*

ש

שבע Q. *be sated, to eat one's fill, satisfy oneself with* (stative verb, SC pausal form שָׂבַע, PC שָׂבַע) (with noun phrase)
 שֶׂה *a small livestock beast (sheep or goat)*
 שָׂדֶה *field* (masc., pl. שְׂדוֹת)
 שים Q. *to put, to make into, to give*
 שכל Hi. *to understand; to have insight; to make wise, insightful; to achieve success*

שְׂמאל *left side, left, north* (śamō(?)l with silent א)
 שמח Q. *to rejoice, be glad* (stative verb)
 שְׂמֵחָה *joy, gladness*
 שנא Q. *to hate* (stative verb, PC שָׂנֵא)
 שְׂעִיר *billy-goat, buck*
 שִׁפָּה *lip, speech, edge*
 שַׂר *ruler, official, prince, captain, chieftain, chief* (gem. noun; pl. cs. st. שָׂרִי)
 שָׂרַף Q. *to burn completely* (transitive)

ש

שְׂאוּל *underworld* (fem.)
 שאל Q. *to ask, inquire*
 שאר Ni. *be left over, remain; Hi. to leave over, spare*

שְׂאֵרִית *remainder; remnant* (fem.)
 שִׁבְט *rod, staff, scepter, tribe*
 שבע Ni. *to swear, take an oath*

Vocabulary in Alphabetical Order

שבר	Q. to break, break in pieces	שְׁלוֹם	welfare, peace, completeness
שבת	Q. to cease; to desist; to rest; Hi. to cause to cease, put an end to exterminate, destroy; to remove	שלח	Q. to send; Pi. to send off; to send out, forth; to let go, set free
שַׁבָּת	Sabbath (f. or m.; pl. שַׁבָּתוֹת)	שֻׁלְחָן	table
שדד	Q. to devastate, despoil, deal violently with	שָׁלַךְ	Hi. to throw
שדד	Q. to devastate, despoil, deal violently with	שָׁלַל	spoil, plunder, booty
שוב	Q. to turn back, return (intrans.); Hi. to bring back, return (trans.)	שלם	Pi. to make whole or good, restore; make good, i.e., pay (vows); to requite, recompense, reward
שָׁוְא	emptiness; nothingness	שָׁלַם	a kind of offering: conclusion offering; salvation offering
שופר	horn (as a wind instrument)	שָׁם	there (adv.)
שור	a single beast, bovid (bull, etc.)	שֵׁם	name (masc., pl. שֵׁמוֹת)
שחט	Q. to slaughter	שמד	Hi. to annihilate, exterminate; destroy
שחת	Hi./Pi. to ruin, destroy; annihilate, exterminate	שָׁמַיִם	heaven, sky
שיר	Q. to sing (PC יָשִׁיר)	שָׁמֵם	Q. to be uninhabited, be deserted; to shudder, be appalled; Ni. to be made uninhabited, deserted; to be made to tremble
שיר	song	שְׁמֹמָה	desolation; devastation; waste
שית	Q. to set, put (PC יָשִׁית)	שָׁמֶן	oil, fat, fatness
שכב	Q. to lie down (3 m. sg. PC יִשְׁכַּב)	שמע	Q. to hear, to listen to
שכח	Q. to forget	שמר	Q. to keep, watch, preserve
שכם	Hi. to do something early; to rise early	שֶׁמֶשׁ	sun (fem.)
שָׁכָם	shoulder, back	שֵׁן	tooth, ivory (gem. noun; dual שֵׁנַיִם)
שכן	Q. to settle down, dwell		

שָׁנָה	<i>year</i> (pl. שָׁנִים)
שַׁעַר	<i>gate</i>
שִׁפְחָה	<i>maid, maid-servant</i> (pl. שִׁפְחוֹת)
שָׁפַט	<i>Q. to judge, govern</i>
שֹׁפֵט	<i>judge, ruler, governor</i> (part. act. Qal)
שָׁפַךְ	<i>Q. to pour, pour out</i>

שָׁקָה	<i>Hi. to give to drink; to cause to drink water</i> (causative counterpart to the verb שָׁתָה Q. <i>to drink</i>)
שֶׁקֶל	<i>weight; shekel</i> (measurement of weight; about 11 g)
שָׁקַר	<i>breach of faith, lie</i>
שָׁרַת	<i>Pi. to serve</i>
שָׁתָה	<i>Q. to drink</i>

ת

תְּהִלָּה	<i>glory, praise; song of praise</i>
תְּוֹךְ	<i>midst</i> (cs. st. תוֹךְ)
תוֹעֵבָה	<i>abomination, abhorrence</i>
תוֹרָה	<i>instruction</i>
תַּחַת	<i>under, beneath, instead of, in place of</i>
תָּקַע	<i>Q. to give a blow, blast; clap; drive in</i>

תָּמִיד	<i>continuously, always</i> (adv.), <i>continuity</i> (noun)
תָּמִים	<i>complete; without fault; perfect; impeccable; honest, devout</i> (adj.)
תָּמַם	<i>Q. to be complete, finished</i>
תַּפִּלָּה	<i>prayer</i>
תָּפַשׁ	<i>Q. to lay hold of, seize</i>
תְּרוּמָה	<i>contribution, offering</i>

Alphabetical List of Proper Nouns

The following list contains the proper nouns that are included in the exercises.

אַבִּיגַיִל	Abigail	אֵלִימֶלֶךְ	Elimelech
אַבִּימֶלֶךְ	Abimelech	אֵלִיעֶזֶר	Eliezer
אַבְיָתָר	Abiathar	אֵלִיאִים	Eliakim
אַבְנֵר	Abner	אֵלִישָׁע	Elisha
אַבְרָהָם	Abraham	אֵלְעָזָר	Eleazar
אַבְרָם	Abram	אָמוֹץ	Amoz
אַבְשָׁלוֹם	Absalom	אֲמִנֹן	see אֲמִנֹן
אָדָם	Adam	אֲמֹנֹן	Amnon
אֶדוֹם	Edom	אֶנוֹשׁ	Enosh
אֲדֹנִיָּהוּ	Adonija	אָסָא	Asa
אֶהוּד	Ehud	אֶסָפָה	Asaph
אַהֲרֹן	Aaron	אֶסְתֵּר	Esther
אוּרִיָּה	Uriah	אֶפְרַיִם	Ephraim
אֲזִיָּהוּ	Uzziah	אַרָם	Aram, Arameans
אַחָאָב	Ahab	אַשּׁוּר	Assyria, Assyrians
אַחִיָּז	Ahas	אַשֶׁר	Asher
אַחִיָּזְיָהוּ	Ahaziah	אַשְׁרָה	Asherah
אַחִיטוּב	Ahitub	בְּאֵר שֶׁבַע	Beersheba
אַחִיתֹפֶל	Ahithophel	בָּבֶל	Babylon, Babel
אַחִימֶלֶךְ	Ahimelech	בֵּית-אֵל	Bethel
אַחִינוֹאֵם	Ahinoam	בֵּית-חֹרֹן	Beth-horon
אִיּוֹב	Job	בֵּית לָחֶם	Bethlehem
אִיזָבֵל	Jezebel	בֵּית-עֶקֶד	Beth-eked
אַכִּישׁ	Achish	בֵּית-שֶׁמֶשׁ	Beth-shemesh
אֵלִיָּהוּ	Elijah		

Alphabetical List of Proper Nouns

בִּלְהָה	Bilhah	זִמְרִי	Zimri
בַּלְעָם	Balaam	חֶבְרוֹן	Hebron
בָּלָק	Balak	חַגִּי	Haggai
בֶּן־הַדָּד	Ben -hadad	חוּשִׁי	Hushai
בִּנְיָמִין	Benjamin	חֲזָאֵל	Hazael
בְּנֵיָהוּ	Benaiah	חֶזְקִיָּהוּ	Hezekiah
בּוֹאֵז	Boaz	חִירָם	Hiram
בַּעַל־פְּעוֹר	Baal-peor (name of a place and of a deity)	חִלְקִיָּהוּ	Hilkiah
בַּעֲשָׂא	Baasha	חֲנוּךְ	Hanoch
בָּרַק	Barak	חֲנַנְיָה	Hananaiah
בַּת־שֶׁבַע	Bathsheba	חֹפְנִי	Hophni
גָּד	Gad	חֹרֵב	Horeb
גִּדְעוֹן	Gideon	חָרָן	Haran
גִּלְגָּל	Gilgal	יֹאשִׁיָּהוּ	Josiah
גִּלְיָת	Goliath	יָבִישׁ־גִּלְעָד	Jabesh-gilead
גִּלְעָד	Gilead	יֵהוּא	Jehu
גָּאֵל	Gaal	יְהוֹאָחָז	Jehoahaz
גֹּשֶׁן	Goshen	יְהוֹאָשׁ	Jehoash
גָּת	Gath	יְהוּדָה	Judah
דָּוִד	David	יְהוֹיָדָע	Jehoiada
דַּמָּשְׁקַי	Damascus	יְהוֹיָאִימ	Jehoiakim
דָּן	Dan	יוֹנָתָן	Jonathan
הָבֵל	Abel	יְהוֹרָם	Joram
הָגָר	Hagar	יְהוֹשֻׁעַ	Joshua
הוֹשֵׁעַ	Hosea	יְהוֹשָׁפָט	Josaphat
זְבֻלֹן	Zebulun	יֹאָב	Joab
זֶבַח	Zebah	יֹאָשׁ	Joash
זֶבֻל	Zebul	יוֹסֵף	Joseph
זִיפְ	Ziph	יֹרָם	Joram
זִלְפָּה	Zilpah	יַעֲקֹב	Jacob
		יֶפְנֶה	Jephunneh

יָפֶת	Japhet	מִצְפָּה	Mizpah
יִפְתָּח	Jephthah	מִצְרַיִם	Egypt
יִצְחָק	Isaac	מִרְיָם	Miriam
יֵרֻבְעֵל	Jerubbaal	מֹשֶׁה	Moses
יֵרֹבָעַם	Jeroboam	נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר	Nebuchadnezzar
יַרְדֵּן	Jordan	נָבוֹת	Naboth
יְרוּשָׁלַם	Jerusalem	נוֹן	Nun
יְרִיחוֹ	Jericho	נָחוֹר	Nahor
יֵרֵמְיָהוּ	Jeremiah	נְחֵמְיָה	Nehemiah
יִשְׂרָאֵל	Israel	נָחָשׁ	Nahash
יֵשִׁי	Jesse	נֶכֶחַ	Neco
יִשְׁמָעֵאל	Ishmael	נַעֲמִי	Naomi (Hebrew <i>na'omi</i>)
יִשְׁעִיָּהוּ	Isaiah	נַעֲמָן	Naaman
כָּלֵב	Caleb	נַפְתָּלִי	Naphtali
כִּלְיוֹן	Chilion	נֵר	Ner
כְּנָעַן	Canaan	נָתָן	Nathan
כַּרְמֶל	Carmel	נֶתְנָאֵל	Nethanel
לֵאָה	Leah	סִיחֹן	Sihon
לָבָן	Laban	סִינַי	Sinai
לְבָנוֹן	Lebanon	סֻכּוֹת	Succoth
לוֹט	Lot	עֹבֵד עֲדָם	Obed-edom
לֵוִי	Levi	עָזָה	Gaza
לָמֶךְ	Lamech	עֲזֵקָה	Azekah
מֶגִּדּוֹ	Megiddo	עֲזַרְיָהוּ	Azariah
מִדְיָן	Midian	עֵי	Ai (almost always with the article)
מוֹאָב	Moab	עָכָן	Achan
מַחְלֹן	Mahlon	עֵלִי	Eli
מִיכְמָשׁ	Michmash	עֹמְרִי	Omri
מִלְכָּה	Milcah	עַמּוֹן	Ammon
מְנַחֵם	Menahem		
מִפְּיִבְשֶׁת	Mephibosheth		

Alphabetical List of Proper Nouns

עֹרְפָּה	Orpah	שָׂרָה	Sarah
עֵשָׂו	Esau	שָׂרַי	Sarai
פִּינְחָס	Pinehas	שָׂאֻל	Saul
פֶּקַח	Pekah	שֶׁבְנָא	Shebna
צָדוֹק	Zadok	שְׁלֹמֹה	Solomon
צִדְקִיָּהוּ	Zedekiah	שֵׁם	Shem
צִיּוֹן	Zion	שְׁמוּאֵל	Samuel
זַלְמוּנָא	Zalmunna	שִׁמְעוֹן	Simeon
זֹאֵר	Zoar	שִׁמְעִי	Shimei
קָדֵשׁ	Kadesh	שְׁמַעְיָה	Shemaiah
קָדֵשׁ בְּרִנֵּה	Kadesh-barnea	שָׁמְרוֹן	Samaria
קַיִן	Cain	שַׁמְשׁוֹן	Samson
קִישׁוֹן	Kishon	שָׁפָן	Shaphan
רְאוּבֵן	Reuben	שִׁישַׁק	Shishak
רֶבֶקָה	Rebekah	שֵׁת	Seth
רוּת	Ruth	תָּבוֹר	Tabor
רְחֹבָם	Rehoboam	תִּמְנָה	Timnah
רָחֵל	Rachel	תָּמָר	Tamar
רָמוֹת גִּלְעָד	Ramoth-gilead	תֶּקוּעַ	Tekoa